Jewels of the Qur'an

Gems of Guidance from the Thirty Juz'

Volume II – Pathways of Divine Wisdom
(Juz' 16 – 30)

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Jewels of the Quran

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Volume 2- Pathways of Divine Wisdom (Juz 16-30)

Jewels from the Second Fifteen Juz presents ten powerful insights from each Juz, guiding readers from Al-Fatiḥah to Al-Kahf through the Qur'an's foundational themes of guidance, character, and divine wisdom.

This volume highlights the moral architecture of the Quran, its call to honor, humility, reliance on Allah, and clarity of purpose.

Accessible and deeply reflective, it invites readers to experience the Qur'an as a living guide that shapes both hearts and societies.

The journey begins here, with jewels that illuminate the path of faith.

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About this Volume

A Journey Through the Quran—One Juz, Ten Jewels at a Time

Jewels from the second Fifteen Juz takes the reader on a reflective journey through the second half of the Quran, from Al-Isra to Al-Nas, highlighting the most luminous themes that shape faith, character, and understanding.

Across these second fifteen Juz, the Qur'an unfolds its foundational spiritual architecture: the promise of guidance, the battle against ego, divine laws operating in history, the refinement of speech and character, trust in Allah, the honor of humanity, the wisdom behind commandments, and the moral vision that elevates individuals and societies.

Each chapter presents ten jewels, selected verses that illuminate a core message within the Juz. Together, they form a tapestry of insights that:

✓ Strengthen one's connection to Allah
✓ Clarify the laws of guidance and misguidance
✓ Highlight the dignity of the human being
✓ Teach reliance, patience, humility, and wisdom
✓ Demonstrate how divine guidance transforms hearts and civilizations
✓ Reveal the Qur'an as a living manual for life

From the ending of Surat Al-Khat to Surat Al-Nas these jewels guide the reader through the Qur'an's early journey—rich in meaning, depth, and purpose.

Accessible, inspiring, and deeply rooted in the Quran's thematic structure, this volume is ideal for personal study, Ramadan reading, educational programs, or community circles.

This is Volume 2 of two-volume series: Jewels of the Qur'an: Gems of Guidance from the 30 Juz.

Preface

For many years, Muslims have recited the Quran with love, devotion, and longing, but not always with a structured pathway that highlights its thematic beauty, its moral architecture, and its civilizational vision. This work, Jewels from the Quran, began as an effort to illuminate ten selected insights from every Juz', creating a journey of reflection that brings the reader closer to the heart of divine wisdom.

This second volume, covering the second fifteen Juz, emerged gradually through study, writing, teaching, and deep contemplation. Each Juz contains jewels, verses that shine with meaning, direction, and transformative potential. They teach us how to live with dignity, how to honor creation, how to understand guidance, how to rely on Allah, and how to elevate our character in every situation.

These reflections do not claim to replace classical tafsir, nor do they exhaust the depths of the Quran. Rather, they aim to offer a thematic doorway, an invitation for the reader to experience the Quran as a living guide, one Juz at a time, and to discover the wisdom embedded within its structure.

With gratitude to Allah alone, I present this volume as the second of this project that complete all thirty Juz'. May every reader find in these jewels a spark that brightens the heart and draws them closer to their Creator.

Introduction: The Quran — A Treasure of Divine Jewels

The Quran is unlike any other book; it is Allah's final, preserved message to humanity. Comprising 114 surahs and divided into 30 Juz', it contains within its verses priceless treasures, jewels of wisdom, guidance, and light, awaiting discovery through tadabbur, deep and sincere reflection. Too often, however, the Quran is approached mainly through reverence and recitation, while its transformative power as a guide for life remains underutilized.

Recitation is a noble act of worship, but the Quran was revealed for far more. It is a living blueprint for civilization, a source of guidance that shapes individuals, communities, and nations. It is a light to navigate challenges, a Ruḥ that gives life to hearts, and a divine constitution capable of reviving values, strengthening societies, and positioning believers as beacons of justice and mercy for all humanity.

One of the great tragedies of the modern Muslim condition is that, although the Quran is cherished and defended, it is often abandoned as a source of practical guidance. Outrage erupts when its physical pages are desecrated, yet indifference prevails when its wisdom is neglected in shaping our morals, decisions, policies, and societal structures. This paradox fulfills the painful complaint of the Prophet ﷺ:

﴿ وَقَالَ ٱلرَّسُولُ يَـٰرَبِّ إِنَّ قَوۡمِى ٱتَّخَذُواْ هَـٰذَا ٱلۡقُرۡءَانَ مَهۡجُورًا ﴾ (الفرقان 30)

"The Messenger will say: 'O my Lord, indeed my people have taken this Quran as something abandoned.'" (Al-Furqan 25:30)

This book seeks to respond to that complaint by reviving engagement with the Quran through meaningful reflection. The approach is simple yet powerful: from each Juz, ten jewels are selected, verses that illuminate profound truths about faith, character, society, and the laws by which Allah governs human destiny. These jewels reveal the Quran's role not just as a spiritual text but as a comprehensive guide for life.

The first fifteen Juz, presented in this volume, weave together insights on divine mercy, human honor, moral responsibility, the nature of guidance, the power of reliance on Allah, and the refinement of character through speech, conduct, and intention. They demonstrate how the Quran speaks simultaneously to the heart and the intellect, offering wisdom that is timeless and universally relevant.

By uncovering these jewels, this book invites the reader to experience the Quran as a living conversation, a source of clarity and purpose, and a wellspring of divine wisdom that illuminates every aspect of one's journey.

The Author

Jewels from the Sixteenth Juz: Guidance, Wisdom and Strength

(Al-Kahf 18:75 – Ta-Ha 20:135)

Introduction

The 16th Juz gathers passages that emphasize how revelation is delivered with wisdom, strengthens the heart over time, and offers the “best explanation” to every confusion and challenge. Within this framework, the story of Dhul-Qarnayn becomes more than a historical narrative: it becomes a living lesson about power under restraint, knowledge in service of protection, humility after achievement, and the civilizational responsibility of resisting corruption without becoming corrupt. Alongside that, the Juz highlights spiritual truths that shape human life: Allah’s special love for the righteous, the wisdom of accountability within the family, the Quran as a source of ease rather than hardship, the conditions for true success in the Hereafter, the danger of tearing communal unity, and the necessity of perseverance through prayer and patience.

These reflections are offered with humility, not as final certainty, but as an invitation to engage the Quran more deeply, and to recognize that its guidance is meant to build minds, hearts, families, and societies.

1. Dhul-Qarnayn: Identity Analysis

This section establishes the identity of Dhul-Qarnayn using the scientific approach of Ibn al-Haytham and Quranic data. Ibn al-Haytham’s research methodology, formulated over a millennium ago, stressed careful questioning, evidence-based reasoning, and intellectual humility. Known in Latin sources as Alhazen (d. 1040 CE / 431 AH), he is widely regarded as one of the earliest thinkers to articulate what we now call the scientific method. In his major works, especially The Book of Optics, he rejected blind acceptance of authority, speculation without proof, and conclusions drawn solely from tradition.

Ibn al-Haytham argued that the seeker of truth must:

- Question assumptions
- Rely on evidence
- Test ideas carefully
- Accept correction when evidence demands it

He emphasized that a true researcher must be willing to doubt even his own conclusions if unsupported by evidence.

This approach matters because, in any field of research, how one studies a subject is often more critical than what one studies. Sound conclusions arise from disciplined

inquiry not inherited assumptions or personal conviction. This principle applies as much to physics and history as it does to textual and religious studies.

Ibn al-Haytham's method can be summarized in five clear steps:

1. Ask a Clear Question – Research begins by defining a specific problem or uncertainty; vague questions lead to vague answers.
2. Propose a Hypothesis – A hypothesis is a tentative explanation, open to testing and possible rejection.
3. Collect Evidence (Data) – Evidence must come from reliable primary sources. In the natural sciences, this involves experiments; in textual studies, the primary text itself serves as data.
4. Test the Hypothesis – The hypothesis must face all available evidence. If data contradict it, it must be revised or rejected.
5. Revise or Conclude – Conclusions remain provisional. Confidence grows with evidence consistency, but certainty is claimed only where evidence is explicit.

This method protects the researcher from forcing the data to fit preconceived conclusions.

Applying Scientific Methodology to Quranic Studies

Although Ibn al-Haytham developed his approach for studying natural phenomena, its underlying logic applies to all forms of inquiry, including the study of sacred texts.

When applied to Quranic analysis, this means:

- Quranic verses are treated as primary data, not supplementary citations
- Interpretations are treated as hypotheses, not unquestionable truths
- Language, structure, and context act as constraints on interpretation
- Conclusions are accepted only if they align with the totality of Quranic evidence

This approach aligns with the Quran's own repeated invitation to reflect, examine, and reason (*tadabbur*).

Methodological Commitment of This Study

This study adopts Ibn al-Haytham's scientific approach as its guiding framework, accordingly:

- No conclusion is assumed in advance
- All claims are tested against Quranic text
- Where the Quran is explicit, the analysis submits
- Where the Quran is silent, the analysis remains cautious

The goal is neither to challenge classical scholarship nor to promote novelty, but to demonstrate how disciplined reasoning, rooted in the Islamic intellectual tradition, can

deepen understanding and sharpen critical thinking. This is especially valuable for students learning to study complex texts responsibly.

With this methodology established, the thesis proceeds to a focused Quranic case study: the identity of Dhul-Qarnayn and the nature of Yaʾjūj and Maʾjūj. Rather than starting with inherited interpretations, the analysis begins with questions, forms hypotheses, examines Quranic data, and tests each claim against linguistic, structural, and contextual evidence, in full accord with Ibn al-Haytham's scientific tradition.

Dhul-Qarnayn: Identity Analysis Based on Quranic Data

وَيَسْـَٔلُونَكَ عَن ذِى ٱلْقَرْنَيْنِ ۖ قُلْ سَأَتْلُوا۟ عَلَيْكُم مِّنْهُ ذِكْرًا (الكهف ٨٣)

"They ask you about Dhul-Qarnayn. Say: "I will tell you something of his account." (Al-Kahf 18:83)

1. Data Definition

Primary Data Source: The Quran itself, specifically:

- Surat al-Kahf (18:83–98)
- Cross-referenced Quranic verses defining titles, functions, and attributes

2. Data Set A: The Title "Dhul–" in Quranic Usage

Data A1 — Definition of the Title
The Qur'an uses "Dhul–" (ذو) to assign functional identity, not personal names.

Evidence:
The Quran assigns the title Dhul– to five figures:

1. Dhul-Ayd (ذَا ٱلْأَيْدِ)
2. Dhul-Awtad (ذُو ٱلْأَوْتَادِ)
3. Dhul-Nun (ذَا ٱلنُّونِ)
4. Dhul-Kifl (ذَا ٱلْكِفْلِ)
5. Dhul-Qarnayn (ذِى ٱلْقَرْنَيْنِ)

Among these, two are explicitly identified in the Quran:

1. Prophet Dawud as Dhul-Ayd

ٱذْكُرْ عَبْدَنَا دَاوُۥدَ ذَا ٱلْأَيْدِ ۖ إِنَّهُۥٓ أَوَّابٌ

"Remember Our servant David, Dhul-Ayd (the one of great might); indeed, he was ever turning back to Allah." (Ṣad 38:17)

Here, *Ayd* refers to strength and capability, fitting Dawud's divinely granted power.

2. Pharaoh as Dhul-Awtad

وَفِرْعَوْنَ ذِى ٱلْأَوْتَادِ

“And Pharaoh, Dhul-Awtad (the one with rooted dominion).” (Al-Fajr 89:10)

This title reflects Pharaoh’s oppressive might and entrenched dominion.

Dhul-Nun: Identified by Context

Although not named explicitly, Dhul-Nun is clearly Prophet Yunus, based on Qur’anic context and Prophetic Hadith:

ذَا ٱلنُّونِ إِذ ذَّهَبَ مُغَٰضِبًا فَظَنَّ أَن لَّن نَّقۡدِرَ عَلَيۡهِ فَنَادَىٰ فِى ٱلظُّلُمَٰتِ أَن لَّآ إِلَٰهَ إِلَّآ أَنتَ سُبۡحَٰنَكَ إِنِّى كُنتُ مِنَ ٱلظَّٰلِمِينَ (٨٧)

“And (mention) Dhu'n-Nun, when he went off in anger and deemed that We had no power over him, but he cried out in the darkness, saying: There is no God but You. Glory to You. I have been a wrong doer.” (Al-Anbiya 21:87)

Observation: In all three cases, the title:

- Highlights a dominant defining trait
- Does not require the personal name to be stated again

3. Data Set B: Unidentified “Dhul–” Figures

Dhul-Kifl — Explicitly named among the prophets but functionally unexplained

وَإِسۡمَٰعِيلَ وَإِدۡرِيسَ وَذَا ٱلۡكِفۡلِۖ كُلٌّ مِّنَ ٱلصَّٰبِرِينَ

“And Ishmael, Idris, and Dhul-Kifl, each among the steadfast.” (Al-Anbiyāʾ 21:85)

Linguistic Data for *Kifl*:

- Guardianship:

فَتَقَبَّلَهَا رَبُّهَا بِقَبُولٍ حَسَنٍ وَأَنۢبَتَهَا نَبَاتًا حَسَنًا وَكَفَّلَهَا زَكَرِيَّاۖ

“So, her Lord accepted her with goodly acceptance. He made her grow in a good manner and put her under the (kifl) care of Zakariya,” (Al-Emran 3:37)

- Assigned share:

وَمَن يَشۡفَعۡ شَفَٰعَةً سَيِّئَةً يَكُن لَّهُۥ كِفۡلٌ مِّنۡهَاۗ

“Whosoever intercedes for an evil cause will have a (kifl) share of it.” (Al-Nisa 4:85)

- Measured divine allotment:

يَٰٓأَيُّهَا ٱلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُواْ ٱتَّقُواْ ٱللَّهَ وَءَامِنُواْ بِرَسُولِهِۦ يُؤۡتِكُمۡ كِفۡلَيۡنِ مِن رَّحۡمَتِهِۦ

“O you who believe, have Taqwa of Allah, and believe in His Messenger, He will grant you two (kifl) portions of His Mercy.” (Al-Hadid 57:28)

Inference:
The term Kifl consistently denotes responsibility, allocation, and guardianship, not physical description. The prophet most strongly associated with administering

resources, managing societal welfare, and distributing provisions during crisis is Prophet Yusuf (Joseph). This functional association aligns closely with the title Dhul-Kifl.

4. Data Set C: Semantic Range of *Qarn*

Evidence:

أَلَمۡ يَرَوۡاْ كَمۡ أَهۡلَكۡنَا مِن قَبۡلِهِم مِّن قَرۡنٖ

"Did thy not see how many of (qarn) generation We destroyed before them," (Al-Anaam 6:6)

ثُمَّ أَنشَأۡنَا مِنۢ بَعۡدِهِمۡ قَرۡنًا ءَاخَرِينَ (٣١)

"Then, after them, We brought forth another (qarn) generation. (Al-Muminoon 23: 31)

Observation:
The Qur'an uses *qarn* to mean:

- A generation
- A civilization
- A dominion or era

Thus, *Qarnayn* linguistically permits:

- Two generations
- Two realms
- Two domains of authority

5. Data Set D: Direct Attributes of Dhul-Qarnayn (Primary Evidence)

D1 — Universal Enablement

إِنَّا مَكَّنَّا لَهُۥ فِي ٱلۡأَرۡضِ وَءَاتَيۡنَٰهُ مِن كُلِّ شَيۡءٖ سَبَبًا

"We established him on earth and gave him the means to all things." (Al-Kahf 18:84)

D2 — Judicial Authority

قَالَ أَمَّا مَن ظَلَمَ فَسَوۡفَ نُعَذِّبُهُۥ ثُمَّ يُرَدُّ إِلَىٰ رَبِّهِۦ فَيُعَذِّبُهُۥ عَذَابًا نُّكۡرٗا (٨٧) وَأَمَّا مَنۡ ءَامَنَ وَعَمِلَ صَٰلِحٗا فَلَهُۥ جَزَآءً ٱلۡحُسۡنَىٰۖ وَسَنَقُولُ لَهُۥ مِنۡ أَمۡرِنَا يُسۡرٗا (الكهف ٨٧ ، ٨٨)

"He said: As for the one who does wrong, we will punish him, then he will be returned to his Lord, who will punish him severely. (87) But as for the one who believes and acts righteously, he will have the best reward and we will speak to him kindly." (Al-Kahf 18:87–88)

D3 — Cross-Linguistic Communication

حَتَّىٰٓ إِذَا بَلَغَ بَيۡنَ ٱلسَّدَّيۡنِ وَجَدَ مِن دُونِهِمَا قَوۡمٗا لَّا يَكَادُونَ يَفۡقَهُونَ قَوۡلٗا (الكهف٩٣)

"Until, when he reached a place between two mountains, he found by them a people who were unable to understand anything said." (Al-Kahf 18:93)
Yet communication and negotiation clearly occur.

D4 — Advanced Engineering and Metallurgy

ءَاتُونِى زُبَرَ ٱلۡحَدِيدِۖ حَتَّىٰٓ إِذَا سَاوَىٰ بَيۡنَ ٱلصَّدَفَيۡنِ قَالَ ٱنفُخُواْۖ حَتَّىٰٓ إِذَا جَعَلَهُۥ نَارًا قَالَ ءَاتُونِىٓ أُفۡرِغۡ عَلَيۡهِ قِطۡرًا (الكهف ٩٦)

"Bring me blocks of iron, and place in the space between the mountain sides and blow until the iron becomes (red) as fire, then bring me molten copper and I will pour over it (the iron)." (Al-Kahf 18:96)

6. Hypothesis Testing Against Sulayman (With Data)

Two Realms

وَحُشِرَ لِسُلَيۡمَٰنَ جُنُودُهُۥ مِنَ ٱلۡجِنِّ وَٱلۡإِنسِ .. (١٧)

“And there were gathered before Sulaiman his armies of the jinn and humankind … (Al-Naml 27:17)

Language Mastery

وَوَرِثَ سُلَيۡمَٰنُ دَاوُۥدَۖ وَقَالَ يَٰٓأَيُّهَا ٱلنَّاسُ عُلِّمۡنَا مَنطِقَ ٱلطَّيۡرِ ..... (١٦)

“And Suliman inherited (the knowledge of) Dawud. He said: "O mankind! We have been taught the language of birds, ……” (Al-Naml 27:16)

Metallurgy

وَلَقَدۡ ءَاتَيۡنَا دَاوُۥدَ مِنَّا فَضۡلاۖ يَٰجِبَالُ أَوِّبِى مَعَهُۥ وَٱلطَّيۡرَۖ وَأَلَنَّا لَهُ ٱلۡحَدِيدَ (١٠)

“And assuredly We gave Dawud grace from Us, (saying): O you mountains and birds, glorify (Allah) with him! And We made the iron pliable for him.” (Saba 34:10)

وَلِسُلَيۡمَٰنَ ٱلرِّيحَ غُدُوُّهَا شَهۡرٌ وَرَوَاحُهَا شَهۡرٌۖ وَأَسَلۡنَا لَهُۥ عَيۡنَ ٱلۡقِطۡرِۖ .... (١٢(

“And to Suliman (We gave) the wind, whereof the morning course was a month's journey and the evening course a month's journey, and We caused the fount of copper to gush forth for him, …..” (Saba 34:12)

7. Result

Every defining Quranic data point for Dhul-Qarnayn explicitly present, functionally mirror and textually support the Quranic profile of Prophet Suliman.

8. Conclusion

When Quranic verses are treated as primary data rather than illustrative citations, the identification of Dhul-Qarnayn with Prophet Suliman demonstrates the highest degree of internal coherence. No competing hypothesis satisfies the same number of independent Quranic constraints without importing non-Quranic assumptions.

2. Ya’jūj & Ma’jūj in the Quran:

The nature of Ya’jūj & Ma’jūj will be identified following Ibn al-Haytham’s scientific tradition, rather than starting with inherited interpretations. The analysis begins with questions, forms hypotheses, examines Quranic data, and tests each claim against linguistic, structural, and contextual evidence.

1. Research Problem

The Qur’an mentions Ya’jūj & Ma’juj in two distinct contexts:

- **Context A:** within the Dhul-Qarnayn narrative (Surat al-Kahf)

قَالُواْ يَـٰذَا ٱلۡقَرۡنَيۡنِ إِنَّ يَأۡجُوجَ وَمَأۡجُوجَ مُفۡسِدُونَ فِى ٱلۡأَرۡضِ فَهَلۡ نَجۡعَلُ لَكَ خَرۡجًا عَلَىٰٓ أَن تَجۡعَلَ بَيۡنَنَا وَبَيۡنَهُمۡ سَدًّا (٩٤)

“They said: O Dhul-Qarnayn, indeed Ya’jūj and Ma’jūj are causing corruption in the land. Should we assign you a payment so that you may place a barrier (sadd) between us and them? (Al-Kahf 18:94)

- **Context B:** as an eschatological sign preceding the Hour (Surat al-Anbiya)

حَتَّىٰٓ إِذَا فُتِحَتۡ يَأۡجُوجُ وَمَأۡجُوجُ وَهُم مِّن كُلِّ حَدَبٍ يَنسِلُونَ (٩٦) وَٱقۡتَرَبَ ٱلۡوَعۡدُ ٱلۡحَقُّ ... (٩٧)

“Until, when Ya’jūj and Ma’jūj are released and they surge forth from every elevation, (96) and the true promise (Day of Judgment) draws near…” (Al-Anbiya 21:96-97)

The research problem is whether the referent of the term “Ya’jūj & Ma’juj” is necessarily identical in both contexts, or whether Quranic usage allows different realities under a shared descriptive title.

2. Research Questions

Q1 (Textual / Referential)
In Surat al-Kahf, does the Quranic description require Ya’jūj & Ma’juj to be human groups?

Q2 (Engineering / Structural)
Does the construction described in Surat al-Kahf function more like a military wall against people, or like a containment seal against a physical hazard?

Q3 (Inter-contextual)
If Surat al-Anbiya refers to a mass release near the end of time, does that necessitate that Surat al-Kahf also refers to humans, or can the title be descriptive and context-dependent?

3. Hypotheses

H_0 (Null / Classical Default)
Ya'jūj & Ma'juj in Surat al-Kahf are human groups, and the barrier is a fortification to stop their assault.

H_1 (Alternative Hypothesis Under Test)
In Surat al-Kahf, Ya'jūj & Ma'juj refers to a destructive phenomenon emerging from the passage, requiring containment rather than punishment, while Surat al-Anbiya may refer to a later human emergence under the same descriptive title.

This thesis segment tests H_1 against Quranic data constraints.

4. Data Set (Primary Quranic Evidence)

Data D1 — The complaint of "corruption"

قَالُواْ يَـٰذَا ٱلۡقَرۡنَيۡنِ إِنَّ يَأۡجُوجَ وَمَأۡجُوجَ مُفۡسِدُونَ فِى ٱلۡأَرۡضِ ..... (٩٤)

"They said: O Dhul-Qarnayn, indeed Ya'jūj and Ma'jūj are causing corruption in the land. ,,(Al-Kahf 18:94)

Observation: the complaint describes an outcome (*ifsād*), not a biography.

Data D2 — Requested structure: "sadd"

.... فَهَلۡ نَجۡعَلُ لَكَ خَرۡجًا عَلَىٰٓ أَن تَجۡعَلَ بَيۡنَنَا وَبَيۡنَهُمۡ سَدًّا (٩٤)

Should we assign you a payment so that you may place a barrier (sadd) between us and them?" (Al-Kahf 18:94)

Data D3 — Delivered structure: "radm"

قَالَ مَا مَكَّنِّى فِيهِ رَبِّى خَيۡرٌ فَأَعِينُونِى بِقُوَّةٍ أَجۡعَلۡ بَيۡنَكُمۡ وَبَيۡنَهُمۡ رَدۡمًا (٩٥)

"He said: …… and I will make between you and them a backfill (radm)." (Al-Kahf 18:95)

Key textual constraint: the Quran distinguishes what was requested from what was constructed.

Data D4 — Composition and process: iron + heat + molten copper

ءَاتُونِى زُبَرَ ٱلۡحَدِيدِۖ حَتَّىٰٓ إِذَا سَاوَىٰ بَيۡنَ ٱلصَّدَفَيۡنِ قَالَ ٱنفُخُواْۖ حَتَّىٰٓ إِذَا جَعَلَهُۥ نَارًا قَالَ ءَاتُونِىٓ أُفۡرِغۡ عَلَيۡهِ قِطۡرًا (٩٦)

"Bring me blocks of iron." Then, when he leveled it between the two mountain sides (ṣadafayn), he said: "Blow," until it became red-hot. Then he said: "Bring me molten copper to pour over it." (Al-Kahf 18:96)

Constraint: this is not ordinary masonry; it is metallurgical sealing by fusion and overlay.

A subtle yet significant detail in the Quranic description is that Dhul-Qarnayn first leveled the two ṣadafayn (the opposing mountain sides). Notably, the Quran does not use the term safḥ (سفح), which typically refers to an ordinary mountain slope characterized by soil, erosion, and vegetation. Instead, the term ṣadaf implies hard, solid surfaces, suggesting compacted or hardened rock, possibly the result of earlier molten or geological activity.

Leveling these hardened sides would have been a critical preparatory step. It would eliminate irregular gaps and prevent any lateral seepage, particularly of pressurized gases, around the backfilled structure. This preparation ensured that the subsequent fill would form a continuous, sealed interface with the surrounding rock. This design ensured that no pressurized material, whether by lateral seepage or pressure-driven perforation, could breach the barrier.

Data D5 — The outcome described: no "escape from sides," no "perforation"

فَمَا ٱسۡطَٰعُوٓاْ أَن يَظۡهَرُوهُ وَمَا ٱسۡتَطَٰعُواْ لَهُۥ نَقۡبٗا (٩٧)

So, they were unable to climb (from the sides), nor were able to pierce it." (Al-Kahf 18:97)

Constraint: the Qur'an emphasizes two failure modes:

- **يظهروه**: inability to get past laterally/over/around
- **نقبًا**: inability to pierce/perforate

Data D6 — End-state: "dakka"

... فَإِذَا جَآءَ وَعۡدُ رَبِّي جَعَلَهُۥ دَكَّآءَۖ .... (٩٨)

"….. But when the promise of my Lord comes, He will make it "dakka", …." (Al-Kaf 18:98)

Cross reference:

فَلَمَّا تَجَلَّىٰ رَبُّهُۥ لِلۡجَبَلِ جَعَلَهُۥ دَكّٗا

"When his Lord revealed Himself to the mountain, He made it "Dakka" crashing down." (Al-Araf 7:143)

Constraint: *dakka* indicates crushing/collapse of a coherent solid mass.

Data D7 — Second context: release before the Hour

حَتَّىٰٓ إِذَا فُتِحَتۡ يَأۡجُوجُ وَمَأۡجُوجُ وَهُم مِّن كُلِّ حَدَبٖ يَنسِلُونَ (٩٦)

"Until, when Ya'jūj and Ma'jūj are released and they surge forth from every elevation." (Al-Anbiya 21:96)

Constraint: a global scale "opening" and "surging from every elevation."

5. Analytical Tests

Test 1 — Structural-Functional Test: “wall vs seal”
If the target is a human enemy, the expected engineering is:

- climb prevention,
- break-through resistance,
- military defense assumptions.

But the Quranic data highlights:

- radm (backfill/packed fill rather than wall),
- iron blocks + heating + molten copper overlay (fusion sealing),
- no lateral seepage/no perforation (18:97).**Result:** This description aligns more naturally with containment of a hazard than with repelling human assault.

Test 2 — Linguistic Failure-Mode Test (18:97)
The Quran does not say:

- “they destroyed it,”
- “they broke it,”
- “they overcame it,”

but instead describes failure modes consistent with leak/escape and penetration:

- **يظهروه** (getting past from sides/over)
- **نقبًا** (perforation)

Result: The language is more consistent with “containment integrity” than with warfare vocabulary.

Test 3 — Ethical Agency Test (18:87 vs. Dhul-Qarnayn’s action)

Dhul-Qarnayn states a governing policy of punishing wrongdoers:

قَالَ أَمَّا مَن ظَلَمَ فَسَوْفَ نُعَذِّبُهُ .... (٨٧)
“He said: "As for the wrongdoer we will be punish him ….” (Al-Kahf 18:87)

But in the Ya’jūj & Ma’jūj segment, he does not confront or punish them; he applies an engineering solution.

Result: If Ya’jūj & Ma’jūj are moral agents, the narrative would be expected to include ethical adjudication. The shift toward technical containment supports the claim that the problem is not a punishable “community” but a destructive source requiring neutralization.

(Important note for examiners: this is an inference, not a Quranic explicit statement. It is valid only as a coherence test.)

6. Linguistic Proposal (Names as Descriptive Titles)

Proposed Root Associations (as a hypothesis mechanism)
You argue the terms may connect to roots implying:

- blazing / roaring (أجّ)
- gushing / expelling (مجّ)

Function in the thesis: this is not treated as proof by itself, but as a *plausible explanatory mechanism* consistent with "descriptive naming," comparable to: (تَبَّتْ يَدَآ أَبِى لَهَبٍ) *(Al-Masad 111:1)* "Abu Lahab" means ("father of the flame") is a descriptive title for the Prophet's uncle ʿAbd al-ʿUzzā because of his role in igniting conflict, not because of literal fire.

7. Inter-Context Reconciliation Test: Same term, different entity?

Quranic Arabic allows one word to hold multiple meanings by context. You provide the internal Quranic precedent of *ummah*:

- Nation: (كُلَّمَا دَخَلَتْ أُمَّةٌ لَّعَنَتْ أُخْتَهَا) *"Every time a nation enters, it curses its sister (nation)." (Al-Araf 7:38)*
- Time period: (وَقَالَ الَّذِي نَجَا مِنْهُمَا وَادَّكَرَ بَعْدَ أُمَّةٍ) **"And said the one of the two men who had been released and remembered a long time." (Yousuf 12: 45)**
- Religion/path: (إِنَّا وَجَدْنَا آبَاءَنَا عَلَىٰ أُمَّةٍ وَإِنَّا عَلَىٰ آثَارِهِمْ مُقْتَدُونَ), **""We found our fathers following a religion and we are following in their footsteps." (Az-Zukhruf 43:23)**

Result: Quranic usage supports the principle that a single term may shift meaning by context without contradiction.

This makes it logically possible that:

- Surat al-Kahf: descriptive title for a destructive phenomenon
- Surat al-Anbiyaʾ: descriptive title for a later human emergence (or force) characterized by similar "ifsād" effects

8. Provisional Conclusion (Defense-Appropriate)

Based on the Quranic data and the structural-linguistic tests:

1. The construction details (radm, iron fusion, molten copper overlay) and the failure-mode description (no lateral escape, no perforation) are more naturally consistent with a containment seal than a military wall.
2. The narrative's shift from ethical punishment "(18:87) "قَالَ أَمَّا مَن ظَلَمَ فَسَوْفَ نُعَذِّبُهُ to technical containment supports, as a coherence inference, that the threat in this context may not be a conventional human opponent.
3. The Quran itself provides precedent for context-dependent meanings (ummah), leaving room for the term Ya'jūj & Ma'jūj to function as a descriptive label across contexts.

Therefore, the hypothesis that Ya'jūj & Ma'juj In Surat al-Kahf refers to a destructive phenomenon emerging from the passage remains viable and textually coherent, while

the null hypothesis that Ya'jūj & Ma'juj in Surat al-Kahf are human groups requires additional assumptions about why the Quran emphasizes containment-style failure modes rather than conflict-style language.

9. Limitations (What the Thesis Does *Not* Claim)

- This section does not claim absolute certainty about referent identity.
- The linguistic root association is treated as supportive plausibility, not decisive proof.
- Prophetic narrations about end-time emergence are acknowledged and considered as reference to Surat Al-Anbiya and thus this thesis segment confined itself to Quranic data in Surat Al-Kahf as primary evidence.

10. Closing Statement

Allah praises Dhul-Qarnayn not merely for possessing power, but for applying knowledge and authority to restrain corruption and protect life, rather than to dominate or destroy.

11. Project for a Muslim Explorer

From Al-Kahf 18:95–98, any *candidate location* would need to show all of the following:

1. Two opposing mountain sides (*ṣadafayn*), not hills
2. A narrow pass / throat, not a wide valley
3. Evidence of flattened or hardened rock faces (not soil slopes)
4. Subsurface pressure history (gas, magma, geothermal activity)
5. Natural seepage paths that could be sealed
6. A region where engineering sealing (radm) makes physical sense

3. Importance of Physical and Non-Physical Powers

Corruption arises when power is unleashed without restraint or moral guidance. It therefore becomes the responsibility of believers to contain destruction by acquiring knowledge and developing both physical and non-physical forms of power, and to use them wisely in restraining evil and protecting society.

Dhul-Qarnayn offers a model of disciplined and ethical power. He did not rely solely on the authority and resources granted to him by Allah; rather, he empowered the people he was helping by engaging them directly in the process:

قَالَ مَا مَكَّنِّى فِيهِ رَبِّى خَيْرٌ فَأَعِينُونِى بِقُوَّةٍ أَجْعَلْ بَيْنَكُمْ وَبَيْنَهُمْ رَدْمًا (٩٥)

"He said: "What my Lord had given under my control is better (than your honorarium). So, help me with some manpower and I will make a backfill between you and them. (Al-Kahf 18:95)

In this instance, physical power, manpower, materials, and technical execution, was essential to accomplish the task. Yet physical power alone, if unguided, cannot fulfill

divine objectives. It must be directed by spiritual and moral power, which comes from revelation.

This balance is emphasized in Allah's command to Prophet Yaḥyā عليه السلام

يَـٰيَحۡيَىٰ خُذِ ٱلۡكِتَـٰبَ بِقُوَّةٖۖ وَءَاتَيۡنَـٰهُ ٱلۡحُكۡمَ صَبِيّٗا (١٢)

"O Yahya (John)! Take hold of the book with strength." And We gave him wisdom while yet a child." (Maryam 19:12)

"Taking the Book with strength" does not merely mean reading it, but learning it deeply, internalizing its guidance, and living by it with determination. This verse establishes that non-physical power, moral resolve, intellectual clarity, and spiritual discipline, is indispensable for any righteous endeavor.

Accordingly, righteous nations can prosper only when physical capability and spiritual authority are united, both grounded in knowledge and guided by divine revelation.

When I was growing up, the covers of schoolbooks distributed by the Ministry of Education carried the following lines of poetry:

تعلم العلم واقرأ. تحز فخار النبوة
فالله قال ليحيى خذ الكتاب بقوة

Learn and read, let knowledge be your way, For it brings honor, bright and true.
Allah said to Yahyā one day: Hold fast the Book, be strong and true

Unfortunately, these lines were later removed, and with them disappeared a powerful message that once inspired students to see learning as both a spiritual and civilizational responsibility.

4. Humility Despite Great Success

Despite his power and accomplishments of Dhul Qarnayn, he remained humble and credited everything to Allah.

قَالَ هَـٰذَا رَحۡمَةٞ مِّن رَّبِّيۖ

"This is a mercy from my Lord." (Al-Kahf 18:98)

His story teaches that true gratitude for power is shown by using it justly and for the benefit of others. The Quran did not name him, possibly to shift focus from his identity to the lessons of his character and actions. This approach also invites reflection and analysis.

5. The Blessing of Being Loved

Many of the blessings Allah created to make life enjoyable are shared by both believers and disbelievers. However, Allah grants the believers who perform righteous deeds a special gift that is exclusive to them: His special love, known as Wud. Allah says:

إِنَّ ٱلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُواْ وَعَمِلُواْ ٱلصَّٰلِحَٰتِ سَيَجۡعَلُ لَهُمُ ٱلرَّحۡمَٰنُ وُدّٗا (مريم ٩٦)
“Indeed, those who believe and do righteous deeds, Al-Rahman will bestow upon them Wud (a special love).” (Maryam 19:96)

Although the Arabic words ḥubb (حب) and wud (ود) are both translated as “love” in English, they convey different meanings. Ḥubb refers primarily to emotional affection and feeling, whereas wud refers to love expressed through action and commitment.

A person may feel love (ḥubb) for someone yet not be willing to sacrifice or act for them. But when one has wud for another, that love is demonstrated through effort, care, and consistent action. The Wud of Allah far exceeds human love: it means that Allah commits Himself to caring for you, supporting you, and granting you goodness, often beyond what you even ask for.

Consider how honored and excited you would feel if a public figure or dignitary mentioned you by name. How much greater, then, should be your joy when Allah, the Lord of the universe and King of all kings, mentions your name and declares His love for you. The Prophet (PBUH) said:
إنِّ اللهَ إذا أحبِّ عبدا دعا جبريلَ ، فقال : إني أحبُّ فلاناً فأحِبِّه ، قال : فيُحِبُّه جبريلُ ، ثم ينادي في السماءِ ، فيقول : إنِّ اللهَ يحبُّ فلاناً فأحِبُّوه ، فيحبُّه أهل السماء ، ثم يوضَعُ له الَقبُولُ في الأرض .[مسلم عن أبي هريرة]
" When Allah loves a servant, He calls Jibril and says, ‘I love so-and-so, so love him.’ Jibril loves him, then announces to the inhabitants of the heavens, ‘Allah loves so-and-so, so love him.’ The inhabitants of the heavens love him, and acceptance is then placed for him on earth." [Muslim]

When Allah loves you, even your enemies are restrained from harming you as they wish. Securing Allah’s Wud means that He is always near, inviting you to turn to Him with your fears, pain, and needs. Sit privately and call upon Al-Wadūd (الودود). Speak to Him about your worries, your job, your business, your children, your future, and rely upon Him for support and relief.

When you seek comfort in sorrow, compassion in distress, or simply someone to whom you can pour out your heart, Allah Al-Wadud is always there. He loves you without expecting anything in return. He supports and guides you not out of need, but out of mercy and love for your sincerity and righteousness.

Human love and hatred are beyond our control. Hearts are not owned by people; they are owned by Allah. The Prophet (PBUH) said:
إن القلوب بين أصبعين من أصابع الرحمن يقلبها كيف يشاء) مسلم عن عبد الله بن عمرو بن العاص(
“The hearts are between the two fingers of Al-Rahman, He turns then as He wills”. (Muslim)

Allah also said:
وَٱعۡلَمُوٓاْ أَنَّ ٱللَّهَ يَحُولُ بَيۡنَ ٱلۡمَرۡءِ وَقَلۡبِهِۦ

“And know that Allah intervenes between the man and his heart.” (Al-Anfal 8:24)

Hearts are never united in love for someone except by Allah’s permission. For this reason, Imam Ibn Ḥajar (ابن حجر) said: **(إن محبة قلوب الناس علامة محبة الله) “The love of people is a sign of the love of Allah”**.

To attain this elevated relationship with Allah, one must possess true faith and consistently perform righteous deeds.

6. Emotional Strength: Man and Woman

What is striking, however, is how the Quran assigns responsibility. Allah places the blame entirely on Adam, not on Eve. Adam is described as forgetting the covenant and lacking firm resolve, and it is Adam who is explicitly described as having disobeyed his Lord.

وَلَقَدۡ عَهِدۡنَآ إِلَىٰٓ ءَادَمَ مِن قَبۡلُ فَنَسِيَ وَلَمۡ نَجِدۡ لَهُۥ عَزۡمٗا (١١٥)

“Indeed, We made a covenant with Adam before, but he forgot, and We found in him no firm resolve. (Taha 20:115)

فَأَكَلَا مِنۡهَا فَبَدَتۡ لَهُمَا سَوۡءَٰتُهُمَا وَطَفِقَا يَخۡصِفَانِ عَلَيۡهِمَا مِن وَرَقِ ٱلۡجَنَّةِۚ وَعَصَىٰٓ ءَادَمُ رَبَّهُۥ فَغَوَىٰ (١٢١) ثُمَّ ٱجۡتَبَٰهُ رَبُّهُۥ فَتَابَ عَلَيۡهِ وَهَدَىٰ (١٢٢)

“Both ate from the tree, and their private parts became manifest to them, and they began to cover themselves with the leaves of Paradise for their covering. Thus, Adam disobeyed his Lord and went astray (121) Then his Lord chose him, accepted his repentance, and guided him.” (Taha 20: 1121-122)

Despite the shared action, the Quran singles out Adam for accountability. This reflects divine wisdom and deep understanding of human nature. Allah knows the emotional sensitivity of women and does not burden them with blame in a way that would harm or diminish them.

From this, an important moral lesson emerges: a true man carries responsibility, especially within the family. A husband who is willing to shoulder blame, rather than assign it, preserves harmony and emotional safety in the home. Learning to say “I am sorry”, even when one believes he is not at fault—often leads to a calmer, happier, and more stable life.

This is not weakness; it is strength guided by wisdom.

7. Allah’s Revelation is Intended for Ease

Allah comforts the Prophet (PBUH) and by extension, all believers, by clarifying that the revelation of the Quran and its commands are not meant to impose hardship.

مَآ أَنزَلۡنَا عَلَيۡكَ ٱلۡقُرۡءَانَ لِتَشۡقَىٰٓ (٢)

“We have not sent down the Quran to you to cause you difficulty.” (Taha 20:2).

Then, Allah discusses in some details the story of Prophet Musa to illustrate that Allah's message is intended to make life easy and comfortable and Allah's support will always be with those who follow it and deliver it. Allah offers a detail that is only mentioned once in the Quran, and it can be associated with ease and removing hardships. says:

To illustrate this principle, Allah presents the story of Prophet Musa عليه السلام, showing that divine revelation is meant to bring reassurance, ease, and divine support to those who receive it and convey it. Within this narrative, Allah mentions a unique detail that appears only once in the entire Quran and can be closely associated with comfort and the removal of hardship:

فَلَمَّآ أَتَىٰهَا نُودِىَ يَـٰمُوسَىٰٓ (١١) إِنِّىٓ أَنَا۠ رَبُّكَ فَٱخۡلَعۡ نَعۡلَيۡكَۖ إِنَّكَ بِٱلۡوَادِ ٱلۡمُقَدَّسِ طُوًى (١٢)

"When he came to it (the fire), he was called: "O Musa (11) Indeed, I am your Lord, <u>So, take off your shoes,</u> you are in the sacred valley of Tuwa. (Taha 20:11-12)

In these verses, Allah commands Prophet Musa to remove his shoes without providing an explicit explanation. This omission invites reflection, especially in light of the Surah's opening declaration that revelation is not intended to cause hardship. Removing one's shoes is a natural sign of comfort and relief. When a person returns home after fatigue or long travel, one of the first acts of rest is to remove their shoes.

Thus, this command symbolizes the transition of Prophet Musa into a state of reassurance, divine protection, and inner ease as he is chosen for prophethood. It marks the beginning of a mission carried not by burden alone, but by divine support.

To reinforce this meaning, Allah later makes clear that hardship is not caused by revelation itself, but rather by turning away from it:

وَمَنۡ أَعۡرَضَ عَن ذِكۡرِى فَإِنَّ لَهُۥ مَعِيشَةً ضَنكًا وَنَحۡشُرُهُۥ يَوۡمَ ٱلۡقِيَـٰمَةِ أَعۡمَىٰ (١٢٤)

"Whoever turns away from My remembrance (the Quran) will have a life of hardship, and on the Day of Resurrection We shall raise him up blind." (Taha 20:124)

Classical books of tafsir commonly offer two explanations for the command to remove the shoes:

1. Prophet Musa's shoes were made from the skin of a dead donkey and were therefore unsuitable for the sacred valley of Tuwa.
2. He was commanded to remove them so his feet would directly touch the blessed land.

However, these explanations raise several difficulties:

1. The donkey is not an impure or inferior animal. It is mentioned in the Quran within a narrative that highlights Allah's power and resurrection (the story of ʿUzayr), which undermines the claim that its skin is inherently filthy.

2. People have historically entered, and continue to enter, the valley of Tuwa wearing shoes, and animals freely roam the area.
3. Prophet Musa was traveling through the desert, where footwear would more likely be clean than contaminated.
4. Islamic practice allows, and even encourages, prayer in shoes when they are clean. The Prophet (PBUH) said:

قال رسول الله صلى الله عليه وسلم "خالفوا اليهود فإنهم لا يصلون في نعالهم ولا خفافهم".

"Be different from the Jews, for they do not pray in their shoes or leather slippers."

The Prophet (PBUH) also said:

إذا جاء أحدكم إلى المسجد فلينظر ، فإن رأى في نعليه قذراً أو أذى فليمسحه وليصل فيهما

"When one of you comes to the mosque, let him look at his shoes. If he sees any dirt or harm on them, let him wipe them and pray in them." (Abu Dawud)

Notably, this command appears only once in the Quran, despite the story of Prophet Musa being mentioned approximately 136 times across 34 Surahs. This strong uniqueness suggests that the instruction is not incidental but thematically linked to the core message of Surah Ṭa Ha: that divine guidance is a source of reassurance, not distress.

Accordingly, the command to remove the shoes aligns naturally with the Surah's opening declaration, Allah's revelation is intended to bring ease, comfort, and stability, not hardship.

8. Success in the Hereafter in One Sentence

This verse defines, in a single statement, who is truly worthy of hoping to meet Allah. Such a person must come to Allah with two essentials: sincere righteous deeds and pure monotheism (tawḥid). Righteous deeds are not limited to acts of worship alone; they must shape the believer into a moral exemplar in every sphere of life, one's relationship with Allah, with family and friends, with adversaries, with the poor and the wealthy, and with all of creation, including humans, animals, and the natural world.

قُلۡ إِنَّمَآ أَنَا۠ بَشَرٞ مِّثۡلُكُمۡ يُوحَىٰٓ إِلَيَّ أَنَّمَآ إِلَٰهُكُمۡ إِلَٰهٞ وَٰحِدٞۖ فَمَن كَانَ يَرۡجُواْ لِقَآءَ رَبِّهِۦ فَلۡيَعۡمَلۡ عَمَلٗا صَٰلِحٗا وَلَا يُشۡرِكۡ بِعِبَادَةِ رَبِّهِۦٓ أَحَدَۢا (١١٠)

"Say: I am only a human being like you. It has been revealed to me that your God is One God. So, whoever hopes to meet his Lord, let him do righteous deeds and associate none in the worship of his Lord." (Al-Kahf 18:110)

The path to attaining such exemplary conduct is to take the Prophet (PBUH) as one's model. Only through following his character and way of life does a person become truly deserving of hoping to meet Allah. Allah states:

لَّقَدۡ كَانَ لَكُمۡ فِي رَسُولِ ٱللَّهِ أُسۡوَةٌ حَسَنَةٞ لِّمَن كَانَ يَرۡجُواْ ٱللَّهَ وَٱلۡيَوۡمَ ٱلۡأٓخِرَ وَذَكَرَ ٱللَّهَ كَثِيرٗا (٢١)

“Indeed, in the Messenger of Allah you have an excellent example for whoever hopes for Allah (the meeting with) and the Last Day and remembers Allah much.” (Al-Ahzab 33:21)

Accordingly, hoping to meet Allah is not a mere claim or emotion; it requires a serious and continuous study of the Prophet’s (PBUH) character and the conscious effort to embody his conduct in all aspects of life.

9. Breaking Unity Cannot be Treated Easily

Unity among the followers of any prophet is a matter of profound seriousness, especially because every believing community inevitably includes deviants and hypocrites. The challenge, therefore, is not whether deviation will occur, but how it should be handled without destroying the unity of the community itself.

The Quran illustrates this delicate balance through the position of Prophet Harun during the crisis of the golden calf. Despite the gravity of the sin committed by some of the Children of Israel, Harun refrained from confronting them violently or expelling them. When Prophet Musa questioned him about this restraint, he explained his reasoning:

إِنِّى خَشِيتُ أَن تَقُولَ فَرَّقْتَ بَيْنَ بَنِىٓ إِسْرَٰٓءِيلَ وَلَمْ تَرْقُبْ قَوْلِى (٩٤)

“I feared that you would say: 'You have caused division among the Children of Israel and did not observe my instruction.” (Taha 20:94)

This response reveals a critical principle of prophetic leadership: preserving the unity of the community sometimes takes precedence over immediate confrontation, even when serious wrongdoing is present. Prophet Harun recognized that forceful action at that moment would have fractured the community beyond repair, undermining the very mission he was entrusted to protect.

The same principle is evident in the leadership of Prophet Muḥammad (PBUH). Despite being fully aware of the plots, rumors, and internal disruption caused by the hypocrites in Madinah, the Prophet (PBUH) chose restraint. One of his central concerns was that outsiders would say, “Muhammad is killing his own companions.” Such a perception would have damaged the message of Islam and torn the community apart.

Thus, the Quran and the Prophetic model teach that unity is a fragile trust. Breaking it cannot be treated casually, nor can it be repaired easily once shattered. Wisdom in leadership lies in distinguishing between correcting deviation and preserving the collective body, knowing when to confront, when to restrain, and when to prioritize the survival and cohesion of the Ummah over immediate punitive action.

10. Perseverance

Obedience to Allah requires perseverance, and the means by which perseverance is attained are patience and prayer. Allah instructs His Messenger (PBUH) and through him, all believers, to remain steadfast through constant remembrance and devotion:

فَٱصۡبِرۡ عَلَىٰ مَا يَقُولُونَ وَسَبِّحۡ بِحَمۡدِ رَبِّكَ قَبۡلَ طُلُوعِ ٱلشَّمۡسِ وَقَبۡلَ غُرُوبِهَاۖ وَمِنۡ ءَانَآيِٕ ٱلَّيۡلِ فَسَبِّحۡ وَأَطۡرَافَ ٱلنَّهَارِ لَعَلَّكَ تَرۡضَىٰ (١٣٠)

"So, be patient over what they say, and glorify the praise of your Lord before sunrise and before sunset, and during some hours of the night and at the ends of the day, so that you may be content." (Taha 20:130)

In this verse, as in many others, the Quran establishes patience and prayer as the foundations of obedience and spiritual endurance. Perseverance is not sustained by resolve alone, but by regular connection with Allah through worship and remembrance.

For this reason, Allah gives a direct command regarding the household:

وَأۡمُرۡ أَهۡلَكَ بِٱلصَّلَوٰةِ وَٱصۡطَبِرۡ عَلَيۡهَاۖ لَا نَسۡـَٔلُكَ رِزۡقٗاۖ نَّحۡنُ نَرۡزُقُكَۗ وَٱلۡعَٰقِبَةُ لِلتَّقۡوَىٰ (١٣٢)

"And command your family to pray and be patient in doing so. We do not ask you for provision; We provide for you. And the best outcome is for those of taqwa." (Taha 20:132)

Allah emphasizes that enjoining prayer within the family is itself an act that requires patience and perseverance. Guidance is not imposed instantly; it is nurtured through consistency, example, and endurance. Adhering to this divine instruction plays a vital role in establishing spiritual stability within the household and can resolve many family tensions by anchoring daily life in worship, trust, and shared purpose.

Conclusion

Taken together, the jewels of this Juz present a coherent Quranic vision of righteous strength. True power is not the ability to dominate, but the ability to restrain corruption and protect life, guided by revelation, disciplined by humility, and supported by collective effort, as Dhul-Qarnayn exemplifies. The believer is reminded that spiritual success is not claimed by words but earned through sincere tawḥid and righteous deeds that radiate integrity in every relationship and responsibility.

At the same time, the Juz teaches that Allah's guidance is not a burden but a mercy: turning to it brings ease, while turning away from it produces constriction and hardship. It reminds us that unity is a fragile trust that can be shattered easily and repaired with difficulty; therefore, wisdom is needed in confronting deviation without destroying the community itself. And it anchors endurance in its two greatest supports: patience and prayer, first in personal life, then in the home, where lasting stability begins.

In the end, this Juz calls the reader to become the kind of person who truly "hopes to meet Allah": grounded in revelation, strengthened by worship, refined in character, and committed to using knowledge and power as a mercy rather than a weapon.

Jewels from the Seventeenth Juz: Reflections on Trials, Trust, and Divine Support

(Al-Anbia 21:1 – Al-Hajj 22:78)

Introduction

The seventeenth Juz of the Quran presents a powerful constellation of themes that speak directly to the human journey through time and accountability. It confronts the nearness of reckoning, exposes the reality of divine testing through both ease and hardship, unveils the vastness of the unseen universe, traces the rise and fall of civilizations, and reveals the intimate relationship between sincere supplication and divine response.

This chapter gathers selected verses and reflections that show how Allah educates humanity through two complementary books: the revealed Word and the created world. Together, these signs train the heart to worship with sincerity, the mind to reason with clarity, and the will to act with responsibility. In this Juz, the Quran emerges not as a text for ritual alone, but as a comprehensive guide that prepares the believer to live with purpose, patience, courage, and unwavering trust in Allah.

1. Time is Running Out Soon

From the moment a person is born, the clock of life begins its steady countdown toward an inevitable end, the moment when one's record is submitted for final judgment. Yet many people live as though time was open-ended, squandering their days without realizing that every passing moment is irretrievable. Like students unaware that an exam has a fixed duration, they waste precious time despite repeated warnings.

The Quran captures this dangerous illusion with striking clarity:

ٱقۡتَرَبَ لِلنَّاسِ حِسَابُهُمۡ وَهُمۡ فِي غَفۡلَةٖ مُّعۡرِضُونَ (١)

"The reckoning of people has drawn near, yet they remain heedless and turned away." (Al-Anbia 21:1)

Allah then describes their response to divine reminders:

مَا يَأۡتِيهِم مِّن ذِكۡرٖ مِّن رَّبِّهِم مُّحۡدَثٍ إِلَّا ٱسۡتَمَعُوهُ وَهُمۡ يَلۡعَبُونَ (٢) لَاهِيَةٗ قُلُوبُهُمۡۗ

"Whenever a renewed reminder comes to them from their Lord, they listen to it playfully (2) their hearts distracted." (Al-Anbia 21:2-3)

The tragedy is not ignorance, but negligence. The reminders are heard yet treated lightly. The heart remains disengaged, as though accountability was a distant abstraction rather than an approaching certainty.

The Quran then removes another common misconception: that divine testing occurs only through hardship. In reality, Allah tests human beings through both adversity and ease:

كُلُّ نَفۡسٖ ذَآئِقَةُ ٱلۡمَوۡتِۗ وَنَبۡلُوكُم بِٱلشَّرِّ وَٱلۡخَيۡرِ فِتۡنَةٗۖ وَإِلَيۡنَا تُرۡجَعُونَ (٣٥)

“Every soul is certain to taste death: We test you with both hardship and ease as a trial, and to Us you will be returned.” (Al-Anbiya 21:35)

In fact, ease often proves the more dangerous test. When confronted with hardship, people instinctively turn to Allah in humility and dependence. But when tested with comfort, wealth, influence, or success, many grow complacent, sensing less need for guidance. It is precisely at this point that heedlessness deepens, and Satan’s deception becomes more effective.

Thus, the nearness of accountability and the subtlety of divine testing together form the opening warning of this Juz: time is limited, the test is ongoing, and distraction is its greatest enemy.

2. Validate Knowledge Through Expertise and Sound Reason

One of the recurring obstacles to accepting divine guidance has always been resistance to the idea that Allah sends human beings as His messengers. Some reject this outright, unable to reconcile ordinary human life with divine revelation. Others accept the human messenger but then elevate him beyond human limits, drifting toward deification in an attempt to resolve the same tension.

The Quran addresses this confusion through two complementary and rational steps.

First, Allah directs people to consult those who possess historical and scriptural knowledge, scholars and followers of earlier revelations, who can testify that all of Allah’s messengers were human beings. This establishes continuity in divine practice and removes the claim that a human messenger is something unprecedented:

وَمَآ أَرۡسَلۡنَا قَبۡلَكَ إِلَّا رِجَالٗا نُّوحِيٓ إِلَيۡهِمۡۖ فَسۡـَٔلُوٓاْ أَهۡلَ ٱلذِّكۡرِ إِن كُنتُمۡ لَا تَعۡلَمُونَ (٧)

“We sent before you only men to whom We revealed [Our message]. If you do not know, ask the people of remembrance.” (Al-Anbiya 21:7)

Second, Allah closes the door to deification by appealing to simple, undeniable reason. He highlights two essential human traits that are incompatible with divinity: dependence and mortality:

وَمَا جَعَلۡنَٰهُمۡ جَسَدٗا لَّا يَأۡكُلُونَ ٱلطَّعَامَ وَمَا كَانُواْ خَٰلِدِينَ (٨)

“We did not make them bodies that they did not eat food, nor were they immortal.” (Al-Anbiya 21:8)

The need for nourishment signifies dependence; mortality signifies limitation. Both are definitive attributes of created beings, not of God.

Together, these verses establish a foundational Quranic principle: truth is confirmed through informed authority and reinforced by plain reason. Authentic knowledge validates revelation, while simple observation dismantles false beliefs. Divine guidance does not ask people to abandon reason; it asks them to use it honestly.

This rational clarity prepares the reader for what follows in the Juz: a sequence of signs, arguments, and historical lessons meant not to overwhelm, but to awaken hearts before time runs out.

3. Confirmation of Intelligent Creations Beyond Earth

The Quran affirms that intelligent, conscious beings exist beyond humanity, inhabiting the vast expanse of creation. These beings are not detached from divine awareness; rather, they are fully conscious of Allah and continuously engaged in worship and glorification.

Allah states:

وَلَهُۥ مَن فِى ٱلسَّمَٰوَٰتِ وَٱلْأَرْضِ ۚ وَمَنْ عِندَهُۥ لَا يَسْتَكْبِرُونَ عَنْ عِبَادَتِهِۦ وَلَا يَسْتَحْسِرُونَ (١٩) يُسَبِّحُونَ ٱلَّيْلَ وَٱلنَّهَارَ لَا يَفْتُرُونَ (٢٠)

“To Him belongs whoever is in the heavens and the earth. Those who are with Him are never too proud to worship Him, nor do they grow weary. (19) They glorify Him night and day without ceasing.” (Al-Anbiya 21:19-20)

The phrase **“whoever is in the heavens and the earth”** establishes a broad category that includes more than human beings. The Quran speaks of created entities whose existence, awareness, and devotion are real, even if their nature lies beyond human perception.

The Quran further expands this vision by describing universal submission that includes both animate and inanimate creation:

أَلَمْ تَرَ أَنَّ ٱللَّهَ يَسْجُدُ لَهُۥ مَن فِى ٱلسَّمَٰوَٰتِ وَمَن فِى ٱلْأَرْضِ وَٱلشَّمْسُ وَٱلْقَمَرُ وَٱلنُّجُومُ وَٱلْجِبَالُ وَٱلشَّجَرُ وَٱلدَّوَآبُّ وَكَثِيرٌ مِّنَ ٱلنَّاسِ ..... (الحَجّ ١٨)

“Do you not see that to Allah prostrates whoever is in the heavens and whoever is on the earth, the sun, the moon, the stars, the mountains, the trees, the animals, and many among humankind ……” (Al-Hajj 22:18)

These verses establish a foundational Quranic worldview: all creation is alive with purpose, awareness, and obedience, each according to its own mode of existence. The Quran repeatedly affirms that creation possesses forms of communication and submission that are real, though often hidden from human senses. The limitation, therefore, is not in creation’s awareness, but in humanity’s perception.

This Quranic perspective stands in contrast to modern scientific speculation, which often asks whether humanity is alone in the universe. Contemporary astronomy estimates that the observable universe contains trillions of galaxies, with billions of potentially habitable planets. In response to this vastness, scientists have proposed probabilistic models, such as the Drake Equation, to estimate the number of technologically advanced civilizations that might exist within the Milky Way.

$$N = R^{¿} \times f_p \times n_e \times f_l \times f_i \times f_c \times L$$ Where:

- N = number of communicative civilizations
- $R^{¿}$ = average rate of star formation
- f_p = fraction of stars with planets
- n_e = average number of habitable planets per star
- f_l = fraction of planets that could support life that can be developed
- f_i = fraction of planets that develop intelligent life
- f_c = fraction of civilizations that develop technology to release detectable signals
- L = duration over which such civilizations release detectable signals

While such models vary widely in their conclusions, the Quran approaches the question from an entirely different angle. It does not speculate about isolated pockets of intelligence struggling to emerge in a silent universe. Instead, it presents the cosmos as fully inhabited by conscious creation, constantly engaged in glorification and submission to its Creator.

The Quran itself provides examples of this concealed awareness. Prophet Sulaiman (peace be upon him) was granted the ability to understand the speech of birds and the communication of ants, communities described as organized, intentional, and morally aware. The miracle was not that these creatures communicated, but that he was enabled to comprehend their language.

Thus, from the Quranic perspective, intelligence and awareness are not rare anomalies in the universe. They are intrinsic features of creation. What is rare is not conscious life, but human humility, the willingness to recognize that existence extends far beyond what the senses can detect.

4. The Mystery of the Universe’s Creation

Human beings have always been drawn to the question of how the universe began and how it will ultimately end. Across history, scientists and philosophers have proposed competing theories to explain cosmic origins. The Quran does not enter this discussion to satisfy curiosity alone, but to redirect it, inviting reflection, inspiring inquiry, and grounding exploration in reverence for the Creator and the coherence of His design.

In Surah Al-Anbiya, two verses stand out as foundational references to the beginning and conclusion of the universe.

The first describes the heavens and the earth as once forming a single, unified entity before undergoing a decisive separation:

أَوَلَمۡ يَرَ ٱلَّذِينَ كَفَرُوٓاْ أَنَّ ٱلسَّمَٰوَٰتِ وَٱلۡأَرۡضَ كَانَتَا رَتۡقٗا فَفَتَقۡنَٰهُمَاۖ .... (٣٠)

“Do those who disbelieve not see that the heavens and the earth were once a joined entity, and We then split them apart? ..” (Al-Anbiya 21:30)

The Quran does not specify the physical mechanism of this separation, nor does it attempt to reduce creation to a technical process. Instead, it affirms two decisive truths: unity preceded differentiation, and the transition occurred by divine command.

In the same verse, Allah immediately connects cosmic origin to biological reality:

وَجَعَلۡنَا مِنَ ٱلۡمَآءِ كُلَّ شَيۡءٍ حَيٍّۚ أَفَلَا يُؤۡمِنُونَ (٣٠)

“And We made from water every living thing. Will they then not believe?” (Al-Anbiya 21:30)

Here, the Quran links the structure of the cosmos with the emergence of life, emphasizing continuity between the grand scale of creation and the intimate reality of living beings. Life is neither accidental nor detached from the universe’s origin; it is woven into its design.

Later in the same Surah, the Quran shifts from origin to destiny, presenting a striking image of cosmic closure:

يَوۡمَ نَطۡوِي ٱلسَّمَآءَ كَطَيِّ ٱلسِّجِلِّ لِلۡكُتُبِۚ (١٠٤)

“On the Day when We will fold the heaven like the folding of a scroll for records..” (Al-Anbiya 21:104)

The imagery of folding and unfolding conveys order, intentionality, and reversibility. Just as creation began deliberately, it will be concluded deliberately. The universe is not drifting toward chaos but moving toward fulfillment according to a divine promise:

كَمَا بَدَأۡنَآ أَوَّلَ خَلۡقٖ نُّعِيدُهُۥۚ وَعۡدًا عَلَيۡنَآۚ إِنَّا كُنَّا فَٰعِلِينَ (١٠٤)

“Just as We began the first creation, We will repeat it. This is a promise binding upon Us, and We will surely fulfill it.” (Al-Anbiya 21:104

The Quran thus frames the universe as finite, purposeful, and reversible, governed not by chance but by command.

This Juz further deepens the cosmological picture by introducing a critical concept: time is not uniform across all realms of existence. The Quran presents multiple statements that challenge the assumption that time flows identically everywhere. Two verses explicitly compare divine time to human reckoning:

وَيَسۡتَعۡجِلُونَكَ بِٱلۡعَذَابِ وَلَن يُخۡلِفَ ٱللَّهُ وَعۡدَهُۥۚ وَإِنَّ يَوۡمًا عِندَ رَبِّكَ كَأَلۡفِ سَنَةٖ مِّمَّا تَعُدُّونَ (٤٧)

“And they ask you to hasten on the punishment. But Allah never fails His Promise. Indeed, a day with your Lord is like a thousand years of what you count.” (Al-Hajj 22:47)

يُدَبِّرُ ٱلْأَمْرَ مِنَ ٱلسَّمَآءِ إِلَى ٱلْأَرْضِ ثُمَّ يَعْرُجُ إِلَيْهِ فِى يَوْمٍ كَانَ مِقْدَارُهُۥٓ أَلْفَ سَنَةٍ مِّمَّا تَعُدُّونَ (٥)

“He manages the affair from the heaven to the earth, then it ascends to Him in a day whose measure is a thousand years of what you count.” (Al-Sajda 32:5)

In both cases, the phrase “of what you count” anchors the comparison explicitly to human temporal reckoning. The Qur’an acknowledges human time as one valid measure, but not the only one.

A third verse introduces a far greater timescale:

﴿تَعْرُجُ ٱلْمَلَـٰٓئِكَةُ وَٱلرُّوحُ إِلَيْهِ فِى يَوْمٍ كَانَ مِقْدَارُهُۥ خَمْسِينَ أَلْفَ سَنَةٍ﴾

“The angels and the Spirit ascend to Him in a day whose measure is fifty thousand years.” (Al-Ma‘ārij 70:4)

Here, the Quran deliberately omits any reference to human reckoning. This omission is significant. It suggests that angelic ascent occurs within a different temporal domain, not merely a longer duration of the same time humans experience.

The Quran thus presents time as plural and contextual:

- Human time tied to earthly cycles,
- Divine administration operating on different scales,
- Angelic realms functioning within distinct temporal frameworks.

The Quran does not collapse these into a single model, nor does it attempt to quantify them mathematically. It preserves distinction, hierarchy, and mystery.

Modern physics arrived, centuries later, at a comparable insight: time is not absolute. Einstein’s theory of Special Relativity demonstrated that time depends on motion; as velocity increases, time slows relative to a stationary observer, a phenomenon known as <u>time dilation</u>. This effect has been experimentally confirmed through atomic clocks, satellites, and GPS systems. The relationship is governed by the equation

$$\text{Time dilation factor} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{1-\frac{v^2}{c^2}}}$$ where:

- v is the speed of motion
- c is the speed of light

What Speed Corresponds to “One Day = One Thousand Years”?

If one day in a moving frame corresponds to 1,000 years on Earth, then the time dilation factor is:

$$1000 \times 365 \approx 365{,}000$$

Solving Einstein's equation shows that such a ratio is only achieved when the moving system travels at:

$$v \approx 0.999999999996\ c$$

That is: Less than one millimeter per second below the speed of light, an extreme condition far beyond ordinary cosmic motion.

While the Quran is not a physics textbook, this scientific discovery provides a useful analogy. It shows that the intuition of uniform time is false, and that time varies across contexts, and human experience represents only one frame among many.

The Quran invites humanity to contemplate the universe's origin, structure, and destiny not as products of blind chance, but as expressions of deliberate order and divine will. It presents a cosmos that begins and ends by command, operates across multiple temporal frameworks, and remains intelligible without being exhaustively defined.

Scientific inquiry, when guided by humility, becomes a form of reflection rather than rivalry. The Quran does not discourage exploration; it anchors it, so that wonder leads not to arrogance, but to recognition of the One who began creation and will bring it to completion.

5. Revelation and Civilizational Development

Divine revelation is often narrowly understood as guidance limited to belief, worship, and personal morality. The Quran, however, presents a broader vision of waḥy (وحي): a form of divine inspiration that also nurtures human intellect, craftsmanship, and civilizational advancement. Revelation does not merely reform hearts; it equips humanity with the knowledge and skills necessary to preserve life, organize society, and fulfill its role as steward on earth.

One clear example appears in the mission of Prophet Nuḥ (peace be upon him), who was divinely guided to build the ship, an unprecedented engineering achievement allowing survival amid global catastrophe and laying foundations for maritime knowledge. Likewise, Allah granted Prophet Dawud (peace be upon him) specialized knowledge in metallurgy and armor-making:

وَعَلَّمۡنَٰهُ صَنۡعَةَ لَبُوسٖ لَّكُمۡ لِتُحۡصِنَكُم مِّنۢ بَأۡسِكُمۡۖ فَهَلۡ أَنتُمۡ شَٰكِرُونَ (٨٠)

"We taught him how to make coats of armor for your benefit, to protect you in battle. Will you then be grateful?" (Al-Anbiya 21:80)

Iron is among the most resistant naturally occurring materials, requiring controlled technique and precision to shape. The Quran attributes this mastery not to trial-and-error alone, but to divine enablement, whether through inspired knowledge of techniques, extraordinary facilitation, or a combination of both.

This is further elaborated in Surah Sabaʾ:

وَلَقَدۡ ءَاتَيۡنَا دَاوُۥدَ مِنَّا فَضۡلٗاۖ يَٰجِبَالُ أَوِّبِي مَعَهُۥ وَٱلطَّيۡرَۖ وَأَلَنَّا لَهُ ٱلۡحَدِيدَ (١٠)

“And We certainly granted Dawud favor from Us, [saying]: O mountains and birds, echo with him in praise! And We made iron pliable for him.” (Saba 34:10)

The Quran does not specify *how* this pliability occurred. It leaves open multiple possibilities:

- inspiration toward advanced metalworking techniques,
- divine protection from the dangers of heat and forging,
- or a temporary suspension of ordinary physical constraints.

All possibilities point to the same truth: Allah is sovereign over the laws of nature and grants humanity access to them when wisdom and mercy require it.

This pattern extends beyond metallurgy. From Nuḥ’s ship emerged principles of buoyancy and structural design; from Yusuf’s administration came models of economic planning and crisis management; from Suliyman’s authority came advances in organization, construction, and governance. Each prophetic mission marked progress in both spiritual orientation and applied knowledge.

The Quran thus presents revelation as a catalyst for civilization, not an obstacle to it. When later Muslim societies embraced the Qur’anic calls to *tafakkur* “تفكر” (reflection) and *taʿaqqul* “تعقل” (reasoned understanding), these principles translated into tangible achievements: sophisticated water systems, metallurgy, architecture, chemistry, and engineering. Knowledge flourished not despite faith, but because of it.

Figures such as Jabir ibn Ḥayyan advanced experimental chemistry and metallurgical techniques; Muslim engineers developed complex hydraulic systems; and craftsmen refined high-quality steels renowned for durability and precision. These were not isolated achievements, but expressions of stewardship (khalifah) grounded in tawhid.

Seen in this light, the Quran’s integration of revelation and applied knowledge is an expression of mercy. Protection through armor, survival through shipbuilding, stability through planning, and stewardship through knowledge all reflect divine compassion extended through prophetic guidance.

It is within this comprehensive framework that Allah defines the mission of His final Messenger (PBUH)

وَمَآ أَرۡسَلۡنَٰكَ إِلَّا رَحۡمَةٗ لِّلۡعَٰلَمِينَ (١٠٧)

“And We have not sent you, [O Mohammad], except as a mercy for all the worlds.” (Al-Anbiya 21:107)

This mercy encompasses not only spiritual salvation, but guidance that nurtures life, preserves dignity, restrains destruction, and builds civilization upon moral clarity.

6. Guaranteed Immediate Fulfillment of Certain Dua

While all sincere supplication (duʿaʾ) is heard by Allah, the Qu'an highlights specific invocations that carry an explicit promise of immediate divine response. Among the most powerful is the supplication of Prophet Yunus (Dhul-Noon) when he found himself enveloped in layers of darkness, physical, emotional, and spiritual.

وَذَا ٱلنُّونِ إِذ ذَّهَبَ مُغَٰضِبًا فَظَنَّ أَن لَّن نَّقۡدِرَ عَلَيۡهِ فَنَادَىٰ فِى ٱلظُّلُمَٰتِ أَن لَّآ إِلَٰهَ إِلَّآ أَنتَ سُبۡحَٰنَكَ إِنِّى كُنتُ مِنَ ٱلظَّٰلِمِينَ (٨٧)

"And [mention] Dhul-Noon, when he went away in anger, thinking We would not restrain him. Then he called out in the darkness: 'There is no god but You. Glory be to You! Indeed, I have been among the wrongdoers." (Al-Anbiya 21:87)

This supplication combines three essential elements:

1. Absolute affirmation of *tawhid*,
2. Glorification of Allah beyond any imperfection,
3. Honest acknowledgment of personal fault.

Allah's response is immediate and universalized:

فَٱسۡتَجَبۡنَا لَهُۥ وَنَجَّيۡنَٰهُ مِنَ ٱلۡغَمِّۚ وَكَذَٰلِكَ نُـۨجِى ٱلۡمُؤۡمِنِينَ (٨٨)

"So, We responded to him and saved him from distress. This is how We do save the believers." (Al-Anbiya 21:88)

The Quran does not present this rescue as an isolated event. It explicitly extends the promise to all believers who invoke Allah with the same sincerity, humility, and clarity.

Imam Jafar al-Ṣadiq reflected on this Quranic pattern with amazement, noting how Allah repeatedly pairs moments of fear or distress with specific invocations, followed immediately by divine relief. His reflections highlight a profound reality: the Quran is not only guidance, but a manual of divine response.

Jafar al-Ṣadiq said: "I am astonished at the one who feels fear but does not remember the verse in which Allah says:

الَّذِينَ قَالَ لَهُمُ النَّاسُ إِنَّ النَّاسَ قَدْ جَمَعُوا لَكُمْ فَاخْشَوْهُمْ فَزَادَهُمْ إِيمَانًا وَقَالُوا حَسْبُنَا اللَّهُ وَنِعْمَ الْوَكِيلُ

"Those to whom the people said, "Indeed, a great army has gathered against you, so fear them." But it only increased them in faith, and they said, "Allah is sufficient for us, and He is the best disposer of affairs." (Al-Imran 3: 173)

For I have heard Allah say immediately after it:

فَانْقَلَبُوا بِنِعْمَةٍ مِنَ اللَّهِ وَفَضْلٍ لَمْ يَمْسَسْهُمْ سُوءٌ

"So, they returned with grace and favor from Allah, no harm had touched them." (Al-Imran 3: 174)

He continued: “I am astonished at the one who feels distressed and anxious yet does not recall Allah’s words about Dhul-Noon:

لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ سُبْحَانَكَ إِنِّي كُنْتُ مِنَ الظَّالِمِينَ

"There is no God but You, glory to you, I have been among the wrongdoers."(Al-Anbia 21:87)

For I have heard Allah say right afterward:

فَاسْتَجَبْنَا لَهُ وَنَجَّيْنَاهُ مِنَ الْغَمِّ وَكَذَلِكَ نُنْجِي الْمُؤْمِنِينَ

" We responded to him and saved him from distress. This is how We do save the believers." (Al-Anbia 21:88)

And he added: I am astonished at the one who fears the deceit of others but does not remember the saying of Allah about the believer from the family of Pharaoh:

فَسَتَذْكُرُونَ مَا أَقُولُ لَكُمْ وَأُفَوِّضُ أَمْرِي إِلَى اللَّهِ إِنَّ اللَّهَ بَصِيرٌ بِالْعِبَادِ

"I commit my affairs entirely to Allah; surely Allah is fully aware of His servants,"(Ghafer 40:44)

For I have heard Allah say afterward:

فَوَقَاهُ اللَّهُ سَيِّئَاتِ مَا مَكَرُوا وَحَاقَ بِآلِ فِرْعَوْنَ سُوءُ الْعَذَابِ

"So, Allah protected him from their evil schemes." (Ghafer 40:45)

These reflections reveal a profound Qur’anic reality: the Quran is not merely a book of guidance, but a living manual of divine response. Certain supplications are deliberately paired with Allah’s immediate answer, inviting the believer to trust, invoke, and witness the promise fulfilled through sincerity and faith.

7. Beware of the Danger of Conditional Faith

These verses issue a serious warning against conditional faith, belief that survives only in comfort and collapses under trial. The Quran makes clear that true faith is not measured by verbal profession, but by steadfastness when circumstances turn difficult.

وَمِنَ ٱلنَّاسِ مَن يَعۡبُدُ ٱللَّهَ عَلَىٰ حَرۡفٖۖ فَإِنۡ أَصَابَهُۥ خَيۡرٌ ٱطۡمَأَنَّ بِهِۦۖ وَإِنۡ أَصَابَتۡهُ فِتۡنَةٌ ٱنقَلَبَ عَلَىٰ وَجۡهِهِۦ
خَسِرَ ٱلدُّنۡيَا وَٱلۡأٓخِرَةَۚ ذَٰلِكَ هُوَ ٱلۡخُسۡرَانُ ٱلۡمُبِينُ (١١) يَدۡعُواْ مِن دُونِ ٱللَّهِ مَا لَا يَضُرُّهُۥ وَمَا لَا يَنفَعُهُۥۚ ذَٰلِكَ
هُوَ ٱلضَّلَٰلُ ٱلۡبَعِيدُ (١٢) يَدۡعُواْ لَمَن ضَرُّهُۥٓ أَقۡرَبُ مِن نَّفۡعِهِۦۚ لَبِئۡسَ ٱلۡمَوۡلَىٰ وَلَبِئۡسَ ٱلۡعَشِيرُ (١٣)

“And among people is one who worships Allah on the edge. If good befalls him, he is reassured by it; but if a trial afflicts him, he turns back on his face, losing both this world and the Hereafter. That is the manifest loss. (11) He calls upon besides Allah what can neither harm nor benefit him. That is extreme misguidance. (12) He calls upon one whose harm is closer than his benefit, how wretched a protector and how wretched an ally.” (Al-Hajj 22:11-13)

The image is striking. To worship “on the edge” is to stand at the margin of commitment, never fully rooted, always prepared to withdraw. Such a person approaches faith as a transaction: if ease continues, belief remains; if hardship appears, belief retreats. Such a person will face the consequence: “He loses both this world and the Hereafter”.

In this world, such faith produces anxiety and instability, because security depends on circumstances that constantly change. In the Hereafter, it results in loss because devotion was never anchored in sincerity.

This pattern is not new. Allah reminds believers that earlier communities were tested severely:

أَمۡ حَسِبۡتُمۡ أَن تَدۡخُلُواْ ٱلۡجَنَّةَ وَلَمَّا يَأۡتِكُم مَّثَلُ ٱلَّذِينَ خَلَوۡاْ مِن قَبۡلِكُمۖ مَّسَّتۡهُمُ ٱلۡبَأۡسَآءُ وَٱلضَّرَّآءُ وَزُلۡزِلُواْ حَتَّىٰ يَقُولَ ٱلرَّسُولُ وَٱلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُواْ مَعَهُۥ مَتَىٰ نَصۡرُ ٱللَّهِۗ أَلَآ إِنَّ نَصۡرَ ٱللَّهِ قَرِيبٞ (٢١٤)

“Do you think you will enter Paradise while there has not yet come to you the like of what came to those who passed before you? They were touched with hardship and adversity until the messenger and those who believed with him said, ‘When will the help of Allah come?’ Indeed, the help of Allah is near.” (**Al-Baqarah 2:214)**

Even prophets and their companions reached moments of intense strain, yet they did not abandon faith. Trial was not evidence against truth; it was the arena in which truth was proven.

The Israelites offer a recurring example: gratitude flourished during visible miracles but weakened when hardship returned. Their story stands as a mirror for any community that allows comfort, rather than conviction, to govern belief.

In contrast, the sincere believer’s relationship with Allah is not transactional. Ease becomes an opportunity for gratitude; hardship becomes a field for patience. The Prophet (PBUH) summarized this unique state:

عَنْ أبِي يَحْيَى صُهَيْبِ بْنِ سِنَانٍ قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ الله ﷺ: عَجَباً لأمْرِ الْمُؤْمِنِ إِنَّ أَمْرَهُ كُلَّهُ لَهُ خَيْرٌ، وَلَيْسَ ذَلِكَ لأَحَدٍ إلاَّ للْمُؤْمِن: إِنْ أَصَابَتْهُ سَرَّاءُ شَكَرَ فَكَانَ خَيْراً لَهُ، وَإِنْ أَصَابَتْهُ ضَرَّاءُ صَبَرَ فَكَانَ خيْراً لَهُ.) رواه مسلم (

“How amazing is the affair of the believer! For him, there is good in every situation. If something pleasing befalls him, he is grateful and that is good for him; and if hardship strikes him, he is patient and that is good for him.” (Muslim)

Thus, while superficial faith seeks comfort, true faith seeks Allah Himself. Those who remain firm under trial gain inner stability in this life and eternal security in the next. Those who worship on the edge risk losing both.

8. You Fulfill the Command and Allah Delivers the Results

Allah commanded Prophet Ibrahim (peace be upon him) to proclaim the pilgrimage, despite standing alone in a barren valley, far removed from population centers and human infrastructure. By any human calculation, the command appeared impossible: how could a single voice reach people across continents and generations? Yet Allah said:

وَأَذِّنْ فِي النَّاسِ بِالْحَجِّ يَأْتُوكَ رِجَالًا وَعَلَى كُلِّ ضَامِرٍ يَأْتِينَ مِنْ كُلِّ فَجٍّ عَمِيقٍ) الحج(

"And proclaim to mankind the Hajj (pilgrimage). They will come to you on foot and on every lean camel, they will come from every distant pass." (Al-Hajj 22:27)

Ibrahim's responsibility was not to achieve, but to obey. He fulfilled the command without hesitation. The outcome, millions responding across centuries, belonged entirely to Allah. A single act of obedience became a timeless global reality.

This episode establishes a foundational Qur'anic principle: Human responsibility lies in obedience; divine responsibility lies in outcomes.

The action is required, but it is never sufficient on its own. When obedience is sincere and uncompromised, Allah magnifies its effects beyond human capacity.

This principle applies universally. When believers align their actions fully with Allah's commands, pure in intention and firm in obedience, Allah blesses even limited efforts with disproportionate impact. What appears insignificant by worldly standards becomes, by divine will, transformative.

Yet many believers reverse this equation. They rely heavily on strategy, wealth, influence, and calculation, often compromising divine principles to secure results. When success does not materialize, frustration and doubt follow. The Quran teaches a different logic:

- effort without obedience is hollow,
- obedience, even with minimal means, invites divine support.

True success is not measured by the scale of human effort, but by its alignment with Allah's command. When obedience is complete, Allah assumes responsibility for the result.

9. The Fundamental Rule for Securing Divine Support

The Quran establishes a clear, unwavering law of victory: divine support is granted only to those who actively support Allah's cause. This principle is neither symbolic nor rhetorical; it is a binding promise repeatedly affirmed in revelation.

وَلَيَنصُرَنَّ ٱللَّهُ مَن يَنصُرُهُۥٓ ۗ إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ لَقَوِىٌّ عَزِيزٌ (٤٠)

"Indeed, Allah will surely support those who Support Him. Truly, Allah is All-Powerful, All-Mighty." (Al-Hajj 22:40)

The same rule is restated with equal clarity in Surat Muhammad:

يَـٰٓأَيُّهَا ٱلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوٓاْ إِن تَنصُرُواْ ٱللَّهَ يَنصُرۡكُمۡ وَيُثَبِّتۡ أَقۡدَامَكُمۡ (٧)

"O you who believe! If you support Allah, He will support you and make your footing firm." (Muhammad 47:7)

The Quran then removes all ambiguity by defining precisely who qualifies as those who "support Allah":

ٱلَّذِينَ إِن مَّكَّنَّـٰهُمۡ فِى ٱلۡأَرۡضِ أَقَامُواْ ٱلصَّلَوٰةَ وَءَاتَوُاْ ٱلزَّكَـوٰةَ وَأَمَرُواْ بِٱلۡمَعۡرُوفِ وَنَهَوۡاْ عَنِ ٱلۡمُنكَرِۗ وَلِلَّهِ عَـٰقِبَةُ ٱلۡأُمُورِ (٤١)

"[They are] those who, when We establish them in the land, establish prayer, pay the Zakat, command what is right, and forbid what is evil. And to Allah belongs the outcome of all matters." (Al-Hajj 22:41)

Divine support, therefore, is not earned through slogans, emotional attachment, or identity alone. It is secured through obedience, moral responsibility, and the active establishment of justice, beginning with personal conduct and extending to society.

History repeatedly confirms this law. Communities that appeared weak by worldly measures, small in number and limited in resources, prevailed against far greater forces, not through superior strategy alone, but through divine support earned by clarity of purpose and integrity of action.

The most striking example is the generation of the Prophet's Companions. Within a few decades, they overcame the two dominant empires of their age, not because they possessed greater armies, but because they carried a mission grounded in truth and justice.

One of their representatives summarized that mission when addressing a Persian general:

"**Allah has sent us to deliver you from the worship of creation to the worship of the Creator of creation; from the narrowness of this world to the vastness of this world and the Hereafter; and from the injustice of religions to the justice of Islam."**

They supported Allah by upholding His commands, carrying the message of His Messenger (PBUH), and standing firmly for justice. In return, Allah fulfilled His promise, granting them victory, stability, and enduring impact.

The rule remains unchanged across time: support Allah's cause, and Allah will support you.

10. Recognizing Allah Through the Simplest Sign of Creation

Throughout the Quran, Allah presents signs not only in the extraordinary, but in the most ordinary and familiar elements of creation, directing human intellect toward a simple conclusion: none is worthy of worship except Him. One of the most striking examples appeals to reason through the smallest of creatures:

يَـٰٓأَيُّهَا ٱلنَّاسُ ضُرِبَ مَثَلٌ فَٱسْتَمِعُوا۟ لَهُۥٓ ۚ إِنَّ ٱلَّذِينَ تَدْعُونَ مِن دُونِ ٱللَّهِ لَن يَخْلُقُوا۟ ذُبَابًا وَلَوِ ٱجْتَمَعُوا۟ لَهُۥ .. (٧٣)

“O mankind! A parable is presented, so listen to it carefully: those whom you call upon besides Allah could never create a single fly, even if they all came together for that purpose. ...” (Al-Hajj 22:73)

Allah deliberately chooses the fly, an insect often dismissed as insignificant, to expose the absolute helplessness of all false objects of worship. Even if every idol, power, or authority were to unite, they could not create the simplest living creature. The verse then sharpens the argument further:

ۖ وَإِن يَسْلُبْهُمُ ٱلذُّبَابُ شَيْـًٔا لَّا يَسْتَنقِذُوهُ مِنْهُ ۚ ضَعُفَ ٱلطَّالِبُ وَٱلْمَطْلُوبُ (٧٣)

“And if the fly were to snatch something away from them, they could not recover it. How weak are both the seeker and the sought,” (Al-Hajj 22:73)

Modern scientific observation deepens this reflection. A fly feeds by secreting digestive enzymes that chemically break down substances before ingestion. Once this process occurs, the original material is permanently altered, it cannot truly be retrieved. The Quranic statement is therefore not only rhetorically precise, but scientifically accurate. Allah ends the verse with a devastating assessment:” How weak are both the seeker and the sought”.

The one who seeks help from false gods is weak, and what he seeks is even weaker. Allah then identifies the root of this failure:

مَا قَدَرُوا۟ ٱللَّهَ حَقَّ قَدْرِهِۦٓ ۗ إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ لَقَوِىٌّ عَزِيزٌ (٧٤)

"They have not given Allah His rightful due. Indeed, Allah is All-Powerful, All-Mighty.” (Al-Hajj 22:74)

True recognition of Allah arises from thoughtful observation and sincere reflection. Even the smallest creature, when examined carefully, reveals layers of complexity, precision, and wisdom that point unmistakably to a Creator beyond comparison. Those who truly ponder such signs are not led to arrogance, but to humility, awe, and unwavering faith.

Failure to recognize Allah does not arise from lack of evidence, but from lack of reflection. Even the smallest creature, when examined honestly, reveals layers of complexity, precision, and design that point unmistakably to a Creator of absolute power

and wisdom. Those who truly reflect are not led to arrogance, but to humility; not to doubt, but to awe; not to confusion, but to unwavering faith.

Conclusion

Taken together, the reflections in this chapter reveal the seventeenth Juz as a coherent moral framework built upon three enduring principles: steadfast faith under trial, responsible effort in obedience to Allah, and complete reliance on Him for outcomes. The verses remind us that time is limited, accountability is inevitable, and that true loss is not the loss of comfort or position, but the loss of one's standing in the Hereafter.

At the same time, this Juz makes clear that revelation is not a retreat from the world, but guidance for engaging it rightly. Faith is tested through action, knowledge is meant to build and protect civilization, supplication is paired with trust, and divine support is granted according to clear moral laws. Victory, relief, and stability are not the products of power alone, but of sincerity, obedience, and perseverance upon truth.

If these jewels awaken in the reader a deeper awareness of Allah's nearness, a firmer resolve to obey Him without conditions, and renewed confidence that sincere effort, however small, can be magnified by Allah's power, then they will have fulfilled their purpose, by His permission.

Jewels from the Eighteenth Juz: Divine Light, Human Responsibility, and Social Order

(Al-Munenoon 23:1 -Al-Furqan 25:20)

Introduction

Introduction

The selected verses from Juz 18 revolve around two tightly connected Qur'anic themes: moral order within society and measured responsibility before Allah. At the heart of this Juz stands Surah Al-Nūr, which lays down a comprehensive framework for social integrity, beginning with the supremacy of divine command, refining personal and social conduct, regulating modesty, establishing the Masjid as a center of moral illumination, and culminating in a conditional promise of security and leadership.

Alongside this moral architecture, the Juz addresses foundational realities of human existence: that life is a measured test, that essential provision such as water is precisely controlled by Allah, that history unfolds according to moral laws, and that messengers are human so accountability remains unavoidable. Together, these verses demonstrate that stability, guidance, and leadership arise only when moral clarity and responsibility are firmly established.

1. Rank Your Character Against that of the Successful Believers

Surah Al-Mu'minūn opens by presenting the defining qualities of true believers. These opening verses function as a moral and spiritual scorecard, enabling believers to evaluate themselves before they are evaluated by Allah. Notably, the Quran integrates acts of worship with moral conduct (العبادات والأخلاق), emphasizing that success in the sight of Allah requires both inward devotion and outward discipline

Omar ibn al-Khaṭṭāb (RA) reported that the Prophet ﷺ said:
عن عمر بن الخطاب - رضي الله عنه - قال : قال رسول الله - صلى الله عليه وسلم ....."أُنْزِلَ عَلَيَّ عَشْرُ آيَاتٍ مَنْ أَقَامَهُنَّ دَخَلَ الْجَنَّةَ ، ثُمَّ قَرَأَ : " قَدْ أَفْلَحَ الْمُؤْمِنُونَ" ، حَتَّى خَتَمَ عَشْرَ آيَاتٍ)الترمذي(
"Ten verses were revealed to me; whoever upholds them will enter Paradise. Then He (PBUH) recited (قَدْ أَفْلَحَ الْمُؤْمِنُونَ) "Indeed the believers had succeeded" until He finished the ten verses of Surah Al Mu'minun." [Tirmidhi]

The Surah begins by identifying six core characteristics that define successful believers. These traits are deliberately structured, reflecting a balanced integration of worship, self-restraint, and social responsibility:
قَدۡ أَفۡلَحَ ٱلۡمُؤۡمِنُونَ (١) ٱلَّذِينَ هُمۡ فِي صَلَاتِهِمۡ خَٰشِعُونَ (٢) وَٱلَّذِينَ هُمۡ عَنِ ٱللَّغۡوِ مُعۡرِضُونَ (٣) وَٱلَّذِينَ هُمۡ لِلزَّكَوٰةِ فَٰعِلُونَ (٤) وَٱلَّذِينَ هُمۡ لِفُرُوجِهِمۡ حَٰفِظُونَ (٥) إِلَّا عَلَىٰٓ أَزۡوَٰجِهِمۡ أَوۡ مَا مَلَكَتۡ أَيۡمَٰنُهُمۡ فَإِنَّهُمۡ

غَيْرُ مَلُومِينَ (٦) فَمَنِ ٱبْتَغَىٰ وَرَآءَ ذَٰلِكَ فَأُوْلَـٰٓئِكَ هُمُ ٱلْعَادُونَ (٧) وَٱلَّذِينَ هُمْ لِأَمَـٰنَـٰتِهِمْ وَعَهْدِهِمْ رَٰعُونَ (٨) وَٱلَّذِينَ هُمْ عَلَىٰ صَلَوَٰتِهِمْ يُحَافِظُونَ (٩)

"Indeed, the Believers have succeeded:

1. **Those who are reverent (have Khoshoo) in their prayers.**
2. **Those who turn away from Laghw (vain talk and deeds).**
3. **Those who are active in working to pay the Zakat.**
4. **Those who guard their private parts, except with their spouses or those lawfully permitted; whoever seeks beyond that are transgressors.**
5. **Those who faithfully observe their trusts and covenants.**
6. **And those who carefully maintain their prayers." (Al- Mu'minūn 23:1-9)**

One trait that is frequently underestimated, yet deliberately placed immediately after prayer, is abstaining from laghw (اللَّغْو) (vain or purposeless speech and action). Laghw includes idle talk, gossip, backbiting, fruitless arguments, and activities that consume time without moral, intellectual, or practical benefit. Such behaviors drain attention, corrode relationships, and weaken spiritual focus.

By ranking avoidance of laghw directly after humility in prayer, the Quran highlights the decisive role of speech and attention in shaping character. What a person consciously avoids is as revealing as what they actively perform.

A critical linguistic detail strengthens the certainty of this success. In Arabic, when قد precedes a present-tense verb, it may indicate possibility. However, when it precedes a past-tense verb, it conveys certainty and confirmation. Thus, (قَدْ أَفْلَحَ الْمُؤْمِنُونَ) does not describe potential success. t declares a success already affirmed by Allah.

This emphatic construction appears sparingly in the Quran, including:

﴿ قَدْ أَفْلَحَ مَنْ زَكَّاهَا ﴾) سورة الشمس (

"Indeed, he who purified his soul has succeeded." (Ash-Shams 91:9)

(قَدْ أَفْلَحَ مَنْ تَزَكَّى)) سورة الأعلى (

"Indeed, he one who purifies himself has succeeded." (Al-Ala 87:14)

In all cases, success is presented not as a distant hope but as a realized outcome.

Surah Al-Mu'minūn therefore defines success neither by status nor wealth, but by disciplined worship, moral restraint, responsible speech, and trustworthiness. These verses invite believers to measure themselves honestly and to align their lives with a success that Allah Himself has already confirmed.

2. Human Life Supply—Water Is Under Allah's Absolute Control

Human survival depends on resources that lie entirely beyond human command, and among them, water stands foremost. Life collapses without it, and even slight imbalance in its quantity results either in destruction through flooding or death through drought. Control over water is, therefore, control over life itself. Allah declares:

وَأَنزَلۡنَا مِنَ ٱلسَّمَآءِ مَآءَۢ بِقَدَرٖ فَأَسۡكَنَّٰهُ فِي ٱلۡأَرۡضِۖ وَإِنَّا عَلَىٰ ذَهَابِۭ بِهِۦ لَقَٰدِرُونَ (١٨)

"We sent water down from the sky in precise measure and We settled it within the earth — and indeed, are fully capable of taking it away." (Al- Mu'minun 23:18)

This verse establishes three foundational realities:

1. Water is sent in measured quantity, not randomly or autonomously.
2. Its storage within the earth is divinely arranged, not a human achievement.
3. Its continued availability is conditional, entirely subject to Allah's will.

The phrase **(فَأَسۡكَنَّٰهُ فِي ٱلۡأَرۡضِ) "We settled it in the earth"** points directly to underground water systems, natural reservoirs that sustain human civilization, agriculture, and ecosystems. Humanity benefits from these systems without having designed, regulated, or guaranteed them. Their existence is a divine mercy; their disappearance would be a reminder of dependence.

Allah then reinforces this truth through a complementary verse:

وَأَرۡسَلۡنَا ٱلرِّيَٰحَ لَوَٰقِحَ فَأَنزَلۡنَا مِنَ ٱلسَّمَآءِ مَآءٗ فَأَسۡقَيۡنَٰكُمُوهُ وَمَآ أَنتُمۡ لَهُۥ بِخَٰزِنِينَ (٢٢)

"We send the winds for fertilization and send down water from the sky, providing it for you to drink, but you are not the ones who store it." (Al-Hijr 15: 22)

The precision of the Qur'anic wording is critical. The phrase **فَأَسۡقَيۡنَٰكُمُوهُ "We gave it to you to drink."** narrows the focus from rainwater in general to drinking water specifically. Humans may store water externally, but they cannot store it within themselves. The Quran thus establishes a hierarchy of dependence:

- Allah controls the sending of water,
- Allah controls its storage in the earth,
- Allah controls its distribution into living bodies,
- And Allah alone can withhold it entirely.

Water, therefore, is not merely a physical resource, it is a daily sign of measured provision and continuous dependence upon Allah.

3. Egypt's Unique Position in the Quranic Narrative

Among all lands mentioned in the Quran, Egypt occupies a uniquely prominent position. No other country is associated with as many recorded events. Approximately five hundred verses refer directly or indirectly to events that occurred there, particularly those connected to Prophet Musa and Prophet Yūsuf (peace be upon them).

In Juz 18, this focus appears clearly in Allah's statement:

ثُمَّ أَرۡسَلۡنَا مُوسَىٰ وَأَخَاهُ هَـٰرُونَ بِـَٔايَـٰتِنَا وَسُلۡطَـٰنٖ مُّبِينٍ (٤٥) إِلَىٰ فِرۡعَوۡنَ وَمَلَإِيۡهِۦ فَٱسۡتَكۡبَرُواْ ..

"Then We sent Moses and his brother Aaron, with Our signs and clear authority, (45) to Pharaoh and his elite, but they responded with arrogance; .." (Al-Mu'minūn 23:45-46)

This passage highlights not only prophetic confrontation, but also a fully developed political structure: centralized authority, a ruling elite, and an entrenched system of power.

Another verse in the same Juz refers to the land of Sinai:

وَشَجَرَةٗ تَخۡرُجُ مِن طُورِ سَيۡنَآءَ تَنۢبُتُ بِٱلدُّهۡنِ وَصِبۡغٖ لِّلۡأٓكِلِينَ (٢٠)

"And a tree, growing out of Mount Sinai, that produces oil and relish for the eaters." (Al- Mu'minūn 23:20)

Although the tree is not named explicitly, the description strongly points to the olive tree, mentioned here after Allah speaks of rain-watered vegetation. Its inclusion highlights Sinai, and by extension Egypt, as a land of both material sustenance and symbolic guidance.

The Quran's sustained focus on Egypt is not incidental. Egypt functions as a historical laboratory in which the laws governing civilizations are demonstrated through lived events rather than abstract theory.

Within the Egyptian narratives, the Quran presents a complete civilizational ecosystem:

- Absolute centralized authority → Pharaoh
- Administrative elite → al-malāʾ (the ruling class)
- State economy → agriculture, storehouses, cycles of abundance and famine
- Social stratification → oppression of the Children of Israel
- Official ideology → deification of political power
- Knowledge systems → magic and institutionalized deception
- Crisis management → Yusuf's administration during famine
- Civilizational transition → the Exodus and collapse of tyranny

Egypt stands in the Quran not merely as a as a geographical location of past events, but as a recurring case study for humanity, a warning, a lesson, and a mirror for every society that seeks power without justice or prosperity without moral restraint.

4. Every Test Is Measured to One's Capacity

One of the most common arguments against belief in God is the presence of evil in the world. This argument, however, rests on a misunderstanding of the nature of life itself.

From the Quranic perspective, life is not a final destination but a testing ground. Hardship, struggle, and moral challenge are not flaws in the system; they are essential components of it.

Just as students must undergo examinations to demonstrate readiness and progress, human beings are tested to reveal faith, integrity, and accountability. The Quran repeatedly frames life as an examination of belief, character, and obedience, both in hardship and in ease.

Crucially, Allah establishes a decisive principle that no test exceeds a person's capacity:

((وَلَا نُكَلِّفُ نَفْسًا إِلَّا وُسْعَهَا ۖ وَلَدَيْنَا كِتَابٌ يَنطِقُ بِالْحَقِّ ۚ وَهُمْ لَا يُظْلَمُونَ)) المؤمنون: 62
"We do not burden any soul beyond its capacity. With Us is a record that speaks the truth, and they will not be wronged." (Al-Mu'minun 23:62)

Every test is precisely measured, recorded with truth, and administered with absolute justice. Failure, therefore, is never the result of unbearable burden, but of moral neglect:

بَلْ قُلُوبُهُمْ فِى غَمْرَةٍ مِّنْ هَـٰذَا وَلَهُمْ أَعْمَـٰلٌ مِّن دُونِ ذَٰلِكَ هُمْ لَهَا عَـٰمِلُونَ (٦٣)
"Rather, their hearts are immersed in heedlessness of this (message), and they are occupied with other deeds." (Al- Mu'minun 23: 63)

The Quran thus identifies the true cause of failure: heedlessness, not hardship. Guidance is available, capacity is sufficient, and accountability is clear.

5. The Supremacy of Divine Command in Establishing Moral Order

Surah Al-Noor opens by declaring its purpose with unmistakable clarity. It is not a collection of optional moral recommendations, but a divinely mandated framework intended to illuminate social life, protect human dignity, and purify relationships:

سُورَةٌ أَنزَلْنَـٰهَا وَفَرَضْنَـٰهَا وَأَنزَلْنَا فِيهَآ ءَايَـٰتٍۭ بَيِّنَـٰتٍ لَّعَلَّكُمْ تَذَكَّرُونَ (١)
"This is a Surah which We have sent down and made obligatory, and in it We have sent down clear verses so that you may take heed." (Al-Noor 24:1)

The name Al-Noor (The Light) signals the Surah's central function: to illuminate the moral and social fabric of society. Its commands are designed to protect honor, restrain desire, establish justice, and guide people toward Allah through clarity rather than ambiguity.

Immediately after this declaration, the Surah presents one of its most serious legal rulings:

ٱلزَّانِيَةُ وَٱلزَّانِي فَٱجۡلِدُواْ كُلَّ وَٰحِدٖ مِّنۡهُمَا مِاْئَةَ جَلۡدَةٖۖ وَلَا تَأۡخُذۡكُم بِهِمَا رَأۡفَةٞ فِي دِينِ ٱللَّهِ إِن كُنتُمۡ تُؤۡمِنُونَ بِٱللَّهِ وَٱلۡيَوۡمِ ٱلۡأٓخِرِۖ وَلۡيَشۡهَدۡ عَذَابَهُمَا طَآئِفَةٞ مِّنَ ٱلۡمُؤۡمِنِينَ (٢)

"The adulteress and the adulterer, flog each of them with one hundred lashes. Let not pity for them should prevail upon you in the matter of Allah's religion, if you believe in Allah and the Last Day. And let a party of believers witness their punishment." (Al-Noor 24:2)

This placement is deliberate. The Quran begins by safeguarding sexual morality, because its corruption destabilizes families, lineage, trust, and ultimately the foundations of society itself.

It must be emphasized that such punishments are not individual actions. They are applied exclusively by a legitimate judicial authority to ensure due process, evidentiary standards, and social stability. Vigilante enforcement is categorically prohibited.

A long-standing juristic debate concerns whether this punishment applies equally to married and unmarried offenders. The verse itself makes no distinction. It is historically documented that the Prophet (PBUH), before the completion of certain revelations, adjudicated some cases according to existing Jewish law, which prescribed stoning for adultery. However, there is no definitive evidence that the Prophet (PBUH) applied stoning after the revelation of this verse in a new case.

This uncertainty is explicitly acknowledged in a report from ʿAbdullāh ibn Abī Awfā:

عن الشيباني سألت عبد الله بن أبي أوفى هل رجم رسول الله صلى الله عليه وسلم قال نعم قلت قبل سورة النور أم بعد قال لا أدري)البخاري(

"He was asked whether the Messenger of Allah (PBUH) ordered stoning. He said yes. He was then asked: was that before or after Surah Al-Noor? He replied: I do not know. (Bukhari)

Therefore, any juristic claim that permanently substitutes a Quranic ruling with pre-Quranic legislation requires unequivocal proof. Absent such proof, elevating earlier law above the Quran risks undermining the supremacy of divine revelation.

It must also be noted that establishing the crime of adultery requires four independent eyewitnesses in addition to the accuser, making false accusation extremely dangerous. Any accusation lacking four witnesses results in severe punishment for slander. Consequently, such penalties were not enforced during the Prophet's lifetime except in cases of voluntary confession.

The objective of this ruling is deterrence, moral clarity, and protection of society, not punishment for its own sake.

Having established firm legal boundaries that protect dignity and reputation, the Surah then moves to refining everyday social conduct, addressing behaviors that preserve trust and emotional well-being.

6. Proper Protocol of visiting Peoples' homes

Surah Al-Noor transitions from major moral violations to subtle yet powerful rules of social etiquette. Trust, after all, is destroyed not only by crimes, but also by everyday insensitivity. Allah says:

يَـٰٓأَيُّهَا ٱلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُواْ لَا تَدۡخُلُواْ بُيُوتًا غَيۡرَ بُيُوتِكُمۡ حَتَّىٰ تَسۡتَأۡنِسُواْ وَتُسَلِّمُواْ عَلَىٰٓ أَهۡلِهَاۚ ذَٰلِكُمۡ خَيۡرٞ لَّكُمۡ لَعَلَّكُمۡ تَذَكَّرُونَ (٢٧) فَإِن لَّمۡ تَجِدُواْ فِيهَآ أَحَدٗا فَلَا تَدۡخُلُوهَا حَتَّىٰ يُؤۡذَنَ لَكُمۡۖ وَإِن قِيلَ لَكُمُ ٱرۡجِعُواْ فَٱرۡجِعُواْۖ هُوَ أَزۡكَىٰ لَكُمۡۚ وَٱللَّهُ بِمَا تَعۡمَلُونَ عَلِيمٞ (٢٨)

"O you who believe, do not enter houses other than your own until you seek familiarity and greet their inhabitants; that is better for you, in order that you may remember; And if you find no one therein, still, do not enter until permission has been given. And if you are told to return, then return; that is purer for you. And Allah is All-Knower of what you do" (Al-Noor 24:27-28).

At first glance, this instruction may appear self-evident. Yet it addresses a common social tension: visiting someone who may feel obligated to receive a guest despite being distracted, burdened, or unprepared.

The key term here is **تَسۡتَأۡنِسُواْ (tastanisū)**. Often translated as "seek permission," but its root **(أنس)** conveys comfort, ease, and emotional readiness. The verse therefore requires more than formal consent; it requires genuine welcome. Entry is only appropriate when the host is truly comfortable with the visit.

If one is asked to return, the Quran reframes this not as rejection, but as moral refinement:

هُوَ أَزۡكَىٰ لَكُمۡۚ

"That is purer for you."

This command protects emotional boundaries, preserves relationships, and prevents resentment, essential elements of a society built on trust rather than pressure.

Once private spaces are protected and social boundaries respected, the Surah advances to regulating modesty itself, guarding not only homes, but eyes, hearts, and desires.

7. Guidelines for Modesty in Women's Dress

The Quranic verse that provides direct guidance regarding women's modesty, specifically the protection of private parts and restraint in adornment, states:

وَقُل لِّلۡمُؤۡمِنَٰتِ يَغۡضُضۡنَ مِنۡ أَبۡصَٰرِهِنَّ وَيَحۡفَظۡنَ فُرُوجَهُنَّ وَلَا يُبۡدِينَ زِينَتَهُنَّ إِلَّا مَا ظَهَرَ مِنۡهَاۖ وَلۡيَضۡرِبۡنَ بِخُمُرِهِنَّ عَلَىٰ جُيُوبِهِنَّۖ (٣١)

"And say to the believing women to lower their gaze, guard their private parts, and not to display their adornment except what is apparent thereof, and to draw their head covering over their over chests (the necks and bosoms,) …. (Al-Noor 24:31)

The central phrase in this verse is **(وَلَا يُبۡدِينَ زِينَتَهُنَّ إِلَّا مَا ظَهَرَ مِنۡهَاۖ) "and do not to expose their adornment except what is apparent thereof."** This expression is intentionally concise and open-ended. Any attempt to define what qualifies as "apparent" requires adding explanatory qualifiers, and it is precisely here that scholarly interpretations diverge. Common interpretive additions include:

1. "What is apparent due to necessity"
2. "What is apparent due to need"
3. "What is apparent according to custom"

Each addition yields a different level of restriction. Yet it is essential to recognize that all such qualifiers are interpretive additions, not explicit Quranic statements. Had Allah intended to restrict the phrase to necessity, need, or custom, He could have done so unambiguously.

Because of this openness, scholars often turn to hadith literature for further clarification. The most frequently cited narration is attributed to Sayyidah Aishah (RA), reported by Khalid ibn Dureik (خالد بن دريك), concerning Asma bint Abi Bakr :

عن **خالد بن دريك** عن عائشة رضي الله عنها: أن أسماء بنت أبي بكر دخلت على رسول الله صلى الله عليه وسلم وعليها ثياب رقاق، فأعرض عنها رسول الله صلى الله عليه وسلم، وقال: يا أسماء إن المرأة إذا بلغت المحيض **لم تصلح أن يرى منها إلا هذا وهذا- وأشار إلى وجهه وكفيه). رواه أبو داود (**

قال أبو داود هذا مرسل **خالد بن دريك** لم يدرك عائشة رضي الله عنها. وقال ابن القطان: ومع هذا فخالد مجهول الحال.

"Asma, daughter of Abu Bakr (that is, Aisha's sister), entered upon the messenger of Allah (PBUH) wearing thin clothes. The Messenger of Allah (PBUH) turned away and said, "O Asma, when a woman reaches the age of menstruation, nothing should be seen of her except this and this,' and he pointed to his face and hands." (Sunan Abu Dawud)

This narration appears only in Sunan Abu Dawud. Abu Dawud himself classified it as "mursal", since Khalid ibn Dureik did not meet ʿAishah (RA). Additionally, Ibn al-Qattan (ابن القطان) noted that Khalid's reliability is unknown.

Given the absence of explicit Quranic specification and the weakness of the most commonly cited hadith, any rigid definition of what "is apparent" must be understood as interpretive rather than definitive.

The Qur'an establishes the principle of modesty, lowering the gaze, guarding private parts, and restraining display, while leaving room for contextual judgment rather than imposing uniform rigidity across cultures and eras.

This approach is consistent with the Quran's broader methodology: it sets ethical boundaries while avoiding unnecessary constraints that could distort lived reality.

Importantly, this command is not isolated. It is part of a gradual moral architecture constructed throughout Surah Al-Noor. Before declaring that Allah is the Light of the heavens and the earth (24:35), the Surah prepares hearts and societies to receive that light through self-restraint, moral discipline, and respect for boundaries.

Light does not enter a space overwhelmed by chaos and impulse. It requires clarity, order, and openness. Thus, modesty in this Surah is not merely concealment, it is moral refinement. It disciplines desire, reduces distraction, and clears the path from confusion toward illumination.

The light described later in the Surah does not descend into a moral vacuum. It shines upon hearts that have been trained to receive it.

8. The Masjid as a Source and Projector of Divine Light

After establishing moral discipline, modesty, and respect for boundaries, Surah Al-Noor reaches its conceptual center. Allah now discloses the source of all guidance and the mechanism through which it enters human life

ٱللَّهُ نُورُ ٱلسَّمَٰوَٰتِ وَٱلْأَرْضِ ۚ مَثَلُ نُورِهِۦ كَمِشْكَوٰةٍ فِيهَا مِصْبَاحٌ ۖ ٱلْمِصْبَاحُ فِى زُجَاجَةٍ ۖ ٱلزُّجَاجَةُ كَأَنَّهَا كَوْكَبٌ دُرِّىٌّ
يُوقَدُ مِن شَجَرَةٍ مُّبَٰرَكَةٍ زَيْتُونَةٍ لَّا شَرْقِيَّةٍ وَلَا غَرْبِيَّةٍ يَكَادُ زَيْتُهَا يُضِىٓءُ وَلَوْ لَمْ تَمْسَسْهُ نَارٌ ۚ نُّورٌ عَلَىٰ نُورٍ ۗ يَهْدِى
ٱللَّهُ لِنُورِهِۦ مَن يَشَآءُ ۚ وَيَضْرِبُ ٱللَّهُ ٱلْأَمْثَٰلَ لِلنَّاسِ ۗ وَٱللَّهُ بِكُلِّ شَىْءٍ عَلِيمٌ (٣٥)

"Allah is the Light of the heavens and the earth. The parable of His Light is that of a niche within which is a lamp; the lamp is within glass; the glass as if it were a shining star, lit from a blessed olive tree, neither of the east nor of the west, whose oil would almost glow even if untouched by fire. Light upon light. Allah guides to His Light whom He wills." (Al-Noor 24:35)

The parable describes a complete illumination system: a niche that focuses light, a lamp as its source, pure fuel that nearly glows on its own, and a glass so clear it intensifies brightness rather than distorting it. Every element is refined, balanced, and purposeful. The result is not scattered illumination, but concentrated guidance, light upon light.

The Quran then links this parable directly to a physical and social reality:

فِى بُيُوتٍ أَذِنَ ٱللَّهُ أَن تُرْفَعَ وَيُذْكَرَ فِيهَا ٱسْمُهُۥ يُسَبِّحُ لَهُۥ فِيهَا بِٱلْغُدُوِّ وَٱلْءَاصَالِ (٣٦)

"In houses (mosques), which Allah has permitted to be raised and in which His Name is remembered, and His purity is pronounced in the morning and in the evening." (Al-Noor 24:36)

The preposition **فِي (in)** is decisive. Divine light is not abstract; it is cultivated *within* specific institutions. Just as the niche is not the source of light but its organizer and

projector, the Masjid is not the source of revelation but the space in which divine guidance is nurtured, disciplined, and transmitted to society.

Allah then identifies the human carriers of this light:

رِجَالٌ لَّا تُلْهِيهِمْ تِجَـٰرَةٌ وَلَا بَيْعٌ عَن ذِكْرِ ٱللَّهِ وَإِقَامِ ٱلصَّلَوٰةِ وَإِيتَآءِ ٱلزَّكَوٰةِ ۙ يَخَافُونَ يَوْمًا تَتَقَلَّبُ فِيهِ ٱلْقُلُوبُ وَٱلْأَبْصَـٰرُ (٣٧)

"Men whom neither trade nor commerce distracts them from the Remembrance of Allah, establishing prayers, and giving the Zakat. They fear a Day when hearts and eyes will be overturned (out of the horror of the torment of the Day of Resurrection)." (Al-Noor 24: 37)

These are individuals whose priorities are anchored in remembrance, prayer, charity, and accountability. Their hearts are not detached from life but disciplined within it.

Historically, the Masjid fulfilled precisely this role. It was the center of prayer, governance, education, consultation, justice, and social cohesion. From it emerged scholars, judges, leaders, and reformers. The Masjid (jāmiʿ) gave rise to the university (jāmiʿah), and divine light shaped both intellect and character.

In this parable:

- Revelation fuels the lamp,
- The intellect absorbs and processes it,
- The purified soul transmits it without distortion,
- And the Masjid focuses and projects it into society.

When this system functions as intended, individuals emerge as beacons of moral clarity. Divine light does not remain confined within walls, it radiates outward, preparing a community for trust, responsibility, and leadership.

This naturally leads to the next question: Under what conditions does Allah entrust such a community with authority on earth?

9. The Conditional Divine Promise

When Allah makes promises, He does not present them as unconditional guarantees. Rather, His promises are tied to moral readiness and spiritual responsibility. The promise of succession and security on earth is among the most significant collective promises in the Quran:

وَعَدَ ٱللَّهُ ٱلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا۟ مِنكُمْ وَعَمِلُوا۟ ٱلصَّـٰلِحَـٰتِ لَيَسْتَخْلِفَنَّهُمْ فِى ٱلْأَرْضِ كَمَا ٱسْتَخْلَفَ ٱلَّذِينَ مِن قَبْلِهِمْ وَلَيُمَكِّنَنَّ لَهُمْ دِينَهُمُ ٱلَّذِى ٱرْتَضَىٰ لَهُمْ وَلَيُبَدِّلَنَّهُم مِّنۢ بَعْدِ خَوْفِهِمْ أَمْنًا ۚ يَعْبُدُونَنِى لَا يُشْرِكُونَ بِى شَيْـًٔا ۚ وَمَن كَفَرَ بَعْدَ ذَٰلِكَ فَأُو۟لَـٰٓئِكَ هُمُ ٱلْفَـٰسِقُونَ (٥٥) وَأَقِيمُوا۟ ٱلصَّلَوٰةَ وَءَاتُوا۟ ٱلزَّكَوٰةَ وَأَطِيعُوا۟ ٱلرَّسُولَ لَعَلَّكُمْ تُرْحَمُونَ (٥٦)

"Allah has promised those among you who believe and do righteous deeds that He will surely grant them succession in the land, as He granted it to those before

them; that He will firmly establish for them their religion which He has chosen for them; and that He will replace their fear with security, provided that they worship Me and associate nothing with Me. And whoever disbelieves after that, those are the defiantly disobedient. (55) [People], keep up the prayer, pay the Zakah, and obey the Messenger, so that you may receive mercy. (Al-Noor 24:55-56)

This promise includes three major outcomes:

1. Succession and leadership on earth,
2. Empowerment of the chosen religion,
3. Security replacing fear.

Yet Allah explicitly conditions these outcomes. Leadership is not granted for identity, lineage, or aspiration, it is earned through obedience and integrity. The Quran identifies the conditions clearly:

- True belief that manifests in obedience,
- Righteous action that benefits society,
- Exclusive worship of Allah without association,
- Establishment of prayer,
- Payment of zakah,
- Obedience to the Messenger (PBUH).

These are not ritual checklists. They form **the moral infrastructure of leadership.** When these conditions are fulfilled, Allah guarantees stability, empowerment, and mercy. When they are betrayed, empowerment collapses into corruption.

Allah then issues a severe warning:

وَمَن كَفَرَ بَعْدَ ذَٰلِكَ فَأُو۟لَٰٓئِكَ هُمُ ٱلْفَٰسِقُونَ

“And whoever disbelieves after that, those are the defiantly disobedient.” (Al-Noor 24:55)

This is not mere theological disbelief. It is rejection through betrayal of responsibility after empowerment.

Thus, Surah Al-Noor establishes a clear sequence:
moral discipline → illumination → institutional cultivation → conditional empowerment.

The Qur’an then anticipates the final objection: Why should such responsibility be accepted at all? The answer lies in the nature of messengers and accountability.

10. The Nature of Messengers

The Quran repeatedly exposes the false arguments used to reject Allah’s messengers. In this passage, Allah dismantles the claim that a messenger must be extraordinary in wealth or form and reveals the real reason behind rejection: denial of accountability.

وَقَالُواْ مَالِ هَٰذَا ٱلرَّسُولِ يَأۡكُلُ ٱلطَّعَامَ وَيَمۡشِي فِي ٱلۡأَسۡوَاقِۖ لَوۡلَآ أُنزِلَ إِلَيۡهِ مَلَكٞ فَيَكُونَ مَعَهُۥ نَذِيرًا (٧) أَوۡ يُلۡقَىٰٓ إِلَيۡهِ كَنزٌ أَوۡ تَكُونُ لَهُۥ جَنَّةٞ يَأۡكُلُ مِنۡهَاۚ وَقَالَ ٱلظَّٰلِمُونَ إِن تَتَّبِعُونَ إِلَّا رَجُلٗا مَّسۡحُورًا (٨)

"They say, 'What sort of messenger is this? He eats food and walks in the marketplaces! Why has no angel been sent down with him as a warner? (7) Or why has he not been given treasure, or a garden to eat from?' And the wrongdoers say, 'You are only following a man under a spell." (Al-Furqan 25:7-8)

The objections appear material: why is he human, why does he work, why is he not accompanied by angels or wealth? But Allah exposes these claims as pretexts. Their comparisons are confused, their demands inconsistent.

Then the Quran states the real cause explicitly:

بَلۡ كَذَّبُواْ بِٱلسَّاعَةِۖ وَأَعۡتَدۡنَا لِمَن كَذَّبَ بِٱلسَّاعَةِ سَعِيرًا (١١)

"Rather, they deny the Hour, and We have prepared a blazing Fire for those who deny the Hour." (Al-Furqan 25:11)

Rejection of the Messenger is rooted not in intellectual doubt, but in refusal to accept judgment, moral limits, and ultimate accountability.

Allah then establishes a universal rule:

وَمَآ أَرۡسَلۡنَا قَبۡلَكَ مِنَ ٱلۡمُرۡسَلِينَ إِلَّآ إِنَّهُمۡ لَيَأۡكُلُونَ ٱلطَّعَامَ وَيَمۡشُونَ فِي ٱلۡأَسۡوَاقِۗ) ....٢٠)

"We did not send before you any messengers except that they ate food and walked in the marketplaces. ....." (Al-Furqan 25:20)

Messengers are human by divine design so that guidance remains practical and binding. Accepting a human messenger means accepting responsibility. Those who deny the Hour will always reject the Messenger, regardless of how clear the message is.

Conclusion

The selected verses of Juz 18 present a unified Qur'anic logic: moral order precedes social stability, and accountability precedes divine empowerment. Through Surah Al-Noor, Allah establishes boundaries that protect honor, privacy, and trust; disciplines desire through modesty; concentrates guidance within the Masjid; and then promises security and succession, but only upon obedience and sincerity.

The remaining verses remove all excuses. Tests are never beyond human capacity, provision is never outside Allah's control, history is governed by moral law, and messengers are human so guidance cannot be evaded. Rejection, therefore, is not caused by hardship, scarcity, or ambiguity—but by refusal to accept responsibility and the coming of the Hour.

Juz 18 teaches that divine light is not granted to societies that demand power, but to those that submit to moral truth. Where Allah's command is honored, light emerges. Where it is ignored, decline inevitably follows.

Jewels from the Nineteenth Juz: Truth, Integrity, and the Architecture of Divine Guidance

(Verses 21 of Al-Furqan to 55 of Al-Naml)

Introduction

The nineteenth Juz of the Qur'an moves between two vast domains: the architecture of divine guidance and the architecture of human civilization. It opens with Allah revealing the Qur'an as a criterion for all of humanity, and it closes with a prophet-king governing a multi-species civilization with justice, knowledge, and humility. Between these two poles, the Juz weaves together deep spiritual truths, ethical foundations, and civilizational patterns that explain how societies rise, fall, and are judged.

This Juz does not merely call individuals to faith; it shows how belief, knowledge, power, technology, and moral accountability interact. It teaches that guidance is not given randomly, that civilizations are tested by how they use their capacities, and that even the smallest creature can play a decisive role in history.

The following ten Jewels draw out these themes, inviting the reader to see the Qur'an not only as a book of devotion, but as a map of reality itself.

1. The Slow and Thematic Study of the Quran

Truth seekers raise sincere questions in order to clarify matters, verify what is true, and remove doubt. By contrast, those who reject divine authority often raise objections not to understand, but to evade moral and spiritual responsibility. One such objection was voiced by the disbelievers of Mecca, who claimed that they would have believed in the Quran had it been revealed all at once. Allah responds to this claim directly:

وَقَالَ ٱلَّذِينَ كَفَرُواْ لَوۡلَا نُزِّلَ عَلَيۡهِ ٱلۡقُرۡءَانُ جُمۡلَةٗ وَٰحِدَةٗۚ كَذَٰلِكَ لِنُثَبِّتَ بِهِۦ فُؤَادَكَۖ وَرَتَّلۡنَٰهُ تَرۡتِيلٗا (٣٢)

"Those who disbelieve say, "Why was the Quran not revealed to him all at once?" Thus (it is revealed gradually) so that We strengthen your heart with it, and We have arranged it in a deliberate, measured manner." (Al-Furqan 25:32)

This verse not only refutes their objection but also reveals a fundamental principle of how divine guidance was delivered. The phrase (وَرَتَّلۡنَٰهُ تَرۡتِيلٗا) indicates intentional ordering and measured sequencing, not randomness or haste. Classical translations reflect this by rendering it as "in stages," "with deliberate arrangement," or "in a well-ordered manner."

The key term here is tartīl (ترتيل), which appears only twice in the Quran: here, and in Surat al-Muzzammil: (73:4)

وَرَتِّلِ ٱلۡقُرۡءَانَ تَرۡتِيلًا (٤)

“And recite the Qur’an with measured recitation”. (Al-Muzzammil 73:4)

In this verse, tartīl is traditionally understood as a command to recite in a careful, deliberate, and mindful way, clearly articulated, unrushed, and attentive to meaning.

When these two verses are read together, an important symmetry emerges. In Surat al-Furqan, Allah performs tartīl in the mode of revelation in gradual and purposeful revelation to strengthen the heart of the Prophet ﷺ. In Surat al-Muzzammil, the Prophet ﷺ is commanded to perform tartīl in recitation, as preparation for bearing the weight of revelation:

وَرَتِّلِ ٱلْقُرْءَانَ تَرْتِيلاً (٤) إِنَّا سَ نُلْقِى عَلَيْكَ قَوْلاً ثَقِيلاً (٥)

“Recite the Qur’an with measured recitation. (4) Indeed, We are about to place upon you a weighty message.” (Al-Muzzammil 73:4-5)

Classically, this pairing indicates that measured recitation supports spiritual endurance, while gradual revelation supports emotional and psychological stability. Both serve the same divine purpose: enabling the Messenger ﷺ to carry a message of immense gravity.

Beyond this, the Quran’s gradual revelation was closely tied to lived events, questions, and struggles faced by the early Muslim community. Guidance was delivered in context, allowing it to be immediately understood, applied, and embodied. In this sense, revelation itself was not only gradual, but educationally structured, another dimension of divine tartīl.

Linguistically, the root ر ت ل (r-t-l) conveys the idea of ordered arrangement and deliberate alignment of similar elements. Classical usage includes expressions such as ratala al-khayl (رتل الخيل), meaning to arrange horses of similar type in a disciplined row. This denotes not mere sequence, but purposeful organization based on relevance and similarity.

In this light, studying the Quran thematically, by gathering and correlating verses that address a single subject, may be understood as a reflective application of the Quran’s tartīl-based structure. This approach seeks to honor the Quran’s underlying principle: that guidance is meant to be encountered in an ordered, coherent, and integrated way.

Thus, just as divine tartīl organized revelation in a form suited to human capacity and lived reality, thematic study seeks to allow the Quran to explain itself, as expressed in the classical principle: القرآن يفسر بعضه بعضًا “The Qur’an explains itself through itself.”

2. The Best Tafseer of the Quran is the Divine One

The Quran is the Word of Allah, and no one is more qualified to explain it than Allah Himself. This foundational principle is stated explicitly:

وَلَا يَأۡتُونَكَ بِمَثَلٍ إِلَّا جِئۡنَٰكَ بِٱلۡحَقِّ وَأَحۡسَنَ تَفۡسِيرًا (٣٣)

“They do not bring you any example except that We bring you the truth and the best explanation.” (Al-Furqan 25:33)

Classical scholars understood this verse as the foundation of Quranic self-interpretation: (The Qur’an explains itself through itself “القرآن يفسر بعضه بعضًا”). Therefore, the highest form of interpretation is using the Quran to explain the Quran: Ambiguous verses are clarified by explicit ones, general statements by specific ones, and concise passages by fuller explanations found elsewhere in the text.

Scholars like al-Shāṭibī noted that the Quran is not structured like a linear textbook. Instead, it weaves central themes, such as faith, divine justice, and mercy, across various contexts. These repetitions are not redundant; they offer variations that deepen meaning. Understanding a topic, therefore, requires a thematic approach: gathering all relevant verses to allow their cumulative message and internal coherence to emerge.

This explains why the Prophet ﷺ did not leave verse-by-verse commentary. His mission was to embody and apply the message, while the Quran maintained its own explanatory framework. Scholars such as Ibn Taymiyyah noted that the Prophet ﷺ provided clarification primarily where it was needed for law and practice.

The Quran does not require an external authority to speak for it; it invites every believer to engage in *tadabbur* (deep reflection). To balance direct engagement with scholarly tradition, consider this approach:

1. Thematic Synthesis: Gather all verses on a specific theme and reflect on their patterns and connections.
2. Scholarly Refinement: Consult *tafsīr* literature after initial reflection. This allows the scholars to enrich and refine your understanding rather than replace it.

Starting with *tafsīr* alone risks narrowing your perspective to a specific author’s historical context. By allowing the Quran to speak first, you honor the Divine Word while remaining humble before the wisdom of the scholars. This balance preserves personal responsibility and fulfills the Quranic invitation to sincere, thoughtful engagement.

3. Shadow

The following verses highlight Allah’s control over the shadow as a sign of cosmic order and divine governance:

أَلَمۡ تَرَ إِلَىٰ رَبِّكَ كَيۡفَ مَدَّ ٱلظِّلَّ وَلَوۡ شَآءَ لَجَعَلَهُۥ سَاكِنًا ثُمَّ جَعَلۡنَا ٱلشَّمۡسَ عَلَيۡهِ دَلِيلاً (٤٥) ثُمَّ قَبَضۡنَٰهُ إِلَيۡنَا قَبۡضًا يَسِيرًا (٤٦)

“Have you not seen how your Lord spread the shadow. If He willed, He could have made it still. But We have made the sun its guide (45) Then We withdraw it to Us a gradual concealed withdrawal.” (Al-Furqan 25:45-46)

The Quran directs our attention to the movement of shadows, a familiar yet profound occurrence. Physically, a shadow appears when an object obstructs light. As the Earth rotates, the sun's relative position shifts, causing shadows to lengthen, shorten, and move. The Quran beautifully describes the sun as a "guide" for the shadow, acknowledging that its celestial motion governs the shadow's behavior. While science explains this through rotation and orbit, the Quranic perspective views this predictability as a reflection of divine order rather than mere chance

Shadows are essential to the Earth's delicate equilibrium:

- Climate Regulation: By reducing solar energy on specific surfaces, shadows create temperature differentials that drive air movement and influence local climates.
- Visual Perception: Light and shadow provide depth, shape, and spatial definition; without them, our visual world would appear flat and indistinguishable.
- Sustainability of Life: The balance between light and shade is part of a system that includes photosynthesis and the water cycle. While light fuels growth and oxygen production, the alternating shade regulates the heat that makes regions habitable.

The invitation to observe the "stretching and withdrawing" of shadows is more than poetic imagery. It is a call to recognize the intricate coordination between light, motion, and biology. In these daily shifts, the believer is invited to see the wisdom of the Creator and His sustaining power over the physical laws that make life possible

4. Rank Yourself Against the Righteous Slaves of Allah

In this remarkable passage, Allah describes the defining qualities of His chosen servants, ʿIbād al-Raḥman, the servants of Al-Rahman. These verses offer a complete moral and spiritual profile that every sincere believer is invited to measure himself against:

وَعِبَادُ ٱلرَّحۡمَٰنِ ٱلَّذِينَ يَمۡشُونَ عَلَى ٱلۡأَرۡضِ هَوۡنٗا وَإِذَا خَاطَبَهُمُ ٱلۡجَٰهِلُونَ قَالُواْ سَلَٰمٗا (٦٣) وَٱلَّذِينَ يَبِيتُونَ
لِرَبِّهِمۡ سُجَّدٗا وَقِيَٰمٗا (٦٤) وَٱلَّذِينَ يَقُولُونَ رَبَّنَا ٱصۡرِفۡ عَنَّا عَذَابَ جَهَنَّمَۖ إِنَّ عَذَابَهَا كَانَ غَرَامًا (٦٥) إِنَّهَا
سَآءَتۡ مُسۡتَقَرّٗا وَمُقَامٗا (٦٦) وَٱلَّذِينَ إِذَآ أَنفَقُواْ لَمۡ يُسۡرِفُواْ وَلَمۡ يَقۡتُرُواْ وَكَانَ بَيۡنَ ذَٰلِكَ قَوَامٗا (٦٧) وَٱلَّذِينَ
لَا يَدۡعُونَ مَعَ ٱللَّهِ إِلَٰهًا ءَاخَرَ وَلَا يَقۡتُلُونَ ٱلنَّفۡسَ ٱلَّتِي حَرَّمَ ٱللَّهُ إِلَّا بِٱلۡحَقِّ وَلَا يَزۡنُونَۚ وَمَن يَفۡعَلۡ ذَٰلِكَ يَلۡقَ
أَثَامٗا (٦٨) يُضَٰعَفۡ لَهُ ٱلۡعَذَابُ يَوۡمَ ٱلۡقِيَٰمَةِ وَيَخۡلُدۡ فِيهِۦ مُهَانًا (٦٩) إِلَّا مَن تَابَ وَءَامَنَ وَعَمِلَ عَمَلٗا صَٰلِحٗا
فَأُوْلَٰٓئِكَ يُبَدِّلُ ٱللَّهُ سَيِّـَٔاتِهِمۡ حَسَنَٰتٖۗ وَكَانَ ٱللَّهُ غَفُورٗا رَّحِيمٗا (٧٠) وَمَن تَابَ وَعَمِلَ صَٰلِحٗا فَإِنَّهُۥ يَتُوبُ إِلَى
ٱللَّهِ مَتَابٗا (٧١) وَٱلَّذِينَ لَا يَشۡهَدُونَ ٱلزُّورَ وَإِذَا مَرُّواْ بِٱللَّغۡوِ مَرُّواْ كِرَامٗا (٧٢) وَٱلَّذِينَ إِذَا ذُكِّرُواْ بِـَٔايَٰتِ
رَبِّهِمۡ لَمۡ يَخِرُّواْ عَلَيۡهَا صُمّٗا وَعُمۡيَانٗا (٧٣)

The Righteous Slaves of Al-Raḥmān are those who:

1. Walk upon the earth with humility.

2. Respond to ignorance with dignity and peace.
3. Spend their nights in prayer, standing and prostrating before their Lord.
4. Pray earnestly for protection from Hell, recognizing the seriousness of its punishment.
5. Show moderation in their spending, neither wasteful nor stingy.
6. Worship none besides Allah.
7. Do not taking a life unjustly.
8. Guard their chastity and stay away from immorality.
9. Repent sincerely and do righteous deeds when they err, trusting that Allah can transform their sins into good deeds.

10. Do not bear false witness or participate in deceit.
11. Pass by idle and degrading speech with dignity.
12. Respond to Allah's signs with open hearts and attentive minds, not with heedlessness.

Together, these qualities form a complete framework for the Islamic personality, built upon three interconnected foundations:

- Iman (faith): expressed through devotion, reliance on Allah, and sincere repentance.
- Ibadah (worship and obedience): manifested in prayer, moral discipline, and balanced living.
- Akhlaq (character): reflected in humility, self-control, honesty, and mercy toward others.

These verses show that Islam is not merely belief or ritual. It is a holistic way of being in the world, balancing devotion to Allah with responsibility toward others

Allah concludes this passage by promising forgiveness, mercy, and lasting honor in Paradise for those who embody these traits. These verses are not meant only to inspire admiration; they are meant to invite honest self-evaluation. Every believer is called to ask: Which of these qualities have I truly adopted? Which ones still need work?

5. The Singularity of the Righteous and the Messengers

Among the defining qualities of ʿIbād al-Raḥmān is their profound supplication:

وَٱلَّذِينَ يَقُولُونَ رَبَّنَا هَبۡ لَنَا مِنۡ أَزۡوَٰجِنَا وَذُرِّيَّٰتِنَا قُرَّةَ أَعۡيُنٖ وَٱجۡعَلۡنَا لِلۡمُتَّقِينَ إِمَامًا (٧٤)

"And those who say, "Our Lord, grant us from our spouses and children comfort to our eyes and make us an Imam for the people of Taqwa." (Al-Furqan 25:74)

The structure of this supplication is striking. It begins in the plural,"grant us… from our spouses and children", yet it concludes with the singular: "make us an Imam." Grammatically, one might expect "make us Imams," but the Quran deliberately uses the singular (an Imam). This choice conveys a profound theological idea: the truly righteous,

though many in number and scattered across generations, form a single moral and spiritual entity. They are united by one vision, one standard of righteousness, and one path of devotion.

The Quran applies the same principle to the messengers of Allah. Although many prophets were sent across history, their mission is described as one. This is beautifully illustrated in the story of Musa and Harun (peace be upon them). Though two individuals, they are commanded together and described as a single Messenger:

قَالَ كَلَّاۖ فَٱذۡهَبَا بِـَٔايَٰتِنَآۖ إِنَّا مَعَكُم مُّسۡتَمِعُونَ (١٥) فَأۡتِيَا فِرۡعَوۡنَ فَقُولَآ إِنَّا رَسُولُ رَبِّ ٱلۡعَٰلَمِينَ (١٦)
“(Allah) said: " Go you both with Our Signs; indeed, We are with you, listening. (15) "And go both of you to Fir'aun (Pharaoh) and say: 'We both are a Messenger of the Lord of all the worlds.” (Al-Shuara 26:12-16)

The verbs are dual, go both of you, say both of you, yet the noun rasūl (messenger) is singular. The Quran thus emphasizes that the mission, authority, and message are one, even when carried by more than one individual.

This unity is extended across all prophethood. In Surat al-Nisa, the Quran treats belief in all messengers as one indivisible act of faith:
إِنَّ ٱلَّذِينَ يَكۡفُرُونَ بِٱللَّهِ وَرُسُلِهِۦ وَيُرِيدُونَ أَن يُفَرِّقُواْ بَيۡنَ ٱللَّهِ وَرُسُلِهِۦ وَيَقُولُونَ نُؤۡمِنُ بِبَعۡضٖ وَنَكۡفُرُ بِبَعۡضٖ وَيُرِيدُونَ أَن يَتَّخِذُواْ بَيۡنَ ذَٰلِكَ سَبِيلًا (١٥٠) أُوْلَٰٓئِكَ هُمُ ٱلۡكَٰفِرُونَ حَقّٗاۚ وَأَعۡتَدۡنَا لِلۡكَٰفِرِينَ عَذَابٗا مُّهِينٗا (١٥١) وَٱلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُواْ بِٱللَّهِ وَرُسُلِهِۦ وَلَمۡ يُفَرِّقُواْ بَيۡنَ أَحَدٖ مِّنۡهُمۡ أُوْلَٰٓئِكَ سَوۡفَ يُؤۡتِيهِمۡ أُجُورَهُمۡۗ وَكَانَ ٱللَّهُ غَفُورٗا رَّحِيمٗا (١٥٢)
“Verily, those who disbelieve in Allah and His Messengers and wish to make distinction between Allah and His Messengers by saying, "We believe in some but reject others," and wish to adopt a way in between. (150) They are in truth disbelievers. And We have prepared for the disbelievers a humiliating torment. (151) But those who believe in Allah and His Messengers and make no distinction between any of them, He will grant reward, and Allah is Ever Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.” (Al-Nisa 4:150-151)

To reject even one messenger is to fracture the unified chain of divine guidance.

The Quran thus presents both the prophets and the people of taqwa as single, continuous realities across time. They are not disconnected individuals but members of one enduring spiritual body, bound together by the same truth, the same moral vision, and the same devotion to Allah.

The Prophet ﷺ expressed this unity with luminous clarity:
عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ، قَالَ قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صلى الله عليه وسلم " أَنَا أَوْلَى النَّاسِ بِعِيسَى ابْنِ مَرْيَمَ فِي الدُّنْيَا وَالآخِرَةِ، وَالأَنْبِيَاءُ إِخْوَةٌ لِعَلاَّتٍ، أُمَّهَاتُهُمْ شَتَّى، وَدِينُهُمْ وَاحِدٌ ".
“The Prophets are brothers from different mothers; their religion is one.” (Al-Bukhari, 3443; Muslim, 2365)

Therefore, when the righteous pray, “Make us an Imam for the people of taqwa,” they are not asking for personal leadership or social authority. They are asking to belong to this unified caravan of the guided, to be integrated into the same moral and spiritual lineage that carried divine light through all generations.

6. The Divine Support and the Role of the Magicians

The Qur’an describes the decisive moment when Pharaoh’s magicians encountered the truth of Musa’s sign:

فَأُلۡقِيَ ٱلسَّحَرَةُ سَٰجِدِينَ (٤٦) قَالُوٓاْ ءَامَنَّا بِرَبِّ ٱلۡعَٰلَمِينَ (٤٧) رَبِّ مُوسَىٰ وَهَٰرُونَ (٤٨)
“So, the magicians were cast down in prostration. (46) They said, ‘We believe in the Lord of the worlds, (47) the Lord of Musa and Harun.” (Al-Shuara 26:46-48)

The phrasing فَأُلْقِيَ (“were cast down”) is deeply significant. By using the passive voice, the Quran conveys a sense of sudden, overpowering force. It suggests that the magicians did not arrive at a slow, hesitant decision; rather, the truth they witnessed was so unmistakable that it compelled them into prostration before conscious deliberation could even intervene.

Theologically, this moment is profound because of who these men were. They were not mere spectators; they were the elite experts of their craft and the pillars of Pharaoh’s ideological authority.

- Expert Witnesses: By declaring that Musa’s miracle was not magic but divine truth, they provided the most credible expert testimony possible against Pharaoh’s claims.
- Divine Irony: Allah turned the very instruments of Pharaoh’s power into witnesses for the Truth, dismantling the regime's authority from within.

The Quran emphasizes the depth of their transformation through their response to Pharaoh’s threats. Despite his vows of mutilation and crucifixion, they remained unshakable. Their faith was not just immediate; it was informed by their professional understanding and empowered by divine grace.

From a Quranic perspective, the magicians represent a divine pattern: Truth is often made manifest through those best equipped to recognize its authenticity. Their story serves as a powerful example of how divine guidance can penetrate and overturn entrenched falsehood, transforming its most skilled defenders into instruments of truth.

7. Bani Israel After the Drowning of Pharaoh

The Quran gives significant attention to the fate of Bani Israel both before and after the drowning of Pharaoh and his army. Among the key verses describing the aftermath are the following:

فَأَخْرَجْنَـٰهُم مِّن جَنَّـٰتٍ وَعُيُونٍ (٥٧) وَكُنُوزٍ وَمَقَامٍ كَرِيمٍ (٥٨) كَذَٰلِكَ وَأَوْرَثْنَـٰهَا بَنِىٓ إِسْرَٰٓءِيلَ (٥٩)

“So, We expelled them from gardens and springs, (57) and from treasures and an honorable station. (58) Thus, it was, and We caused the Children of Israel to inherit them.” (Al-Shuara 26:57-59)

These verses state that Pharaoh’s people were stripped of their wealth, resources, and status, and that Bani Israel were made heirs to what had been taken from them. This immediately raises an interpretive question: what exactly did this inheritance entail?

Classical tafsir generally does not interpret these verses as meaning that Bani Israel ruled Egypt itself. Many commentators understand this inheritance as a pattern: Allah removes wealth, and power from oppressors and grants similar blessings to the oppressed elsewhere and at a later stage. Others interpret the inheritance as referring to the blessed lands of the eastern Mediterranean, based on verses in Surat Al-Araf:

فَأَخَذْنَاهُمْ فَأَغْرَقْنَاهُمْ فِي الْيَمِّ ... وَأَوْرَثْنَا الْقَوْمَ الَّذِينَ كَانُوا يُسْتَضْعَفُونَ مَشَارِقَ الْأَرْضِ وَمَغَارِبَهَا الَّتِي بَارَكْنَا فِيهَا

“So We took vengeance on them and drowned them in the sea… And We made the people who had been oppressed inherit the eastern and western parts of the land which We had blessed.” (Al-Araf 7:136–137)

The Historical Question

Outside the Quran, the Exodus is one of the most debated episodes in ancient Near Eastern history. Modern scholarship remains divided between three broad positions:

- A large-scale departure from Egypt occurred, reflected mainly in biblical tradition with limited archaeological traces.
- The Exodus is largely a literary construction with no recoverable historical core.
- Elements of the narrative (foreign laborers in Egypt, Semitic populations, eventual movement into Canaan) are historically plausible, but the unified story reflects later shaping.

Likewise, multiple chronologies have been proposed, most commonly ranging from the 15th to the 13th centuries BCE. Several New Kingdom pharaohs have been suggested as candidates (Thutmose III-18th Dynasty, Amenhotep II-18th Dynasty, Ramesses II -19th Dynasty, Merneptah -19th Dynasty, and Ramesses III-20th Dynasty), but no consensus exists.

It must also be noted that the absence of direct Egyptian records of a drowned pharaoh is not unusual, as Egyptian royal inscriptions were designed to preserve triumph, not catastrophe. Defeats, disasters, and humiliations were omitted or reinterpreted rather than recorded.

Quranic Data That Merit Investigation

While archaeology remains uncertain, the Quran provides a remarkably consistent internal dataset that can serve as a framework for future historical inquiry. When the relevant passages are assembled [e.g., Al-Araf (7); Yunus (10); Al-Isra (17); Ṭaha (20); Al-Shuara (26); Al-Qaṣaṣ (28); Ghafir (40)], several patterns emerge:

1. Political and Narrative Consistency
   - The Qur'an presents a single Pharaoh across Musa's story, from infancy to destruction.
   - His power, arrogance, and downfall are personalized and total.
   - No successor dynasty is mentioned after the drowning; the narrative focuses on the collapse of his authority.

2. Linguistic Precision
   - The ruler in Yusuf's time is called malik (king), while Musa's antagonist is called firʿawn, aligning with Egyptological evidence that "Pharaoh" became a formal royal title in the New Kingdom period (beginning with the 18th dynasty around the year 1550 BCE under Ahmose I who expelled the Hyksos and unified Egypt).

3. Destruction of Pharaoh's Works

The Qur'an repeatedly emphasizes not only Pharaoh's death but the destruction of what he built:

وَدَمَّرْنَا مَا كَانَ يَصْنَعُ فِرْعَوْنُ وَقَوْمُهُۥ وَمَا كَانُوا يَعْرِشُونَ

This language invites correlation with archaeological patterns of abandoned or disrupted royal infrastructure, though no specific site is named.

4. Inheritance Language

The repeated use of inheritance in connection with Bani Israel is linguistically significant. It refers to taking over what belonged to the defeated party. Whether this included Egypt itself or only later settlement elsewhere remains an open Quranic question rather than a settled tafsir conclusion.

Conclusion

The Qur'an presents the Exodus as a real historical collapse of tyranny followed by a transfer of power and blessing. While modern archaeology has not yet reconstructed this episode with certainty, the Quranic account provides coherent and testable narrative that invite serious interdisciplinary investigation rather than dismissal.
This is not a suggestion that archaeology must confirm the Quran, it is an argument that the Quran preserves historical data that archaeology has not yet fully recovered.

8. The People of Ad: A Quran-Based Hypothesis

The Quran provides unusually rich descriptions of the civilization of Ad. In Suat Al-Shuara, their prophet Hud addresses them as a people of power, engineering, and arrogance:

أَتَبْنُونَ بِكُلِّ رِيعٍ ءَايَةً تَعْبَثُونَ (١٢٨) وَتَتَّخِذُونَ مَصَانِعَ لعلكم تَخْلُدُونَ (١٢٩) وَإِذَا بَطَشْتُم بَطَشْتُمْ جَبَّارِينَ (١٣٠)

"Do you build monuments on every high place, just for fun? (128) "And do you take maṣani, so you may live forever (129) " And when you strike, you strike as tyrants? "(Al-Shuara 26:128-130)

Rather than limiting the word maṣani (مصانع) to pre-modern installations, the Quran deliberately uses a term whose semantic range expands with human technological development. The term maṣani (مصانع) derives from the root ṣ-n-aʿ, meaning to make, engineer, construct, or fabricate with skill. Unlike words for houses, palaces, or fortresses, maṣāniʿ denotes places of engineered production and civilizational construction. The verse does not say that the buildings were meant to last forever; it says that the people took these engineered complexes as though *they themselves* would live forever, implying long-term societal dependence on large-scale, technologically maintained infrastructure.

Despite the detailed Quranic descriptions of Ad's civilization, no archaeological consensus exists regarding Ad. One reason is that investigation has often been guided by geographical traditions rather than by the Qur'an's internal data. A Quran-first research program requires assembling all relevant verses and deriving a self-contained civilizational profile before searching for material correlates.

From the Quran alone, the people of Ad emerge as:

- An early post-Flood civilization
- Inhabiting or dominating sand-dune regions (*al-Aḥqāf*)
- Possessing exceptional physical strength
- Builders of pillar-based monumental architecture (*Iram dhāt al-ʿimād*)
- Operators of large-scale **maṣāniʿ,** engineered production facilities
- Destroyed by a sustained, extreme wind that annihilated the population but spared the structures

Hypothesis

Based strictly on this Quranic dataset, a testable hypothesis may be stated: "Ad constituted a technologically ambitious, high-capacity engineered society situated at the margins of major sand systems and habitable basins, whose collapse resulted from an extreme, sustained wind disaster capable of killing human populations while leaving major structures and installations standing."

This model can be tested against:

- Paleoenvironmental reconstructions of ancient dune-margin societies,
- Archaeological evidence of early pillar-based monumental engineering,
- Geological indicators of large-scale wind-driven devastation.

This Quran-first methodology differs fundamentally from tafsir-driven geography. Rather than fixing Ad to a location before analysis, it derives structural descriptors, dunes, pillars, engineered complexes, and wind destruction, directly from the Quran. Classical tafsir traditions may later be examined as historical memory, but they should not control the primary model.

If archaeology converges with those traditions, both are strengthened. If it diverges, the Qur'anic pattern remains primary. In this way, the Qur'an is honored as a self-consistent civilizational witness, while external sciences are invited to test rather than dictate interpretation.

9. Why Shuayb Is Not Called "Their Brother"

In Surat Al-Shuara, the Quran introduces several prophets using a strikingly consistent formula:

إِذۡ قَالَ لَهُمۡ أَخُوهُمۡ نُوحٌ أَلَا تَتَّقُونَ (١٠٦)

When their brother Nuh said to them: Will you not have Tawqa? (106))

إِذۡ قَالَ لَهُمۡ أَخُوهُمۡ هُودٌ أَلَا تَتَّقُونَ (١٢٤)

When their brother Hud said to them: Will you not have Tawqa? (124))

إِذۡ قَالَ لَهُمۡ أَخُوهُمۡ صَٰلِحٌ أَلَا تَتَّقُونَ (١٤٢)

When their brother Saleh said to them: Will you not have Tawqa? (142))

إِذۡ قَالَ لَهُمۡ أَخُوهُمۡ لُوطٌ أَلَا تَتَّقُونَ (١٦١)

When their brother Lot said to them: Will you not have Tawqa? (161))

In each case, the prophet is introduced as "their brother" (أخوهم). This Quranic expression signifies tribal, ethnic, and social belonging. These prophets were not outsiders; they were born from within their communities. Their message therefore carried not only divine authority but moral proximity: they were calling their own people to accountability.

Yet when the Quran turns to the people of Al-Aykah, the pattern is deliberately broken:

كَذَّبَ أَصۡحَٰبُ لۡـَٔيۡكَةِ ٱلۡمُرۡسَلِينَ (١٧٦) إِذۡ قَالَ لَهُمۡ شُعَيۡبٌ أَلَا تَتَّقُونَ (١٧٧) إِنِّي لَكُمۡ رَسُولٌ أَمِينٞ (١٧٨)

"The dwellers of Al-Aikah [near Madyan (Midian)] belied the Messengers. (176) When Shuaib said to them: "Will you not have Taqwa? (177) "I am a trustworthy Messenger to you." (Al-Shuara 26:176-178)

Shuayb is not called "their brother." This omission is not stylistic; it is structural. Elsewhere, Shuaib is called the brother of Madyan:

وَإِلَىٰ مَدْيَنَ أَخَاهُمْ شُعَيْبًا (85) .....

“And to Madyan (We sent) their brother, Shuaib….” (Al-Araf 7:85)

This means that Al-Aykah and Madyan are not the same people, even though they were geographically and economically connected. Prophet Shuaib belonged by blood and lineage to Madyan, but he was sent as a messenger to the people of al-Aykah, a different social group.

The Qur’an is therefore drawing a subtle but powerful distinction:

- Madyan = Shuayb’s people (his brothers)
- Al-Aykah = a connected but distinct economic-religious community

The people of Al-Aykah appears to be organized around a commercial hub, trade zone, or resource-rich settlement rather than a lineage-based tribe. Thus, Prophet Shuaib was addressing a commercial civilization whose corruption lay in fraud, exploitation, and economic injustice. He said to them:

۞ أَوۡفُواْ ٱلۡكَيۡلَ وَلَا تَكُونُواْ مِنَ ٱلۡمُخۡسِرِينَ (١٨١) وَزِنُواْ بِٱلۡقِسۡطَاسِ ٱلۡمُسۡتَقِيمِ (١٨٢) وَلَا تَبۡخَسُواْ ٱلنَّاسَ أَشۡيَآءَهُمۡ وَلَا تَعۡثَوۡاْ فِي ٱلۡأَرۡضِ مُفۡسِدِينَ (١٨٣)

“Give full measure: do not sell others short. (181) Weigh with correct scales; (182) do not defraud people of what is theirs and do not spread corruption on earth.” (Al-Shuara 26:181-183)

By withholding the term “brother,” the Quran signals that Prophet Shuaib was sent to the people of Al-Aykah as a divinely appointed moral auditor. His message centered on:

- dishonest trade
- false weights and measures
- economic oppression
- social injustice

This linguistic precision reinforces one of the Quran’s deepest patterns: **Prophethood is always socially embedded, but never socially constrained.**

10 Blame Yourself first Before Accusing Others

When Prophet Sulaiman noticed that the hoopoe was not present, he did not immediately accuse it of negligence. Instead, he first questioned his own perception:

وَتَفَقَّدَ ٱلطَّيۡرَ فَقَالَ مَا لِيَ لَآ أَرَى ٱلۡهُدۡهُدَ أَمۡ كَانَ مِنَ ٱلۡغَآئِبِينَ (٢٠)

“He inspected the birds, and said: "Why I do not see the hoopoe, or is he among the absentees?” (Al-Naml 27:20)

This subtle wording teaches a profound principle of leadership and moral discipline. Sulaiman first considers the possibility that he himself may be mistaken before concluding that the hoopoe is absent. The Quran thus presents self-examination as the first step before judgment, a principle that applies to all human relationships.

Only after this does Sulaiman speak of possible punishment, showing that accountability follows verification, not assumption. Shortly thereafter, the hoopoe returns:

فَمَكَثَ غَيْرَ بَعِيدٍ فَقَالَ أَحَطتُ بِمَا لَمْ تُحِطْ بِهِۦ وَجِئْتُكَ مِن سَبَإٍۭ بِنَبَإٍ يَقِينٍ (٢٢)

"It did not stay away long, and it said: 'I have grasped what you have not grasped, and I have come to you from Saba (Sheba) with certain news." (27:22)

The Quran emphasizes two things here. First, the hoopoe's absence was not neglect; it was purposeful. Second, even a seemingly small member of the community had access to information crucial to the mission of a prophet.

This scene illustrates a deeper Quranic principle: Allah distributes knowledge and perception across His creation in ways that transcend hierarchy. Sulaiman, a prophet and king, is informed by a bird. Authority does not eliminate the need for listening; power does not negate the value of the smallest contributor.

The hoopoe's report concerns the political and religious state of a distant people, showing that Allah uses even the smallest creatures to uncover hidden realities and bring them to light. This is not about zoology; it is about divine governance. The universe, in all its parts, participates in Allah's unfolding plan.

Thus, the story teaches three enduring lessons:

- examine yourself before blaming others,
- do not dismiss anyone as insignificant,
- and recognize that Allah may deliver crucial truth through the least expected means.

Together, these form a Quranic ethic of humility, responsibility, and attentive leadership.

Conclusion

The nineteenth Juz presents a breathtaking vision of reality: a universe ordered by divine wisdom, societies tested by how they use power, and individuals measured by humility and truthfulness. From the shadow that cools the earth, to the bird that informs a prophet, to the rise and fall of civilizations, everything moves within Allah's moral and cosmic law.

These Jewels invite the reader to see the Qur'an not as a collection of isolated teachings but as an integrated vision of reality, one that binds faith, reason, nature, and history into a single coherent whole.

Jewels from the Twentieth Juz: Faith, Trial, and Human Destiny

(Al-Naml 27:56 – Al-Ankabout 29:45)

Introduction

This chapter presents a selection of Qur'anic jewels from the twentieth Juz, illustrating how brief yet precise verses convey profound guidance on faith, morality, destiny, and the unseen. Each section highlights a central theme, such as trials, reliance upon Allah, the signs of the Hour, the responsibility of knowledge, and the moral purpose of worship, demonstrating how the Qur'an addresses both the intellect and the heart. Together, these reflections show that Qur'anic brevity is not a limitation, but a vehicle for depth, clarity, and enduring relevance.

1. The Rise of the Beast – A major Pre-Hour Sign

In the famous Hadith of Jibril, the Angel asked the Prophet ﷺ four questions: What is Islam? What is Iman? What is Ihsan? And what are the signs of the Day of Judgment? The Prophet ﷺ answered each of them. After Jibril departed, the Companions asked who the visitor had been, and the Prophet ﷺ replied: "That was Jibril; he came to teach you your religion." (Muslim)

This hadith shows that Islam, as a complete religion, consists of four integrated dimensions:

1. **Islam**: the outward acts of worship that regulate our physical submission to Allah.
2. **Iman:** the articles of faith that reside in the heart.
3. **Ihsan:** excellence in conduct, living with constant awareness that Allah sees us.
4. **The Signs of the Hour**: future realities that believers must understand in order to remain firm when trials and confusion arise.

These four together define not only how a believer lives, but also how he understands the destiny of the world.

Some of the signs of the Hour mark a point beyond which repentance and new faith will no longer be accepted. Allah says:

هَلۡ يَنظُرُونَ إِلَّآ أَن تَأۡتِيَهُمُ ٱلۡمَلَٰٓئِكَةُ أَوۡ يَأۡتِيَ رَبُّكَ أَوۡ يَأۡتِيَ بَعۡضُ ءَايَٰتِ رَبِّكَۗ يَوۡمَ يَأۡتِي بَعۡضُ ءَايَٰتِ رَبِّكَ لَا يَنفَعُ نَفۡسًا إِيمَٰنُهَا لَمۡ تَكُنۡ ءَامَنَتۡ مِن قَبۡلُ أَوۡ كَسَبَتۡ فِيٓ إِيمَٰنِهَا خَيۡرٗاۗ قُلِ ٱنتَظِرُوٓاْ إِنَّا مُنتَظِرُونَ (الأنعام: 158).

"Are they waiting for the angels to come to them, or for your Lord to come, or for some of the signs of your Lord to come? On the Day when some of your Lord's signs come, no soul will benefit from its faith if it did not believe before or earn good through its faith. Say: 'Wait; indeed, we too are waiting" (Al-Naam 6:158)

Among the many signs of the Hour mentioned by the Prophet ﷺ, some are minor and others are major. The Qur'an itself refers explicitly to four of the major signs, one of which appears in this Juz: the emergence of "a creature that moves upon the earth" (dabbah) that will speak to mankind:

وَإِذَا وَقَعَ ٱلۡقَوۡلُ عَلَيۡهِمۡ أَخۡرَجۡنَا لَهُمۡ دَآبَّةٗ مِّنَ ٱلۡأَرۡضِ تُكَلِّمُهُمۡ أَنَّ ٱلنَّاسَ كَانُواْ بِـَٔايَٰتِنَا لَا يُوقِنُونَ (٨٢)

"When the decree (of the Hour) comes upon them, We will bring forth for them a creature (dabbah) from the earth that will speak to them, because people were not certain about our signs." (Al-Naml 27:82)

Most narrations describing the Beast in detail are weak, and even the sounder reports remain ambiguous. This has led some scholars to observe that the Arabic word dabbah (a creature that moves upon the earth) can linguistically include human beings, leaving open the possibility that the creature may not be an animal in the conventional sense.

Among the more reliable reports is the hadith narrated by al-Tirmidhi and Ibn Mājah, in which the Prophet ﷺ said:

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ، أَنَّ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ صلى الله عليه وسلم قَالَ " تَخْرُجُ الدَّابَّةُ مَعَهَا خَاتَمُ سُلَيْمَانَ وَعَصَا مُوسَى فَتَجْلُو وَجْهَ الْمُؤْمِنِ وَتَخْتِمُ أَنْفَ الْكَافِرِ بِالْخَاتَمِ حَتَّى إِنَّ أَهْلَ الْخِوَانِ لَيَجْتَمِعُونَ فَيَقُولُ هَاهَا يَا مُؤْمِنُ وَيُقَالُ هَاهَا يَا كَافِرُ وَيَقُولُ هَذَا يَا كَافِرُ وَهَذَا يَا مُؤْمِنُ " .

"A creature will emerge carrying the staff of Musa and the ring of Suliman. It will brighten the face of the believer and mark the nose of the disbeliever with the ring, so that when people sit together, they will say, "Here is a believer, and 'Here is a disbeliever." (At-Tirmidhi 3187, Ibn Majah 4066)

This sign represents a decisive moment when inner belief becomes outwardly visible, and ambiguity between faith and disbelief comes to an end.

The Qur'an also mentions three other major pre-Hour signs:

1. The return of Prophet 'Isa (Jesus):

وَإِن مِّنۡ أَهۡلِ ٱلۡكِتَٰبِ إِلَّا لَيُؤۡمِنَنَّ بِهِۦ قَبۡلَ مَوۡتِهِۦۖ ..... (١٥٩)

"There is none of the People of the Book but will believe in him (Isa) before his death; ….." (Al-Nisa 4:159)

2. The release of Gog and Magog (Ya'juj and Ma'juj):

حَتَّىٰٓ إِذَا فُتِحَتۡ يَأۡجُوجُ وَمَأۡجُوجُ وَهُم مِّن كُلِّ حَدَبٖ يَنسِلُونَ (٩٦)

"When Gog and Magog are let loose and they surge from every elevation." (Al-Anbiya 21:96)

3. The widespread Smoke:

فَٱرۡتَقِبۡ يَوۡمَ تَأۡتِي ٱلسَّمَآءُ بِدُخَانٖ مُّبِينٖ (١٠) يَغۡشَى ٱلنَّاسَۖ هَٰذَا عَذَابٌ أَلِيمٞ (١١)

“So, watch for a day when the sky brings visible smoke (10) that will envelop people. This will be a painful punishment.” (Al-Dukhan 44:10-11)

In addition, the Prophet (PBUH) mentioned ten major signs in a famous hadith narrated by Muslim, Abu Dawud, and al-Tirmidhi. Hudhaifah ibn Usayd (RA) reported that the Prophet (PBUH) said:

عن حذيفة بن أسيد الغفاري رضي الله عنه قال: اطلع النبي صلى الله عليه وسلم علينا ونحن نتذاكر فقال: ((ماذا تذاكرون؟))، قالوا: نذكر الساعة، قال: ((إنها لن تقوم حتى تروا قبلها عشر آيات؛ فذكر الدخان، والدجال، والدابة، وطلوع الشمس من مغربها، ونزول عيسى ابن مريم، ويأجوج ومأجوج، وثلاثة خسوف؛ خسف بالمشرق، وخسف بالمغرب، وخسف بجزيرة العرب، وآخر ذلك نار تخرج من اليمن تطرد الناس إلى محشرهم))]رواه مسلم (2901)، **وأبو داود** (4311)، والترمذي (2183)[.

“The Hour will not come until you see ten signs: the smoke, the Dajjal, the Beast, the rising of the sun from the west, the descent of ‘Isa son of Maryam, the emergence of Gog and Magog, three landslides: one in the east, one in the west, and one in the Arabian Peninsula, and finally a fire that will emerge from Yemen driving people to their place of assembly.” (Muslim, Abu Daud and Tirmidhi)

It is important to understand that the purpose of learning about the major signs of the Hour is not academic curiosity, nor the construction of speculative timelines. These signs are reminders of an unavoidable reality: this world is temporary, and every soul is moving toward its appointed meeting with Allah. Whether a person witnesses these major signs or not, their own Day of Judgment effectively begins at the moment of death. From that point onward, accountability is certain and irreversible. Therefore, preparation for the Hereafter is not tied to the appearance of global signs, but to daily repentance, sincere faith, righteous action, and a heart attached to Allah. The believer lives in a state of readiness, not because the Beast may emerge or the sun may rise from the west in their lifetime, but because death itself may arrive at any moment.

2. The Mountains – Allah’s Perfect Design

The Qur’an contains many verses that point to the profound order embedded within Allah’s creation. These verses speak in a language accessible to all people, yet they also invite those who reflect deeply to discover layers of meaning that unfold with knowledge and observation. In this way, the Qur’an addresses both the hearts of believers and the minds of thinkers.

One of the most striking examples of this is found in the following verse:

وَتَرَى ٱلۡجِبَالَ تَحۡسَبُهَا جَامِدَةٗ وَهِيَ تَمُرُّ مَرَّ ٱلسَّحَابِۚ صُنۡعَ ٱللَّهِ ٱلَّذِيٓ أَتۡقَنَ كُلَّ شَيۡءٍۚ إِنَّهُۥ خَبِيرُۢ بِمَا تَفۡعَلُونَ (٨٨)

“You see the mountains and think they are motionless, yet they pass by like the clouds pass. Such is the work of Allah, Who has perfected all things. Indeed, He is fully aware of what you do”. (Al-Naml 27:88)

To the naked eye, mountains appear fixed and immovable. Yet the Qur’an declares that they are in motion, moving smoothly and silently, like drifting clouds. This statement

reflects a reality that modern science has only recently come to appreciate mountains are carried along by the motion of the Earth itself.

The Earth rotates on its axis at about 1,000 miles per hour. At the same time, it travels around the Sun at roughly 67,000 miles per hour. Our solar system, in turn, orbits the center of the galaxy at nearly 490,000 miles per hour, while the galaxy itself moves through space at extraordinary speeds. In this vast cosmic motion, mountains, along with everything on Earth, are never truly still.

Yet despite these immense velocities, we experience the world as stable and calm. We walk on solid ground, build cities, and live our lives without feeling any of this motion. This stability is not accidental. It is part of Allah's perfect design. He has synchronized these movements with such precision that life on Earth remains secure, balanced, and habitable.

This delicate balance between enormous motion and perfect stability is one of the great signs of divine mastery. It reveals how Allah governs the universe with flawless order, ensuring that even forces beyond human imagination serve life rather than destroy it.

For this reason, the Qur'an concludes this passage with a call to gratitude and reflection:

وَقُلِ ٱلۡحَمۡدُ لِلَّهِ سَيُرِيكُمۡ ءَايَٰتِهِۦ فَتَعۡرِفُونَهَاۚ وَمَا رَبُّكَ بِغَٰفِلٍ عَمَّا تَعۡمَلُونَ (٩٣)

"Say: 'All praise belongs to Allah. He will show you His signs, and you will recognize them. And your Lord is not unaware of what you do." (Al-Naml 27:93)

The more humanity discovers about the universe, the clearer Allah's signs become. Every new insight into creation is not a challenge to faith, but an invitation to deeper awe, gratitude, and humility before the One who perfected all things.

3. Beware of Personal Exaltation and Mischief

Among the gravest sins that lead a person to destruction are self-exaltation and the spread of corruption through the disregard for human life and dignity. These two evils were the defining characteristics of history's greatest tyrant: Pharaoh. Allah describes him in the Qur'an:

إِنَّ فِرۡعَوۡنَ عَلَا فِى ٱلۡأَرۡضِ وَجَعَلَ أَهۡلَهَا شِيَعًا يَسۡتَضۡعِفُ طَآئِفَةً مِّنۡهُمۡ يُذَبِّحُ أَبۡنَآءَهُمۡ وَيَسۡتَحۡيِۦ نِسَآءَهُمۡۚ إِنَّهُۥ كَانَ مِنَ ٱلۡمُفۡسِدِينَ (٤)

"Indeed, Pharaoh exalted himself in the land and made its people into factions, oppressing a group among them, slaughtering their sons and letting their women live. Indeed, he was one of the corrupters." (Al-Qasas 28:4)

Pharaoh's tyranny did not begin with violence; it began with 'uluww/ علوّ. the desire to rise above others, to dominate, to see oneself as superior. From that arrogance came political division, social stratification, and eventually mass murder. The Qur'an presents

this pattern not as ancient history, but as a recurring human disease: when people elevate themselves above others, corruption soon follows.

For this reason, Allah makes a profound declaration about who deserves the Hereafter:
تِلْكَ ٱلدَّارُ ٱلْأَخِرَةُ نَجْعَلُهَا لِلَّذِينَ لَا يُرِيدُونَ عُلُوًّا فِى ٱلْأَرْضِ وَلَا فَسَادًا ۚ وَٱلْعَـٰقِبَةُ لِلْمُتَّقِينَ (٨٣)
“That Home of the Hereafter (i.e., Paradise) We assign to those who do not desire exaltation on the earth. nor corruption. And the good end is for those who have Taqwa.” (Al-Qasas 28:83)

This verse reveals a timeless law: Paradise is not for those who seek to rise above others, but for those who humble themselves before Allah. It is not for those who dominate and exploit, but for those who restrain their egos and purify their actions.

True faith is therefore not merely what one believes, but how one relates to power, people, and privilege. Every believer is tested with influence, wealth, knowledge, or authority. The question is always the same: Will it produce humility and justice, or arrogance and corruption?

The Qur’an leaves no doubt about the answer that leads to salvation.

4. Brevity in Conveying Multiple Layers of Meaning

One of the linguistic miracles of the Qur’an is its ability to deliver deep, diverse, and emotionally powerful meanings with astonishing brevity. A single verse can contain information, commands, emotional reassurance, and future promise, all woven into a perfectly balanced structure.

A striking example appears in Allah’s address to the mother of Musa (Moses):

وَأَوْحَيْنَآ إِلَىٰٓ أُمِّ مُوسَىٰٓ أَنْ أَرْضِعِيهِ ۖ فَإِذَا خِفْتِ عَلَيْهِ فَأَلْقِيهِ فِى ٱلْيَمِّ وَلَا تَخَافِى وَلَا تَحْزَنِىٓ ۖ إِنَّا رَآدُّوهُ إِلَيْكِ وَجَاعِلُوهُ مِنَ ٱلْمُرْسَلِينَ (٧)
“We inspired the mother of Musa: Nurse him, and when you fear for him, cast him into the river. Do not fear and do not grieve. We will return him to you and make him one of the Messengers" (Al-Qasas 28:7)

In this single verse, Allah conveys eight distinct messages, perfectly balanced in form and meaning:

1. Two statements of information (خبر)
    - We inspired the mother of Musa
    - When you fear for him
2. Two commands (أمر)
    - Nurse him
    - Cast him into the river

3. Two prohibitions (نهي)
    - Do not fear
    - Do not grieve
4. Two glad tidings (بشارة)
    - We will return him to you
    - We will make him one of the messengers

Within a single, flowing sentence, Allah provides guidance, instruction, emotional reassurance, and a vision of the future. The mother of Musa is not only told what to do, but how to feel, and what outcome to expect, all in a moment of extreme distress.

This is not merely eloquence; it is divine precision. Every word is placed where it belongs, and nothing is wasted. The verse addresses the mind, the heart, and the future at the same time, demonstrating how the Qur'an communicates complex realities in a form that is both concise and deeply compassionate.

Such verses remind us that the Qur'an is not only a book of laws or stories, but a perfectly crafted message designed to guide human beings through their most difficult moments with clarity, balance, and hope.

5. Even Pharaoh Was Bound by Law

Although Pharaoh (Fir'awn) was a tyrant who exalted himself above all people, the Qur'anic narrative suggests that his rule was not based on random impulse alone. Rather, he governed within a structured legal and political system. Ancient Egypt was built around the concept of Ma'at/ ماعت., order, justice, balance, and truth. Pharaoh was the supreme authority, but he ruled through courts, officials, and procedures, not through constant arbitrary violence.

This background helps explain a striking feature of the Qur'anic story: Musa was not immediately executed when he returned to Egypt, even though he had previously killed an Egyptian.

Musa had fled Egypt after killing a man, a crime that, in ancient Egypt, was normally punishable by death if proven to be intentional. He then spent many years in Madyan, fulfilling a contractual term of service to his father-in-law:

قَالَ إِنِّيٓ أُرِيدُ أَنۡ أُنكِحَكَ إِحۡدَى ٱبۡنَتَيَّ هَٰتَيۡنِ عَلَىٰٓ أَن تَأۡجُرَنِي ثَمَٰنِيَ حِجَجٖۖ فَإِنۡ أَتۡمَمۡتَ عَشۡرٗا فَمِنۡ عِندِكَۖ ..... (٢٧) .... (٢٨) ۞ فَلَمَّا قَضَىٰ مُوسَى ٱلۡأَجَلَ وَسَارَ بِأَهۡلِهِۦٓ ءَانَسَ مِن جَانِبِ ٱلطُّورِ نَارٗا ..... (٢٩)
"He said, 'I wish to marry you to one of my two daughters, on the condition that you serve me for eight years; but if you complete ten, that will be your own choice …….' (27) …. (28) Then when Moses had completed the term and was traveling with his family, he saw a fire on the side of the mountain ……." (Al-Qasas 28: 29)

This passage shows that Musa remained in Madyan for eight to ten years. His decision to return afterward strongly implies that he believed the immediate legal threat against him had ended because the case had expired due to the statute of limitation in the law.

More importantly, when Musa returned and confronted Pharaoh, Pharaoh did not order his execution for the earlier killing. Instead, he challenged him publicly, debated him, and demanded proof. This behavior only makes sense within a system that, at least formally recognized legal process, evidence, and public procedure.

Ancient Egyptian law was not merely a system of terror. It was a developed judicial structure with courts, judges, records, and high officials such as viziers who administered justice. Pharaoh was regarded as the embodiment of Ma‘at, meaning that even he was expected to rule according to law, order, and legitimacy.

Thus, even in the court of a tyrant, law still exerted a restraining force.

The Qur’an’s depiction is therefore remarkably precise: Pharaoh was oppressive and corrupt, but he was not lawless. His tyranny operated within a system of power, institutions, and legal norms, which Allah would ultimately overthrow through Musa, not by chaos, but by truth.

6. The Diverse Social Position of Bani Israel in Egypt

It is often assumed that all of the Children of Israel were equally oppressed in Egypt. The Qur’an, however, presents a more complex social reality. While many among Bani Israel were subjected to humiliation, forced labor, and persecution, others became wealthy, influential, and integrated into the Egyptian elite, sometimes even participating in the oppression of their own people.

The most striking example of this is Qaroun, whom the Qur’an explicitly identifies as one of the people of Musa:

إِنَّ قَـٰرُونَ كَـانَ مِن قَوْمِ مُوسَىٰ فَبَغَىٰ عَلَيْهِمْ ۖ وَءَاتَيْنَـٰهُ مِنَ ٱلْكُنُوزِ مَآ إِنَّ مَفَاتِحَهُۥ لَتَنُوٓأُ بِٱلْعُصْبَةِ أُو۟لِى ٱلْقُوَّةِ
إِذْ قَالَ لَهُۥ قَوْمُهُۥ لَا تَفْرَحْ ۖ إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ لَا يُحِبُّ ٱلْفَرِحِينَ (٧٦) وَٱبْتَغِ فِيمَآ ءَاتَىٰكَ ٱللَّهُ ٱلدَّارَ ٱلْـَٔاخِرَةَ ۖ وَلَا تَنسَ
نَصِيبَكَ مِنَ ٱلدُّنْيَا ۖ وَأَحْسِن كَمَآ أَحْسَنَ ٱللَّهُ إِلَيْكَ ۖ وَلَا تَبْغِ ٱلْفَسَادَ فِى ٱلْأَرْضِ ۖ إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ لَا يُحِبُّ ٱلْمُفْسِدِينَ (٧٧)
قَالَ إِنَّمَآ أُوتِيتُهُۥ عَلَىٰ عِلْمٍ عِندِىٓ (٧٨)

“Indeed, Qaroun was from the people of Musa, but he transgressed against them. And We gave him treasures whose keys would burden a group of strong men. When his people said to him, ‘Do not exult; Allah does not love the exultant. (76) Seek with what Allah has given you the Home of the Hereafter, and do not forget your share of this world. Do good as Allah has done good to you, and do not seek corruption in the land; indeed, Allah does not love corrupters.’ (77) He said, ‘I was only given it because of knowledge I have.” (Al-Qasas 28:76-78)

These verses reveal several important realities about the social structure of Bani Israel in Egypt:

- Qaroun was “from the people of Musa,” yet he “transgressed against them.” This means that he sided with the power structure rather than with his own oppressed community.
- His extraordinary wealth shows that some Israelites had access to economic and political privilege, becoming part of Egypt’s elite.
- His people reminded him that wealth is a trust: it should lead to gratitude, charity, and moral restraint, not arrogance and corruption.

But Qaroun rejected this moral responsibility. He attributed his success solely to his own knowledge and ability, erasing Allah from the picture. As a result, Allah made him a lasting sign:

فَخَسَفۡنَا بِهِۦ وَبِدَارِهِ ٱلۡأَرۡضَ فَمَا كَانَ لَهُۥ مِن فِئَةٖ يَنصُرُونَهُۥ مِن دُونِ ٱللَّهِ وَمَا كَانَ مِنَ ٱلۡمُنتَصِرِينَ (٨١)

“So, We caused the earth to swallow him and his home. He had no group to help him against Allah, nor was he of those who could save themselves.” (Al-Qasas 28:81)

Qaroun’s story exposes a painful truth: oppressed communities can contain internal collaborators, individuals who use their privilege, wealth, and proximity to power to reinforce injustice rather than resist it. Such people often become more dangerous than the external oppressor.

As for the physical location of Qaroun’s palace or his buried treasure, the Qur’an gives no details. The common association of Qaroun with Lake Qaroun in the Fayoum region is speculative and unsupported by historical or geological evidence. What matters in the Qur’anic narrative is not where his wealth went, but why he lost it. His downfall is not a story of buried gold; it is a warning about buried hearts.

7. The Divine Law: Belief Must be Demonstrated

The Qur’an repeatedly emphasizes that life on earth is a continuous process of testing, and that true success is not granted merely through verbal claims of faith, but through sincerity proven by action and perseverance. Allah states this principle clearly:

أَحَسِبَ ٱلنَّاسُ أَن يُتۡرَكُوٓاْ أَن يَقُولُوٓاْ ءَامَنَّا وَهُمۡ لَا يُفۡتَنُونَ (٢) وَلَقَدۡ فَتَنَّا ٱلَّذِينَ مِن قَبۡلِهِمۡۖ فَلَيَعۡلَمَنَّ ٱللَّهُ ٱلَّذِينَ صَدَقُواْ وَلَيَعۡلَمَنَّ ٱلۡكَٰذِبِينَ (٣)

“Do people think that they will be left alone because they say, ‘We believe,’ and they will not be tested? Indeed, We tested those before them. Thus, Allah will make evident those who are truthful and will make evident the liars.” (Al-Ankabout 29:2-3)

These verses address a recurring question: Why are people tested if Allah already knows their responses in advance? On a literal reading, the phrase (فَلَيَعْلَمَنَّ ٱللَّهُ) ("so that Allah will know") might seem to imply that Allah acquires knowledge through testing. This, however, is impossible. Allah's knowledge is eternal, complete, and independent of time.

The meaning here is not that Allah comes to know something He did not know before, but that His knowledge becomes manifest through outward, recorded actions. Allah does not hold people accountable merely on the basis of foreknowledge, but on the basis of evidence established through lived reality. In this way, judgment is founded on demonstrable proof that no one can dispute.

This principle safeguards the perfection of divine justice. Even with full records, some people would still deny wrongdoing or claim injustice. Absolute justice therefore requires that the evidence emerges from the individual themselves, until denial becomes impossible and acknowledgment becomes inevitable.

The Qur'an illustrates this with a powerful scene from the Day of Judgment:

وَيَوْمَ يُحْشَرُ أَعْدَآءُ ٱللَّهِ إِلَى ٱلنَّارِ فَهُمْ يُوزَعُونَ (١٩) حَتَّىٰٓ إِذَا مَا جَآءُوهَا شَهِدَ عَلَيْهِمْ سَمْعُهُمْ وَأَبْصَـٰرُهُمْ وَجُلُودُهُم بِمَا كَانُوا۟ يَعْمَلُونَ (٢٠) وَقَالُوا۟ لِجُلُودِهِمْ لِمَ شَهِدتُّمْ عَلَيْنَا ۖ قَالُوٓا۟ أَنطَقَنَا ٱللَّهُ ٱلَّذِىٓ أَنطَقَ كُلَّ شَىْءٍ وَهُوَ خَلَقَكُمْ أَوَّلَ مَرَّةٍ وَإِلَيْهِ تُرْجَعُونَ (٢١)

"On the Day when the enemies of Allah are gathered to the Fire. (19) When they arrive to it, their hearing, their sight, and their skins will testify against them regarding what they used to do. (20) And they will say to their skins, 'Why did you testify against us?' They will reply, 'Allah made us speak—the One who makes everything speak. He created you the first time, and to Him you are returned. '" (Fussilat 41:19–21)

Here, a person's own faculties, once used in denial, become witnesses against them. The Qur'an makes clear that this testimony is not imposed arbitrarily, but arises from the very assumption that wrongdoing could be hidden from Allah.

This meaning is further clarified in an authentic hadith narrated by Anas ibn Malik. The Prophet ﷺ described that on the Day of Judgment, a person will argue with Allah, saying:

عن أنس رضي الله عنه قال: قال رسول الله صلى الله عليه وسلم من مخاطبة العبد ربه يقول: يارب ألم تجرني من الظلم؟ قال: يقول: بلى قال: فيقول: فإني أجيز على نفسي إلا شاهدا مني قال: فيقول: كفى بنفسك اليوم عليك شهيدا وبالكرام الكاتبين شهودا قال: فيختم على فيه فيقال لأركانه: انطقي قال: فتنطق بأعماله ثم يخلى بينه وبين الكلام قال: فيقول: بعدا لكنّ وسحقا فعنكنّ كنت أناضل) رواه مسلم

"My Lord, did You not protect me from injustice?" Allah will say, "Yes." The person will then say, "I will not accept any witness against me except from myself." Allah will reply, "Today you are sufficient as a witness against yourself, along with the noble scribes." Then his mouth will be sealed, and his limbs will be commanded to speak, and they will testify to his deeds. When he is allowed to

speak again, he will say to his limbs, “Away with you! It was for your sake that I was arguing (denying).” (Muslim)

This scene completes the principle: belief must be demonstrated, denial must collapse from within, and justice must be acknowledged even by the one being judged.

Thus, trials in this world are not meant to inform Allah, they are meant to establish truth for us. By the time judgment is passed, every soul will recognize that Allah’s justice is not only perfect in knowledge, but perfect in evidence, transparency, and fairness.

8. Divine Invitation to Exploration

Allah honors human curiosity and directs it, because through reflection, investigation, and discovery, humanity becomes capable of fulfilling its role as khalifah on earth. Curiosity is not presented in the Qur’an as a spiritual liability, but as a God-given capacity through which people uncover the resources Allah placed in creation and learn how to use them responsibly.

This curiosity naturally extends beyond the material world to questions about origins, resurrection, and even about Allah Himself. Revelation does not suppress these questions; rather, it channels them away from idle speculation and toward guided understanding.

The Qur’an records that Prophet Ibrahim asked how Allah gives life to the dead, and that Prophet Musa asked to behold his Lord. In both cases, Allah did not rebuke the question itself. Instead, He responded with demonstrations that instructed, reassured, and elevated understanding, establishing that sincere, truth-seeking inquiry is welcomed when it remains anchored to revelation.

With this framework, Allah issues a universal command to observe and reflect:

قُلۡ سِيرُواْ فِي ٱلۡأَرۡضِ فَٱنظُرُواْ كَيۡفَ بَدَأَ ٱلۡخَلۡقَۚ ثُمَّ ٱللَّهُ يُنشِئُ ٱلنَّشۡأَةَ ٱلۡأٓخِرَةَۚ إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ عَلَىٰ كُلِّ شَيۡءٖ قَدِيرٞ (٢٠)

“Say, ‘Travel through the land and observe how He began the creation; then Allah will bring forth the next creation. Indeed, Allah is over all things competent.’" (Al-Ankaboot 29:20)

This verse invites believers to explore the world, its peoples, ruins, fossils, ecosystems, and cosmic signs, and to reflect on how creation began. Such reflection is meant to strengthen conviction in resurrection, not weaken it. The Qur’an deliberately links observation of the first creation with certainty in the second, making empirical inquiry a bridge to eschatological faith.

In modern terms, this command encompasses disciplines such as history, archaeology, geology, biology, and cosmology, when pursued with humility, intellectual honesty, and moral restraint. Exploration is not an end in itself; it is a means to recognize divine power, wisdom, and purpose.

At the same time, the Qur'an issues a firm warning against adopting narratives about origins from those who speak without knowledge. After mentioning Iblis and his followers, Allah states:

۞ مَّآ أَشۡهَدۡتُهُمۡ خَلۡقَ ٱلسَّمَٰوَٰتِ وَٱلۡأَرۡضِ وَلَا خَلۡقَ أَنفُسِهِمۡ وَمَا كُنتُ مُتَّخِذَ ٱلۡمُضِلِّينَ عَضُدٗا (٥١)

"I did not make them witness to the creation of the heavens and the earth, nor their own creation; nor did I take the misleaders as helpers." (Al-Kahf 18:51)

This verse establishes a crucial epistemic principle: accounts of ultimate beginnings and endings must rest on sound revelation or honest inquiry that recognizes its limits, not on myth, conjecture, or ideological storytelling disguised as knowledge.

The Qur'anic posture, therefore, is neither anti-curiosity nor anti-science. It is a disciplined affirmation that while ultimate reliance belongs to Allah alone, genuine exploration of His creation is itself an act of obedience. Just as trusting false powers instead of Allah is likened to clinging to a fragile spider's web, trusting ungrounded claims about creation is an intellectual illusion.

The believer is thus called to unite spiritual reliance with careful, critical study, traveling the earth, observing its signs, and allowing both revelation and creation to illuminate the truth together.

9. Reliance in Others is Like Reliance on a Spider's Web

Allah presents a powerful parable to describe those who seek protection, security, and ultimate support from anything other than Him:

مَثَلُ ٱلَّذِينَ ٱتَّخَذُواْ مِن دُونِ ٱللَّهِ أَوۡلِيَآءَ كَمَثَلِ ٱلۡعَنكَبُوتِ ٱتَّخَذَتۡ بَيۡتٗاۖ وَإِنَّ أَوۡهَنَ ٱلۡبُيُوتِ لَبَيۡتُ ٱلۡعَنكَبُوتِۖ لَوۡ كَانُواْ يَعۡلَمُونَ (٤١)

"The example of those who take protectors instead of Allah is that of the spider who takes a house. And indeed, the weakest of houses is the spider's house, if only they knew." (Al-Ankabout 29:41)

At first glance, this comparison may appear puzzling. Modern knowledge tells us that spider silk itself is remarkably strong relative to its size. Yet the Qur'anic description does not refer to the strength of a single thread, but to the nature of the house as a refuge. A spider's web offers no real protection from wind, rain, heat, or impact. It has no shelter, no stability, and no defense when true danger arrives.

This is precisely the point of the parable. Any reliance placed in created beings, whether power, wealth, influence, institutions, or human alliances, may appear impressive or intricate, but it remains fundamentally fragile. When serious trials come, such reliance collapses just as easily as a spider's web.

Those who depend on worldly powers often focus on visible strength, much like insects drawn into a web without perceiving its purpose. What seems like safety becomes a trap. The web does not protect the insect; it entangles, immobilizes, and destroys it. Likewise, those who seek ultimate security, dignity, or salvation from anything other than Allah often find themselves constrained, controlled, and harmed by the very forces they trusted.

The Qur'an makes clear that such parables are deliberate educational tools, meant to deepen understanding and reflection:

وَتِلْكَ ٱلْأَمْثَـٰلُ نَضْرِبُهَا لِلنَّاسِ ۖ وَمَا يَعْقِلُهَآ إِلَّا ٱلْعَـٰلِمُونَ (٤٣)

"These are the examples We present to people, but none understand them except those of knowledge." (Al-Ankabout 29:43)

Early Muslims understood that failing to reflect upon Qur'anic parables was not a minor oversight; it signaled a lack of depth in understanding. When Allah sets forth a similitude, believers are expected to pause, reflect, and uncover its relevance to their lives.

Here, the lesson is unmistakable: any reliance not rooted in tawhid is unstable and deceptive, like the spider's house. True security, protection, and dignity can only be found in reliance upon Allah alone. the One whose support never collapses and whose refuge never fails.

10. The Moral Influence of Prayers

Prayer is central to a Muslim's life, yet it is not an end in itself. Rather, it is a divinely ordained means to reach a higher and more comprehensive state: continuous remembrance of Allah. When prayer is reduced to a routine ritual rather than embraced as a transformative practice, a person may perform it regularly while showing little change in character or conduct. Such a gap reveals a misunderstanding of prayer's true purpose.

Allah has granted prayer as a direct and intimate connection between the servant and his Lord, a channel through which hearts are purified and souls are refined. The natural fruit of this connection must appear in one's behavior, choices, and moral restraint. Allah says:

ٱتْلُ مَآ أُوحِىَ إِلَيْكَ مِنَ ٱلْكِتَـٰبِ وَأَقِمِ ٱلصَّلَوٰةَ ۖ إِنَّ ٱلصَّلَوٰةَ تَنْهَىٰ عَنِ ٱلْفَحْشَآءِ وَٱلْمُنكَرِ ۗ وَلَذِكْرُ ٱللَّهِ أَكْبَرُ ۗ وَٱللَّهُ يَعْلَمُ مَا تَصْنَعُونَ (٤٥)) العنكبوت(

“Recite what has been revealed to you of the Book and establish the prayer. Indeed, prayer restrains from shameful and wrongful deeds. And the remembrance of Allah is greater. And Allah knows what you do” (Al-Ankaboot 29:45)

This verse clarifies a crucial hierarchy. The remembrance of Allah (dhikr Allah) is described as “greater” not because prayer is of lesser value, but because prayer is the primary means leading to the greater objective. By definition, the objective surpasses the means that lead to it, no matter how essential those means are.

A simple illustration makes this clear. If a parent tells their child, “Drive slowly so that you arrive home safely,” the true goal is safe arrival, while driving slowly is the necessary means. The means is indispensable, but it exists to serve the higher purpose. Likewise, prayer is the greatest means Allah has given us to attain the supreme aim of living in constant awareness of Him.

Prayer itself is an immense honor. It is the only act of worship that the Prophet ﷺ received directly in the heavens during the Miraj. Through it, the Creator of the universe invites His servant into a private audience, allowing the servant to speak, to ask, and to receive mercy and guidance. Few gifts are greater, yet many fail to recognize the magnitude of this invitation.

Although prayer is itself a form of remembrance that shields the heart from indecency and wrongdoing, life beyond the prayer mat is filled with distractions, pressures, and temptations. For this reason, remembrance must extend beyond the moments of formal prayer. “The remembrance of Allah is greater” because it spans the entire day, governing behavior at work, within the family, and in society.

Moreover, dhikr is not limited to repeating words on the tongue. It is a conscious state of heart and mind in which one’s thoughts, intentions, and actions remain aligned with awareness of Allah and the pursuit of His pleasure. When prayer fulfills this role, it becomes a living force, shaping character, restraining sin, and guiding the believer toward integrity in every aspect of life.

Conclusion

Taken together, these jewels from the twentieth Juz form a coherent tapestry of guidance: belief must be demonstrated through action, worship must shape character, and true security can only be found in reliance upon Allah. Reflecting on these themes moves the reader beyond recitation toward internalization, allowing the Qur’an to inform one’s worldview, discipline one’s conduct, and guide one’s preparation for the Hereafter. In this way, the Qur’an becomes not only a text to be read, but a compass by which life is oriented.

Jewels from the Twenty First Juz: Fitrah, Family, and Faithful Leadership

(Al-Ankabout 29:46 – Al-Ahzab 33:30)

Introduction

The twenty-first Juz of the Quran presents a rich and integrated set of themes that address belief and resurrection, family and parenting, gratitude and leadership, sin and repentance, and the unseen consequences of human choices in this life and the next. Throughout this Juz, Allah draws attention to His signs in creation and society, demonstrating that true religion is in full harmony with the pure human fitrah, and that corruption on earth is largely the result of humanity's departure from that natural order. The creation of the spouse as a source of tranquility, the central role of gratitude, and the contrast between hopeful hardship and deceptive ease all emerge as practical lessons for the believer.

At the heart of this Juz stands the wisdom of Luqman, a complete curriculum for tarbiyah. It begins with tawhid, deepens through awareness of Allah's knowledge and gentleness, then progresses to prayer, social responsibility, humility, and honoring parents, even when faith is challenged. Alongside this moral framework, the Juz reminds us that resurrection is as easy for Allah as the creation of a single soul, that the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ is the supreme role model for those who hope to meet Allah and the Last Day, and that true religious leadership is granted only to those who combine patience with certainty in Allah's signs.

These "jewels" of the twenty-first Juz form a coherent and practical program for nurturing a sound heart, a righteous family, and a principled community. The guidance presented here is not abstract theology, but a lived roadmap, one that begins at home and extends outward to society, calling the believer to honor Allah's signs through character, gratitude, humility, and responsibility.

1. Honor Allah's signs by Honoring the Wife

In Surat Al-Rum, Allah draws attention to several of His signs in creation in verses 20–25 and 46, each introduced by the phrase: "And among His signs…" (وَمِنْ ءَايَٰتِهِۦٓ). These signs invite deep reflection, guiding people to recognize the perfection of Allah's wisdom in how He created the universe and prepared it as a place of stability, comfort, and benefit for human life.

Among these profound signs is the creation of spouses:

وَمِنْ ءَايَـٰتِهِۦٓ أَنْ خَلَقَ لَكُم مِّنْ أَنفُسِكُمْ أَزْوَٰجًا لِّتَسْكُنُوٓا۟ إِلَيْهَا وَجَعَلَ بَيْنَكُم مَّوَدَّةً وَرَحْمَةً ۚ إِنَّ فِى ذَٰلِكَ لَـَٔايَـٰتٍ لِّقَوْمٍ يَتَفَكَّرُونَ (٢١)

"And among His signs is that He created for you, from yourselves, mates, that you may find tranquility in her; and He placed between you affection and mercy. Indeed, in that are signs for a people who reflect" (Al-Room 30:21)

Allah highlights that the wife is a sign of His wisdom in creation. He made her a source of sukoun, rest, comfort, and inner tranquility, for her husband. This is the first objective of marriage: that a man finds repose with his wife, and that this tranquility is secured by Allah through the placement of mawaddah (deep affection and love) and rahmah (mercy, tenderness, and compassion) between them. This mutual love and mercy are the foundation of a happy family and a stable home.

Allah further reminds the husband that his wife is not a stranger to him; she is "from yourselves," sharing his own nature and humanity. To harm her, humiliate her, or live in constant conflict with her is, in reality, to disturb one's own peace and to wage harm against one's own soul.

This same expression, "from yourselves" (مِّنْ أَنفُسِكُمْ), is used in the Qur'an to describe the intimate, compassionate relationship between the Prophet ﷺ and this Ummah:

لَقَدْ جَآءَكُمْ رَسُولٌ مِّنْ أَنفُسِكُمْ عَزِيزٌ عَلَيْهِ مَا عَنِتُّمْ حَرِيصٌ عَلَيْكُم بِٱلْمُؤْمِنِينَ رَءُوفٌ رَّحِيمٌ (١٢٨)

"There has certainly come to you a Messenger from yourselves. Grievous to him is what you suffer; [he is] concerned over you and to the believers he is kind and merciful." (Al-Tawba 9:128)

Just as the Prophet ﷺ was deeply concerned for the well-being of his community, the husband is called to care for his wife with attentiveness, mercy, and gentleness, recognizing her as part of his own life and soul. Honoring the wife, therefore, is not merely good manners; it is recognition of a divine sign placed within one's own home.

The Prophet ﷺ made this principle explicit when he said:

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ، قَالَ قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صلى الله عليه وسلم " أَكْمَلُ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ إِيمَانًا أَحْسَنُهُمْ خُلُقًا وَخِيَارُكُمْ خِيَارُكُمْ لِنِسَائِهِمْ خُلُقًا "

"The most complete of believers in faith are those with the best character, and the best of you are the best in behavior to their women." (Al-Tirmidhi 1162)

He also said:

عَنْ عَائِشَةَ، قَالَتْ قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صلى الله عليه وسلم " خَيْرُكُمْ خَيْرُكُمْ لأَهْلِهِ وَأَنَا خَيْرُكُمْ لأَهْلِي

"The best of you is the best to his wives, and I am the best of you to my wives." (Al-Tirmidhi)

These teachings show that honoring one's wife with affection, mercy, and respect is not a secondary courtesy but a defining mark of true faith and prophetic character. To honor the wife is to honor one of Allah's signs, to guard her dignity, seek her comfort, and

establish a home in which the Quranic ideals of love and mercy are not merely recited, but lived.

2. True Religion and the Pure Fitrah

The uniqueness of Islam, as delivered in its pure form by Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, lies in its complete harmony with the natural disposition (fitrah) of humankind. This harmony is the defining mark of the true religion of Allah: it corresponds perfectly to the sound nature He instilled within every human being. Allah says:

فَأَقِمْ وَجْهَكَ لِلدِّينِ حَنِيفًا ۚ فِطْرَتَ ٱللَّهِ ٱلَّتِى فَطَرَ ٱلنَّاسَ عَلَيْهَا ۚ لَا تَبْدِيلَ لِخَلْقِ ٱللَّهِ ۚ ذَٰلِكَ ٱلدِّينُ ٱلْقَيِّمُ وَلَٰكِنَّ أَكْثَرَ ٱلنَّاسِ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ (٣٠)

“So, direct your face toward the religion, Hanif (inclining to truth), the fitrah of Allah upon which He has created people. There is no change in the creation of Allah. That is the upright religion, but most people do not know" (Al-Rum 30:30)

This verse makes clear that the straight religion to which Allah calls humanity is the ḥanif religion, pure, upright, and free from deviation, and that it is fully consistent with the original fitrah of every human being. Islam does not suppress human nature; rather, it purifies, disciplines, and directs it, restoring people to the uncorrupted state from which false beliefs, shirk, and immoral practices have alienated them.

For this reason, Allah repeatedly commands adherence to the way of Prophet Ibrahim (peace be upon him), who is uniquely described as ḥanif. Guided by his sound fitrah, Ibrahim recognized the oneness of Allah and rejected idolatry even before revelation was given to him. Allah says:

وَقَالُوا۟ كُونُوا۟ هُودًا أَوْ نَصَٰرَىٰ تَهْتَدُوا۟ ۗ قُلْ بَلْ مِلَّةَ إِبْرَٰهِـۧمَ حَنِيفًا ۖ وَمَا كَانَ مِنَ ٱلْمُشْرِكِينَ (١٣٥)

“They said: Be Jews or Christians, you will be guided. Say: Rather, (we follow) the religion of Ibrahim, “Hanif”, and he was not of the polytheists.” (Al-Baqarah 2:135)

قُلْ إِنَّنِى هَدَىٰنِى رَبِّىٓ إِلَىٰ صِرَٰطٍ مُّسْتَقِيمٍ دِينًا قِيَمًا مِّلَّةَ إِبْرَٰهِيمَ حَنِيفًا ۚ وَمَا كَانَ مِنَ ٱلْمُشْرِكِينَ (١٦١)

“Say, "Indeed, my Lord has guided me to a straight path - a correct religion - the religion of Ibrahim, “Hanif”, and he was not of the polytheists.” (Al-Anaam 6:161)

The religion of Ibrahim is ḥanifiyyah: a decisive turning away from all forms of shirk and deviation, and a complete turning toward Allah with purity of belief and worship. This is the same religion that Prophet Muhammad ﷺ came to confirm and complete, not a new creed, but the restoration and perfection of the primordial way of tawhid planted within every sound heart.

The religion that truly aligns with the pure fitrah rests upon three foundational principles:

- Belief in Allah alone as Lord, Creator, and the only One worthy of worship.
- Belief in the Day of Judgment and final accountability.
- Performance of righteous deeds that benefit both the individual and society.

These principles are common to all prophetic messages, even though the details of certain laws and rituals differed from one community to another. Allah says:

وَمَا تَفَرَّقَ ٱلَّذِينَ أُوتُواْ ٱلۡكِتَٰبَ إِلَّا مِنۢ بَعۡدِ مَا جَآءَتۡهُمُ ٱلۡبَيِّنَةُ (٤) وَمَآ أُمِرُوٓاْ إِلَّا لِيَعۡبُدُواْ ٱللَّهَ مُخۡلِصِينَ لَهُ ٱلدِّينَ حُنَفَآءَ وَيُقِيمُواْ ٱلصَّلَوٰةَ وَيُؤۡتُواْ ٱلزَّكَوٰةَۚ وَذَٰلِكَ دِينُ ٱلۡقَيِّمَةِ (٥)

"The People of the Scripture did not differ except after clear proof had come to them. (4) And they were not commanded except to worship Allah, sincere to Him in religion, inclining to truth, and to establish prayer and give zakah. That is the upright religion." (Al-Bayyina 98:4-5)

Thus, the upright religion (ad-dīn al-qayyim/ دِينُ ٱلۡقَيِّمَةِ) consists of sincere worship of Allah alone, lived in a state of ḥanifiyyah that corresponds to the fitrah, and expressed through acts of devotion, most notably prayer and zakah which cultivate justice, compassion, and social responsibility.

This Qur'anic concept of fitrah is further clarified in the Sunnah, where the Prophet ﷺ directly linked pure human nature to tawhid. He (PBUH) said:

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ، قَالَ قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صلى الله عليه وسلم " مَا مِنْ مَوْلُودٍ إِلاَّ يُلِدَ عَلَى الْفِطْرَةِ فَأَبَوَاهُ يُهَوِّدَانِهِ وَيُنَصِّرَانِهِ وَيُشَرِّكَانِهِ "

"Every child is born upon the fitrah; then his parents make him a Jew, or a Christian, or a Polytheist." (al-Bukhari, Muslim)

This hadith explains that the original state of every human being is one of natural readiness to recognize and submit to Allah's oneness. Deviation arises later through external influences, cultural conditioning, and distorted teachings. The role of revelation, culminating in Islam, is to call humanity back to that original clarity, remove layers of corruption, and realign the heart with what it was created for: knowing, loving, and worshipping its Lord.

3. The Corruption on Earth is Man-Made

Allah directs humanity to read history and observe the world carefully in order to grasp a fundamental divine law: moral corruption leads to social, economic, and environmental corruption. Allah says:

ظَهَرَ ٱلۡفَسَادُ فِي ٱلۡبَرِّ وَٱلۡبَحۡرِ بِمَا كَسَبَتۡ أَيۡدِي ٱلنَّاسِ لِيُذِيقَهُم بَعۡضَ ٱلَّذِي عَمِلُواْ لَعَلَّهُمۡ يَرۡجِعُونَ (٤١) قُلۡ سِيرُواْ فِي ٱلۡأَرۡضِ فَٱنظُرُواْ كَيۡفَ كَانَ عَٰقِبَةُ ٱلَّذِينَ مِن قَبۡلُۚ كَانَ أَكۡثَرُهُم مُّشۡرِكِينَ (٤٢)

"Corruption has appeared on land and sea because of what people's hands have earned, so that He may let them taste part of what they have done, that perhaps they may return. (41) Say: Travel through the earth and observe how was the end of those before; most of them were idolaters." (Al-Room 30:41-42)

These verses establish that fasad, manifested in unrest, injustice, environmental damage, scarcity, and societal breakdown, is not accidental or random. It arises directly from human actions. Allah allows people to experience some of the consequences of their deeds, not purely as punishment, but as a warning and an invitation to repentance and return to the straight path.

The term “idolaters” (mushrikīn) in this context is not limited to those who bow to carved idols. It includes anyone who abandons the pure fitrah Allah placed within them and assigns ultimate authority to something other than Allah, whether by worshipping created beings, absolutizing human ideologies, or elevating personal desires and interests to the level of supreme law. In doing so, people effectively place themselves or others as partners with Allah in defining right and wrong, constructing false value systems that contradict divine guidance.

This corruption at the level of belief and intention inevitably manifests as outward corruption in society. Allah makes this link explicit in this verse:

وَمَآ أَصَٰبَكُم مِّن مُّصِيبَةٖ فَبِمَا كَسَبَتۡ أَيۡدِيكُمۡ وَيَعۡفُواْ عَن كَثِيرٖ (٣٠)

“And whatever misfortune befalls you, it is because of what your hands have earned. And He pardons much.” (Al-Shura 42:30)

Calamities, whether affecting individuals, communities, or entire civilizations, are often the cumulative result of wrongdoing, injustice, arrogance, and moral decay. Yet Allah’s mercy far outweighs His retribution: He forgives far more than He allows to appear as consequence in this world, granting repeated opportunities for repentance and reform.

Despite the clarity of this Quranic diagnosis, many Muslims today fall into the habit of blaming external forces alone, colonialism, foreign conspiracies, or hostile powers, while ignoring internal moral causes. When hearts are corrupted, knowledge alone does not produce reform; instead, it becomes a tool for further damage, including:

- Spreading mischief and corruption in the land.
- Oppressing the weak and exploiting the vulnerable.
- Betraying trusts and normalizing injustice.
- Exploiting religious language and symbols for personal or political gain.

In such a condition, religion may be spoken, but the lived reality reflects a practical form of shirk: granting ultimate loyalty to power, wealth, tribe, or ideology instead of to Allah and His guidance. The Quran calls believers to confront this disease honestly, to recognize that much of the corruption on earth is indeed man-made, and to act upon the divine cure: sincere tawbah, purification of the heart, and a return to justice, humility, and obedience.

The Prophet ﷺ also warned that specific moral violations lead to specific worldly consequences. Among the narrations reported is the saying of Ibn ʿAbbās (may Allah be pleased with them):

عن ابن عباس - رضي الله عنهما - قال : "ولا نقص قوم المكيال والميزان إلا قطع عنهم الرزق ... " . رواه مالك .

“Whenever a people cheat in weights and measures, their provisions are cut off and hardship is sent upon them.” (Malik)

Such reports reflect the same Quranic pattern: when people corrupt markets, oppress others, and violate justice, Allah allows them to taste the bitter fruits of their own actions in this world, before the full reckoning of the Hereafter.

4. Gratitude to Allah is for Your Own Benefit

This Juz introduces us to Luqman. Scholars have differed over whether he was a prophet or a righteous servant of Allah, but in reality, this question carries little practical benefit. Had knowing his precise rank been essential for guidance, Allah would have stated it explicitly. Instead, Allah emphasized what truly matters: that Luqman was granted ḥikmah, wisdom, and that our concern should be to seek that wisdom and live by it, rather than to debate the status of the one who possessed it.

Allah teaches that wisdom is a divine gift, granted to whom He wills, and that receiving it is among the greatest forms of goodness:

يُؤْتِى ٱلْحِكْمَةَ مَن يَشَآءُ ۚ وَمَن يُؤْتَ ٱلْحِكْمَةَ فَقَدْ أُوتِىَ خَيْرًا كَثِيرًا ۗ وَمَا يَذَّكَّرُ إِلَّآ أُو۟لُوا۟ ٱلْأَلْبَٰبِ (٢٦٩)

“He grants wisdom to whom He wills, and whoever has been granted wisdom has certainly been given abundant good. But none will remember except those of understanding.” (Al-Baqarah 2:269).

One of the clearest manifestations of Luqman’s wisdom is his deep understanding that gratitude to Allah is, in reality, a benefit that returns to one’s own self. Allah says

وَلَقَدْ ءَاتَيْنَا لُقْمَٰنَ ٱلْحِكْمَةَ أَنِ ٱشْكُرْ لِلَّهِ ۚ وَمَن يَشْكُرْ فَإِنَّمَا يَشْكُرُ لِنَفْسِهِۦ ۖ وَمَن كَفَرَ فَإِنَّ ٱللَّهَ غَنِىٌّ حَمِيدٌ (١٢)

“And We certainly gave Luqman wisdom [and said], ‘Be grateful to Allah.’ And whoever is grateful is grateful only for his own benefits; and whoever is ungrateful, then indeed, Allah is Free of need, Praiseworthy (Luqman 31:12)

Allah does not increase in greatness when He is thanked, nor does He diminish when gratitude is withheld. Rather, gratitude refines the heart, nurtures inner peace, and becomes a means for attracting further blessings in this life and the Hereafter. Luqman grasped this divine law clearly, a law Allah expressed in this verse:

وَإِذْ تَأَذَّنَ رَبُّكُمْ لَئِن شَكَرْتُمْ لَأَزِيدَنَّكُمْ

“**And your Lord has proclaimed: ‘If you are grateful, I will surely increase you [in favor].” (Ibrahim 14:7)**

Gratitude, therefore, is both an act of worship and a means of increase. The wise believer understands that thanking Allah is never a burden imposed upon the soul; rather, it is an investment whose returns are manifold. Through gratitude, faith deepens, the heart gains emotional balance, and life itself becomes more grounded and purposeful. Like Luqman, the person of wisdom recognizes every moment of gratitude as a step toward greater clarity, lasting contentment, and the continued flow of divine favor.

5. Teaching Priorities for Children

One of the greatest lessons drawn from the story of Luqman is not just what Luqman taught his son but the *order* by which he taught him. Luqman’s approach to education is itself an expression of divine wisdom, one preserved in the Quran as a model for parents, teachers, and all who are entrusted with nurturing the next generation.

Luqman’s priorities unfold in a deliberate and meaningful sequence:

1. Establishing *tawhid* and the gravity of *shirk*.
2. Cultivating awareness of Allah’s knowledge, nearness, and gentleness.
3. Introducing core religious obligations and social responsibility.
4. Refining character through humility in behavior and speech.

This order reflects a deep understanding of human development: belief before law, awareness before obligation, and inner grounding before outward conduct.

Step 1: Begin with Tawhid and the Gravity of Shirk

Luqman begins by appealing to his son’s innate sense that injustice is something grave and repulsive. He explains that the greatest injustice of all is associating partners with Allah:

وَإِذْ قَالَ لُقْمَانُ لِابْنِهِ وَهُوَ يَعِظُهُ يَا بُنَيَّ لَا تُشْرِكْ بِاللَّهِ إِنَّ الشِّرْكَ لَظُلْمٌ عَظِيم

“And [remember] when Luqman said to his son while he was advising him, ‘O my dear son, do not associate anything with Allah. Indeed, association with Him is a great injustice." (Luqman 31:13)

To clarify why shirk is such a profound injustice, Luqman directs his son to reflect upon Allah’s creation:

خَلَقَ ٱلسَّمَٰوَٰتِ بِغَيْرِ عَمَدٍ تَرَوْنَهَا ۖ وَأَلْقَىٰ فِى ٱلْأَرْضِ رَوَٰسِىَ أَن تَمِيدَ بِكُمْ وَبَثَّ فِيهَا مِن كُلِّ دَآبَّةٍ ۚ وَأَنزَلْنَا مِنَ ٱلسَّمَآءِ مَآءً فَأَنۢبَتْنَا فِيهَا مِن كُلِّ زَوْجٍ كَرِيمٍ (١٠) هَٰذَا خَلْقُ ٱللَّهِ فَأَرُونِى مَاذَا خَلَقَ ٱلَّذِينَ مِن دُونِهِۦ ۚ بَلِ ٱلظَّٰلِمُونَ فِى ضَلَٰلٍ مُّبِينٍ (١١)

“He created the heavens without pillars that you see, and He cast into the earth firmly set mountains lest it should shift with you, and He dispersed throughout it from every creature. And We sent down rain from the sky and caused to grow therein [plants] of every noble kind in pairs. (10) That is the creation of Allah. So, show Me what those other than Him have created. Rather, the unjust are in clear misguidance.” (Luqman 31:10-11)

By contrasting Allah’s absolute creative power with the complete incapacity of all others, Luqman demonstrates that equating the Creator with beings who create nothing is both irrational and unjust. Teaching tawhid through reflection on creation roots faith in both the intellect and the heart.

Step 2: Instill Awareness of Allah’s Knowledge and Gentleness

Next, Luqman teaches his son that Allah does not merely create and then withdraw. Rather, He knows, oversees, and brings forth even the most hidden of things. To engrave this awareness, Luqman presents a vivid and unforgettable image:

يَا بُنَيَّ إِنَّهَا إِنْ تَكُ مِثْقَالَ حَبَّةٍ مِنْ خَرْدَلٍ فَتَكُنْ فِي صَخْرَةٍ أَوْ فِي السَّمَاوَاتِ أَوْ فِي الْأَرْضِ يَأْتِ بِهَا اللَّهُ إِنَّ اللَّهَ لَطِيفٌ خَبِير

"O my dear son, even if something were the weight of a mustard-seed and if it were (hidden) in a rock, or (anywhere) in the heavens or on earth, Allah will bring it forth: for Allah is Gentle, and All-Aware.” (Luqman 31:16)

Here Luqman introduces Allah through His attributes of al-Lateef (the Gentle, Subtle) and al-Khabir (the All-Aware). This nurtures awe without fear, accountability without despair, and love alongside reverence. It also offers a powerful lesson for parents and educators: children should be guided under the gaze of al-Lateef, with compassion, patience, and subtle correction, rather than through constant threat and punishment.

Step 3: Introduce Core Commands After Knowing Allah

Once belief and awareness are firmly established, Luqman introduces his son to religious and moral obligations:

يَا بُنَيَّ أَقِمِ الصَّلَاةَ وَأْمُرْ بِالْمَعْرُوفِ وَانْهَ عَنِ الْمُنْكَرِ وَاصْبِرْ عَلَى مَا أَصَابَكَ إِنَّ ذَلِكَ مِنْ عَزْمِ الْأُمُور

"O my dear son! establish regular prayer, enjoin what is good and forbid what is wrong; and be patient over whatever befalls you. Indeed, that is of the matters requiring strong resolve.” (Luqman 31:17)

Prayer is mentioned first, transforming knowledge of Allah into lived connection and daily remembrance. Faith thus becomes experiential rather than abstract. Luqman then expands his son’s responsibility beyond himself, teaching him concern for the moral health of society. Finally, he prepares him for the reality that standing for truth invites hardship, and that patience in adversity is a hallmark of moral strength and leadership.

Step 4: Shape Character Through Humility and Gentle Conduct

After grounding belief and duty, Luqman turns to character and outward behavior, emphasizing humility in both demeanor and speech:

وَلَا تُصَعِّرۡ خَدَّكَ لِلنَّاسِ وَلَا تَمۡشِ فِي ٱلۡأَرۡضِ مَرَحًاۖ إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ لَا يُحِبُّ كُلَّ مُخۡتَالٖ فَخُورٖ (١٨) وَٱقۡصِدۡ فِي مَشۡيِكَ وَٱغۡضُضۡ مِن صَوۡتِكَۚ إِنَّ أَنكَرَ ٱلۡأَصۡوَٰتِ لَصَوۡتُ ٱلۡحَمِيرِ (١٩)

"Do not turn your cheek away from people in contempt, nor walk upon the earth arrogantly. Indeed, Allah does not love every self-deluded boaster. (18) And be moderate in your pace and lower your voice; indeed, the most offensive of sounds is the braying of donkeys. " (Luqman 31:18-19)

Luqman warns against arrogance in posture, expression, and speech, reminding that outward conduct reflects the inner state of the heart. He teaches balance, dignity, and restraint, emphasizing that harshness and loudness in speech are signs of moral ugliness, not strength.

In this way, Luqman's counsel becomes a timeless educational framework: begin with pure tawhid, deepen awareness of Allah's nearness and gentleness, introduce obligations only after belief is rooted, and finally refine character through humility and beautiful conduct. It is a complete curriculum, one that builds faith, responsibility, and noble character in harmony.

6. Honoring Parents, Especially the Mother

It is striking that within the narrative of Luqman, he does not himself instruct his son, "Obey me and your mother," despite the central importance of honoring parents in Islam. Instead, Allah Himself intervenes in the passage to deliver this command directly. This shift in voice highlights how weighty the parent–child relationship is from a divine perspective, elevating it beyond personal authority to a sacred moral obligation.

Allah singles out the mother in particular, drawing attention to her sacrifices, the physical weakness, pain, and vulnerability of pregnancy, followed by childbirth and the intense care of the child during the first two years of life. These realities are presented as a primary reason for children to show deep gratitude and goodness to their parents:

وَوَصَّيۡنَا ٱلۡإِنسَٰنَ بِوَٰلِدَيۡهِ حَمَلَتۡهُ أُمُّهُۥ وَهۡنًا عَلَىٰ وَهۡنٖ وَفِصَٰلُهُۥ فِي عَامَيۡنِ أَنِ ٱشۡكُرۡ لِي وَلِوَٰلِدَيۡكَ إِلَيَّ ٱلۡمَصِيرُ (١٤)

"And We have enjoined upon man [care] for his parents. His mother carried him in weakness upon weakness, and his weaning is in two years. [We said], 'Be grateful to Me and to your parents; to Me is the final destination." (31:14)

Here, gratitude is directed in two connected directions: first to Allah, the ultimate source of life, care, and provision, and then to the parents as the immediate means through which that care reached the child. By joining the commands "Be grateful to Me and to

your parents," the Quran makes clear that honoring one's parents is an integral part of gratitude to Allah, not a separate or secondary virtue.

At the same time, Allah establishes a critical boundary. Honoring parents does not mean unconditional obedience, particularly when obedience would violate tawhid. Even if parents exert intense pressure to force their child to abandon pure faith, the believer is not permitted to obey them in matters of shirk. Yet remarkably, the Quran still commands kindness, companionship, and respect:

وَإِن جَٰهَدَاكَ عَلَىٰٓ أَن تُشۡرِكَ بِي مَا لَيۡسَ لَكَ بِهِۦ عِلۡمٞ فَلَا تُطِعۡهُمَاۖ وَصَاحِبۡهُمَا فِي ٱلدُّنۡيَا مَعۡرُوفٗاۖ وَٱتَّبِعۡ سَبِيلَ مَنۡ أَنَابَ إِلَيَّۚ ثُمَّ إِلَيَّ مَرۡجِعُكُمۡ فَأُنَبِّئُكُم بِمَا كُنتُمۡ تَعۡمَلُونَ (١٥)

"But if they strive to make you associate with Me that of which you have no knowledge, then do not obey them; yet accompany them in this world with kindness, and follow the path of those who turn back to Me. Then to Me will be your return, and I will inform you of what you used to do." (Luqman 31:15)

This verse establishes a precise and balanced ethic:

- No obedience is permitted where parents demand shirk or disobedience to Allah.
- Ongoing kindness, service, and honorable companionship remain obligatory throughout their lives.

The believer is further instructed to "follow the path of those who turn back to Me," highlighting the importance of surrounding oneself with righteous companions, teachers, and a supportive community. This guidance is especially significant for those whose families oppose their faith. It places a communal responsibility upon the Muslim society to provide compassion, mentorship, and belonging, particularly for youth and new Muslims, so that no one feels forced to choose between loyalty to Allah and respectful care for their parents.

In this way, the Quran preserves both pillars: unwavering commitment to tawhid and unwavering excellence in character. It teaches that true faith never justifies cruelty or abandonment, and that honoring parents, especially the mother, remains a lifelong obligation, even amid deep differences of belief.

7. The Creation and Resurrection of the Soul

One of the primary reasons people reject revelation is their refusal to believe in resurrection and the Day of Judgment. Unable to imagine how scattered bodies and decayed remains could ever be restored; they dismiss the Hereafter as impossible. Yet this denial does not arise from evidence; it stems from a limited and distorted understanding of creation itself.

Allah addresses this doubt by directing humanity back to the most fundamental reality: the first creation is already the greatest proof. The One who brought human beings into

existence from nothing, and who originated all of humanity from a single soul, is fully capable of returning them all to life at once for judgment. In this context, Allah says:

مَّا خَلۡقُكُمۡ وَلَا بَعۡثُكُمۡ إِلَّا كَنَفۡسٖ وَٰحِدَةٍۗ إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ سَمِيعُۢ بَصِيرٌ (٢٨)

“Your creation and your resurrection are but like that of a single soul. Indeed, Allah is All-Hearing, All-Seeing.” (Luqman 31:28)

This verse collapses all human numbers, generations, nations, and dispersed remains, into a single comparison. For Allah, who is not constrained by time, space, or resources, creating and resurrecting billions is no more difficult than dealing with one soul. The difficulty exists only in the human imagination, not in divine power.

By concluding the verse with “All-Hearing, All-Seeing,” Allah links resurrection to His perfect knowledge. The One who heard every word and saw every action throughout history does not lose track of any soul. Resurrection, therefore, is not only possible; it is the necessary completion of divine justice.

Within the same Juz, Allah reinforces this argument by reminding humanity that initiating creation is already proof of His ability to repeat it:

وَهُوَ ٱلَّذِي يَبۡدَؤُاْ ٱلۡخَلۡقَ ثُمَّ يُعِيدُهُۥ وَهُوَ أَهۡوَنُ عَلَيۡهِۚ .(٢٧)

“And He is the One who begins creation; then He repeats it, and that is easier for Him.” (Al-Room 30:27)

Allah also exposes the logical flaw behind denying resurrection: it is forgetting one’s own origin. He says:

وَضَرَبَ لَنَا مَثَلٗا وَنَسِيَ خَلۡقَهُۥۖ قَالَ مَن يُحۡيِ ٱلۡعِظَٰمَ وَهِيَ رَمِيمٞ (٧٨) قُلۡ يُحۡيِيهَا ٱلَّذِيٓ أَنشَأَهَآ أَوَّلَ مَرَّةٖۖ وَهُوَ بِكُلِّ خَلۡقٍ عَلِيمٌ (٧٩)

“He presents for Us an example and forgets his own creation. He says, ‘Who will give life to bones when they are decayed?’ (78) Say, ‘He will give them life who created them the first time, and He is Knowing of all creation” (Yaseen 36:78–79)

Here, denial of resurrection is exposed as intellectual inconsistency: one who already exists cannot reasonably deny the power that brought him into existence.

To make this reality accessible to every mind, Allah repeatedly points to visible signs, such as the revival of dead earth after rain:

وَمِنۡ ءَايَٰتِهِۦٓ أَنَّكَ تَرَى ٱلۡأَرۡضَ خَٰشِعَةٗ فَإِذَآ أَنزَلۡنَا عَلَيۡهَا ٱلۡمَآءَ ٱهۡتَزَّتۡ وَرَبَتۡۚ إِنَّ ٱلَّذِيٓ أَحۡيَاهَا لَمُحۡيِ ٱلۡمَوۡتَىٰٓۚ إِنَّهُۥ عَلَىٰ كُلِّ شَيۡءٖ قَدِيرٌ (٣٩)

“And among His signs is that you see the earth humbled; then when We send down water upon it, it stirs and swells. Indeed, the One who gave it life is the Giver of life to the dead. Indeed, He is over all things competent” (Fussilat 41:39)

Through these arguments, the Quran presents creation and resurrection as two halves of a single reality. The One who effortlessly originated humanity from a single soul will

just as effortlessly summon every soul back, simultaneously, knowingly, and justly, to stand before Him.

8. The Hopeful Disobedient

When reflecting on those who disobey Allah in this world, two broad conditions can be observed:

1. A disobedient person who lives in misery.
2. A disobedient person who appears to live in comfort and happiness.

The first group, those who disobey Allah yet experience hardship and distress, may, in a profound sense, be fortunate if they read their condition correctly. Their suffering can serve as a merciful warning from Allah, an opportunity to awaken, repent, and change course before facing a far greater loss in the Hereafter. Their pain is not merely punishment; it may be a call to return.

Allah describes the ultimate fate of those who persist in defiance without repentance, while also revealing the purpose of worldly hardship:

وَأَمَّا ٱلَّذِينَ فَسَقُواْ فَمَأۡوَىٰهُمُ ٱلنَّارُۖ كُلَّمَآ أَرَادُوٓاْ أَن يَخۡرُجُواْ مِنۡهَآ أُعِيدُواْ فِيهَا وَقِيلَ لَهُمۡ ذُوقُواْ عَذَابَ ٱلنَّارِ ٱلَّذِي كُنتُم بِهِۦ تُكَذِّبُونَ (٢٠) وَلَنُذِيقَنَّهُم مِّنَ ٱلۡعَذَابِ ٱلۡأَدۡنَىٰ دُونَ ٱلۡعَذَابِ ٱلۡأَكۡبَرِ لَعَلَّهُمۡ يَرۡجِعُونَ (٢١)

“As for those who defiantly disobeyed, their refuge will be the Fire. Every time they wish to come out of it, they will be returned to it and told, ‘Taste the punishment of the Fire which you used to deny.’ (20) And We will surely let them taste the nearer punishment before the greater punishment, so that perhaps they may return” (Al-Sajda 32:20-21)

The “nearer punishment” in this life, manifesting as anxiety, loss, humiliation, or hardship, can become a door of hope if it leads a person back to Allah with sincere repentance. In this sense, worldly suffering may be severe, but it is not devoid of mercy.

The second group, those who disobey Allah while enjoying apparent ease, success, and comfort, are in a far more dangerous position if that ease blinds them to their need for repentance. At times, worldly abundance is not a sign of divine pleasure but a gradual enticement (istidrāj/ إستدراج), in which people are allowed to sink deeper into heedlessness until a sudden and devastating reckoning arrives. Allah says:

فَلَمَّا نَسُواْ مَا ذُكِّرُواْ بِهِۦ فَتَحۡنَا عَلَيۡهِمۡ أَبۡوَٰبَ كُلِّ شَيۡءٍ حَتَّىٰٓ إِذَا فَرِحُواْ بِمَآ أُوتُوٓاْ أَخَذۡنَٰهُم بَغۡتَةٗ فَإِذَا هُم مُّبۡلِسُونَ (٤٤)

“So, when they forgot what they had been reminded of, We opened for them the doors of everything. Then, when they rejoiced in what they were given, We seized them suddenly, and they were plunged into despair.” (Al-Anaam 6:44)

This verse makes clear that not every open door is a blessing in the true sense. When comfort, opportunity, and pleasure accompany persistent disobedience and

forgetfulness of Allah, they may signal not safety, but impending loss. The disobedient person who appears “happy” may, therefore, be in a more perilous state than the one who suffers, because comfort can numb the heart and delay repentance.

The wise believer, whether examining his own condition or advising others, reads both hardship and ease through the lens of the Hereafter:

- Hardship can be a hopeful call back to Allah.
- Ease can be a hidden warning if it is coupled with ongoing disobedience.

In both cases, true safety lies only in returning to Allah, correcting one’s path, and refusing to confuse temporary worldly states, pleasant or painful, with Allah’s final judgment.

9. The Prophet as Best Role Model

One of the central commands in the Quran is to take the Messenger of Allah ﷺ as a living example to be followed. Allah says:

لَقَدْ كَانَ لَكُمْ فِي رَسُولِ اللَّهِ أُسْوَةٌ حَسَنَةٌ لِمَنْ كَانَ يَرْجُو اللَّهَ وَالْيَوْمَ الآخِرَ وَذَكَرَ اللَّهَ كَثِيرًا)الأحزاب(
"Indeed, in the Messenger of Allah, you have a beautiful role model whoever hopes for Allah and the Last Day and remembers Allah often." (Al-Ahzab 33: 21)

This verse connects three core qualities:
- Hope to meet Allah.
- Belief in the Last Day.
- Frequent remembrance of Allah.

Whoever sincerely embodies these qualities will naturally find his most complete and practical roadmap in the life of the Prophet ﷺ. Emulating him is not limited to admiration or emotional attachment; it means consciously shaping one’s daily conduct to resemble his way of life as closely as possible.

Taking the Prophet ﷺ as a true role model requires studying his character in depth, because his *akhlaq* were the living embodiment of the Quran. When our mother Aishah (may Allah be pleased with her) was asked about his character, she replied: *“His character was the Qur’an.”* This statement means that:

- He was the Quran translated into action.
- Every command, prohibition, and moral ideal of the Book was reflected in his behavior.

For this reason, when Allah praised him in the Quran, He praised him foremost for his character:

وَإِنَّكَ لَعَلَى خُلُقٍ عَظِيمٍ) القلم 4 (

"And indeed, you are upon a great moral character." (Al-Qalam 68:4)

This divine testimony establishes that excellence in religion is not measured by knowledge or ritual alone, but by the refinement of character, something the Prophet ﷺ exemplified at the highest level.

Two foundational pillars of his exalted character were truthfulness and trustworthiness. Long before revelation, the people of Makkah unanimously recognized these qualities in him and gave him the title Al-Ṣadiq al-Amin/(الصادق الامين) (The Truthful, the Trustworthy). He:

- Never betrayed a trust, even when dealing with enemies.
- Never spoke a lie, even when dishonesty could have served his worldly interests.

These traits became the bedrock of his dawah. When he stood on Mount Ṣafa and called his people to Islam, they openly acknowledged that they had never known him to lie. A person who claims love for the Prophet ﷺ yet is careless with truthfulness or *Amanah* has not fully taken him as a genuine role model.

Beyond personal morality, the Prophet ﷺ was also the finest leader of individuals and communities. His leadership combined moral integrity with strategic wisdom. Key features of his leadership include:

1. **Integrity**
    - Complete consistency between word and action.
    - Absolute reliability in promises, treaties, and responsibilities.
2. **Vision**
    - A clear, long-term mission: bringing people from darkness to light, not merely securing short-term gains.
    - Preparing generations, as seen in his nurturing of the Companions and concern for those who would come after them.
3. **Adaptability**
    - Employing different strategies in Makkah and Madinah, in peace and war, with the strong and the weak.
    - Flexibility in methods while remaining firm on principles.
4. **Accountability**
    - Welcoming consultation (*shura*) and correction.
    - Accepting responsibility for decisions and constantly seeking Allah's forgiveness.
5. **Decision-making**
    - Combining tawakkul with careful planning and consultation.
    - Acting decisively once a matter was resolved, without hesitation or fear.
6. **Communication skills**
    - Speaking clearly and deliberately, to the point that listeners could count his words.
    - Tailoring speech to the listener, sometimes brief, sometimes detailed; sometimes gentle, sometimes firm.

Studying these dimensions of his life through seerah, ḥadith, and practical application allows Muslims to take the Prophet ﷺ not only as a spiritual guide, but as a model for family life, community building, conflict resolution, and civilizational leadership.

To take the Prophet ﷺ as a role model, therefore, is an ongoing project, one that reshapes character, truthfulness, amanah, and leadership style until they increasingly reflect his noble and beautiful example.

10. Leaders Are Formed by Patience and Certainty

In Surat al-Sajdah, Allah describes a category of people whom He honored with true leadership, leadership grounded not in status or authority, but in inner spiritual qualities:

وَجَعَلۡنَا مِنۡهُمۡ أَئِمَّةٗ يَهۡدُونَ بِأَمۡرِنَا لَمَّا صَبَرُواْۖ وَكَانُواْ بِـَٔايَٰتِنَا يُوقِنُونَ (٢٤)

“And We made from among them leaders who guided [people] by Our command because they were patient and because they have certainty in Our signs.” (Al-Sajda 32:24)

This verse establishes a foundational Quranic principle: genuine religious leadership is neither inherited nor self-proclaimed. It is granted by Allah when two essential qualities are firmly established in a person:

- Patience (*ṣabr*): steadfastness in obedience, restraint from sin, and endurance through hardship and trial.
- Certainty (*yaqīn*): deep, confident conviction in Allah’s revelations that guides thought, behavior, and decision-making.

Scholars have long observed that deviation from Allah’s path generally arises from two internal diseases:

- Carnal desire (*shahwah*), which pulls a person toward sin, ego, and worldly indulgence.
- Doubt or misconception (*shubhah*), which clouds understanding and blurs the distinction between truth and falsehood.

Patience is the cure for *shahwah*, enabling a person to restrain impulses and remain firm upon obedience. Knowledge of revelation, coupled with reflection and sincerity, cultivates *yaqīn*, which dispels *shubhah* and anchors the heart in truth. Only those who struggle against these two diseases within themselves are truly qualified to help guide others.

Yet Allah immediately follows the verse on leadership with a decisive reminder about the limits of human authority:

إِنَّ رَبَّكَ هُوَ يَفۡصِلُ بَيۡنَهُمۡ يَوۡمَ ٱلۡقِيَٰمَةِ فِيمَا كَانُواْ فِيهِ يَخۡتَلِفُونَ (٢٥)

“Indeed, your Lord will judge between them on the Day of Resurrection, concerning that over which they used to differ.” (Al-Sajda 32:25)

This serves as a vital warning, especially to preachers, scholars, and activists, against overstepping their role by hastily declaring others misguided, deviant, or condemned over disputed matters. The Quran draws a clear boundary:

- Human responsibility is to clarify the truth, advise with wisdom, and guide with patience, knowledge, and good character.
- Final judgment regarding hearts, intentions, and ultimate outcomes belongs exclusively to Allah on the Day of Resurrection.

True leadership, therefore, is marked by humility as much as resolve. Those who aspire to guide others to Allah must cultivate patience and certainty within themselves, while exercising restraint, mercy, and fairness toward others. The true leader carries people toward Allah, without claiming Allah’s exclusive right to judge their final destiny.

Conclusion

The guidance of the twenty-first Juz calls the believer to live in harmony with the fitrah, anchored firmly in tawhid, and expressed through gratitude, humility, and upright character. It teaches that honoring Allah’s signs begins with the closest relationships—spouse, parents, and children, and that faith is not complete without mercy, wisdom, and moral responsibility within the family and community. The Juz also challenges the habit of blaming external forces for every misfortune, insisting instead that much of the corruption on land and sea arises from what human hands have earned, and that hardship may be a merciful call back to Allah, while unrepented ease can be a subtle form of trial.

At the same time, the Juz provides clear models and measures: Luqman as a teacher of wisdom, the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ as the living embodiment of the Qur’an and the best role model, and the Qur’anic criteria for leadership, patience and certainty, tempered by humility and restraint in judgment. Ultimate accountability, it reminds us, belongs to Allah alone.

If these jewels are truly internalized, they can reorder a believer’s priorities: to read both hardship and prosperity as messages from Allah; to nurture families with wisdom and gentleness; to uphold truth and trustworthiness; and to aspire to leadership that guides without arrogance or harsh condemnation. The hope is that whoever journeys through this Juz with reflection will emerge with a heart better prepared to meet Allah, a character closer to the Prophet’s example, and a life more aligned with the path of those whom Allah has guided and honored.

Jewels from the Twenty Second Juz: From Intellectual Awe to Civilizational Responsibility

(Al-Ahzab 33:31 -Yasin 36:27)

Introduction

The twenty-second Juz of the Qur'an, spanning parts of Surahs Al-Ahzab, Saba, Fatir, and Yasin, serves as a profound roadmap for the human soul. It is a section of revelation that bridges the gap between the inner heart and the external universe.

In these pages, we are not merely given laws; we are given a strategy for existence. We move from the Pyramid of Faith, which defines our internal spiritual rank, to the Strategy of Reflection, which teaches us how to decouple our minds from the noise of the crowd.

This chapter explores the theme of Conscious Submission. It challenges the believer to move beyond a superficial, identity-based faith into a life where the study of a mountain, the management of a trade route, and the defense of a Prophet's honor are all seen as interconnected acts of worship.

As we journey through these thirteen jewels, we will discover that the path to Divine proximity is paved with intellectual honesty, active gratitude, and the courage to stand alone before Allah.

1. The Pyramid of Faith: From Identity to Excellence

The Qur'an does not present faith as a static label or a binary condition. It does not reduce human spirituality to a simple division between believer and non-believer. Rather, the Qur'an portrays spirituality as a living, evolving reality, one that grows, deepens, and ascends over a lifetime.

This dynamic progression is masterfully captured in Surat Al-Ahzab:

إِنَّ ٱلۡمُسۡلِمِينَ وَٱلۡمُسۡلِمَٰتِ وَٱلۡمُؤۡمِنِينَ وَٱلۡمُؤۡمِنَٰتِ وَٱلۡقَٰنِتِينَ وَٱلۡقَٰنِتَٰتِ وَٱلصَّٰدِقِينَ وَٱلصَّٰدِقَٰتِ وَٱلصَّٰبِرِينَ
وَٱلصَّٰبِرَٰتِ وَٱلۡخَٰشِعِينَ وَٱلۡخَٰشِعَٰتِ وَٱلۡمُتَصَدِّقِينَ وَٱلۡمُتَصَدِّقَٰتِ وَٱلصَّٰٓئِمِينَ وَٱلصَّٰٓئِمَٰتِ وَٱلۡحَٰفِظِينَ فُرُوجَهُمۡ
وَٱلۡحَٰفِظَٰتِ وَٱلذَّٰكِرِينَ ٱللَّهَ كَثِيرًا وَٱلذَّٰكِرَٰتِ أَعَدَّ ٱللَّهُ لَهُم مَّغۡفِرَةً وَأَجۡرًا عَظِيمًا (٣٥)

"Indeed, the Muslim men and Muslim women, the believing men and believing women, the devout men and devout women, the truthful men and truthful women, the patient men and patient women, the humble men and humble women, the charitable men and charitable women, the fasting men and fasting women, the men who guard their chastity and the women who do so, and the men who remember Allah often and the women who do so—for them Allah has prepared forgiveness and a great reward." (Al-Ahzab 33:35)

This is not a random collection of virtues. It is a deliberate spiritual architecture, a ten-station pyramid that guides the seeker from outward religious identity to the summit of Ihsan (spiritual excellence) and Taqwa (God-consciousness).

The Ten Stations of Ascent

1. The Muslim (Submission): The entry point. It begins with the declaration of belonging and the acceptance of Divine guidance.
2. The Believer (Iman): Identity moves from the tongue to the heart. Faith becomes internalized conviction rather than inherited affiliation.
3. The Devout (Qunut): Faith manifests as consistent, conscious obedience. Worship is no longer an occasional act, but a settled way of life.
4. The Truthful (Sidq): The birth of inner integrity. The private and public self becomes one; the heart and tongue speak the same truth and in perfect alignment.
5. The Patient (Sabr): The anchoring of faith. The believer develops endurance in hardship, restraint in temptation, and perseverance in obedience.
6. The Humble (Khushu'): The softening of the heart before Allah. Awe, reverence, and quiet surrender begin to shape one's inner state.
7. The Charitable (Sadaqah): Faith overflows outward. Having been cultivated internally, it now manifests as generosity toward creation.
8. The Faster (Sawm): The discipline of desire. By willingly restraining lawful needs, the seeker gains mastery over the ego.
9. The Chaste (Hifdh): The moral fortress. This represents the peak of self-control—guarding one's purity and dignity against the powerful human instincts.
10. The Constant Remembrance (Dhikr): The summit. At this level, the heart lives in continual awareness of Allah, producing spiritual clarity and moral insight.

إِنَّ ٱلَّذِينَ ٱتَّقَوۡاْ إِذَا مَسَّهُمۡ طَٰٓئِفٞ مِّنَ ٱلشَّيۡطَٰنِ تَذَكَّرُواْ فَإِذَا هُم مُّبۡصِرُونَ (٢٠١)

"Indeed, those who have Taqwa, when a suggestion from Satan touches them, they remember [Him] and at once they gain insight." (Al-A'raf 7:201)

Spiritual growth in Islam is additive, not substitutive. Ascending to a higher station never cancels the lower ones; it perfects them as they become more firmly rooted than ever.

An advanced seeker does not abandon prayer, honesty or patience. Rather, these qualities become deeper, purer, and more sincere than before. The pyramid is accumulative: the higher you climb, the more virtues you carry. Any claim of spiritual "enlightenment" that lacks the foundation of basic morality, discipline, and obedience is a structure without foundations, a house built on sand.

2. Heirs of the Book: Hope for Every Striving Soul

Many sincere believers struggle with a silent, painful internal dialogue: “I am not righteous enough.” “I fall too often to be a real believer.” “I will never reach the level of the truly pious.”

Surat Faṭir directly addresses this inner struggle, replacing despair with a sense of purpose. In a single, profound passage, Allah redefines our relationship with success and failure.

ثُمَّ أَوۡرَثۡنَا ٱلۡكِتَٰبَ ٱلَّذِينَ ٱصۡطَفَيۡنَا مِنۡ عِبَادِنَاۖ فَمِنۡهُمۡ ظَالِمٞ لِّنَفۡسِهِۦ وَمِنۡهُم مُّقۡتَصِدٞ وَمِنۡهُمۡ سَابِقُۢ بِٱلۡخَيۡرَٰتِ بِإِذۡنِ ٱللَّهِۚ ذَٰلِكَ هُوَ ٱلۡفَضۡلُ ٱلۡكَبِيرُ (٣٢) جَنَّٰتُ عَدۡنٖ يَدۡخُلُونَهَا .... (٣٣)

“Then We gave the Book as inheritance to those whom We have chosen from among Our servants. Among them are those who wrong themselves, among them are those who are moderate, and among them are those who race ahead in good deeds by Allah’s permission. That is the great favor. (32) Gardens of Eden! They enter therein...” (Faṭir 35:32-33)

Allah describes three categories of believers, yet all three are called: “Those whom We have chosen from among Our servants.” Even the one who wrongs himself is still included among the chosen. This alone shatters the idea that only spiritual elites belong to Allah.

The Three Categories

1. **Those Who Wrong Themselves**: These are believers who struggle with consistency, fall into sins, and fail repeatedly. Yet, Allah still calls them “My chosen servants.” Their presence in this verse proves that falling into sin does not expel you from Allah’s concern. The only true failure is to abandon the path of repentance.

2. **Those Who Are Moderate:** These are the steady and stable. They fulfill obligations and avoid major sins but do not consistently go beyond the minimum. They are upright and accepted.

3. **Those Who Race in Good Deeds**: These are the spiritually ambitious, those who actively seek excellence (Ihsan) in worship, character and service. Notably, Allah adds: (بِإِذۡنِ ٱللَّهِ) “By Allah’s permission”, reminding us that even excellence is a gift from Allah, not a personal achievement to boast about.

This verse provides the "compass" for the Pyramid of Faith. While the pyramid shows us where we can go, this verse tells us that Allah accepts us where we are. It teaches us three liberating truths:

- Belonging comes before perfection: You do not need to be flawless to be "chosen."

- Struggle does not cancel election: Your internal battles with sin do not mean you aren't an heir to the Book.
- Islam is a directional religion: It is not about where you stand, but which way you are facing.

The real danger is not being a "struggling believer"; the real danger is giving up. To stop trying is to step outside the path entirely. As long as a person regrets their errors and returns to the Divine door, they remain among the heirs.

Allah did not divide humanity into "perfect saints" and "lost failures." Instead, He categorized His chosen servants as:

- The Struggling: Fighting their weaknesses.
- The Steady: Maintaining their ground.
- The Striving: Racing for the heights.

All three are heirs of the Book. All three are invited to the Gardens of Eden. The door upward remains open for everyone, regardless of how many times they have stumbled.

3. Wholehearted Submission: The Prophet as the Living Qur'an

True faith requires unwavering submission to the decrees of Allah and His Messenger ﷺ. In Islam, the Qur'anic command and the Prophetic application are not separate authorities; they are two expressions of the same Divine will. A believer therefore accepts both with an open heart, trusting in Allah's wisdom even when its full depth is not immediately apparent.

The Qur'an makes clear that obedience to the Messenger is not optional, it is a defining condition of faith:

وَمَا كَانَ لِمُؤْمِنٍ وَلَا مُؤْمِنَةٍ إِذَا قَضَى ٱللَّهُ وَرَسُولُهُۥٓ أَمْرًا أَن يَكُونَ لَهُمُ ٱلْخِيَرَةُ مِنْ أَمْرِهِمْ ۗ وَمَن يَعْصِ ٱللَّهَ وَرَسُولَهُۥ فَقَدْ ضَلَّ ضَلَٰلًا مُّبِينًا (٣٦)

"It is not for a believing man or a believing woman—when Allah and His Messenger have decided a matter—to have any choice in their affair. And whoever disobeys Allah and His Messenger has certainly gone astray into clear error." (Al-Ahzab 33:36)

Allah also says:

فَلَا وَرَبِّكَ لَا يُؤْمِنُونَ حَتَّىٰ يُحَكِّمُوكَ فِيمَا شَجَرَ بَيْنَهُمْ ثُمَّ لَا يَجِدُوا۟ فِىٓ أَنفُسِهِمْ حَرَجًا مِّمَّا قَضَيْتَ وَيُسَلِّمُوا۟ تَسْلِيمًا (٦٥)

"But no, by your Lord, they will not truly believe until they make you judge in all disputes between them, then find within themselves no discomfort regarding what you have decided, and submit in full submission." (Al-Nisa 4:65)

The ultimate proof of one's love for Allah is following the Messenger:

قُلۡ إِن كُنتُمۡ تُحِبُّونَ ٱللَّهَ فَٱتَّبِعُونِي يُحۡبِبۡكُمُ ٱللَّهُ وَيَغۡفِرۡ لَكُمۡ ذُنُوبَكُمۡۚ وَٱللَّهُ غَفُورٞ رَّحِيمٞ (٣١) قُلۡ أَطِيعُواْ ٱللَّهَ وَٱلرَّسُولَۖ فَإِن تَوَلَّوۡاْ فَإِنَّ ٱللَّهَ لَا يُحِبُّ ٱلۡكَٰفِرِينَ (٣٢)

"Say: "If you love Allah, follow me, Allah will love you and forgive you your sins. And Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful." (31) Say: "Obey Allah and the Messenger. But if they turn away, then Allah does not like the disbelievers." (Al-Imran 3:31-32)

The Qur'an is the divinely preserved word of Allah and the primary source of guidance. Yet, by Divine design, it often presents universal principles rather than exhaustive procedural detail. The Sunnah—the lived example of the Prophet ﷺ—demonstrates how those principles are embodied in real life.

The Qur'an commands prayer, zakat, fasting, justice, and social responsibility. The Prophet ﷺ showed how to pray, how to give, how to fast, and how to live those commands with balance, mercy, and wisdom. He modeled the harmony between complete reliance on Allah (tawakkul) and active engagement with practical means.

For this reason, even those who advocate a "Qur'an-only" approach cannot escape reliance on the universally transmitted practices of the Prophet, such as the form of prayer and the structure of communal worship. These practices represent a lived Sunnah that predates written collections and has been preserved through continuous communal transmission.

Because Prophetic teachings were transmitted through human chains, scholars developed a rigorous science to distinguish reliable reports from unreliable ones. At the highest level of certainty stands the Hadith Mutawatir, reports transmitted by such large numbers of people in every generation that deliberate fabrication is inconceivable.

Scholars historically differed on the minimum number required for mass transmission:

- Some suggest **10**, citing the Qur'anic description of ten as "complete" (2:196).
- Others suggest **40**, based on Prophetic narrations regarding the strength of a group.
- Some even cite **310** (the number of companions at Badr) or **1,400** (those at the Pledge of Ridwan).

Using the criterion of ten narrators per generation, scholars estimate that roughly 100–350 hadiths reach this level of absolute authenticity.

While Hadith science is a specialized discipline, its spiritual implication is simple: Allah sent the Messenger ﷺ not merely to deliver revelation, but to embody it.

For the believer, following the Prophet ﷺ is not secondary to following the Qur'an. It is the most faithful way of following the Qur'an itself. Wholehearted submission, therefore,

is not abstract belief, it is lived obedience, modeled by the Messenger and embraced with trust, humility, and love.

4. The Strategy of Serious Reflection: Breaking the Noise

When people harbor doubts about the Truth, their instinct is often to look toward the majority or immerse themselves in public discourse. Yet the Qur'an repeatedly indicates that crowds are rarely where deep realization occurs. Genuine understanding requires a deliberate withdrawal from collective noise into purposeful reflection.

In Surat Saba, Allah commands the Prophet ﷺ to present a single, concise piece of advice to his critics:

قُلۡ إِنَّمَآ أَعِظُكُم بِوَٰحِدَةٍۖ أَن تَقُومُواْ لِلَّهِ مَثۡنَىٰ وَفُرَٰدَىٰ ثُمَّ تَتَفَكَّرُواْۚ مَا بِصَاحِبِكُم مِّن جِنَّةٍۚ إِنۡ هُوَ إِلَّا نَذِيرٞ لَّكُم بَيۡنَ يَدَيۡ عَذَابٖ شَدِيدٖ (٤٦)

"Say: I advise you to do one thing only: that you stand for Allah, in pairs or individually, and then reflect. You will realize that your companion is not possessed by madness. He is nothing but a warner to you before a severe punishment" (Saba 34:46)

In large groups, crowd psychology often dominates. People unconsciously absorb prevailing opinions in order to belong. The pressure to conform suppresses independent thought and muffles the voice of the fitrah, the innate human inclination toward truth.

Allah's instruction therefore begins with separation from the crowd.

- Individually (Furādā): To stand alone before Allah, free from social influence, reputational concern, or performative behavior. It is a direct encounter between the soul and its Creator.

- In Pairs (Mathnā): To engage in sincere dialogue with one trusted person. With no audience and no hierarchy, two minds assist each other in removing assumptions and blind spots.

Both modes cultivate honesty, humility, and intellectual courage. Once removed from the noise, a person can objectively assess several core realities emphasized in Surat Saba:

1. Evidence of Character: The Prophet ﷺ lived among his people for decades as Al-Amīn (the trustworthy). Reflection recalls a life defined by integrity, not delusion.

2. Evidence of Sincerity: (قُلۡ مَا سَأَلۡتُكُم مِّنۡ أَجۡرٖ فَهُوَ لَكُمۡۖ إِنۡ أَجۡرِيَ إِلَّا عَلَى ٱللَّهِۖ) "No reward do I ask you... My reward is only from Allah." The Prophet ﷺ repeatedly declared

that he sought no payment, status, or worldly gain. His mission brought hardship, not privilege, evidence that his motivation was purely Divine.

3. Evidence of Source: Allah describes Himself as: (رَبِّي يَقْذِفُ بِالْحَقِّ عَلَّامُ الْغُيُوبِ) "My Lord sends forth the Truth... the Knower of the Unseen." Truth is not a human fabrication; it is a deliberate projection from the Creator into human consciousness.

4. Evidence of Outcome: (جَاءَ الْحَقُّ وَمَا يُبْدِئُ الْبَاطِلُ وَمَا يُعِيدُ) "The Truth has come, and falsehood cannot originate nor restore." Falsehood has no creative power. It only imitates, distorts, and collapses when confronted by Truth.

The strategy concludes with a statement of intellectual honesty:

قُلۡ إِن ضَلَلۡتُ فَإِنَّمَآ أَضِلُّ عَلَىٰ نَفۡسِيۖ وَإِنِ ٱهۡتَدَيۡتُ فَبِمَا يُوحِيٓ إِلَيَّ رَبِّيٓۚ إِنَّهُۥ سَمِيعٞ قَرِيبٞ (٥٠)

"If I go astray, it is only against myself. And if I am guided, it is by what my Lord reveals to me. Indeed, He is All-Hearing, Ever Near" (Saba 34:50)

Guidance is not inherited from crowds. It is earned through sincere engagement with revelation.

Truth does not require a majority vote. It requires an honest heart, a quiet mind, and the courage to stand before Allah.

5. The Source of True Honor: Seeking the Audience of One

When a believer comes to know Allah through reflection on His creation and His Names, a profound inner shift occurs. The heart gradually detaches from craving recognition, applause, and status among people. In their place emerges a firm conviction that all honor originates from a single Source: Allah.

Allah lays down this principle with striking clarity:

مَن كَانَ يُرِيدُ ٱلۡعِزَّةَ فَلِلَّهِ ٱلۡعِزَّةُ جَمِيعًاۚ إِلَيۡهِ يَصۡعَدُ ٱلۡكَلِمُ ٱلطَّيِّبُ وَٱلۡعَمَلُ ٱلصَّٰلِحُ يَرۡفَعُهُۥۚ وَٱلَّذِينَ يَمۡكُرُونَ ٱلسَّيِّـَٔاتِ لَهُمۡ عَذَابٞ شَدِيدٞۖ وَمَكۡرُ أُوْلَٰٓئِكَ هُوَ يَبُورُ (١٠)

“Whoever desires honor, to Allah belongs all honor. To Him ascend good words, and righteous deeds raise them. But those who plot evil will have a severe punishment, and their plotting will perish.” (Fatir 35:10)

This verse reveals a subtle but powerful distinction:

- Good Words (Al-Kalim al-Tayyib): These are pure, sincere, and beneficial words. Allah says they ascend to Him, meaning they are accepted, recorded, and rewarded.

- Righteous Deeds (Al-'Amal al-Salih): For actions, Allah uses a stronger verb: yarfaʿuhu (He raises it). Words may be acknowledged, but deeds are what elevate. They are the engine of spiritual promotion.

Many people compromise their principles to gain social approval. Yet this pursuit often results in losing both Allah's pleasure and people's respect. The Prophet (PBUH) summarized this spiritual law:

من التمس رضا الله عنه بسخط الناس رضي الله عنه ، وأرضى عنه الناس ، ومن التمس رضا الناس بسخط الله ، سخط الله عليه وأسخط عليه الناس .[أخرجه البيهقي في شعب الإيمان]

“"Whoever seeks Allah's pleasure, even if it incurs the displeasure of people, Allah will be pleased with him and will cause the people to be pleased with him. But whoever seeks People's pleasure while incurring the displeasure of Allah, Allah will be displeased with him and will cause the people to be displeased with him. " (Tirmidhi/Bayhaqi)

Why, then, do people still submit to others against their conscience? Most often, it is driven by two primal fears:

- Fear of losing provision
- Fear of losing security or life

The Qur'an dismantles both.

مَّا يَفۡتَحِ ٱللَّهُ لِلنَّاسِ مِن رَّحۡمَةٖ فَلَا مُمۡسِكَ لَهَاۖ وَمَا يُمۡسِكۡ فَلَا مُرۡسِلَ لَهُۥ مِنۢ بَعۡدِهِۦۚ وَهُوَ ٱلۡعَزِيزُ ٱلۡحَكِيمُ (٢)
"Whatever mercy Allah opens for mankind, none can withhold it; and whatever He withholds, none can release it after Him. And He is the All-Mighty, the All-Wise." (Fatir 35:2)

No employer, ruler, institution, or network controls destiny. Allah alone does.

When you realize that no human can open what Allah has closed, and no human can close what Allah has opened, fear dissolves. You stop performing for crowds. You stop bargaining with your conscience. You begin living for an Audience of One. And in that moment, you become truly free.

6. Invoking Blessings: A Divine Partnership

In the Qur'an, most commands begin with the address, (يَٰٓأَيُّهَا ٱلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُواْ)"O you who believe." However, there is one unique command where Allah does not begin by instructing the believers. Instead, He first declares that He Himself and His angels are already engaged in the act, and only then invites the believers to join

إِنَّ اللَّهَ وَمَلائِكَتَهُ يُصَلُّونَ عَلَى النَّبِيِّ يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا صَلُّوا عَلَيْهِ وَسَلِّمُوا تَسْلِيمًا) الأحزاب ٥٦)

"Indeed, Allah and His angels send blessings (Salat) upon the Prophet. O you who believe, ask blessings upon him and greet him with a worthy salutation." (Al-Azab 33:56)

This verse reveals a profound reality: sending blessings upon the Prophet ﷺ is not merely a human devotion, it is participation in an ongoing Divine action.

The word Salat takes different meanings depending on who performs it

1. **From Allah:** It is not a request, but a fulfillment. It signifies divine mercy, exaltation, praise among the angels, and the granting of forgiveness and grace.

2. **From the Angels:** It is **Istighfar** (seeking forgiveness). As carriers of the Throne, they ask Allah to protect and forgive those on Earth (Ghafir 40:7).

الذين يحملون العرش ومن حوله يسبحون بحمد ربهم ويؤمنون به ويستغفرون للذين آمنوا ربنا وسعت كل شيء رحمة وعلماً فاغفر للذين تابوا واتبعوا سبيلك وقهم عذاب الجحيم،)غافر(

"Those who carry the Throne (of Allah) and those around it glorify and Praise to their Lord; believe in Him; and ask forgiveness for those who believe: "Our Lord! Your reach is over all things, in mercy and knowledge. Forgive those who turn in repentance and follow Your Path; and protect them from the Penalty of the Hell Fire!" (Ghafer 40:7)

3. **From the Believers:** It is a **Du'a** (supplication), asking Allah to increase the Prophet's rank, honor his station, and shower him with mercy.

When verse 33:56 was revealed, the companions (*Sahaba*) initially felt a sense of longing. Ibn Abbas reported that the Emigrants and Helpers said:

قال ابن عباس : لما نزل إن الله وملائكته يصلون على النبي قال المهاجرون والأنصار : هذا لك يا رسول الله خاصة ، وليس لنا فيه شيء

"This is for you alone, O Messenger of Allah, and we have no share in it."

They were accustomed to verses where Allah mentions the Prophet and the believers together, such as:

مُّحَمَّدٌ رَّسُولُ ٱللَّهِۚ وَٱلَّذِينَ مَعَهُۥٓ أَشِدَّآءُ عَلَى ٱلۡكُفَّارِ رُحَمَآءُ بَيۡنَهُمۡۖ تَرَىٰهُمۡ رُكَّعٗا سُجَّدٗا يَبۡتَغُونَ فَضۡلٗا مِّنَ ٱللَّهِ وَرِضۡوَٰنٗاۖ) الفَتْح(

"Muhammad, the Messenger of Allah, and those who are with him are strong against the disbelievers, but compassionate among themselves. You see them bowing and prostrating, seeking Bounty from Allah and (His) Good Pleasure." (Al-Fath 48:29)

ءَامَنَ ٱلرَّسُولُ بِمَآ أُنزِلَ إِلَيۡهِ مِن رَّبِّهِۦ وَٱلۡمُؤۡمِنُونَۚ كُلٌّ ءَامَنَ بِٱللَّهِ وَمَلَٰٓئِكَتِهِۦ وَكُتُبِهِۦ وَرُسُلِهِۦ لَا نُفَرِّقُ بَيۡنَ أَحَدٖ مِّن رُّسُلِهِۦۚ

"**The Messenger believes in what has been revealed to him from his Lord, as do the believers. Each one believes in Allah, His Angels, His Books, and His**

Messengers. (They say), "We make no distinction between one another of His Messengers" (Al-Baqarah 2:285)

Shortly after, Allah revealed that the believers are also recipients of Divine and angelic Salat:

هُوَ ٱلَّذِى يُصَلِّى عَلَيْكُمْ وَمَلَـٰٓئِكَتُهُۥ لِيُخْرِجَكُم مِّنَ ٱلظُّلُمَـٰتِ إِلَى ٱلنُّورِ ۚ وَكَانَ بِٱلْمُؤْمِنِينَ رَحِيمًا (٤٣)

"He is the One who sends blessings (Salat) upon you, and His angels as well, so that He may bring you out from darkness into light; and He is ever Merciful to the believers." (Ahzab 33:43)

How does a believer secure this continuous Divine and angelic attention? The Qur'an gives a clear condition: frequent remembrance.

يَـٰٓأَيُّهَا ٱلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا۟ ٱذْكُرُوا۟ ٱللَّهَ ذِكْرًا كَثِيرًا (٤١) وَسَبِّحُوهُ بُكْرَةً وَأَصِيلاً (٤٢).(سورة الأحزاب)

"O you who believe, remember Allah with much remembrance (41) and glorify Him morning and evening. (Al-Ahzab 33:41:42)

The distinguishing mark between sincere faith and hypocrisy is not the presence of remembrance, but its scarcity:

إِنَّ ٱلْمُنَـٰفِقِينَ يُخَـٰدِعُونَ ٱللَّهَ وَهُوَ خَـٰدِعُهُمْ وَإِذَا قَامُوٓا۟ إِلَى ٱلصَّلَوٰةِ قَامُوا۟ كُسَالَىٰ يُرَآءُونَ ٱلنَّاسَ وَلَا يَذْكُرُونَ ٱللَّهَ إِلَّا قَلِيلاً) النساء(

"The hypocrites seek to deceive Allah, but it is He Who deceives them. And when they stand up for the prayer, they stand with laziness and to be seen of men, and they do not remember Allah but a little." (Al-Nisa 4:142)

Sending blessings upon the Prophet ﷺ, engaging in abundant remembrance, and seeking closeness to Allah are not separate acts. They are intertwined pathways into a Divine partnership in which Allah elevates, the angels pray, and the believer walks in light. This is not merely honor, it is transformation.

7. The Great Trust: Empowering the Human Soul

The final two verses of Surat Al-Ahzab are often read in a way that unintentionally portrays the human condition as a tragic cosmic mistake. When approached only through surface-level translations, these verses may seem to depict humanity as reckless, doomed, and inherently unfit for the responsibility it accepted.

Yet through tadabbur (deep reflection) and by keeping in mind Allah's Names, the All-Wise, the All-Merciful, and the All-Just, a far more empowering message emerges.

The verses state:

إِنَّا عَرَضْنَا ٱلْأَمَانَةَ عَلَى ٱلسَّمَٰوَٰتِ وَٱلْأَرْضِ وَٱلْجِبَالِ فَأَبَيْنَ أَن يَحْمِلْنَهَا وَأَشْفَقْنَ مِنْهَا وَحَمَلَهَا ٱلْإِنسَٰنُ ۖ إِنَّهُۥ كَانَ ظَلُومًا جَهُولًا (٧٢) لِّيُعَذِّبَ ٱللَّهُ ٱلْمُنَٰفِقِينَ وَٱلْمُنَٰفِقَٰتِ وَٱلْمُشْرِكِينَ وَٱلْمُشْرِكَٰتِ وَيَتُوبَ ٱللَّهُ عَلَى ٱلْمُؤْمِنِينَ وَٱلْمُؤْمِنَٰتِ ۗ وَكَانَ ٱللَّهُ غَفُورًا رَّحِيمًا (٧٣)

"Indeed, We presented the Trust to the heavens, the earth, and the mountains, but they declined to bear it and were apprehensive of it; and man undertook it. Indeed, he was unjust and ignorant. (72) So that Allah may punish the hypocritical men and hypocritical women and the idolatrous men and idolatrous women, and Allah may turn in mercy to the believing men and believing women. And Allah is Forgiving, Merciful. "(Al-Ahzab 33:72-73)

A purely literal reading often produces three troubling impressions:

- That the Heavens and Earth have free will and consciously "refused" Allah's offer.
- That humanity was foolish for accepting a burden beyond its capacity.
- That the purpose of the trust was merely to create a scenario for punishment.

Such conclusions conflict with a foundational Qur'anic principle

لَا يُكَلِّفُ ٱللَّهُ نَفْسًا إِلَّا وُسْعَهَا

"Allah does not burden any soul beyond its capacity." (Al-Baqarah 2:286)

What is the "Trust" (Al-Amanah)?

In Surat Al-Baqarah, Allah announces:

إِنِّي جَاعِلٌ فِي ٱلْأَرْضِ خَلِيفَةً

"Indeed, I am placing upon the earth a Khalifa (vicegerent)." (Al-Baqarah 2:30)

The Amanah (Trust) is his very role: guardianship of the earth according to Divine guidance.

To fulfill it, Allah equipped humanity with extraordinary endowments:

- **Knowledge:** Adam was taught the names of all things (2:31).
- **Subjugation of creation:** The universe was made serviceable to humankind (45:13).
- **Consciousness with Free Will:** While all creation glorify Allah (17:44), only humans possess the unique ability to consciously choose obedience or rebellion.

To reach a deeper understanding of these verses, we need to re-examine three key Arabic terms:

1. **'Arada (عَرَضَ):** Commonly translated as "offered," it also means **"to project" or "to display."** Just as a "showing hall" (صالة عرض) displays a film, Allah projected the magnitude of this responsibility to the mountains and heavens to demonstrate their relative incapacity compared to the potential of Man.

2. **Abayna (أَبَيْنَ):** Translated as "refused," but linguistically it implies **"incapacity."** In engineering, "pile refusal" occurs when a pile can no longer penetrate soil. The mountains did not "say no" to Allah; they simply reached the limit of their structural capacity.
3. **Ashfaqna (أَشْفَقْنَ):** Often translated as "they were afraid," but it carries the root meaning of **"softness" or "fragility."** It highlights that even the mighty mountains are "softer" than the spiritual and intellectual resilience Allah placed within the human soul.

Why Describe Man as Zalūm "Unjust" and Jahūl (Foolish)?

These descriptors do not condemn humanity for accepting the Trust. They describe what happens when humans neglect it.

- A person is unjust to himself when he wastes the divine potential placed within him
- A person is ignorant when he fails to recognize the honor of being chosen as Allah's vicegerent.

The criticism targets misuse—not existence.

The verses may therefore be understood as conveying:

إِنَّا عَرَضْنَا ٱلْأَمَانَةَ عَلَى ٱلسَّمَٰوَٰتِ وَٱلْأَرْضِ وَٱلْجِبَالِ فَأَبَيْنَ أَن يَحْمِلْنَهَا وَأَشْفَقْنَ مِنْهَا وَحَمَلَهَا ٱلْإِنسَٰنُ ۖ إِنَّهُۥ كَانَ ظَلُومًا جَهُولًا (٧٢) لِّيُعَذِّبَ ٱللَّهُ ٱلْمُنَٰفِقِينَ وَٱلْمُنَٰفِقَٰتِ وَٱلْمُشْرِكِينَ وَٱلْمُشْرِكَٰتِ وَيَتُوبَ ٱللَّهُ عَلَى ٱلْمُؤْمِنِينَ وَٱلْمُؤْمِنَٰتِ ۗ وَكَانَ ٱللَّهُ غَفُورًا رَّحِيمًا (٧٣)

"Allah displayed the Trust—the guardianship of earth according to His guidance—to the heavens, the earth, and the mountains, but they lacked the capacity to carry it. Humanity, uniquely equipped with knowledge, consciousness, and choice, was entrusted with it. When man neglects this endowment, he wrongs himself and behaves in ignorance. (72) As a result, Allah holds accountable those who betray the trust and shows mercy to those who honor it. And Allah is Forgiving, Merciful." (Al-Ahzab 33:72–73)

We were not created as a tragic experiment. We were created as entrusted guardians. The question is not whether we are worthy of the Trust. The question is whether we will rise to it.

8. The Individual's Duty: No One is Excused from the Message

In Surat Yasin, Allah recounts the story of a town to which He sent not one, but three messengers. Despite this extraordinary concentration of guidance, the people rejected them with hostility, ridicule, and threats.

At this critical moment, a man appeared, not from the center of power, but from the farthest part of the city. When he heard the truth, he refused to remain silent.

One might assume that with three messengers already present, the voice of an ordinary man would be unnecessary. Yet he understood something profound: when truth is blocked at the top, it must rise from within the community itself. He did not say, “I am not qualified.” He did not say, “Others are more capable.” He ran.

وَجَآءَ مِنۡ أَقۡصَا ٱلۡمَدِينَةِ رَجُلٞ يَسۡعَىٰ قَالَ يَٰقَوۡمِ ٱتَّبِعُواْ ٱلۡمُرۡسَلِينَ (٢٠) ٱتَّبِعُواْ مَن لَّا يَسۡـَٔلُكُمۡ أَجۡرٗا وَهُم مُّهۡتَدُونَ (٢١) وَمَا لِيَ لَآ أَعۡبُدُ ٱلَّذِي فَطَرَنِي وَإِلَيۡهِ تُرۡجَعُونَ (٢٢) ءَأَتَّخِذُ مِن دُونِهِۦٓ ءَالِهَةً إِن يُرِدۡنِ ٱلرَّحۡمَٰنُ بِضُرّٖ لَّا تُغۡنِ عَنِّي شَفَٰعَتُهُمۡ شَيۡـٔٗا وَلَا يُنقِذُونِ (٢٣) إِنِّيٓ إِذٗا لَّفِي ضَلَٰلٖ مُّبِينٍ (٢٤) إِنِّيٓ ءَامَنتُ بِرَبِّكُمۡ فَٱسۡمَعُونِ (٢٥)

“And there came from the farthest part of the city a man running. He said: ‘O my people, follow the messengers. (20) Follow those who ask of you no reward and who are rightly guided. (21) Why should I not worship the One who created me, and to whom you will be returned? (22) Shall I take besides Him gods whose intercession would not benefit me at all, nor could they save me? (23) Indeed, I would then be in clear error. (24) Indeed, I have believed in your Lord, so listen to me". (Yasin 36: 20-25)

The townspeople, responded with violence and killed him. Yet the Qur’an reveals something extraordinary about the heart of a sincere believer.

قِيلَ ٱدۡخُلِ ٱلۡجَنَّةَۖ قَالَ يَٰلَيۡتَ قَوۡمِي يَعۡلَمُونَ (٢٦) بِمَا غَفَرَ لِي رَبِّي وَجَعَلَنِي مِنَ ٱلۡمُكۡرَمِينَ (٢٧)

“It was said "Enter Paradise." He said, "I wish my people could know (26) How my Lord has forgiven me and made me among the honored." (Yasin 36:26-27)

Even after being murdered, his concern was not revenge. It was guidance for others.

This story establishes a timeless principle: Conveying the message is not limited to prophets, scholars, or specialists. It is the responsibility of every believer.

Allah says:

قُلْ هَذِهِ سَبِيلِي أَدْعُو إِلَى اللَّهِ عَلَى بَصِيرَةٍ أَنَا وَمَنِ اتَّبَعَنِي] سورة يوسف الآية: 108]

"Say (O Muhammad): 'This is my path: I invite to Allah with clear insight, I and those who follow me.'" (Yusuf 12:108)

And the Prophet ﷺ made the minimum threshold accessible to all: (بلغوا عني ولو آية)
"Convey from me, even if it is only one verse." (Al-Bukhari).

The man in Surat Yasin was not a messenger, but he was a carrier of the message. His story proves that sincerity outweighs status, and courage outweighs credentials. Every believer stands at a crossroads: Remain silent… or run toward the truth. And history is changed by those who run.

9. True Scholars: The Scientists of Creation

Modern culture often separates “religious scholars” from “scientists,” as though they occupy two unrelated intellectual worlds. The Qur’an, however, presents a unified vision of knowledge in which studying revelation and studying creation are complementary paths toward knowing Allah.

In Surat Fatir, Allah directly links observation of the natural world with true scholarship:

أَلَمْ تَرَ أَنَّ ٱللَّهَ أَنزَلَ مِنَ ٱلسَّمَآءِ مَآءً فَأَخْرَجْنَا بِهِۦ ثَمَرَٰتٍ مُّخْتَلِفًا أَلْوَٰنُهَا ۚ وَمِنَ ٱلْجِبَالِ جُدَدٌۢ بِيضٌ وَحُمْرٌ مُّخْتَلِفٌ أَلْوَٰنُهَا وَغَرَابِيبُ سُودٌ (٢٧) وَمِنَ ٱلنَّاسِ وَٱلدَّوَآبِّ وَٱلْأَنْعَٰمِ مُخْتَلِفٌ أَلْوَٰنُهُۥ كَذَٰلِكَ ۗ إِنَّمَا يَخْشَى ٱللَّهَ مِنْ عِبَادِهِ ٱلْعُلَمَٰٓؤُا۟ ۗ إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ عَزِيزٌ غَفُورٌ (٢٨)

“Do you not see that Allah sends down rain from the sky, and We bring forth with it fruits of varying colors; and among the mountains are streaks of white and red of varying shades, and others intensely black. (27) And among people, creatures, and livestock are those of varying colors as well. Only those who possess knowledge among His servants truly stand in awe of Allah. Indeed, Allah is All-Mighty, Most Forgiving.” (Fatir 35:27-28)

Immediately before defining who the ulama are, Allah draws attention to:

- **Meteorology and Botany:** rainfall cycle and plant diversity.
- **Geology:** mineral composition and layered mountain formations.
- **Biology and Zoology:** variation within human and animal life.

The Qur’an places these scientific observations as the gateway to understanding who qualifies as a true scholar.

A Linguistic Precision
The phrase (إِنَّمَا يَخْشَى ٱللَّهَ مِنْ عِبَادِهِ ٱلْعُلَمَٰٓؤُا۟) contains a deliberate grammatical structure.

In classical Arabic, a normal sentence order would be:
Verb → Subject → Object

Here, the Qur’an reverses it:
Verb → Object (Allah) → Subject (the scholars)

Combined with *innamā* / إِنَّمَا (only), this structure creates exclusivity.
Meaning: Only those whose knowledge leads them to Allah attain true *khashya*.

This yields a dual definition:

- True scholars are those whose learning increases their awe of Allah.
- Anyone whose knowledge does not produce awe has not yet reached the Qur’anic meaning of scholarship, regardless of credentials.

<u>Redefining *Khashya*</u>

Khashya is often translated as “fear,” but its deeper meaning is reverential awe born from understanding. It is the feeling a person experiences when confronted with overwhelming complexity, precision, and scale, whether in galaxies, ecosystems, or molecular structures.
The Prophet ﷺ affirmed this relationship between knowledge and awe:
والله إني لأعلمهم بالله ، وأشدهم له خشية)البخاري ومسلم(
“By Allah, I am the most knowing of Allah among you, and I am the most in awe (*khashya*) of Him.” (Bukhari & Muslim)

Knowledge does not inflate the ego. True knowledge humbles it.

In Islam, the microscope and the telescope can become instruments of worship. A true scholar reads two books simultaneously:

- The Book of Revelation
- The Book of Creation

And from both, the same conclusion emerges: Allah is Great.

10. The Curse of Greed: Why the Kingdom of Saba Fell

The story of the people of Saba (Sheba) stands as one of the Qur’an’s most penetrating case studies on the relationship between wealth, gratitude, and social justice. Saba was not a poor or struggling society. It was a civilization at the height of success, combining technical ingenuity with strategic geography.

Allah granted them two extraordinary blessings.

- Technological Mastery: They constructed the legendary Ma’rib Dam, an engineering achievement that regulated seasonal floods and transformed an arid land into fertile abundance: (جَنَّتَانِ عَن يَمِينٍ وَشِمَالٍ) "two gardens on the right and on the left" (Saba 34:15).
  Their prosperity was not accidental, it was the product of knowledge, planning, and Divine facilitation.

- Infrastructure and Security: Unlike other nations where travel was a life-threatening risk, Allah blessed Saba with a network of visible, closely spaced, and secure towns
  وَجَعَلْنَا بَيْنَهُمْ وَبَيْنَ ٱلْقُرَى ٱلَّتِى بَـٰرَكْنَا فِيهَا قُرًى ظَـٰهِرَةً وَقَدَّرْنَا فِيهَا ٱلسَّيْرَ
“We placed between them and the towns We had blessed other visible towns and measured the journey between them.” (Saba 34:18)
  Trade was safe. Travel was easy. Prosperity was accessible.

The downfall of Saba did not happen because of scarcity; they fell because of greed. As trade became effortless, the wealthy elite grew resentful that ordinary people could participate in economic life. They desired exclusivity, not shared prosperity. In a shocking display of selfishness, they made the following request:

فَقَالُواْ رَبَّنَا بَـٰعِدۡ بَيۡنَ أَسۡفَارِنَا وَظَلَمُوٓاْ أَنفُسَهُمۡ ... (١٩)

But they said: "Our Lord, make the distance between our journeys longer, and they wronged themselves. (Saba 34:19)

This was not a logistical request. It was a class-based demand. They were asking Allah to dismantle public infrastructure so that only the rich could afford travel, trade, and opportunity. They preferred a smaller elite market over a broad, inclusive economy.

When a society begins to desire hardship for others, it has already signed its own death warrant. Allah responded on two levels:

- Physical Collapse: The Great Dam of Ma'rib was breached (Sayl al-'Arim), turning their fertile land into wasteland.

- Social Disintegration: (فَجَعَلۡنَاهُمۡ أَحَادِيثَ وَمَزَّقۡنَاهُمۡ كُلَّ مُمَزَّقٍ) “We made them tales, and We scattered them completely.” (Saba 34:19) A civilization that once controlled trade routes became nothing more than a cautionary story.

The verse concludes with a powerful reminder:

إِنَّ فِى ذَٰلِكَ لَأٓيَـٰتٍ لِّكُلِّ صَبَّارٍ شَكُورٍ (١٩)

"Indeed, in that are signs for every steadfast, grateful person." (Saba 34:19).

The issue was never wealth. The issue was shukr. Allah presents a contrasting model through the family of Dawud:

ٱعۡمَلُوٓاْ ءَالَ دَاوُۥدَ شُكۡرًاۚ ...(١٣)

" Work, O family of Dawud, in gratitude…" (Saba 34:13)

Gratitude is not passive emotion; it is productive action. True gratitude has five dimensions:

1. Attribution: Recognizing that every blessing comes from Allah.
2. Utilization: Actively using the blessing to fulfill Allah’s directives and serve His creation.
3. Prioritization: Loving the Giver more than the gift.
4. Humility: Viewing blessings as responsibility, not superiority.
5. Perpetual Praise: Maintaining awareness of Allah in ease and hardship.

The Ayah concludes with a sobering reality: (وَقَلِيلٌ مِّنۡ عِبَادِىَ ٱلشَّكُورُ) "Few of My servants are truly grateful." This "minority status" is not something to be feared, but something to be sought.

Saba did not collapse because they were weak. They collapsed because they wanted others to struggle. When wealth stops circulating, societies stop breathing. And when gratitude dies, civilizations die with it.

11. The Death of Solomon: Demystifying the Illusion of the Unseen

One of the most intriguing verses in Surat Saba concerns the death of Prophet Solomon (Sulayman):

فَلَمَّا قَضَيْنَا عَلَيْهِ ٱلْمَوْتَ مَا دَلَّهُمْ عَلَىٰ مَوْتِهِۦٓ إِلَّا دَآبَّةُ ٱلْأَرْضِ تَأْكُلُ مِنسَأَتَهُۥ ۖ فَلَمَّا خَرَّ تَبَيَّنَتِ ٱلْجِنُّ أَن لَّوْ كَانُوا۟ يَعْلَمُونَ ٱلْغَيْبَ مَا لَبِثُوا۟ فِى ٱلْعَذَابِ ٱلْمُهِينِ (١٤)

"When We decreed death for him (Sulayman) nothing indicated his death to them (the Jinn) except a creature of the earth consuming what supported him. Then when he fell, the jinn realized that if they had known the unseen, they would not have remained in humiliating labor." (Saba 34:14)

This account provides a decisive lesson about the limits of created beings, particularly the jinn, and exposes the falsity of any claim to independent knowledge of the unseen (al-ghayb).

The widespread understanding is that Solomon died while leaning on a wooden staff, remaining upright until termites ate through it. While possible, this reading raises reasonable questions:

- **Royal Protocol:** How could a ruler who oversaw a vast empire disappear from active engagement without ministers, guards, or attendants approaching him for an extended period?
- **Physical Reality:** A human body would exhibit visible biological changes long before a solid staff would be fully consumed.

These questions invite careful linguistic and conceptual reflection.

Linguistic Insight: The Meaning of *Minsa'atahu (مِنسَأَتَهُ)*

The word minsa'ah is linked to the root Nasa'a (ن س أ), which conveys meanings of delay, postponement, or regulated timing. While commonly rendered as "staff," the term is not limited to a simple walking stick. Linguistically, it may denote an instrument associated with regulation, control, or deferred action.

This opens space for a broader functional understanding.

The Hypothesis: The Model and the Monitor

We can hypothesize that Solomon, who was granted advanced technology and command over the Jinn, utilized a highly sophisticated system (perhaps a realistic model or a projection) to oversee the Jinn's labor.

Based on Solomon's extraordinary endowments, control over the jinn, mastery of complex construction, and access to advanced means, a plausible hypothesis is:

- **The Model:** Solomon may have employed a realistic representation or projected presence positioned on the throne to maintain order among the jinn.
- **The *Minsa'ah*:** Rather than a mere stick, it functioned as a structural or timing-support mechanism sustaining the appearance of presence.
- **The Creature of the Earth (dabbat al-ardh):** A process of natural or material degradation that compromised this support system.

When the supporting mechanism failed, the representation collapsed, revealing that Solomon had already passed away.

This interpretation remains a hypothesis, not a claim of certainty, but it resolves several practical difficulties while remaining faithful to the Qur'anic wording.

Fundamental Lessons

1. **Exposure of False Claims to the Unseen**

The jinn's humiliation lies at the heart of the verse:

تَبَيَّنَتِ ٱلْجِنُّ أَن لَّوْ كَانُوا۟ يَعْلَمُونَ ٱلْغَيْبَ مَا لَبِثُوا۟ فِى ٱلْعَذَابِ ٱلْمُهِينِ (١٤)

"...they realized, if they had known the unseen they would not have continued in humiliating labor." (Saba 34:14)

Any being that truly possessed unseen knowledge would have recognized Solomon's death immediately.

2. **Death as the Ultimate Equalizer**

Even a prophet-king who commanded wind, jinn, and nature could not escape the Divine decree of death. Absolute power belongs only to Allah.

3. **The Fragility of Illusory Power**

Oppression often survives through appearances rather than reality. Just as the jinn were bound by the illusion of Solomon's presence, many people today are constrained by social, political, or psychological systems whose authority is largely imagined.

4. **Continuity with Scientific Civilization**

Solomon’s governance involved tools, systems, and structured management. This aligns with the Qur’anic portrayal of prophets as builders of civilizations who employ material means in service of justice and order.

The story is not about termites and wood. It is about exposing the myth of hidden knowledge, dismantling false authority, and reminding humanity that true unseen knowledge belongs to Allah alone.

12. The Punishment of the Soul: Spiritual Shackles and Barriers

Verses 7–10 of Surat Yasin present one of the Qur’an’s most sobering descriptions of spiritual consequence. Allah speaks of a category of people for whom belief has become inaccessible, not because evidence is lacking, but because their inner capacity to receive truth has been damaged.

لَقَدْ حَقَّ ٱلْقَوْلُ عَلَىٰٓ أَكْثَرِهِمْ فَهُمْ لَا يُؤْمِنُونَ (٧) إِنَّا جَعَلْنَا فِىٓ أَعْنَـٰقِهِمْ أَغْلَـٰلاً فَهِىَ إِلَى ٱلْأَذْقَانِ فَهُم
مُّقْمَحُونَ (٨) وَجَعَلْنَا مِنۢ بَيْنِ أَيْدِيهِمْ سَدًّا وَمِنْ خَلْفِهِمْ سَدًّا فَأَغْشَيْنَـٰهُمْ فَهُمْ لَا يُبْصِرُونَ (٩) وَسَوَآءٌ عَلَيْهِمْ
ءَأَنذَرْتَهُمْ أَمْ لَمْ تُنذِرْهُمْ لَا يُؤْمِنُونَ (١٠

“The word has certainly been fulfilled against most of them, so they do not believe. (7) We have placed shackles upon their necks up to their chins, so their heads are forced upward. (8) And We have placed a barrier before them and a barrier behind them and covered them, so they cannot see. (9) It is the same whether you warn them or do not warn them, they will not believe.” (Yasin 36:7-10)

Belief is not a human right automatically granted. It is a divine honor. The Qur’an repeatedly shows that this honor is withdrawn from those who persistently embody certain traits: arrogance (كبر), injustice (ظلم), rebellion (فسق), and deliberate lying (كذب).

Allah says:

سَأَصْرِفُ عَنْ ءَايَـٰتِىَ ٱلَّذِينَ يَتَكَبَّرُونَ فِى ٱلْأَرْضِ بِغَيْرِ ٱلْحَقِّ وَإِن يَرَوْا۟ كُلَّ ءَايَةٍ لَّا يُؤْمِنُوا۟ بِهَا وَإِن يَرَوْا۟ سَبِيلَ
ٱلرُّشْدِ لَا يَتَّخِذُوهُ سَبِيلاً وَإِن يَرَوْا۟ سَبِيلَ ٱلْغَىِّ يَتَّخِذُوهُ سَبِيلاً ذَٰلِكَ بِأَنَّهُمْ كَذَّبُوا۟ بِـَٔايَـٰتِنَا وَكَانُوا۟ عَنْهَا غَـٰفِلِينَ
(١٤٦)

“I will turn away from My revelations those who behave arrogantly upon the earth without right. Even if they see every sign, they will not believe in it; and if they see the path of guidance, they do not take it as their way; and if they see the path of misguidance, they will take it as their way. That is because they have rejected Our signs and have been disregarding them.” (Al-Araf 7:146)

Spiritual blindness is therefore not imposed arbitrarily. It is the cumulative outcome of chosen moral corruption.

A natural question arises: Are the shackles and barriers mentioned in Surat Yasin merely figurative, or are they real?

When the Qur'an intends a parable, it typically signals this with expressions such as: "their likeness is as..."

مَثَلُهُمْ كَمَثَلِ ٱلَّذِى ٱسْتَوْقَدَ نَارًا فَلَمَّآ أَضَآءَتْ مَا حَوْلَهُۥ ذَهَبَ ٱللَّهُ بِنُورِهِمْ وَتَرَكَهُمْ فِى ظُلُمَٰتٍ لَّا يُبْصِرُونَ

"Their likeness is as the likeness of one who kindles fire, and when it illuminates everything around him, Allah takes away their lights and leaves them in layers of darkness, so that they see nothing." (Al-Baqarah 2:17)

In Surat Yasin, no such indicator appears. This suggests that the restraints described are rea, though not necessarily physical in the material sense.

A useful conceptual framework is to view the human being as possessing two interrelated forms:

1. The Physical Body: composed of matter and governed by physical laws.
2. The Spiritual Form (Ruh/Nafs): a non-material counterpart that carries consciousness, memory, intention, and moral perception.

This dual perspective aligns with:

وَلَقَدْ خَلَقْنَٰكُمْ ثُمَّ صَوَّرْنَٰكُمْ ثُمَّ قُلْنَا لِلْمَلَٰٓئِكَةِ ٱسْجُدُوا۟ لِأَدَمَ ..... (١١)

"We created you, then we shaped you, then We said to the angels, "Prostrate before 'Adam." ….." (Al-Araf 7:11)

Creation precedes physical shaping, indicating a non-material stage of human existence. Adam was the first physical body that merged from the previously created spiritual form. Using this framework:

- The shackles are restraints placed upon the spiritual form, not the physical neck.
- The forced upward position signifies a soul unable to humble itself, unable to look toward guidance or reflect upon signs.
- The barriers represent perceptual blockages preventing the soul from learning from the past or anticipating the future.

The body may continue to function, eating, speaking, working, while the soul remains imprisoned.

Persistent arrogance does not merely lead to punishment in the Hereafter. It becomes punishment in this life, by destroying the soul's ability to perceive truth. The most terrifying loss is not physical sight; it is the loss of inner sight.

13. Vindicating the Chosen: The Honor of the Prophets

A foundational principle of the Qur'an is that the Prophets are divinely chosen moral exemplars. They are not merely conveyors of messages, but living models of integrity, restraint, and devotion. For this reason, the Qur'an consistently corrects distortions found in previous narratives and historical traditions that attribute grave moral failures to these noble figures.

Within this Juz, Allah explicitly defends Prophet Musa عليه السلام against the slanders of his people and warns the believers not to repeat such behavior:

يَـٰٓأَيُّهَا ٱلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُواْ لَا تَكُونُواْ كَٱلَّذِينَ ءَاذَوْاْ مُوسَىٰ فَبَرَّأَهُ ٱللَّهُ مِمَّا قَالُواْ ۚ وَكَانَ عِندَ ٱللَّهِ وَجِيهًا (٦٩)
"O you who believe, do not be like those who harmed Musa; Allah cleared him of what they alleged, and he was highly honored (Wajihan) in Allah's sight." (Al-Ahzab 33:69)

This term Wajihan (highly honored/distinguished) is a rare and powerful title. It is the same status granted to Prophet Isa

The term wajīh (distinguished, honored, eminent) is rare in the Qur'an and signifies elevated moral and spiritual rank. Significantly, the same title is given to Prophet Isa (Jesus):
إِذْ قَالَتِ ٱلْمَلَـٰٓئِكَةُ يَـٰمَرْيَمُ إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ يُبَشِّرُكِ بِكَلِمَةٍ مِّنْهُ ٱسْمُهُ ٱلْمَسِيحُ عِيسَى ٱبْنُ مَرْيَمَ وَجِيهًا فِى ٱلدُّنْيَا وَٱلْـَٔاخِرَةِ وَمِنَ ٱلْمُقَرَّبِينَ (٤٥)
"Behold! the angels said, "O Maryam Allah sends you glad tidings of a word from Him: His name will be the Messiah, Isa son of Maryam, highly honored (Wajihan) in this world and the Hereafter and among those brought near," (Al-Emran 3:45).

This parallel establishes a Qur'anic pattern: Allah Himself vindicates His Messengers and publicly affirms their honor.

The Qur'an does not treat attacks against Prophets as harmless opinion. It classifies them as acts of aggression against Allah and His order:
إِنَّ ٱلَّذِينَ يُؤْذُونَ ٱللَّهَ وَرَسُولَهُۥ لَعَنَهُمُ ٱللَّهُ فِى ٱلدُّنْيَا وَٱلْـَٔاخِرَةِ وَأَعَدَّ لَهُمْ عَذَابًا مُّهِينًا (٥٧) وَٱلَّذِينَ يُؤْذُونَ ٱلْمُؤْمِنِينَ وَٱلْمُؤْمِنَـٰتِ بِغَيْرِ مَا ٱكْتَسَبُواْ فَقَدِ ٱحْتَمَلُواْ بُهْتَـٰنًا وَإِثْمًا مُّبِينًا (٥٨)
"Indeed, those who harm Allah and His Messenger, Allah has cursed them in this world and the Hereafter and prepared for them a humiliating punishment. (57) And those who harm believing men and women undeservedly bear the crime of a slander and a manifest sin. (Al-Ahzab 33:57-58)

The Quran balances two important truths regarding Messengers. While Allah has granted different prophets different gifts and ranks, yet believers are commanded to affirm all of them without distinction.

تِلْكَ ٱلرُّسُلُ فَضَّلْنَا بَعْضَهُمْ عَلَىٰ بَعْضٍ ۘ مِّنْهُم ....

“Those Messengers We favored some above others: …... (Al-Baqarah 2: 253)

ءَامَنَ ٱلرَّسُولُ بِمَآ أُنزِلَ إِلَيۡهِ مِن رَّبِّهِۦ وَٱلۡمُؤۡمِنُونَۚ كُلٌّ ءَامَنَ بِٱللَّهِ وَمَلَٰٓئِكَتِهِۦ وَكُتُبِهِۦ وَرُسُلِهِۦ لَا نُفَرِّقُ بَيۡنَ أَحَدٖ مِّن رُّسُلِهِۦ

“The Messenger believes in what has been sent down to him from his Lord, and (so do) the believers. Each one believes in Allah, His Angels, His Books, and His Messengers. (They say), "We make no distinction between any of His Messengers.” (Al-Baqarah 2:285)

Honoring the Prophets is not merely an emotional attachment. It is a moral duty: to defend their integrity, to reject fabricated accusations, and to follow their example.

Just as Allah vindicated Musa and ʿIsa, the believer must be a guardian of truth and a protector of the dignity of all righteous servants of Allah.

14. The Marriage to Zaynab (RA)

While cultures and traditions may serve functional purposes, they never possess the authority to override what Allah has declared lawful (halal) or unlawful (haram). One of the most powerful demonstrations of this principle appears in a deeply personal episode from the life of the Prophet (PBUH), an event in which Divine command directly confronted entrenched social customs.

The story centers on Zayd ibn Harithah, a former slave whom the Prophet ﷺ freed and raised with love. Before Islam reformed adoption laws, adopted sons were treated as biological sons. Zayd was even known publicly as Zayd ibn Muhammad.

Allah intended to abolish this practice to preserve clarity of lineage. First, revelation established that adopted sons must be called by their biological fathers’ names. The final and most difficult step required a practical, undeniable example:

The Prophet ﷺ was commanded to marry Zaynab bint Jahsh, his cousin, after her marriage to Zayd ended naturally in divorce.

The Prophet ﷺ knew this command would provoke enormous social backlash. Marrying the former wife of an adopted son violated one of the strongest taboos of Arabian society. Out of concern for public reaction, he initially attempted to delay what he knew Allah had decreed by repeatedly counseling Zayd not to divorce Zaynab.

The Qur’an records this human moment with remarkable honesty:

وَإِذۡ تَقُولُ لِلَّذِيٓ أَنۡعَمَ ٱللَّهُ عَلَيۡهِ وَأَنۡعَمۡتَ عَلَيۡهِ أَمۡسِكۡ عَلَيۡكَ زَوۡجَكَ وَٱتَّقِ ٱللَّهَ وَتُخۡفِي فِي نَفۡسِكَ مَا ٱللَّهُ مُبۡدِيهِ وَتَخۡشَى ٱلنَّاسَ وَٱللَّهُ أَحَقُّ أَن تَخۡشَىٰهُۖ فَلَمَّا قَضَىٰ زَيۡدٞ مِّنۡهَا وَطَرٗا زَوَّجۡنَٰكَهَا لِكَيۡ لَا يَكُونَ عَلَى ٱلۡمُؤۡمِنِينَ حَرَجٞ فِيٓ أَزۡوَٰجِ أَدۡعِيَآئِهِمۡ إِذَا قَضَوۡاْ مِنۡهُنَّ وَطَرٗاۚ وَكَانَ أَمۡرُ ٱللَّهِ مَفۡعُولٗا (٣٧) مَّا كَانَ عَلَى ٱلنَّبِيِّ مِنۡ حَرَجٖ فِيمَا فَرَضَ ٱللَّهُ لَهُۥۖ سُنَّةَ ٱللَّهِ فِي ٱلَّذِينَ خَلَوۡاْ مِن قَبۡلُۚ وَكَانَ أَمۡرُ ٱللَّهِ قَدَرٗا مَّقۡدُورًا (٣٨)

“You were saying to the one (Zaid bin Harithah) whom Allah had favored and you had favored: ‘Keep your wife and fear Allah,’ while concealing within yourself what Allah was about to reveal, and fearing people, whereas Allah has more right to be feared. Then when Zayd had finished with her, We married her to you so that there would be no difficulty for the believers concerning the wives of their adopted sons when they have finished with them. And Allah’s command must be carried out. (37) There is no blame upon the Prophet concerning what Allah has obligated for him. This has always been Allah’s way with those who passed before, and the Command of Allah is certain destiny.” (Al-Ahzab 33:37-38)

Over the centuries, critics and certain narrators have woven a sensationalist narrative around the marriage of the Prophet (PBUH) and Zaynab (RA). By examining the historical facts, we can dismantle these myths and see the event for what it truly was: **a selfless act of religious reform.**

Correcting Common Myths

Myth 1: A Sudden Attraction: Some narratives claim the Prophet ﷺ unexpectedly saw Zaynab and desired her.
Reality: Zaynab was his first cousin. He had known her since childhood. If personal desire were the motive, he could have married her years earlier when she was unmarried. Instead, he personally arranged her marriage to Zayd despite social resistance.

Myth 2: The Prophet ﷺ Caused the Divorce
Reality: When Zayd complained about marital difficulties, the Prophet ﷺ repeatedly said: **“Keep your wife and fear Allah.”** A person seeking a divorce does not urge reconciliation.

Myth 3: The Marriage Was for Personal Pleasure

Reality: This marriage carried immense social cost. It became the greatest source of slander used by hypocrites. The Prophet ﷺ accepted this burden solely to establish a legal principle protecting lineage and abolishing false kinship.

This was not a story of romance. It was a story of revelation enacted through personal sacrifice. Allah used the life of His Messenger ﷺ to dismantle an unjust social structure and to permanently establish that:

- Adoption does not create biological lineage.
- What Allah makes lawful cannot be blocked by social taboos.
- Submission to Allah must come before reputation.

True submission is not proven in comfort. It is proven when obedience costs reputation, status, and peace.

The marriage to Zaynab (RA) stands as a timeless declaration: Allah's command is above culture. Allah's law is above tradition. Allah's pleasure is above public opinion.
Conclusion

Conclusion

The jewels gathered from this Juz converge upon a single, transformative realization: humanity is a creation of immense potential, entrusted with an equally immense responsibility.

Through the story of the people of Saba and the example of the family of Dawud, we have seen that the dividing line between civilizational collapse and Divine favor is not the quantity of wealth a society possesses, but the shukr—active, conscious gratitude—with which it manages what has been given. We have learned that true scholarship is not defined by credentials alone, but by the khashya—the reverential awe—that arises when a mind recognizes the signatures of the Creator embedded within creation.

The journey through this Juz ultimately returns the Trust to the individual.

Whether it is the man who came running from the farthest part of the city in Surat Yasin, or the believer who stands "in singles or in pairs" to reflect before Allah, the message is unmistakable: you are the guardian of truth within your own life.

To live as a believer in the light of the twenty-second Juz is to become someone who:

- Recognizes their unique spiritual and physical endowment.
- Measures worth by deeds, not slogans.
- Places obedience above social pressure.
- Fears no stigma in the pursuit of Divine pleasure.
- Remains among the grateful few who protect and cultivate the blessings entrusted to them.

May these thirteen jewels illuminate our hearts, enabling us to see the world not as a chain of accidents, but as a vast, open book of signs—inviting us to return to our Lord with sound hearts.

Jewels from the Twenty Third Juz: Faith Under Trial, Power Under Trust, and the Path Back to Allah

(Yasin 36:28 Al-Zumar 39:31)

Introduction

Juz 23 explores faith under pressure, pressure of rejection, suffering, authority, moral responsibility, and inner struggle. Throughout its verses, Allah clarifies a central principle: human beings are accountable for effort and integrity, not for controlling outcomes. Guidance, healing, and ultimate success belong to Allah alone.

At the heart of this Juz stands Surat Ṣad, where the lives of Prophets Dawud, Sulaiman, and Ayoub (peace be upon them) are presented as interconnected lessons. Each prophet faces a different form of trial, power, illness, loss, or responsibility, yet all are united by a single trait: constant return to Allah (inabah). These narratives show that righteousness is not defined by circumstance, but by how one responds when tested.

Juz 23 also emphasizes how the Qur'an itself must be approached. The command of Tadabbur calls believers to reflect deeply, think critically, and choose what is best. True intelligence, according to the Qur'an, is not blind imitation nor uncontrolled emotion, but discerning submission guided by revelation.

Equally central is the purification of worship. Allah declares that religion belongs to Him alone, without intermediaries or divided intentions. Sincerity (ikhlāṣ) becomes the measure by which all deeds are accepted or rejected. The Juz opens the door of hope wide: do not despair of the mercy of Allah. No failure is final, and no soul is too distant to return.

1. Divine Blessings That Most People Overlook

The Qur'an frequently draws our attention to profound blessings that surround us so constantly that many people fail to notice them. Among these are the growth of plants, trees, and fruits, sources of sustenance without which human life could not continue. This entire process rests upon two divine gifts: the earth that receives and nurtures the seeds, and the water sent down as rain to revive lifeless soil. Because these blessings come to us daily and without effort, they are often taken for granted, perceived as "ordinary" rather than recognized as continuous miracles worthy of gratitude.

Beyond their role in physical nourishment, the revival of barren land serves as a powerful spiritual analogy. Just as rain revives dry, lifeless soil and brings forth what was hidden beneath it, Allah will revive human beings from their graves on the Day of Resurrection. The Qur'an deliberately links these two scenes, the revival of the earth

and the resurrection of the dead, to awaken both gratitude for divine provision and awareness of the Hereafter:

وَءَايَةٌ لَّهُمُ ٱلْأَرْضُ ٱلْمَيْتَةُ أَحْيَيْنَٰهَا وَأَخْرَجْنَا مِنْهَا حَبًّا فَمِنْهُ يَأْكُلُونَ (٣٣) وَجَعَلْنَا فِيهَا جَنَّٰتٍ مِّن نَّخِيلٍ وَأَعْنَٰبٍ وَفَجَّرْنَا فِيهَا مِنَ ٱلْعُيُونِ (٣٤) لِيَأْكُلُوا۟ مِن ثَمَرِهِۦ وَمَا عَمِلَتْهُ أَيْدِيهِمْ ۖ أَفَلَا يَشْكُرُونَ (٣٥)

"A sign for them is the dead earth: We give it life and We bring forth from it grain from which they eat; (33) We have placed in it gardens of date palms and grapes and We have caused springs to gush forth therein, (34) so that they eat its fruit and of what their hands have made. Will they not, then, give thanks?" (Yasin 36:33-35)

In verse 35, the tiny word "mā" (ما) carries remarkable depth, allowing two complementary meanings to coexiist:

- As negation: "and their hands did not make it," emphasizing that the origin of life, growth, and provision lies entirely with Allah, beyond human power or control.
- As inclusion: "and what their hands have made," pointing to the products humans prepare from these fruits, such as juices, oils, jams, and other foods, using the skills, knowledge, and intelligence Allah has granted them.

With this single word, the verse captures both dimensions of human existence: Allah as the sole Creator of the original blessing, and humans as secondary agents who process and benefit from what He has provided. It is a striking example of how a seemingly small linguistic article in Qur'anic Arabic can open multiple layers of meaning within a single phrase.

Another subtle sign of divine artistry in the Qur'an appears in its use of symmetrical and palindromic letter patterns, structures that read the same forwards and backwards, especially in verses describing circular or continuous motion. Speaking of the precise orbits of the sun and the moon, Allah says:

لَا ٱلشَّمْسُ يَنۢبَغِى لَهَآ أَن تُدْرِكَ ٱلْقَمَرَ وَلَا ٱلَّيْلُ سَابِقُ ٱلنَّهَارِ ۚ وَكُلٌّ فِى فَلَكٍ يَسْبَحُونَ (٤٠)

"The sun cannot overtake the moon, nor can the night outpace the day: each is floating in an orbit [Kullun fi falak]. (Yasin 36:40)

The phrase "كُلٌّ فِي فَلَكٍ" (kullun fī falak) is composed of letters that can be arranged as a perfect palindrome sequence (ك ل ف ي ف ل ك). Just as the celestial bodies move in continuous cycles and return to their starting points, the letters themselves appears to "loop back," subtly reflecting the idea of circular motion embedded in the verse.

A similar pattern appears in the command found in Surat al-Muddaththir:

رَبَّكَ فَكَبِّرْ

"And your Lord, magnify (Rabbaka fa-kabbir)." (Al-Muddathir 74:3)

Here again, the letters (ر ب ك ف ك ب ر) form a palindromic structure. These patterns are not mere stylistic curiosities; they resonate with the meanings of the verses themselves, cycles, continuity, return, and the centrality of Allah's greatness. In this way, the Qur'an's linguistic form reinforces its message, inviting the believer to reflect not only on what is said, but also on the precision and harmony with which it is expressed.

2. The Unique Creation of Cattle

Two Qur'anic passages suggest that the creation of cattle is distinguished in a special way from that of other animals. Together, these verses point to a unique divine origination for cattle, different from other creatures that appear to have been created on earth and may have undergone multiple stages of biological development.

Allah says in Surat Yasin:

أَوَلَمۡ يَرَوۡاْ أَنَّا خَلَقۡنَا لَهُم مِّمَّا عَمِلَتۡ أَيۡدِينَآ أَنۡعَٰمٗا فَهُمۡ لَهَا مَٰلِكُونَ (٧١) وَذَلَّلۡنَٰهَا لَهُمۡ فَمِنۡهَا رَكُوبُهُمۡ وَمِنۡهَا يَأۡكُلُونَ (٧٢) وَلَهُمۡ فِيهَا مَنَٰفِعُ وَمَشَارِبُۚ أَفَلَا يَشۡكُرُونَ (٧٣)) يس(

"Have they not seen that We created for them, from what Our Hands have made, cattle, and they are their owners? (71) And We have subdued them for them, so some of them they ride and some of them they eat. (72) And they have in them benefits and drinks. Will they not then be grateful?" (Yasin 36:71-73)

The phrasing here is striking. Cattle are described as being created from what Allah's "Hands" have made, a formulation not used for other animals, and as deliberately subdued for human benefit. Their role encompasses transportation, nourishment, utility, and provision, all presented as reasons for gratitude.

This special framing is further reinforced in Surat al-Zumar:

خَلَقَكُم مِّن نَّفۡسٖ وَٰحِدَةٖ ثُمَّ جَعَلَ مِنۡهَا زَوۡجَهَا وَأَنزَلَ لَكُم مِّنَ ٱلۡأَنۡعَٰمِ ثَمَٰنِيَةَ أَزۡوَٰجٖۚ ..... (لزمر - الآية 6(

"He created you from a single soul; then made it his mate. And He sent down for you eight pairs of cattle (the male and female pair sheep, goat, cow, and camel) …. **(Al-Zumar 39:6)**

The use of the verb "anzala/ أنزل" (sent down) in reference to cattle is particularly noteworthy. When the Qur'an speaks of human beings, it does not use anzala; instead, it employs ihbiṭou/ اهْبِطُوا (descend), a term associated with moral trial, responsibility, and earthly testing. By contrast, anzala is typically reserved for entities that originate in a higher realm and are bestowed upon the earth by a direct divine act.

A survey of Qur'anic usage shows that anzala is commonly applied to six broad categories: revelation, angels, rain, divine provisions and blessings (such as tranquility, manna and quails, or the table spread for ʿĪsā), cattle, and iron. Among these, cattle and iron stand out, as their being "sent down" is not immediately obvious in a physical sense and invites deeper reflection. While the case of iron lies beyond our present focus, the description of cattle as "sent down" suggests a special status and function in human life.

Taken together, these verses indicate deliberate divine knowledge and preparation regarding cattle. They are not presented merely as biological creatures, but as sign-bearing beings, created, subdued, and provided to humanity for survival, sustenance, and reflection.

This unique status helps illuminate Satan's specific threat mentioned in Surat al-Nisa:

وَلَأُضِلَّنَّهُمْ وَلَأُمَنِّيَنَّهُمْ وَلَآمُرَنَّهُمْ فَلَيُبَتِّكُنَّ ءَاذَانَ ٱلْأَنْعَٰمِ وَلَآمُرَنَّهُمْ فَلَيُغَيِّرُنَّ خَلْقَ ٱللَّهِ)....١١٩..)

"I will surely lead them astray, will fill them with false hopes, and command them so they will "yubattikunna" the "adhan" of the cattle, and I will command them so they will change the creation of Allah…" (Al-Nisa 4:119)

The common translation of يُبَتِّكُنَّ آذَانَ الأَنْعَام as "slit the ears of cattle" is linguistically possible, but it appears limited in explanatory depth. Ear-slitting and physical marking of animals are widespread human practices and, on their own, do not seem to carry the profound theological weight suggested by the verse.

Classical commentators often linked this phrase to pre-Islamic customs in which certain animals, such as the Bahirah, were marked and consecrated to idols, practices explicitly rejected elsewhere in the Qur'an (Surat Al-Ma'idah):

مَا جَعَلَ ٱللَّهُ مِنۢ بَحِيرَةٍ وَلَا سَآئِبَةٍ وَلَا وَصِيلَةٍ وَلَا حَامٍ وَلَٰكِنَّ ٱلَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا۟ يَفْتَرُونَ عَلَى ٱللَّهِ ٱلْكَذِبَ وَأَكْثَرُهُمْ لَا يَعْقِلُونَ (١٠٣)

"Allah has not instituted [an animal called] Bahirah or Sa'ibah or Wasilah or Hami; but those who disbelieve invent a lie against Allah. Most of them do not understand" (Al-Ma'idah 5:103)

While this historical context is valid, it may not exhaust the meaning of the verse. The verb بَتَّكَ (bataka) conveys the sense of severing completely, cutting off at the root. This suggests that Satan's threat speaks of something more radical disruption than a mere physical incision.

Moreover, the word آذَان (adhan) does not only mean "ears." Linguistically, it also denotes "announcement" or "proclamation," as in the adhan of prayer. Read through this broader semantic lens, a deeper layer of meaning emerges.

Under this reading, Satan threatens to cause human beings to sever themselves from the announcement carried by cattle, from the message they proclaim about Allah's creative power, mercy, and deliberate provision. Conceptually, the verse may be understood as:

وَلَآمُرَنَّهُمْ فَلَيُبَتِّكُنَّ ءَاذَانَ ٱلْأَنْعَٰمِ)....١١٩..)

"I will command them to cut off the proclamation of the cattle (as a sign of Allah's creation and mercy) …" (Al-Nisa 4:119)

This interpretation harmonizes with earlier verses that describe cattle as created by Allah's "Hands" and "sent down" as a gift and a sign. Satan's objective, then, is not limited to altering animals physically, but extends to distorting how human beings perceive and respond to the signs embedded in creation.

History appears to reflect this pattern. Rather than recognizing cattle as signs pointing to the Creator, many civilizations elevated them to sacred or semi-divine status. Cattle played central religious roles in ancient Egypt, Greece, Roman culture, and certain Israelite practices, and remain objects of reverence in Hinduism, Jainism, and some

strands of Buddhism. In each case, devotion is redirected from Allah to the creature itself, precisely the misdirection Satan seeks.

Within this framework, the Islamic practice of animal sacrifice, especially during Hajj and Eid al-Adha, functions as a direct corrective. Sacrifice affirms that cattle are not sacred in themselves; they are honored gifts from Allah, to be used in obedience to Him. Claims that sacrifice should be replaced entirely by monetary charity overlook this deeper symbolic and theological dimension. The poor existed during the lifetime of the Prophet ﷺ, yet he consistently practiced and commanded sacrifice. No one embodied greater mercy toward animals than the Prophet ﷺ, and yet he upheld this ritual.

A'ishah (رضي الله عنها) reported that the Prophet ﷺ said:
عن عائشة - رضي الله عنها - قالت : قال رسول الله - صلى الله عليه وسلم - : (ما عمل ابن آدم من عمل يوم النحر أحب إلى الله من إهراق الدم ، وإنه ليؤتى يوم القيامة ، بقرونها وأشعارها وأظلافها ، وإن الدم ليقع من الله بمكان قبل أن يقع بالأرض ، فطيبوا بها نفسا) . رواه الترمذي ، وابن ماجه .
"No deed of the son of Adam on the Day of Sacrifice is more beloved to Allah than the spilling of blood. It will come on the Day of Resurrection with its horns, hair, and hooves, and indeed the blood is accepted by Allah before it even falls upon the ground, so be content with it." (Al-Tirmidhi, and Ibn Majah)

Beyond its spiritual significance, sacrifice also serves as a powerful mechanism of economic circulation, supporting livestock producers, traders, and meat distribution, and often channeling resources from wealthier urban populations to poorer rural communities.

From the Qur'anic perspective, then, cattle emerge as uniquely created, deliberately "sent down," and deeply woven into human survival, health, economy, and spiritual awareness. Their role is intentional rather than accidental, a living sign of Allah's power, mercy, and providence. Satan's threat may thus be understood as an attempt to sever humanity from the message embedded in this sign. Islamic rituals surrounding cattle, especially sacrifice, restore and preserve that meaning, firmly situating human interaction with these creatures within the framework of tawḥid, gratitude, and obedience.

3. The Legacy of Ihsan: A Blueprint for Excellence

In Surah Al-Saffat, Allah (SWT) Allah narrates the stories of several Prophets, among them Nuḥ, Ibrahim, Musa, Haroun, and Ilyas (peace be upon them all). Although their missions, circumstances, and trials differed, a single defining attribute unites them all: the attribute of Ihsan.

After describing their struggles and eventual triumphs, Allah concludes each account with a recurring declaration:

إِنَّا كَذَٰلِكَ نَجۡزِى ٱلۡمُحۡسِنِينَ

"This is how We reward the Muhsineen (the doers of excellence)." (Al-Saffat 37: 80, 110, 121 and 131)

The repetition of this statement is deliberate. It creates a rhythmic pattern that functions as a timeless directive for every believer. By consistently pairing “Peace” (Salam) with reward for Ihsan, the Qur’an teaches that divine peace, honor, and lasting legacy are not arbitrary gifts; they are the natural outcome of a life lived with excellence.

Allah says regarding Nūḥ (AS):

سَلَـٰمٌ عَلَىٰ نُوحٍ فِى ٱلْعَـٰلَمِينَ (٧٩) إِنَّا كَذَٰلِكَ نَجْزِى ٱلْمُحْسِنِينَ (٨٠) إِنَّهُۥ مِنْ عِبَادِنَا ٱلْمُؤْمِنِينَ (٨١)
“Peace be upon Noah throughout all the worlds. (79) This is how We reward the Mohsinum (the doers of excellence). (80) He was one of Our believing servants.” (Al-Saffat 37:79-81)

سَلَـٰمٌ عَلَىٰٓ إِبْرَٰهِيمَ (١٠٩) كَذَٰلِكَ نَجْزِى ٱلْمُحْسِنِينَ (١١٠) إِنَّهُۥ مِنْ عِبَادِنَا ٱلْمُؤْمِنِينَ (١١١)
“Peace be upon Ibrahim. (79) This is how We reward the Mohsinum (the doers of excellence). (80) He was one of Our believing servants.” (Al-Saffat 37:109-111)

سَلَـٰمٌ عَلَىٰ مُوسَىٰ وَهَـٰرُونَ (١٢٠) إِنَّا كَذَٰلِكَ نَجْزِى ٱلْمُحْسِنِينَ (١٢١) إِنَّهُمَا مِنْ عِبَادِنَا ٱلْمُؤْمِنِينَ (١٢٢)
“Peace be upon Musa and Haroun. (79) This is how We reward the Mohsinum (the doers of excellence). (80) They were of Our believing servants.” (Al-Saffat 37:120-122)

سَلَـٰمٌ عَلَىٰٓ إِلْ يَاسِينَ (١٣٠) إِنَّا كَذَٰلِكَ نَجْزِى ٱلْمُحْسِنِينَ (١٣١) إِنَّهُۥ مِنْ عِبَادِنَا ٱلْمُؤْمِنِينَ (١٣٢)
“Peace be upon Ilyasin (Elias). (79) This is how We reward the Mohsinum (the doers of excellence). (80) He was one of Our believing servants.” (Al-Saffat 37:130-132)

Ihsan is often translated as “excellence” or “perfection,” but its meaning is far deeper. It is the determination to perform every act, whether in worship, character, or worldly responsibility, in the best possible manner, with the awareness that Allah is fully aware and ever-present. The legacy of the Prophets presents Ihsan as a comprehensive way of life, encompassing two inseparable dimensions:

Excellence in Worship (Vertical): Perfecting acts of worship through sincerity, attentiveness, and reverence. It is to worship Allah as though one sees Him, and even when one does not see Him, to remain conscious that He surely sees all.

Excellence in Service (Horizontal): Upholding beauty, integrity, and responsibility in interactions with people and the world, within one’s profession, family life, studies, creativity, and service to society. Whether one is a student, parent, teacher, physician, engineer, or businessperson, Ihsan sets the standard: to give one’s best purely for the sake of Allah.

The Prophets were not distinguished merely because they believed, though faith was their foundation. They were distinguished because they translated belief into action of the highest quality. They combined sound faith with patience, sacrifice, trust in Allah, and excellence in conduct.

When believers pursue excellence in their daily responsibilities, they are not simply being “productive” or “high-performing”, but they are also aligning themselves with the prophetic path and placing themselves within the scope of the same divine promise: peace in this life and a legacy of honor that endures beyond death, as Allah promises:

إِنَّ رَحۡمَتَ ٱللَّهِ قَرِيبٞ مِّنَ ٱلۡمُحۡسِنِينَ (٥٦)

"Indeed, Allah’s mercy is always near to the Muhsineen *(the doers of excellence)." (Al-A'raf 7:56)

This verse serves as both motivation and reassurance. Every time a believer chooses Ihsan, in worship, character, or work, he or she draws nearer to the special nearness of Allah’s mercy.

4. Prophet Yunus: The Trial of Patience and the Miracle of Recovery

When Yunus (AS) faced persistent rejection from the people to whom he was sent, he departed before receiving divine permission. The Qur’an describes this departure using the verb abaqa (أَبَقَ), a term commonly used for a slave who flees prematurely. His impatience arose from a subtle but critical misunderstanding: he assumed that because the people had not yet responded, his mission had ended. In doing so, he momentarily forgot that conveying the message is the responsibility of the messenger, while guidance itself belongs solely to Allah. Allah says:

وَإِنَّ يُونُسَ لَمِنَ ٱلۡمُرۡسَلِينَ (١٣٩) إِذۡ أَبَقَ إِلَى ٱلۡفُلۡكِ ٱلۡمَشۡحُونِ (١٤٠) فَسَاهَمَ فَكَانَ مِنَ ٱلۡمُدۡحَضِينَ (١٤١) فَٱلۡتَقَمَهُ ٱلۡحُوتُ وَهُوَ مُلِيمٞ (١٤٢)

“Indeed, Yunus (Jonah) was among the messengers. (139) [Mention] when he ran away to a fully loaded ship. (140) Then he drew lots and was among the losers. (141) Then the whale swallowed him, while he was blameworthy.” (Al-Saffat 37:139-142)

His confinement within the whale became a miraculous school of patience and humility. The whale. an immense creature governed purely by instinct, demonstrated greater obedience at that moment, holding Yunus safely without harming him, acting strictly in accordance with Allah’s command.

What altered the course of Yunus’s ordeal was not chance, but his established relationship with Allah. The Qur’an emphasizes that his deliverance was the result of his consistent glorification of Allah (tasbih) prior to this crisis. This teaches a critical

principle: remembrance in times of ease becomes a means of rescue in times of constriction.

Allah says:

فَلَوْلَآ أَنَّهُۥ كَانَ مِنَ ٱلْمُسَبِّحِينَ (١٤٣) لَلَبِثَ فِى بَطْنِهِۦٓ إِلَىٰ يَوْمِ يُبْعَثُونَ (١٤٤) ۞ فَنَبَذْنَٰهُ بِٱلْعَرَآءِ وَهُوَ سَقِيمٌ (١٤٥) وَأَنۢبَتْنَا عَلَيْهِ شَجَرَةً مِّن يَقْطِينٍ (١٤٦)

"Had he not been of those who glorified Allah, (143) He would have remained in its belly until the Day they are resurrected. (144) But We cast him onto the open shore while he was severely weakened. (145) And We caused a plant of yaqṭeen to grow over him." (Al-Saffat 37:143-146)

When the Qur'an describes Yunus (AS) being cast onto the shore as **سَقِيم** (saqeam), severely weakened and ill, it depicts a state of extreme physical vulnerability. His body had endured prolonged confinement, exposure to harsh internal conditions, dehydration, and trauma. In this precise context, the Qur'an draws attention to the divine response:

وَأَنۢبَتْنَا عَلَيْهِ شَجَرَةً مِّن يَقْطِينٍ (١٤٦)

"And We caused a Yaqteen plant to grow over him." (Al-Saffat 37:146)

Although yaqṭeen is often translated generically as "gourd," linguistic usage and botanical characteristics suggest a more specific identification, commonly associated with Lagenaria siceraria (bottle gourd or Opo squash). This detail is far from incidental. The biological properties of this plant align remarkably with the medical needs of someone suffering from acute skin damage, dehydration, and systemic weakness.

In the case of Prophet Yunus (AS), the yaqteen was not merely shade or nourishment; it functioned as a divinely provided, integrated healing system, addressing protection, hydration, nutrition, and recovery simultaneously.

Unlike many common gourds, the yaqṭeen possesses several distinctive features:

- **Soft, velvety leaves**: While most gourd leaves are rough or prickly, the Yaqteen's leaves are smooth and gentle, allowing direct contact with damaged or sensitive skin without irritation.
- **Broad leafy canopy**: The plant grows rapidly and produces large leaves that provide immediate shade, protecting fragile skin from harsh coastal sunlight.
- **Natural insect deterrence**: The leaves contain compounds that repel flies and insects, creating a natural sterile zone around open or sensitive skin, an essential protection in a humid, coastal environment.
- **Cooling growth pattern**: Its white flowers bloom at dusk or night, reflecting a plant adapted to cooler, shaded conditions rather than intense sunlight.

Through this carefully chosen provision, the Qur'an illustrates a profound principle: Allah's mercy is not only spiritual but precisely calibrated to physical reality. Recovery, like guidance, is a divine gift, but it arrives through means perfectly suited to the condition of the servant.

The story of Yunus (AS) thus stands as a lasting blueprint: patience in duty, humility in error, constancy in remembrance, and complete trust in Allah's wisdom. When these elements come together, even the deepest constrictions can become gateways to renewal, restoration, and success beyond expectation.

5. Engaging the Quran: The Command of Tadabbur

Allah emphasizes that the Qur'an is a clear and blessed Book, revealed not merely to be recited, but to be understood, reflected upon, and lived. Any pursuit of sound, grounded knowledge must therefore begin with deliberate engagement with the Qur'an through Tadabbur. Allah says:

كِتَٰبٌ أَنزَلۡنَٰهُ إِلَيۡكَ مُبَٰرَكٞ لِّيَدَّبَّرُوٓاْ ءَايَٰتِهِۦ وَلِيَتَذَكَّرَ أُوْلُواْ ٱلۡأَلۡبَٰبِ (٢٩)

"(This is) a blessed Book which We have revealed to you, so that they may reflect deeply upon its verses and that those of understanding may be reminded." (Sad 38:29)

At its core, Tadabbur means reflective contemplation that looks toward the aftereffect or consequence (dubur) of a verse, how it reshapes belief, refines character, and directs action. Reading the Qur'an without Tadabbur is like eating without digestion: nourishment is present, but no real strength is gained. For the Qur'an to guide conduct, its meanings must first penetrate the heart and the mind.

Tadabbur may be approached through two complementary dimensions, Spiritual and Intellectual, with a third, more technical form that belongs primarily to linguistic specialists.

Spiritual Tadabbur: Engaging the Heart

Spiritual Tadabbur transforms Qur'anic recitation into a living dialogue with Allah. It is accessible to every believer, regardless of academic background, and its aim is not information, but transformation. Here, verses become personal supplications and moral mirrors.

- Seeking the Good: When encountering descriptions of the righteous or the delights of Paradise, the believer pauses and prays: "O Allah, make me among them."

- Seeking Protection: When reading about hypocrisy, arrogance, or punishment, one turns to Allah saying: "O Allah, I seek refuge in You from these traits and from Your punishment."

- Gratitude for Creation: When Allah points to His signs in creation, the rain, the stars, the mountains, or the human soul, the heart responds with praise and gratitude for being allowed to recognize the One behind these signs..

In this mode, the reader is continuously engaged in dua, which the Prophet ﷺ described as the very essence of worship. Al-Nuʿmān ibn Bashīr (رضي الله عنه) reported that the Prophet ﷺ said::

عن النعمان بن بشيرأن رسول الله صلى الله عليه وسلم، قال: إن الدعاء هو العبادة ، ثم قرأ: " ادعوني أستجب لكم، إن الذين يستكبرون عن عبادتي سَيَدْخُلُونَ جَهَنَّمَ دَاخِرِينَ [غافر: 60] " ،] أحمد في "المسند، و"البخاري في الأدب المفرد.[

“Indeed, supplication is worship itself and then recited: Supplicate to Me; I will respond to you.’ Indeed, those who are too proud for My worship will enter Hell humiliated.” (Ghafir 40:60)

Through Spiritual Tadabbur, the Qur’an ceases to be a distant text and becomes a lived experience, guiding the heart moment by moment.

Intellectual Tadabbur: Engaging the Mind

If Spiritual Tadabbur softens the heart, Intellectual Tadabbur disciplines the mind. It treats the Qur’an as the ultimate framework for understanding reality, moral, social, and civilizational. This form of Tadabbur requires careful analysis, internal consistency, and methodological restraint.

A critical starting point is recognizing that Qur’anic terms must be understood as Allah defines them, not merely as they are used in culture or common speech. Every specialized field operates with its own technical language, and misusing definitions leads to error.

For example, the word “cell” carries very different meanings depending on context:

Example: The Variable Meanings of "Cell"

Field	**Definition of "Cell"**
Biology	The basic structural unit of life.
Technology	A unit in a spreadsheet or mobile network.
Electricity	A single unit in a battery.
Law Enforcement	A room for a prisoner.

Likewise, Qur’anic terms such as "Taqwa" and those who have "Taqwa" (تقوى و متقين), Ihsan and Muhsineen (احسان و محسنين), "Eman" and those who have "Eman" (إيمان و مؤمنون), Ibadah (عبادة), Al-Rahman (الرحمان), guidance (هداية), misguidance (ضلال), knowledge (علم), "Zann" (ظن) (assumption), "Shakk" (شك) (doubt) and Haneef (حنيف) must be derived from the Qur’an’s own usage, not imported from later theology, culture, or philosophy..

The Three Governing Principles of Tadabbur

To prevent subjective or fragmented readings, Intellectual Tadabbur operates through three governing principles. These are not optional techniques; they are safeguards that protect the reader from distortion.

1. Objective Extraction (What is Allah establishing?)

Every verse aims to establish a principle, not merely convey information.

- What universal law, moral truth, or guidance is being set here?
- What belief, attitude, or action is Allah calling me to adopt or abandon?

Without extracting objective meaning, Tadabbur collapses into personal impression rather than divine guidance.

2. Internal Consistency (How does this fit within the Qur'an as a whole?)

The Qur'an explains itself. No verse stands in isolation.

- Is a general statement clarified or restricted by other verses on the same subject?
- Does this interpretation align with foundational Qur'anic principles, such as Allah's absolute justice, wisdom, and mercy?
- Does it preserve the moral integrity and honor of the Prophets, whom Allah has chosen and purified?

Any reading that contradicts established Qur'anic foundations signals a flaw in understanding, not a flaw in revelation.

3. The Law of Context (Why is this said *here*, in this way?)

Meaning emerges not only from words, but from placement.

- How do the verses before and after shape the message?
- Why does the verse conclude with these specific Names or Attributes of Allah?
- Why is this particular word chosen instead of a near-synonym? Each choice points to a precise shade of meaning appropriate to the context.

Ignoring context reduces Tadabbur to word-by-word speculation rather than coherent understanding.

The placement of the command for Tadabbur in **Surat Sad** is itself instructive. This Surah contains profound narratives about Prophets Dawud, Sulaiman, and Ayyub (AS), accounts that are easily misunderstood if approached superficially. Intellectual Tadabbur is essential here to:

- Reconcile the narratives with the established honor, wisdom, and purity of the Prophets.
- Avoid interpretations that inadvertently attribute injustice, heedlessness, or moral failure to those whom Allah has elevated.

Thus, the command لِّيَدَّبَّرُوٓاْ ءَايَـٰتِهِۦ ***"that they may reflect deeply upon its verses"*** is not theoretical. It is a practical requirement for engaging complex Qur'anic narratives with humility, discipline, and reverence.

Through the integration of Spiritual Tadabbur and Intellectual Tadabbur, the believer allows the Qur'an to shape both the heart and the worldview, fulfilling the very purpose for which this blessed Book was revealed.

6. The Legacy of Prophet Dawud: Power, Patience, and the Limits of Authority

In Surat Sad, Allah presents a distinctive portrait of Prophet Dawud (AS). a messenger uniquely granted prophethood, wisdom, and political authority. His kingdom was strong, his rule firm, and his devotion so deep that even the mountains and birds were made to join him in glorifying Allah. Allah says:

ٱصۡبِرۡ عَلَىٰ مَا يَقُولُونَ وَٱذۡكُرۡ عَبۡدَنَا دَاوُۥدَ ذَا ٱلۡأَيۡدِۖ إِنَّهُۥٓ أَوَّابٞ (١٧) إِنَّا سَخَّرۡنَا ٱلۡجِبَالَ مَعَهُۥ يُسَبِّحۡنَ بِٱلۡعَشِيِّ وَٱلۡإِشۡرَاقِ (١٨) وَٱلطَّيۡرَ مَحۡشُورَةٗۖ كُلّٞ لَّهُۥٓ أَوَّابٞ (١٩) وَشَدَدۡنَا مُلۡكَهُۥ وَءَاتَيۡنَٰهُ ٱلۡحِكۡمَةَ وَفَصۡلَ ٱلۡخِطَابِ (٢٠)

"Be patient (O Muhammad) of what they say, and remember Our servant Dawud (David), the man of might who constantly turned to Us. (17) We subjected the mountains to glorify with him in the evening and at sunrise; (18) and the birds gathered, all returning to Allah. (19) We strengthened his kingdom and gave him wisdom and a decisive speech." (Sad 38:17-20)

At first glance, one might ask how the mention of a powerful king with a "strengthened kingdom" consoles the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ during the Makkan period, when he possessed no worldly power and faced relentless rejection. The answer lies in the episode that immediately follows. When read with intellectual Tadabbur, and freed from Isra'iliyyat that misrepresent prophetic integrity, the narrative delivers a critical lesson: even the most powerful ruler cannot compel belief or assume guardianship over people's hearts.

The Qur'an unfolds this lesson through four carefully structured scenes.

Scene 1: The Breach of Sanctuary

Prophet Dawud was in his mihrab, a private, elevated place of worship, when a group (plural: tasawwaru) suddenly climbed over the wall and appeared before him. This unexpected intrusion into a secure space naturally startled him (fazi'a). They then requested judgment in a dispute.

وَهَلۡ أَتَىٰكَ نَبَؤُاْ ٱلۡخَصۡمِ إِذۡ تَسَوَّرُواْ ٱلۡمِحۡرَابَ (٢١) إِذۡ دَخَلُواْ عَلَىٰ دَاوُۥدَ فَفَزِعَ مِنۡهُمۡۖ قَالُواْ لَا تَخَفۡۖ خَصۡمَانِ بَغَىٰ بَعۡضُنَا عَلَىٰ بَعۡضٖ فَٱحۡكُم بَيۡنَنَا بِٱلۡحَقِّ وَلَا تُشۡطِطۡ وَٱهۡدِنَآ إِلَىٰ سَوَآءِ ٱلصِّرَٰطِ (٢٢)

“Has the story of the litigants reached you, when they climbed over the wall of the sanctuary? (21) When they entered upon Dawud, he was alarmed by them. They said, ‘Do not fear. We are two litigants; one of us has wronged the other. Judge between us with truth, do not be unjust, and guide us to the straight path.” (38:21: 22)

Scene 2: The Dispute of Guardianship

One litigant presents the case: his “brother” possesses ninety-nine ewes, while he has only one. The one with abundance pressured him to entrust his single ewe to him, overpowering him through argument.

إِنَّ هَٰذَآ أَخِى لَهُۥ تِسْعٌ وَتِسْعُونَ نَعْجَةً وَلِىَ نَعْجَةٌ وَٰحِدَةٌ فَقَالَ أَكْفِلْنِيهَا وَعَزَّنِى فِى ٱلْخِطَابِ (٢٣)

“This is my brother, has ninety-nine ewes (female sheep), while I have a single ewe. He said: "Entrust it to me, and he overpowered me in speech." (Sad 38:23)

The pivotal word here is أَكْفِلْنِيهَا (akfilniha), derived from kafalah, meaning sponsorship, guardianship, or assuming responsibility, not ownership. The issue is not greed, but overreach in control, where one party assumes it knows what is best for another.

Scene 3: The Swift Ruling

Without further questioning, Prophet Dawud (AS) immediately rules, describing the demand as injustice (ẓulm) and noting how common oppression is among partners.

قَالَ لَقَدْ ظَلَمَكَ بِسُؤَالِ نَعْجَتِكَ إِلَىٰ نِعَاجِهِۦ ۖ وَإِنَّ كَثِيرًا مِّنَ ٱلْخُلَطَآءِ لَيَبْغِى بَعْضُهُمْ عَلَىٰ بَعْضٍ إِلَّا ٱلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا۟ وَعَمِلُوا۟ ٱلصَّٰلِحَٰتِ وَقَلِيلٌ مَّا هُمْ ۗ

“[Dawud] said: "He has certainly wronged you by asking for your ewe to be added to his ewes. Indeed, many partners oppress one another, except those who believe and do righteous good deeds, and few are they." (Sad 38:24)

Some commentators err gravely here, either by turning the account into a parable of immoral desire (which violates prophetic integrity), or by portraying Dawud as unjust or hasty in judgment. Both readings contradict explicit Qur’anic testimony:

وَءَاتَيْنَٰهُ ٱلْحِكْمَةَ وَفَصْلَ ٱلْخِطَابِ (٢٠)

“We gave him wisdom and a decisive speech.” (Sad 38:20)

The real oversight lies not in injustice, but in the recognition that the cause of the dispute is like his effort to bring the small percentage of his subjects who are still outside the divine guidance to the fold of believers using his decisive speech to override their free will by taking over their choices.

Scene 4: Realization and Repentance

Dawud (AS) realizes that this was not a normal legal dispute, but a divinely arranged test, one that mirrored a subtle tendency in his own leadership: the noble desire to

assume responsibility for those not yet guided, even when such responsibility risks overriding their freedom of choice.

وَظَنَّ دَاوُۥدُ أَنَّمَا فَتَنَّٰهُ فَٱسۡتَغۡفَرَ رَبَّهُۥ وَخَرَّ رَاكِعٗا وَأَنَابَ ۩ (٢٤) فَغَفَرۡنَا لَهُۥ ذَٰلِكَۖ وَإِنَّ لَهُۥ عِندَنَا لَزُلۡفَىٰ وَحُسۡنَ مَـَٔابٖ (٢٥) يَٰدَاوُۥدُ إِنَّا جَعَلۡنَٰكَ خَلِيفَةٗ فِي ٱلۡأَرۡضِ فَٱحۡكُم بَيۡنَ ٱلنَّاسِ بِٱلۡحَقِّ وَلَا تَتَّبِعِ ٱلۡهَوَىٰ فَيُضِلَّكَ عَن سَبِيلِ ٱللَّهِۚ ... (٢٦)

“And Dawud realized that We had tested him; so he sought forgiveness from his Lord, fell down bowing and turned back (in repentance). (24) So, We forgave him that, and indeed he has nearness to Us and a excellent return. (25) ‘O Dawud, We have made you a vicegerent on earth, so judge between people with truth and do not follow [your] desire, lest it leads you astray from the path of Allah…” (Sad 38:24-26)

Even noble desire, such as wanting everyone guided, must not override justice or free will. Guidance is offered; acceptance remains a personal choice.

This narrative directly consoles the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ in his Makkan struggle. His compassion for humanity was so deep that Allah cautioned him:

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لَعَلَّكَ بَٰخِعٞ نَّفۡسَكَ أَلَّا يَكُونُواْ مُؤۡمِنِينَ (الشُّعَرَاء)

"(O Prophet) Perhaps you would kill yourself (with grief) because they will not be believers." (Al-Shu'ara 26:3)

If a king as powerful as Dawud could not take guardianship over every heart in his realm, then rejection should not consume the Prophet ﷺ. His duty is clear conveyance, not coercive care.

The legacy of Dawud in Surat Sad is a blueprint for leadership in every age: strength without tyranny, compassion without coercion, authority restrained by humility, and power guided by repentance and justice

7. The Trial of Power: Prophet Sulaiman’s Illness and Kingdom

Surah Sad presents Prophet Sulaiman (AS) as a prophet-king and the son of a prophet-king, inheriting both spiritual responsibility and worldly authority:

وَوَهَبۡنَا لِدَاوُۥدَ سُلَيۡمَٰنَۚ نِعۡمَ ٱلۡعَبۡدُۖ إِنَّهُۥٓ أَوَّابٌ (٣٠)

“And to Dawud We granted Sulaiman. What an excellent servant! Indeed, he was ever turning (to Us). (Sad 38:30)

Despite the vast authority granted to him, Sulaiman (AS) was subjected to a severe and humbling trial. Allah describes this test in strikingly concise terms

وَلَقَدۡ فَتَنَّا سُلَيۡمَٰنَ وَأَلۡقَيۡنَا عَلَىٰ كُرۡسِيِّهِۦ جَسَدٗا ثُمَّ أَنَابَ (٣٤)

“And indeed, We certainly tested Sulaiman and placed upon his throne a mere body; then he turned back (to Allah).” (Sad 38:34)

The Qur’an does not elaborate on the medical details of this illness, but the description is deliberate. Sulaiman, a ruler commanding forces beyond human reach, is reduced to a jasad, a powerless body seated on a throne. Authority remains outwardly present, but the ability to exercise is removed. This scene captures a central Qur’anic principle: power without divine support is empty, and sovereignty is never intrinsic to the human being.

Crucially, Sulaiman (AS) does not object, complain, or question Allah’s decree. The verse concludes with thumma anb/ ثُمَّ أَنَابَ “then he turned back.” His response to loss of power was not resentment, but repentance and renewed reliance upon Allah.

After his recovery, Sulaiman (AS) turns to Allah with a supplication that Allah not only accepts, but answers in a manner unparalleled in human history:

قَالَ رَبِّ ٱغۡفِرۡ لِي وَهَبۡ لِي مُلۡكٗا لَّا يَنۢبَغِي لِأَحَدٖ مِّنۢ بَعۡدِيٓۖ إِنَّكَ أَنتَ ٱلۡوَهَّابُ (٣٥) فَسَخَّرۡنَا لَهُ ٱلرِّيحَ تَجۡرِي
بِأَمۡرِهِۦ رُخَآءً حَيۡثُ أَصَابَ (٣٦) وَٱلشَّيَٰطِينَ كُلَّ بَنَّآءٖ وَغَوَّاصٖ (٣٧) وَءَاخَرِينَ مُقَرَّنِينَ فِي ٱلۡأَصۡفَادِ (٣٨)

“He said, ‘My Lord, forgive me and grant me a kingdom that shall not belong to anyone after me. Indeed, You are the Bestower.’ (35) So, We subjected to him the wind blowing gently by his command wherever he willed, (36) and the devils, every kind of builder and diver, (37) and others bound together in chains.” (Sad 38:35–38)

At first glance, Sulaiman’s request, *“a kingdom that shall not belong to anyone after me”,* is often misunderstood as a desire for exclusivity or superiority. However, Intellectual Tadabbur requires that any interpretation align with two immovable Qur’anic principles:

1. Prophets are moral exemplars, protected from ego-driven ambition.
2. Allah does not praise or reward vanity, nor does He grant it divine endorsement.

Allah explicitly describes Sulaiman as *“niʿma al-ʿabd”* an excellent servant, and affirms that he was *awwāb*, constantly returning to Allah. The granting of this supplication coupled with such praise conclusively rules out selfish motivation.

When read within the Qur’anic framework, Sulaiman’s duʿāʾ is best understood as arising from three principled motives, each rooted in tawhid rather than personal desire.

1. Establishing a Unique, Permanent Sign (Ayah)
Sulaiman sought a form of authority whose very nature would function as an ongoing miracle. The subjugation of wind, jinn, and elements beyond human reach transformed his kingdom into a continuous, living proof of Allah’s absolute sovereignty. This was not power for its own sake, but a public, undeniable ayah demonstrating that dominion belongs to Allah alone.

2. Safeguarding Monotheism from Abuse of Power
By requesting that such a kingdom not be granted to anyone after him, Sulaiman was effectively asking that this level of extraordinary control be sealed off permanently. This closed the door to future tyrants or impostors who might exploit supernatural authority to claim divinity, enslave humanity, or corrupt belief. His request thus functioned as a protective measure for tawhid, not a personal monopoly.

3. Tools for Ultimate Service, Not Personal Rule
The elements granted to Sulaiman were not luxuries. The wind enabled rapid movement and administration across vast lands; the jinn built, dived, and labored where humans could not. These were instruments of service, allowing justice, worship, and order to be established on a scale otherwise impossible. Power, in this context, was a means to fulfill divine responsibility, not a goal in itself.

Seen through this lens, the story of Sulaiman (AS) becomes a profound lesson on the ethics of power. True authority begins with humility, is tested through loss, restored through repentance, and justified only when exercised in service of Allah's purpose.

Surat Sad thus presents a consistent Qur'anic pattern: power is granted, withdrawn, and restored, not to glorify the servant, but to manifest the sovereignty of the Lord.

8. The Trial and Recovery of Prophet Ayoub: Patience, Effort, and Ethical Renewal

In Surah Sad, Allah presents Prophet Ayoub (AS) as the supreme model of patience under prolonged hardship. He was afflicted with severe illness, the loss of wealth, and the loss of family. Authentic reports indicate that his ordeal extended over many years. Yet throughout this prolonged suffering, his supplication to Allah remained dignified, restrained, and deeply God-conscious:

وَٱذۡكُرۡ عَبۡدَنَآ أَيُّوبَ إِذۡ نَادَىٰ رَبَّهُۥٓ أَنِّي مَسَّنِيَ ٱلشَّيۡطَٰنُ بِنُصۡبٖ وَعَذَابٍ (٤١)
"And remember Our servant Ayoub (Job), when he called upon his Lord (saying): "Indeed, Satan has touched me with hardship and suffering." (Sad 38:41)

Ayoub (AS) did not accuse Allah, nor did he protest the decree. Instead, he describes his condition and attributes the harassing aspect of suffering to Satan, maintaining perfect adab with his Lord. This distinction reflects spiritual maturity: acknowledging pain without compromising reverence.

Allah's response to Ayoub's supplication is immediate, but instructive. Restoration does not come through passive relief; it comes through directed effort:

ٱرۡكُضۡ بِرِجۡلِكَۖ هَٰذَا مُغۡتَسَلُۢ بَارِدٞ وَشَرَابٞ (٤٢)
"(**Allah said to him): "Strike the ground with your foot: here is cool water for washing and drinking." (Sad 38:42)**

Even in divine healing, Ayoub is commanded to act. Mercy does not negate effort; it activates it. Physical movement becomes the gateway to physical recovery.

With health restored, Allah then returns Ayoub's family, and more, explicitly framing this restoration as mercy and instruction:

وَوَهَبْنَا لَهُۥٓ أَهْلَهُۥ وَمِثْلَهُم مَّعَهُمْ رَحْمَةً مِّنَّا وَذِكْرَىٰ لِأُو۟لِى ٱلْأَلْبَٰبِ (٤٣)

"And We granted him back his family, and the like of them along with them, as a Mercy from Us, and a reminder for those of understanding." (Sad 38:43)

The final stage of Ayoub's recovery concerns his material standing and moral commitments:

وَخُذْ بِيَدِكَ ضِغْثًا فَٱضْرِب بِّهِۦ وَلَا تَحْنَثْ ۗ إِنَّا وَجَدْنَٰهُ صَابِرًا ۚ نِّعْمَ ٱلْعَبْدُ ۖ إِنَّهُۥٓ أَوَّابٌ (٤٤)

"And take in your hand a Dighthan (bundle of diverse elements) **and strike with it, and do not break your oath. Indeed, We found him patient. What an excellent servant! He was ever turning (to Us)." (Sad 38:44)**

At this point, it is essential to move away from folkloric interpretations, especially the claim that this verse refers to striking Ayoub's wife. Such readings contradict prophetic character, ignore Qur'anic ethics, and overlook the established jurisprudence of oaths, which Allah has already legislated to be expiated through kaffarah, not violence. Ayoub himself was known for meticulous observance of expiation, even on behalf of others.

Instead, Intellectual Tadabbur directs attention to the key term dighthan (ضِغث). Linguistically, a dighthan is a bundle of mixed elements, not a single, uniform object. Within the broader narrative of Ayoub's systematic restoration, health, family, then livelihood, this command emerges not as punishment, but as strategy.

The dighthan represents diversification: a deliberate move away from reliance on a single source of income or production.

This command can be understood across economic contexts:

- **Agrarian context**: A *dighthan* of varied seeds signals a shift toward polyculture, protecting livelihood from crop-specific failures, pests, or blight.
- **Commercial context**: "Striking out" with a *dighthan* of goods reflects portfolio diversification, a foundational principle of risk mitigation in trade.

In both cases, Allah provides Ayoub not merely with resources, but with a method**,** a way to rebuild wealth responsibly and sustainably. At the same time, Allah reinforces the ethical boundary:

وَلَا تَحْنَثْ

"Do not break your oath."

Material recovery must not compromise moral integrity. Wealth is only a blessing when earned and restored without violating commitments or principles.

The Qur’anic business model implicit in Ayoub’s restoration can thus be summarized:

Stage	Command	Principle
Recovery	"Strike the ground" (Effort)	No reward without physical initiative.
Strategy	"Take a Dighthan" (Bundle)	**Diversification:** Protect against future loss.
Ethics	"Do not break your oath"	**Integrity:** Wealth is only a blessing when earned ethically.

Ayoub (AS) is ultimately praised with the same words used for Sulaiman (AS):

نِّعۡمَ ٱلۡعَبۡدُۖ إِنَّهُۥٓ أَوَّابٞ (٤٤)

“What an excellent servant! Indeed, he was ever turning (to Us).” (Sad 38:44)

Together, the stories of Sulaiman and Ayoub present the full spectrum of patience:

- Patience while entrusted with extraordinary power (Sulaiman).
- Patience while stripped of nearly everything (Ayoub).

In both extremes, absolute capacity and near helplessness, the true servant remains awwab, constantly returning to Allah, transforming every condition into a platform for obedience, wisdom, and trust.

9. The Pure Religion: Eliminating the Intermediary

The Qur’an establishes two inseparable conditions for any deed to be accepted by Allah. First, the action must be performed with complete sincerity for Allah alone. Second, no intermediary, no go-between, representative, or spiritual proxy, may be placed between the servant and his Lord. Every form of worship, supplication, prayer, sacrifice, vows, reliance, love, fear, and hope, must be directed exclusively to Allah, without sharing any portion of it with another being.

Allah makes this foundation unmistakably clear:

إِنَّآ أَنزَلۡنَآ إِلَيۡكَ ٱلۡكِتَٰبَ بِٱلۡحَقِّ فَٱعۡبُدِ ٱللَّهَ مُخۡلِصٗا لَّهُ ٱلدِّينَ (٢)

“Indeed, We have sent down the Book to you in truth: So worship Allah making (the practice of) the religion purely for Him.” (Al-Zumar 39: 2)

Here, Allah directly links the revelation of the Book with the purification of religion. The Qur’an did not come merely to inform the intellect, but to reform the heart, so that worship is directed to Allah alone, free from showing off, seeking validation, or relying on created beings. Ikhlas (sincerity) means that Allah is the sole intended object, the sole source of hope, and the sole One feared in worship.

Allah then dismantles the most persistent deviation from this purity: the claim that intermediaries are needed to draw closer to Him.

أَلَا لِلَّهِ ٱلدِّينُ ٱلۡخَالِصُۚ وَٱلَّذِينَ ٱتَّخَذُواْ مِن دُونِهِۦٓ أَوۡلِيَآءَ مَا نَعۡبُدُهُمۡ إِلَّا لِيُقَرِّبُونَآ إِلَى ٱللَّهِ زُلۡفَىٰٓ إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ يَحۡكُمُ بَيۡنَهُمۡ فِي مَا هُمۡ فِيهِ يَخۡتَلِفُونَۗ إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ لَا يَهۡدِي مَنۡ هُوَ كَٰذِبٞ كَفَّارٞ (٣)

"Unquestionably, for Allah is the pure religion. And those who take protectors besides Him [say], 'We only worship them that they may bring us nearer to Allah." Allah will judge between them regarding that in which they differ. Indeed, Allah does not guide one who is a persistent liar and disbeliever." (Al-Zumar 39:3)

This verse exposes a subtle but dangerous misconception: the belief that one is too sinful or too insignificant to approach Allah directly, and therefore must seek saints, idols, or revered figures as spiritual intermediaries. The Qur'an rejects this idea completely. Seeking intermediaries in worship is not humility, it contradicts Tawhid, because it diverts devotion away from the One who alone deserves it.

The pure religion that Allah commands is a direct, unmediated relationship with Him. You call upon Him directly. You rely upon Him directly. You hope in Him directly. No barrier exists except the one created by the servant's own hesitation.

For this reason, Allah commands even His Messenger ﷺ—the most honored of creation, to publicly affirm undivided worship:

قُلۡ إِنِّيٓ أُمِرۡتُ أَنۡ أَعۡبُدَ ٱللَّهَ مُخۡلِصٗا لَّهُ ٱلدِّينَ (١١) وَأُمِرۡتُ لِأَنۡ أَكُونَ أَوَّلَ ٱلۡمُسۡلِمِينَ (١٢) قُلۡ إِنِّيٓ أَخَافُ إِنۡ عَصَيۡتُ رَبِّي عَذَابَ يَوۡمٍ عَظِيمٖ (١٣) قُلِ ٱللَّهَ أَعۡبُدُ مُخۡلِصٗا لَّهُۥ دِينِي (١٤)

"Say, "Surely, I have been commanded to worship Allah, making the religion sincere to Him. (11) And I have been commanded to be the first Muslim. (12) Say, "Surely I fear, if I were to disobey my Lord, the punishment of a tremendous Day." (13) Say, Allah alone I worship, making my religion purely for Him." (Al-Zumar 39: 11-14)

If the Prophet ﷺ is instructed to declare his fear of disobedience and his commitment to pure worship, then no one else can claim exemption. Allah Himself has opened the door and invited every servant personally.

To remove any remaining hesitation, Allah reminds the believer of His nearness:

وَلَقَدۡ خَلَقۡنَا ٱلۡإِنسَٰنَ وَنَعۡلَمُ مَا تُوَسۡوِسُ بِهِۦ نَفۡسُهُۥۖ وَنَحۡنُ أَقۡرَبُ إِلَيۡهِ مِنۡ حَبۡلِ ٱلۡوَرِيدِ (١٦)

"Indeed, We created man and We know what his soul whispers to him, and We are nearer to him than his jugular vein." (Qaf 50:16)

When Allah is nearer than one's own lifeline, there is no need for a mediator. He knows the unspoken fears, the silent regrets, and the hidden hopes. He hears the supplication that never reaches the tongue, and He responds to the heart that turns sincerely.

Yet what if that heart has erred? What if sincerity was compromised? What if worship was neglected?

The same Surah that commands purity of religion immediately opens the horizon of limitless forgiveness:

قُلۡ يَٰعِبَادِيَ ٱلَّذِينَ أَسۡرَفُواْ عَلَىٰٓ أَنفُسِهِمۡ لَا تَقۡنَطُواْ مِن رَّحۡمَةِ ٱللَّهِۚ إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ يَغۡفِرُ ٱلذُّنُوبَ جَمِيعًاۚ إِنَّهُۥ هُوَ ٱلۡغَفُورُ ٱلرَّحِيمُ (٥٣) وَأَنِيبُوٓاْ إِلَىٰ رَبِّكُمۡ وَأَسۡلِمُواْ لَهُۥ مِن قَبۡلِ أَن يَأۡتِيَكُمُ ٱلۡعَذَابُ ثُمَّ لَا تُنصَرُونَ (٥٤)

"Say: "O My servants who have transgressed against themselves [by sinning], do not despair of the mercy of Allah. Indeed, Allah forgives all sins; surely, He is The Ever-Forgiving, The Ever-Merciful. (53) And return to your Lord and submit to Him before the punishment comes to you; then you will not be helped. "(Al-Zumar 39: 53-54)

Notice the expression: *"those who have transgressed against themselves."* Every sin is described not as diminishing Allah's majesty — which remains untouched — but as self-inflicted harm. Sin wounds the soul, distances it from clarity and serenity. Yet even for those who have gone far in wrongdoing, Allah's message is not condemnation but invitation: do not despair.

The door of mercy is not partially open; it remains wide open until life itself closes. The path back is simple and direct, the same directness that defines pure worship:

- Its path is tawbah (returning to Allah).
- Its condition is sincerity.
- Its outcome is renewal.

The servant who once worshiped directly must also repent directly. No intermediary carries repentance. No saint absolves sin. The One who commands sincerity is the same One who forgives all sins.

Thus, pure religion and limitless mercy are not separate themes. They are two movements of the same relationship. Worship is direct. Repentance is direct. Nearness is direct.

The pure religion, therefore, is not merely correct ritual performance. It is the conscious decision to choose Allah alone as the ultimate goal, and when one falters, to return to Him alone, without despair and without barrier.
The believer lives between two certainties:
Absolute sincerity in worship.
Absolute hope in mercy.

And between these two, the soul finds its balance.

10. The Mark of Intelligence: Discernment and the Choice of the Best

A true servant of Allah is not one who follows blindly, but one who listens carefully, reflects deeply, and chooses wisely. The Qur'an praises such a person as truly

intelligent, one who distinguishes between voices, ideas, and opinions, then commits only to what is “aḥsan” the best, the most righteous, and the most beneficial. Allah says:

فَبَشِّرۡ عِبَادِ (١٧) ٱلَّذِينَ يَسۡتَمِعُونَ ٱلۡقَوۡلَ فَيَتَّبِعُونَ أَحۡسَنَهُۥٓۚ أُوْلَٰٓئِكَ ٱلَّذِينَ هَدَىٰهُمُ ٱللَّهُۖ وَأُوْلَٰٓئِكَ هُمۡ أُوْلُواْ ٱلۡأَلۡبَٰبِ (١٨)

“So, give good tidings to My servants (17) Those who listen to speech and follow the best of it. Those are the ones Allah has guided, and those are people of understanding." (Al-Zumar 39:17-18)

These verses celebrate intellectual discernment, the ability to listen without surrendering judgment, to evaluate without arrogance, and to select what aligns most closely with truth and righteousness. Islam thus promotes what we would today call information literacy long before the term existed.

The Ulu al-Albab/ أُوْلُواْ ٱلۡأَلۡبَٰبِ people of deep understanding, are not those who merely echo popular opinion or cling to inherited ideas without reflection. They are those who examine every claim, weigh it against divine guidance, and extract its highest moral and spiritual value. Listening, in the Qur’anic sense, is not passive reception; it is active evaluation followed by responsible choice.

In this verse, Allah defines intelligence as the capacity for Tadabbur, reflective analysis that leads to ethical action. The Qur’an does not call for suspending the mind, but for refining it. To “follow the best of what is said” is to cultivate an inner compass capable of distinguishing between truth and distortion, between fleeting trends and enduring wisdom.

True servitude to Allah, therefore, is not blind obedience to human authority, nor intellectual chaos driven by personal desire. It is enlightened submission, independent thought guided by revelation. Such intellect becomes a light by which the believer navigates the noise of life, consistently choosing the path most pleasing to Allah.

Conclusion

Juz 23 offers a complete spiritual framework, one that begins with responsibility and ends with hope. Across its verses, the Qur’an teaches that faith is lived through patience, effort, discernment, and sincerity, not through passivity or despair.

The prophetic models in this Juz reveal that trials are not signs of abandonment, but means of refinement. Yunus learns patience, Dawoud learns the limits of authority, Sulaiman learns humility in power, and Ayoub embodies endurance in loss. In every case, the servant fulfills his duty while leaving outcomes to Allah.

The Juz also defines true intelligence as the ability to listen, reflect, and follow what is best. Through Tadabbur, the believer learns to engage the Qur’an with both heart and mind, avoiding blind following while remaining anchored to revelation.

At the core of all guidance stands pure worship, direct, sincere, and unmediated. No intermediary stands between the servant and Allah, and no sincere return is ever rejected. After demanding responsibility and ethical clarity, Allah reassures every struggling soul: do not despair. As long as the heart can return, mercy remains near. Faith, as this Juz teaches, is not about never falling, but about always turning back.

Jewels from the Twenty Fourth Juz: A Journey through the Soul, the Universe, and the Divine Command

(Al-Zumar 39:32 – Fussilat 41:46)

Introduction

The twenty-fourth Juz of the Quran is a profound tapestry of spiritual psychology and cosmic majesty. Spanning parts of Surah Az-Zumar, Surah Ghafir, and Surah Fussilat, these verses bridge the gap between our internal world and the vast expanse of the heavens. In this chapter, we explore ten "Jewels"—specific verses that provide deep insights into the nature of the soul, the precision of creation, and the absolute sincerity required to connect with the Creator. These are not merely ancient texts; they are living signals designed to guide the modern mind toward a state of certainty and peace.

1. Sincerity and Pure Devotion

Juz 24 contains a recurring emphasis on Sincerity (Ikhlas), the internal alignment of the heart with one's outward actions. These verses do not just define sincerity; they provide a diagnostic tool to assess the health of our own devotion. The cornerstone of this theme is found early in the Juz:

إِنَّآ أَنزَلۡنَآ إِلَيۡكَ ٱلۡكِتَٰبَ بِٱلۡحَقِّ فَٱعۡبُدِ ٱللَّهَ مُخۡلِصٗا لَّهُ ٱلدِّينَ (٢)

"Indeed, We have sent down the Book to you in truth: So worship Allah making the practice of your religion sincere to Him." (Al-Zumar 39: 2)

The Definition of Sincere Worship: Sincere worship requires that nothing, and no one, comes between the servant and the Creator. Allah directly addresses the fallacy of "intercession" that plagued the people of Makkah. They claimed that their idols were merely "bridges" to the Divine, but Allah identifies this as a lack of sincerity and a form of Shirk (associating partners with Him):

أَلَا لِلَّهِ ٱلدِّينُ ٱلۡخَالِصُۚ وَٱلَّذِينَ ٱتَّخَذُواْ مِن دُونِهِۦٓ أَوۡلِيَآءَ مَا نَعۡبُدُهُمۡ إِلَّا لِيُقَرِّبُونَآ إِلَى ٱللَّهِ زُلۡفَىٰٓ إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ يَحۡكُمُ بَيۡنَهُمۡ فِي مَا هُمۡ فِيهِ يَخۡتَلِفُونَۗ إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ لَا يَهۡدِي مَنۡ هُوَ كَٰذِبٞ كَفَّارٞ (٣)

"Surely, the sincere religion is for Allah. And those who take guardians other than Him (say): "We only worship them in order that they may bring us near to Allah." Verily, Allah will judge between them concerning that wherein they differ. Truly, Allah does not guide him who is a liar, and a relentless disbeliever." (Al-Zumar 39:3)

Sincerity is not a suggestion; it is a divine mandate. To lack sincerity is to possess a fundamental deficiency in belief. The Prophet ﷺ was commanded to declare this twice, emphasizing its gravity:

قُلۡ إِنِّيٓ أُمِرۡتُ أَنۡ أَعۡبُدَ ٱللَّهَ مُخۡلِصٗا لَّهُ ٱلدِّينَ (١١) وَأُمِرۡتُ لِأَنۡ أَكُونَ أَوَّلَ ٱلۡمُسۡلِمِينَ (١٢) قُلۡ إِنِّيٓ أَخَافُ إِنۡ عَصَيۡتُ رَبِّي عَذَابَ يَوۡمٍ عَظِيمٖ (١٣) قُلِ ٱللَّهَ أَعۡبُدُ مُخۡلِصٗا لَّهُۥ دِينِي (١٤)

“Say, “Surely, I have been commanded to worship Allah, making the religion sincere to Him. (11) And I have been commanded to be the first Muslim. (12) Say, “Surely I fear, in case I disobey my Lord, the torment of a Tremendous Day.” (13) Say, Allah I worship, making my religion sincere to Him.” (Al-Zumar 39: 11-14)

The Two Dimensions of Sincerity: For worship to be complete, it must manifest in two ways:

1. External Manifestation: The obedience of the limbs ((الجوارح) to Allah’s commands through visible action.
2. Internal Manifestation: The hidden intention (Niyyah) within the heart, known only to Allah and the individual.

True sincerity requires the full engagement of both the body and the soul. We often see this "forced" upon people during times of extreme distress. When a person faces a crisis, their superficial distractions vanish, and they call upon Allah with total focus. However, the Quran warns against the "fickle heart" that reverts to arrogance once the storm passes:

فَإِذَا مَسَّ ٱلۡإِنسَٰنَ ضُرّٞ دَعَانَا ثُمَّ إِذَا خَوَّلۡنَٰهُ نِعۡمَةٗ مِّنَّا قَالَ إِنَّمَآ أُوتِيتُهُۥ عَلَىٰ عِلۡمِۭۚ بَلۡ هِيَ فِتۡنَةٞ وَلَٰكِنَّ أَكۡثَرَهُمۡ لَا يَعۡلَمُونَ (٤٩)

“And when affliction befalls man, he calls upon Us; then when We bestow on him a favor from Us, he says, "I have only been given it because of [my] knowledge." Rather, it is a trial, but most of them do not know.” (Al-Zumar 39:49)

Cultivating Sincerity Through Reflection: Sincerity is not achieved in a vacuum; it is the fruit of deep reflection on the universe. By observing the order and majesty of creation, a person realizes that only One Being is worthy of such absolute devotion:

خَلَقَ ٱلسَّمَٰوَٰتِ وَٱلۡأَرۡضَ بِٱلۡحَقِّۖ يُكَوِّرُ ٱلَّيۡلَ عَلَى ٱلنَّهَارِ وَيُكَوِّرُ ٱلنَّهَارَ عَلَى ٱلَّيۡلِۖ وَسَخَّرَ ٱلشَّمۡسَ وَٱلۡقَمَرَۖ كُلّٞ يَجۡرِي لِأَجَلٖ مُّسَمّٗىۗ أَلَا هُوَ ٱلۡعَزِيزُ ٱلۡغَفَّٰرُ (٥)

“He has created the heavens and the earth in truth. He wraps the night over the day and wraps the day over the night. And He has subjected the sun and the moon; each is running its course for an appointed term. Verily, He is the All-Mighty, the Oft-Forgiving.” (Al-Zumar 39:5)

2. The Signs of a Sincere Heart

How do we know if we are achieving this? The Juz provides a beautiful description of the sincere believer:

- Consistency: They are obedient "at various times of the night."
- Humility: They are found in prostration and standing.
- Balanced Emotion: They act out of a healthy fear of the Hereafter and a profound hope for Allah's mercy.

أَمَّنۡ هُوَ قَٰنِتٌ ءَانَآءَ ٱلَّيۡلِ سَاجِدٗا وَقَآئِمٗا يَحۡذَرُ ٱلۡأٓخِرَةَ وَيَرۡجُواْ رَحۡمَةَ رَبِّهِۦۗ قُلۡ هَلۡ يَسۡتَوِي ٱلَّذِينَ يَعۡلَمُونَ وَٱلَّذِينَ لَا يَعۡلَمُونَۗ إِنَّمَا يَتَذَكَّرُ أُوْلُواْ ٱلۡأَلۡبَٰبِ (٩)

“Is he who is devoutly obedient at various times of the night, prostrate and upright, being wary of the Hereafter, and hoping for the mercy of his Lord (the same as the disbeliever)? Say, “Are the ones who know equal to the ones who do not know?” Surely only the ones endowed with intellects would remind themselves.” (Al-Zumar 39: 9)

Sincerity in Repentance: Sincerity is the key that unlocks forgiveness. Even those who have "committed excesses against themselves" (sinned greatly) are invited back, provided their turning (Inabah) is sincere and timely:

قُلْ يَٰعِبَادِىَ ٱلَّذِينَ أَسْرَفُوا۟ عَلَىٰٓ أَنفُسِهِمْ لَا تَقْنَطُوا۟ مِن رَّحْمَةِ ٱللَّهِ ۚ إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ يَغْفِرُ ٱلذُّنُوبَ جَمِيعًا ۚ إِنَّهُۥ هُوَ ٱلْغَفُورُ ٱلرَّحِيمُ (٥٣) وَأَنِيبُوٓا۟ إِلَىٰ رَبِّكُمْ وَأَسْلِمُوا۟ لَهُۥ مِن قَبْلِ أَن يَأْتِيَكُمُ ٱلْعَذَابُ ثُمَّ لَا تُنصَرُونَ (٥٤)

“Say: “O My servants who have committed excess against themselves, (i.e., who have committed sins) never give up hope in the mercy of Allah! Surely Allah forgives all sins; surely, He, Ever He, is The Ever-Forgiving, The Ever-Merciful. (53) And turn in penitence to your Lord, and surrender to Him, before the torment comes up to you; thereafter you will not be vindicated.” (Al-Zumar 39: 53-54).

Sincerity in Action: The Power of Dua: While sincerity is a state of the heart, its most potent expression is through Dua (supplication). In Juz 24, Allah emphasizes that calling upon Him is not merely an option, but a fundamental requirement of faith. To abandon Dua is to fall into Kibr (arrogance), a trait that leads to spiritual ruin:

وَقَالَ رَبُّكُمُ ٱدْعُونِىٓ أَسْتَجِبْ لَكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ ٱلَّذِينَ يَسْتَكْبِرُونَ عَنْ عِبَادَتِى سَيَدْخُلُونَ جَهَنَّمَ دَاخِرِينَ (٦٠)

“And your Lord has said, “Call Me, I will respond to you. Surely those who show arrogance against My worship shall enter Hell utterly humiliated.” (Ghaffir 40: 60).

The Pillars of Sincerity: Patience and Forgiveness

Sincere Dua does not exist in isolation; it must be coupled with Sabr (patience) and Istighfar (seeking forgiveness). Sincerity is often tested when an answer to a prayer seems delayed. In these moments, the believer is reminded that Allah’s promise is an absolute truth:

فَٱصْبِرْ إِنَّ وَعْدَ ٱللَّهِ حَقٌّ وَٱسْتَغْفِرْ لِذَنۢبِكَ وَسَبِّحْ بِحَمْدِ رَبِّكَ بِٱلْعَشِىِّ وَٱلْإِبْكَٰرِ (٥٥)

“So be patient – surely, the promise of Allah is truth. And seek forgiveness for your sin and proclaim the purity and praise of your Lord in the evening and at dawn.” (Ghaffir 40:55)

By weaving together these verses, a complete picture of Ikhlas emerges:

- The Root: Understanding that the "Pure Religion" belongs to Allah alone.
- The Tool: Sincere Dua as the primary expression of our dependence on Him.
- The Sustainer: Patience and constant remembrance (Tasbih) to keep the heart firm

3. The Mircle of Sleep

This verse highlights one of Allah's most overlooked miracles: the act of sleep. Because it is a daily occurrence, we often ignore its inherent mystery. We have no ultimate control over our sleep; we cannot force it to happen, nor can we indefinitely prevent it. While we may lie down exhausted, we do not dictate the exact moment of transition, we simply slip into it, just as we suddenly awaken. The Quran draws a direct parallel between sleep and death, offering profound insight into the relationship between the body and the soul:

ٱللَّهُ يَتَوَفَّى ٱلۡأَنفُسَ حِينَ مَوۡتِهَا وَٱلَّتِي لَمۡ تَمُتۡ فِي مَنَامِهَاۖ فَيُمۡسِكُ ٱلَّتِي قَضَىٰ عَلَيۡهَا ٱلۡمَوۡتَ وَيُرۡسِلُ ٱلۡأُخۡرَىٰٓ إِلَىٰٓ أَجَلٖ مُّسَمًّىۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَأٓيَٰتٖ لِّقَوۡمٖ يَتَفَكَّرُونَ (٤٢)

"Allah takes the souls of the dead and the souls of the living while they sleep; He keeps hold of those whose death He has ordained and sends the others back until their appointed time. Truly, there are signs in this for those who reflect." (Al-Zumur 39:42)

While death marks a permanent separation between the body and the soul, sleep constitutes a temporary one. During sleep, the soul is partially freed from the constraints of time and space. This "out-of-body" state facilitates dreams and visions. While many dreams are products of the imagination, "true visions" (Ru'ya) offer glimpses into a non-physical reality. These are not exclusive to Prophets; as seen in the King of Egypt's dream during the time of Prophet Yusuf, even non-believers can receive these signals. This experience demonstrates both the power of Allah and the relativity of time

This verse provides a framework for understanding the soul's nature. Since essential biological functions, like the heartbeat and respiration, continue while the soul is "away" during sleep, it suggests the soul does not directly manage the body's electrochemical functions.

Instead, we might speculate that Allah has equipped the body with an "Internal Operating System" that manages these involuntary processes. This system remains active until the physical "hardware" can no longer support it. While only Allah can "shut down" this system by decree (natural death), humans can interfere with it through violence (murder). In such cases, the body is rendered physically unable to sustain the soul.

What, then, is the soul? A compelling modern analogy is that the soul is a "Hologram of the Self." Just as a hologram contains the data of an entire 3D image in every part, the soul preserves the complete information, memories, and characteristics accumulated during a lifetime. This analogy provides a powerful explanation for the Resurrection:

وَإِذَا ٱلنُّفُوسُ زُوِّجَتۡ (٧)

"And when souls are reunited," (Al-Takwir 81:7)

At the Resurrection, Allah unites the soul with a new body, likely made of a different material suited for eternal existence. Because the soul acts as a "data backup," the moment it is plugged into this new "hardware," the individual instantly possesses all the memories and identity of their earthly life. The Quran reinforces this concept of "Data Preservation" across several other verses:

1/ The "Retaining Record" (Kitabun Hafiz): When skeptics ask how they can be restored from dust, Allah refers to a specific record:

قَدۡ عَلِمۡنَا مَا تَنقُصُ ٱلۡأَرۡضُ مِنۡهُمۡۖ وَعِندَنَا كِتَٰبٌ حَفِيظُۢ (٤)

"We know what the earth diminishes of them, and with Us is a retaining record (Kitabun Hafiz)." (Qaf 50:4)

Even as the hardware dissolves, the "source code" remains secure.

2/ Unique Biological Barcodes: Allah emphasizes the precision of the restoration:

أَيَحۡسَبُ ٱلۡإِنسَٰنُ أَلَّن نَّجۡمَعَ عِظَامَهُۥ (٣) بَلَىٰ قَٰدِرِينَ عَلَىٰٓ أَن نُّسَوِّيَ بَنَانَهُۥ (٤)

"Does man think that We will not reassemble his bones? (3) Yes; indeed, We are Able to reconstruct even his fingertips." (Al-Qiyamah 75:3-4)

The "Hologram" carries the precise individualizing data required to rebuild the exact person.

3/ The Self as Evidence: On Judgment Day, man is told he will be

يُنَبَّؤُاْ ٱلۡإِنسَٰنُ يَوۡمَئِذِۭ بِمَا قَدَّمَ وَأَخَّرَ (١٣) بَلِ ٱلۡإِنسَٰنُ عَلَىٰ نَفۡسِهِۦ بَصِيرَةٞ (١٤)

"On that Day man will be informed of everything he put forward, and everything he left behind. (13) And man will be evidence against himself." (Al-Qiyamah 75:13-14)

For self-testimony to be valid, the resurrected person must have the exact same data and consciousness as their earthly self.

4/ The Original Blueprint: Allah reminds us that the Second Creation is "easier"

وَهُوَ ٱلَّذِي يَبۡدَؤُاْ ٱلۡخَلۡقَ ثُمَّ يُعِيدُهُۥ وَهُوَ أَهۡوَنُ عَلَيۡهِۚ

"And He is the One Who begins the creation, then repeats it; and that is even easier for Him..." (Ar-Rum 30:27)

In any technical sense, repeating a process is simpler when the "code" from the first run is already in hand.

4. Giving Allah His True "Qadr"

This verse contains a powerful reprimand to humanity for our failure to comprehend the majesty of the Creator. It is a theme so central to the Quranic message that it appears in two other places (Al-An'am 6:91 and Al-Hajj 22:74).

وَمَا قَدَرُواْ ٱللَّهَ حَقَّ قَدۡرِهِۦ وَٱلۡأَرۡضُ جَمِيعٗا قَبۡضَتُهُۥ يَوۡمَ ٱلۡقِيَٰمَةِ وَٱلسَّمَٰوَٰتُ مَطۡوِيَّٰتُۢ بِيَمِينِهِۦۚ سُبۡحَٰنَهُۥ وَتَعَٰلَىٰ عَمَّا يُشۡرِكُونَ (٦٧)

"They have not given Allah His true Qadr (status, estimate) that is due to Him. The whole of the earth is in His grasp on the Day of Resurrection, and the heavens will be folded in His Right Hand. Glorified is He, and High is He above all that they associate with Him!" (Al-Zumar 39: 67)

A Linguistic Nuance: Qadr vs. Qadar: In Arabic, the word "Qadr" is often confused with its similar-sounding counterpart. However, the vocalization (Tashkeel) of the letter Dal (د) changes the meaning entirely:

- Qadr (قَدْر) with a Sukoon on the Dal: This means status, worth, value, or grandeur. This is the word used in this verse to describe Allah's immense dignity.
- Qadar (قَدَر) with a Fatha on the Dal: This refers to decree, destiny, or fate.

The verse in Az-Zumar is not speaking about destiny; it is a call to recognize the Magnificence and Grandeur of the One who holds the entire universe in His hand.

The Connection to Laylat al-Qadr: It is no coincidence that this same word, Qadr (with the Sukoon), is repeated three times in Surah Al-Qadr (Chapter 97) to describe the "Night of Glory."

The greatness of that night stems from the revelation of the Quran, a book sent down so that humanity might finally know Allah and give Him His true "Qadr." The connection is profound: the ultimate purpose of all revelation is to teach us how to honor His commands and respect His presence, knowing that He sees all we do, hears all we say, and knows all we think.

The Ramadan Reflection: Many Muslims seek the immense blessings of Laylat al-Qadr during Ramadan, yet those blessings are inherently tied to our recognition of Allah's status. The rituals of fasting and prayer are designed to cleanse the heart and mind, stripping away the distractions of the world so that we can finally "estimate Allah with His true estimate." All the rewards promised on that night are ultimately for those who acknowledge Allah's true worth and align their lives with His greatness.

5. The Final Journey – A Tale of Two Gates

After judgment is rendered with absolute justice, humanity will be divided into two distinct groups, each led toward their eternal destination. The Quranic description of these journeys reveals a deep psychological and spiritual contrast in how these souls are received.

1. The Arrival at Hell: The Arrogant
For those who rejected the truth, the arrival is sudden and jarring. They are driven in groups toward a destination that remains closed until the very last moment:

وَسِيقَ ٱلَّذِينَ كَفَرُوٓاْ إِلَىٰ جَهَنَّمَ زُمَرًا ۖ حَتَّىٰٓ إِذَا جَآءُوهَا فُتِحَتۡ أَبۡوَٰبُهَا وَقَالَ لَهُمۡ خَزَنَتُهَآ أَلَمۡ يَأۡتِكُمۡ رُسُلٞ مِّنكُمۡ يَتۡلُونَ عَلَيۡكُمۡ ءَايَٰتِ رَبِّكُمۡ وَيُنذِرُونَكُمۡ لِقَآءَ يَوۡمِكُمۡ هَٰذَاۚ قَالُواْ بَلَىٰ وَلَٰكِنۡ حَقَّتۡ كَلِمَةُ ٱلۡعَذَابِ عَلَى ٱلۡكَٰفِرِينَ (٧١) قِيلَ ٱدۡخُلُوٓاْ أَبۡوَٰبَ جَهَنَّمَ خَٰلِدِينَ فِيهَاۖ فَبِئۡسَ مَثۡوَى ٱلۡمُتَكَبِّرِينَ (٧٢)

And those who disbelieved will be driven to Hell in groups until when they reach it, its gates will be opened. And its keepers will say, "Did the Messengers not come to you from yourselves, reciting to you the revealed verses of your Lord, and forewarning you of the inevitable Meeting of this Day of yours?" They will say: "Yes. But the Word of torment has been justified against the disbelievers!" It will be said (to them): "Enter you the gates of Hell wherein you shall abide forever. A most evil abode for the arrogant!" (Al-Zumar 39:72)

The phrasing suggests that the gates are thrust open only upon their arrival, adding to their terror. They are met not with a welcome, but with a stinging interrogation from the keepers of Hell, who remind them of the warnings they ignored. Their final label is "the arrogant," for it was pride that kept them from the truth.

2. The Arrival at Paradise: The Mindful

In beautiful contrast, the journey of the righteous is one of peace and honor. They are led toward Paradise in groups, but their experience at the gate is fundamentally different:

وَسِيقَ ٱلَّذِينَ ٱتَّقَوۡاْ رَبَّهُمۡ إِلَى ٱلۡجَنَّةِ زُمَرًا ۖ حَتَّىٰٓ إِذَا جَآءُوهَا وَفُتِحَتۡ أَبۡوَٰبُهَا وَقَالَ لَهُمۡ خَزَنَتُهَا سَلَٰمٌ عَلَيۡكُمۡ طِبۡتُمۡ فَٱدۡخُلُوهَا خَٰلِدِينَ (٧٣)

“And those who kept their duty to their Lord will be led to Paradise in groups until when they reach it, and its gates will be opened, and its keepers will say: Peace be upon you! You are ever pure, so enter it abiding therein forever." (Al-Zumar 39:73)

Upon entering, the believers erupt in gratitude, testifying that Allah has fulfilled His promise and granted them an inheritance where they may dwell wherever they wish. The scene concludes with a magnificent vision of the angels encircling the Throne of Allah, glorifying Him in a final, universal declaration of praise.

The Linguistic Miracle: The "Waw" of Welcome

A fascinating detail emerges when we compare the Arabic phrasing of these two arrivals. It is a testament to the precision of the Quranic text

For Hell (39:71):

وَسِيقَ ٱلَّذِينَ كَفَرُوٓاْ إِلَىٰ جَهَنَّمَ زُمَرًا ۖ حَتَّىٰٓ إِذَا جَآءُوهَا فُتِحَتۡ أَبۡوَٰبُهَا

(...until when they reached it, its gates were opened)

For Paradise (39:73).

وَسِيقَ ٱلَّذِينَ ٱتَّقَوۡاْ رَبَّهُمۡ إِلَى ٱلۡجَنَّةِ زُمَرًا ۖ حَتَّىٰٓ إِذَا جَآءُوهَا وَ فُتِحَتۡ أَبۡوَٰبُهَا

(...until when they reached it, and its gates were [already] opened)

The addition of the letter Waw (و), meaning "and", in the description of Paradise is highly significant. In Arabic linguistics, this is often referred to as the Waw al-Hal/الحال (the Waw of state/condition). It indicates that when the believers arrived, the gates were already open in anticipation of their arrival.

While the disbelievers face the shock of a gate opening to imprison them, the believers find a home that has been prepared and opened for them long before they reached it. This is consistent with Surah Sad in which Allah says

هَٰذَا ذِكۡرٞۚ وَإِنَّ لِلۡمُتَّقِينَ لَحُسۡنَ مَـَٔابٖ (٤٩) جَنَّٰتِ عَدۡنٖ مُّفَتَّحَةٗ لَّهُمُ ٱلۡأَبۡوَٰبُ (٥٠)
This is a Reminder, and indeed for those who have Taqwa a good place of return, (49) the gardens of Edn (everlasting Gardens), whose doors are (already) opened for them. (Sad 38:49-50)

The difference between the two destinations is not just the location, but the reception. One group is met with a closed door and a question of reproach; the other is met with an open door and a greeting of "Salam."

6. The Angelic Support System

One of the most profound honors given to the believer is revealed in a "royal scene" from the Unseen. These verses describe the majestic angels who carry the Throne of Allah, the highest ranking of all created beings, and their surprising preoccupation: they are in a continuous state of supplication for you.

You may feel weak or discouraged by your own sins, but if you turn back to Allah in repentance, the elite of the heavens advocates for you by name:

ٱلَّذِينَ يَحۡمِلُونَ ٱلۡعَرۡشَ وَمَنۡ حَوۡلَهُۥ يُسَبِّحُونَ بِحَمۡدِ رَبِّهِمۡ وَيُؤۡمِنُونَ بِهِۦ وَيَسۡتَغۡفِرُونَ لِلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُواْ رَبَّنَا وَسِعۡتَ كُلَّ شَيۡءٖ رَّحۡمَةٗ وَعِلۡمٗا فَٱغۡفِرۡ لِلَّذِينَ تَابُواْ وَٱتَّبَعُواْ سَبِيلَكَ وَقِهِمۡ عَذَابَ ٱلۡجَحِيمِ (٧) رَبَّنَا وَأَدۡخِلۡهُمۡ جَنَّٰتِ عَدۡنٍ ٱلَّتِي وَعَدتَّهُمۡ وَمَن صَلَحَ مِنۡ ءَابَآئِهِمۡ وَأَزۡوَٰجِهِمۡ وَذُرِّيَّٰتِهِمۡۚ إِنَّكَ أَنتَ ٱلۡعَزِيزُ ٱلۡحَكِيمُ (٨) وَقِهِمُ ٱلسَّيِّـَٔاتِۚ وَمَن تَقِ ٱلسَّيِّـَٔاتِ يَوۡمَئِذٖ فَقَدۡ رَحِمۡتَهُۥۚ وَذَٰلِكَ هُوَ ٱلۡفَوۡزُ ٱلۡعَظِيمُ (٩)
“Those (angels) who bear the Throne (of Allah) and those around it glorify the praises of their Lord, and believe in Him, and ask forgiveness for those who believe (saying): "Our Lord! You have embraced all things in Your mercy and knowledge, so forgive those who turn to You in repentance and have followed Your Way and save them from the torment of the blazing Fire! (7) Our Lord! admit them to the gardens of Adn (Eden) which you have promised them, together with whoever is righteous among their fathers, their spouses and their offspring! Indeed, You are the All-Mighty, the All-Wise. (8) And protect them from the consequence of evil deeds, and whomsoever You protect from the consequence of evil deeds on that day will be shown Your mercy." And that is the supreme success. (Ghaffir 40:7-9)

The angels do not just pray for your safety; they pray for your legacy and your joy. They ask Allah to admit you into the Gardens of Eden and, most touchingly, to reunite you with your righteous parents, spouses, and children. This reveals the immense love Allah has for the repentant soul; He has commissioned His most powerful servants to be your personal advocates.

This celestial support is further explained by the relationship between human remembrance (Dhikr) and divine response. When you remember Allah, a reciprocal process begins:

يَـٰٓأَيُّهَا ٱلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا۟ ٱذْكُرُوا۟ ٱللَّهَ ذِكْرًا كَثِيرًا (٤١) وَسَبِّحُوهُ بُكْرَةً وَأَصِيلًا (٤٢) هُوَ ٱلَّذِى يُصَلِّى عَلَيْكُمْ وَمَلَـٰٓئِكَتُهُۥ لِيُخْرِجَكُم مِّنَ ٱلظُّلُمَـٰتِ إِلَى ٱلنُّورِ ۚ وَكَانَ بِٱلْمُؤْمِنِينَ رَحِيمًا (٤٣)

“O you who believe, remember Allah with much remembrance (41) and glorify Him morning and evening. (42) "He is the One who sends blessings (Salat) upon you, and His angels as well, so that He may bring you out from darkness into light; and He is ever Merciful to the believers.” (Ahzab 33:41-43)

The "Salat" of the angels is their prayer for your forgiveness, acting as a spiritual lighthouse that pulls you out of the darkness of confusion and sin into the light of guidance.

Our relationship with the angels is not limited to the distant heavens. For those who strive to remain steadfast (Istiqamah) on the straight path, the angels become active, comforting companions at the most critical moment of life: the transition of death.

إِنَّ ٱلَّذِينَ قَالُوا۟ رَبُّنَا ٱللَّهُ ثُمَّ ٱسْتَقَـٰمُوا۟ تَتَنَزَّلُ عَلَيْهِمُ ٱلْمَلَـٰٓئِكَةُ أَلَّا تَخَافُوا۟ وَلَا تَحْزَنُوا۟ وَأَبْشِرُوا۟ بِٱلْجَنَّةِ ٱلَّتِى كُنتُمْ تُوعَدُونَ (٣٠) نَحْنُ أَوْلِيَآؤُكُمْ فِى ٱلْحَيَوٰةِ ٱلدُّنْيَا وَفِى ٱلْـَٔاخِرَةِ ۖ وَلَكُمْ فِيهَا مَا تَشْتَهِىٓ أَنفُسُكُمْ وَلَكُمْ فِيهَا مَا تَدَّعُونَ (٣١)

“As for those who say, ‘Our Lord is Allah, and stand firm on the straight path, the angels will descend on them and say, ‘Have no fear or grief, but rejoice in the good news of Paradise, which you have been promised. (30) We are your allies in this world and in the world to come, where you will have everything you desire and ask for.” (Fussilat 41: 30-31)

Imagine the moment of leaving this world: while the body fails, the "allies" from the Unseen appear to remove all fear and grief. They welcome the soul not as a stranger, but as a friend for whom they have been praying since the first moment of their repentance. The believer is never truly alone.

7. The Nature of Revelation – Creation or Command?

During the Abbasid Caliphate (833–851 CE), a fierce intellectual struggle arose over whether the Quran was "created" (makhluq) or the "uncreated" word of Allah. While philosophers debated, the Quran itself offered a definitive characterization: it is a Spirit (Ruh) born of the Divine Command (Amr).

رَفِيعُ ٱلدَّرَجَٰتِ ذُو ٱلۡعَرۡشِ يُلۡقِي ٱلرُّوحَ مِنۡ أَمۡرِهِۦ عَلَىٰ مَن يَشَآءُ مِنۡ عِبَادِهِۦ لِيُنذِرَ يَوۡمَ ٱلتَّلَاقِ (١٥)
“He is exalted in rank, the Lord of the Throne. He casts the Spirit of His command upon whom He will of His servants, to warn of the Day of Meeting.” (Ghafir 40:15)

The Distinction Between Khalq and Amr

In Quranic terminology, there is a vital distinction between the "World of Creation" (Alam al-Khalq), which includes matter, time, and biology, and the "World of Command" (Alam al-Amr), the celestial realm of divine decree. By calling the Quran a "Spirit from His Command," Allah places the Revelation above the laws of physical creation. This theme is reinforced in Surah Ash-Shura:

وَكَذَٰلِكَ أَوۡحَيۡنَآ إِلَيۡكَ رُوحٗا مِّنۡ أَمۡرِنَاۚ مَا كُنتَ تَدۡرِي مَا ٱلۡكِتَٰبُ وَلَا ٱلۡإِيمَٰنُ وَلَٰكِن جَعَلۡنَٰهُ نُورٗا نَّهۡدِي بِهِۦ مَن نَّشَآءُ مِنۡ عِبَادِنَاۚ وَإِنَّكَ لَتَهۡدِيٓ إِلَىٰ صِرَٰطٖ مُّسۡتَقِيمٖ) الشورى: ٥٢)
"And thus We have revealed to you a Spirit from Our command. You did not know what the Book or faith was, but We made it a light by which We guide whom We will of Our servants, and indeed, you guide to a straight path " (Ash-Shura 42:52)

The "Spirit" as a Life-Giving Force

Calling the Revelation a "Spirit" (Ruh) is a deliberate and powerful metaphor. Just as the soul (Ruh) gives life to a physical body, the Revelation gives life to the human heart. Without it, the intellect is merely "hardware" without an "operating system" (referencing our earlier analogy). Based on these verses, the Quran is not a mere "created substance" or a static book of history. It is:

- Eternal in Origin: Proceeding directly from the Divine Command.
- Luminous in Nature: Described as a "Light" (Nur) that penetrates spiritual darkness.
- Transcendent: It exists outside the constraints of time to shape human history.

Understanding the Quran as a "Spirit from His Command" changes how we interact with it. It is not just a text to be analyzed; it is the bridge between the Timeless Creator and time-bound creation, manifesting Allah’s eternal word in the language of humanity.

8. The Mircle of Plant Growth

One of the most striking features of the Quran is its linguistic elasticity. A verse can be understood simply by a layman, yet reveal profound scientific complexity when viewed through the lens of modern research. Consider the description of life emerging from barren, compacted soil. The specific verbs used in the Arabic text point toward complex physical and biological processes that occur in a precise series:

وَمِنۡ ءَايَٰتِهِۦٓ أَنَّكَ تَرَى ٱلۡأَرۡضَ خَٰشِعَةٗ فَإِذَآ أَنزَلۡنَا عَلَيۡهَا ٱلۡمَآءَ ٱهۡتَزَّتۡ وَرَبَتۡۚ إِنَّ ٱلَّذِيٓ أَحۡيَاهَا لَمُحۡيِ ٱلۡمَوۡتَىٰٓۚ إِنَّهُۥ عَلَىٰ كُلِّ شَيۡءٖ قَدِيرٌ (٣٩)

"And among His signs is that you see the earth barren, but when We send down water upon it, it shakes (ihtazzat) and swells (rabat). Verily, He who gives it life is indeed He who gives life to the dead. Surely, He has the power to do everything." (Fussilat 41:39)

For centuries, the "shaking" and "swelling" of the earth were viewed purely as literary metaphors. However, modern soil science and the discovery of Brownian Motion (first observed by Robert Brown in 1827) provide a technical framework for these stages:

1. The Kinetic Stage: "It Shakes" (Ihtazzat)
The first stage involves the physical movement of soil particles upon contact with rainwater. Raindrops falling on the earth at random move in every direction, colliding with microscopic soil particles. This causes the particles to vibrate and move erratically, a phenomenon known as Brownian Movement. This "shaking" is essential for the distribution of minerals and the creation of micro-cracks in the soil.

2. The Volumetric Stage: "It Swells" (Rabat)
The second stage refers to the growth in size of the soil particles as they absorb water. Soil particles, particularly clay minerals, are composed of thin, jointed layers. Between these layers are spaces that allow water molecules and dissolved ions to enter. As water diffuses between these layers, it causes the particles to expand and the soil to swell.

This swelling property is critical; it allows the soil to hold water near the surface rather than letting it penetrate too deep into the earth, ensuring that moisture remains accessible for organisms and plant roots.

3. The Biological Stage: Germination
The final stage is the biological re-animation of the earth. The soil that appeared "dead" or dormant comes to life. The Brownian Movement assists in distributing the nourishing particles needed by the seeds to begin sprouting. The soil "opens up" through the previous physical stages, allowing the delicate vegetation to emerge.

For the layman, this is a beautiful metaphor for the Resurrection—the return of life to that which was dust. For the scientist, it is a precise description of the physicochemical transformation of the earth's crust, a testament to the One who "re-animates" the dead.

9. The Pre-Measured Provisions

The Earth is approximately 4.6 billion years old. From its very inception, Allah designed it as a self-sustaining vessel. Aside from sunlight, nothing essential to life arrives from outside our atmosphere. Every resource needed to sustain every human, animal, bird, and insect, from the first creature to the last, was already embedded within the Earth’s systems at the moment of its creation.

قُلۡ أَئِنَّكُمۡ لَتَكۡفُرُونَ بِٱلَّذِى خَلَقَ ٱلۡأَرۡضَ فِى يَوۡمَيۡنِ وَتَجۡعَلُونَ لَهُۥٓ أَندَادًاۚ ذَٰلِكَ رَبُّ ٱلۡعَٰلَمِينَ (٩) وَجَعَلَ فِيهَا رَوَٰسِىَ مِن فَوۡقِهَا وَبَٰرَكَ فِيهَا وَقَدَّرَ فِيهَآ أَقۡوَٰتَهَا فِىٓ أَرۡبَعَةِ أَيَّامٖ سَوَآءٗ لِّلسَّآئِلِينَ (١٠)

"Say, 'How can you disbelieve in the One who created the earth in two Days? How can you set up other rivals to Him, He is the Lord of the worlds!' (9) He placed firm mountains on it, blessed it, and measured out its provisions in four days, equal for all who ask." (Fussilat 41:9-10)

The phrase "measured out its provisions" (qaddara fiha aqwataha/ وَقَدَّرَ فِيهَآ أَقۡوَٰتَهَا) implies a precise calculation.

In modern terms, we refer to this as the carrying capacity of the planet. Allah informs us that these provisions were not an afterthought; they were "locked in" during the foundational stages of the planet's history. Furthermore, the term "equal for all who ask" (sawā'an li-ssā'ilīn/ سَوَآءٗ لِّلسَّآئِلِينَ) suggests that the resources were designed to be sufficient for the entire collective of "seekers", every living being that requires sustenance.

These verses fundamentally refute the Malthusian theory, proposed by Thomas Robert Malthus, which suggests that population growth will inevitably outstrip food production. According to the Quranic worldview, the problem is never a lack of creation, but rather a failure of distribution. Contemporary data support this:

- Sufficient Caloric Output: According to the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO), the world currently produces enough calories to feed 10 billion people, far exceeding the current population of 8 billion. We live on a planet of abundance, not scarcity.

- Access and Inequality: The World Food Programme (WFP) highlights that hunger is rarely caused by a physical scarcity. It is a byproduct of economic inequality, political conflict, and market failures.

The "injustice" mentioned in the Quran often manifests as the hoarding of these pre-measured provisions. When we encroach on resources meant for the collective, we disrupt the divine balance (Mizan). Food shortages are not a failure of Earth's capacity; they are a failure of human character. Recognizing this should inspire a drive for justice: if Allah provided for "all who ask," our duty is to ensure those provisions reach their rightful recipients.

10. The Moral Compass of the Messenger

The Quran, as Allah's final message, requires a human vessel to reach the hearts of others. However, the message cannot be delivered through logic alone; it requires a superior moral character. To invite others to Allah, a Muslim must be a living embodiment of the faith's impact, demonstrating kindness, tolerance, and unshakable patience.

Allah defines the highest form of human discourse not by its eloquence, but by its purpose and the speaker's integrity

وَمَنْ أَحْسَنُ قَوْلاً مِّمَّن دَعَآ إِلَى ٱللَّهِ وَعَمِلَ صَـٰلِحًا وَقَالَ إِنَّنِى مِنَ ٱلْمُسْلِمِينَ (٣٣)

"And who is better in speech than he who invites to Allah, and does righteous deeds, and says: "I am one of the Muslims." (Fussilat 41:33)

This verse establishes a three-part criterion for the caller: Inspiration (inviting to Allah), Consistency (doing righteous deeds), and Identity (humbly submitting as a Muslim).

The most challenging aspect of representing Islam is dealing with opposition. Allah provides a psychological masterclass in conflict resolution, commanding us to respond to negativity with its opposite

وَلَا تَسْتَوِى ٱلْحَسَنَةُ وَلَا ٱلسَّيِّئَةُ ۚ ٱدْفَعْ بِٱلَّتِى هِىَ أَحْسَنُ فَإِذَا ٱلَّذِى بَيْنَكَ وَبَيْنَهُۥ عَدَٰوَةٌ كَأَنَّهُۥ وَلِىٌّ حَمِيمٌ (٣٤)

The good deed and the evil deed are not equal. Repel the evil deed with one which is better, then verily; he, between whom and you there was enmity, (will become) as he was a close friend. (Fussilat 41: 34)

By refusing to mirror anger or malice, the believer breaks the cycle of animosity. This proactive kindness (Idfa') has the power to melt hearts, turning a staunch enemy into a "close friend" (Waliyyun Hamim/ وَلِىٌّ حَمِيمٌ).

Allah acknowledges that this restraint is difficult, requiring a specific spiritual maturity:

وَمَا يُلَقَّىٰهَآ إِلَّا ٱلَّذِينَ صَبَرُوا۟ وَمَا يُلَقَّىٰهَآ إِلَّا ذُو حَظٍّ عَظِيمٍ (٣٥)

But none is granted it except those who are patient - and none is granted it except the owner of the great fortune (of soul)." (41:35)

To respond to an insult with a prayer or kindness is a sign of "great fortune." It indicates a heart so rich in its connection to Allah that it no longer needs to defend its own ego. To protect this state, one must guard against the "whispers" of the ego and Satan that urge revenge:

وَإِمَّا يَنزَغَنَّكَ مِنَ ٱلشَّيْطَـٰنِ نَزْغٌ فَٱسْتَعِذْ بِٱللَّهِ ۚ إِنَّهُۥ هُوَ ٱلسَّمِيعُ ٱلْعَلِيمُ (٣٦)

"And if a whisper from the devil reaches you then seek refuge in Allah. Indeed. He is the All-Hearer, the All-Knower." (Fussilat 41:36)

By seeking refuge, the believer pauses. They recognize that anger is a distraction from their mission, allowing them to return to a state of peace and continue inviting others through their conduct. Character is the "silent Dawah", it is the patient response to mistreatment that reaches the soul and transforms enemies into allies.

Conclusion

As we reflect on these ten Jewels, a clear theme emerges: the inseparable link between the Microcosm (the human heart) and the Macrocosm (the universe).

From the biological "Internal Operating System" that manages our sleep to the vast geological "Endowment" that provides for billions of people, the twenty-fourth Juz reminds us that we are part of a meticulously managed divine system. Whether it is the subtle linguistic difference of a single letter (Waw) describing the gates of Paradise, or the celestial support of the Throne-bearing angels, every verse invites us to move from a state of heedlessness to one of deep reflection (Tafakkur).

Ultimately, these Jewels teach us that when we give Allah His true Qadr (Status) and approach Him with a heart of Ikhlas (Sincerity), the "Spirit of the Command" transforms our lives, leading us from darkness into light.

Jewels from the Twenty-Fifth Juz: From the Inner Cosmos of the Soul to the Collective Unity of the Ummah

(Fussilat 41:47 to Al-Jathiya 45:37)

Introduction

The twenty-fifth Juz of the Qur'an, comprising Surahs Fuṣṣilat, Ash-Shura, Az-Zukhruf, Ad-Dukhan, and Al-Jathiyah, offers a comprehensive architectural framework for the believer's life. It bridges the inner world of faith and consciousness with the external realities of family, society, and civilization.

Across these surahs, the Qur'an moves seamlessly from the linguistic depth of revelation, its capacity to unfold meaning across generations, to the practical ethics that govern human relationships and communal life. It addresses the individual heart, the structure of the family, the unity of the Ummah, and the trajectory of humanity toward its final return to Allah.

This chapter explores ten interconnected themes that speak directly to the enduring challenges of every age. It begins with the Qur'an as a dynamic and ever-unfolding miracle, examines the roots and remedies of division, and culminates in the realities of accountability and the signs that precede the Last Hour.

Through this journey, the Qur'an emerges not as a historical record, but as a living guide, a Shariah that provides a clear and enduring path for navigating the complexities of both this world and the Hereafter.

1. The Everlasting Miracle – Science and Revelation

Allah affirms that the miracle of Qur'an is not static confined to a single era, but a living and dynamic miracle, one whose signs continue to unfold as human knowledge expands:

سَنُرِيهِمۡ ءَايَٰتِنَا فِى ٱلۡأَفَاقِ وَفِىٓ أَنفُسِهِمۡ حَتَّىٰ يَتَبَيَّنَ لَهُمۡ أَنَّهُ ٱلۡحَقُّۗ ..... (٥٣)

"We will show them Our signs in the horizons and within themselves until it becomes clear to them that it (the Quran) is the truth. …" (Fussilat 41: 53)

One of the most remarkable features of the Qur'an is its linguistic elasticity. Its verses communicate meaning at multiple levels simultaneously: they are accessible to the layperson, yet capable of revealing profound depths when examined through advancing human knowledge. As scientific understanding progresses, new dimensions of these verses become increasingly apparent, without exhausting their meaning. Consider the following examples:

The Expanding Universe: The Qur'an describes the nature of the cosmos in a manner that aligns with what modern cosmology has only recently discovered:

وَٱلسَّمَآءَ بَنَيْنَـٰهَا بِأَيْيْدٍ وَإِنَّا لَمُوسِعُونَ (٤٧)

"We have built the heaven (universe) with might, and indeed We are expanding it." (Al-Dhariyat 51:47)

Fluid Dynamics and Barriers: The meeting of distinct bodies of water, while maintaining their unique properties, is described with striking precision:

وَهُوَ ٱلَّذِى مَرَجَ ٱلْبَحْرَيْنِ هَـٰذَا عَذْبٌ فُرَاتٌ وَهَـٰذَا مِلْحٌ أُجَاجٌ وَجَعَلَ بَيْنَهُمَا بَرْزَخًا وَحِجْرًا مَّحْجُورًا (٥٣)

"**And He is the One who has released the two seas, one fresh and sweet and one salty and bitter; and He placed between them a barrier and a forbidding partition." (Al-Furqan 25:53)**

The Multilayered Earth and Heavens: The Qur'an points to a structured complexity in both the heavens and the earth.

اللَّهُ الَّذِي خَلَقَ سَبْعَ سَمَوَاتٍ وَمِنَ الْأَرْضِ مِثْلَهُنَّ يَتَنَزَّلُ الْأَمْرُ بَيْنَهُنَّ لِتَعْلَمُوا أَنَّ اللَّهَ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ قَدِيرٌ وَأَنَّ اللَّهَ قَدْ أَحَاطَ بِكُلِّ شَيْءٍ عِلْمًا

"Allah is the One Who created seven heavens and of the earth the like thereof (i.e. seven). His Command descends between them, that you may know that Allah has power over all things, and that Allah surrounds (comprehends) all things in (His) Knowledge." (Al-Talaq 65:12)

The Motion of the Earth: While mountains appear static to human perception, the Quran alludes to their continuous motion, consistent with the rotation of the Earth:

وَتَرَى ٱلْجِبَالَ تَحْسَبُهَا جَامِدَةً وَهِىَ تَمُرُّ مَرَّ ٱلسَّحَابِ صُنْعَ ٱللَّهِ ٱلَّذِىٓ أَتْقَنَ كُلَّ شَىْءٍ ... (٨٨)

"And you will see the mountains, thinking them still, while they pass as the passing of the clouds; (such is) the making of Allah, Who perfected all things …." (Al-Naml 27:88)

These examples are not isolated observations; rather, they illustrate a consistent pattern: the Qur'an speaks in a manner that transcends the scientific capacity of its first audience while remaining continuously relevant to later generations.

Thus, the miracle of the Qur'an is not limited to its initial impact upon the Arabs of the 7th century. Instead, it renews itself across time, inviting every generation to rediscover its signs in light of their own expanding horizons of knowledge.

While these correspondences are deeply meaningful, the harmony between revelation and observed reality should be seen not as forced alignment, but as an invitation to contemplation, where the advancement of knowledge becomes a means of deepening certainty in the truth of the Qur'an, rather than restricting its meaning.

2. Prohibition of Using Religion as a pretext for creating division

A central command of the Quran is the strict prohibition against using divine revelation as a tool for creating division among believers. This mandate was not unique to the Final Revelation; rather, it is a foundational principle shared across the missions of all the messengers of Allah, particularly the Ulul ‘Azm/(أولى العزم من الرسل) (the most resolute messengers): Nuh, Ibrahim, Musa, Isa, and Muhammad (peace be upon them all).

شَرَعَ لَكُم مِّنَ ٱلدِّينِ مَا وَصَّىٰ بِهِۦ نُوحًا وَٱلَّذِىٓ أَوۡحَيۡنَآ إِلَيۡكَ وَمَا وَصَّيۡنَا بِهِۦٓ إِبۡرَٰهِيمَ وَمُوسَىٰ وَعِيسَىٰٓۖ أَنۡ أَقِيمُواْ ٱلدِّينَ وَلَا تَتَفَرَّقُواْ فِيهِۚ (١٣)

“He (Allah) has ordained for you the same religion which He ordained for Nuh (Noah), and that which We have revealed to you (O Muhammad), and that which We ordained for Ibrahim (Abraham), Musa (Moses) and Isa (Jesus) saying you should establish the religion and make no divisions in it.” (Ash-Shura 42:13)

This verse establishes a profound reality: the essence of Allah’s religion is one. Therefore, no fundamental division should exist among those who follow His guidance. Yet, history, and present reality, demonstrates the opposite: divisions persist not only between followers of different prophets, but even among those who claim allegiance to the same messenger.

The Qur’an identifies the true roots of such division, not ignorance, but moral and social corruption. It explicitly states that fragmentation occurs even after knowledge has been made clear:

وَمَا تَفَرَّقُوٓاْ إِلَّا مِنۢ بَعۡدِ مَا جَآءَهُمُ ٱلۡعِلۡمُ بَغۡيَۢا بَيۡنَهُمۡۚ .... (١٤)

“And they did not divide till after knowledge had come to them, through transgression between themselves. …..” (Ash-Shura 42:14)

Thus, division is not primarily an intellectual failure, it is a moral one. The Qur’an attributes it to baghy (بغي): transgression, rivalry, and the pursuit of dominance. This manifests in several recurring patterns:

- Claims of Superiority: One group asserting exclusive salvation or inherent superiority over others.
- Exploitation by Leaders: Corrupt or self-serving leaders weaponizing religion to secure wealth, influence, or political power.
- Blind Following: The manipulation of sincere but uninformed followers, leading them to sacrifice their lives, resources, and loyalty for causes that ultimately serve human agendas rather than divine truth.

Despite this, the Qur’an also affirms a critical principle: Allah preserves human freedom of choice. He does not immediately punish those who create division or deviate from guidance. Instead, His decree allows for a delay in judgment:

...وَلَوۡلَا كَلِمَةٞ سَبَقَتۡ مِن رَّبِّكَ إِلَىٰٓ أَجَلٖ مُّسَمّٗى لَّقُضِيَ بَيۡنَهُمۡۚ

"...And had it not been for a Word that went forth before from your Lord for an appointed term, the matter would have been settled between them." (Ash-Shura 42:14)

This delay is itself a manifestation of divine mercy. If accountability were immediate, humanity would not withstand its consequences. Instead, the "appointed term" represents a window of opportunity, extending throughout one's life, for reflection, correction, repentance, and ultimately, a return to unity.

In this light, the Qur'anic call is not merely to avoid division in form, but to purify the inner motives that give rise to it. True unity is not achieved through uniformity of labels, but through sincerity in seeking the truth and submission to Allah alone.

Division is not a sign of strength; it is a deviation from revelation. And unity is not achieved by claiming the truth, but by humbly submitting to it.

3. The Key Means to Eliminate Division

To dismantle the structures of division, believers must adopt specific ethical principles and behaviors designed to preserve unity and protect the integrity of the community.

The foremost safeguard against division is a firm commitment to revelation over the shifting whims (ahw'a') of human desire. Those who reject truth often do so not from lack of knowledge, but because they elevate their desires to the status of ultimate authority, effectively treating them as their "god."

أَفَرَءَيۡتَ مَنِ ٱتَّخَذَ إِلَٰهَهُۥ هَوَىٰهُ وَأَضَلَّهُ ٱللَّهُ عَلَىٰ عِلۡمٖ وَخَتَمَ عَلَىٰ سَمۡعِهِۦ وَقَلۡبِهِۦ وَجَعَلَ عَلَىٰ بَصَرِهِۦ غِشَٰوَةٗ فَمَن يَهۡدِيهِ مِنۢ بَعۡدِ ٱللَّهِۚ أَفَلَا تَذَكَّرُونَ (٢٣)

"Have you seen the one who takes his desire as his god, and Allah has let him go astray knowingly, and sealing his hearing and his heart, and placing a veil over his sight? Who then can guide him after Allah? Will you not then reflect?" (Al-Jathiya 45:23)

When desire becomes the source of guidance, the heart becomes sealed. To counter this, Allah provides a clear and comprehensive roadmap:

فَلِذَٰلِكَ فَٱدۡعُۖ وَٱسۡتَقِمۡ كَمَآ أُمِرۡتَۖ وَلَا تَتَّبِعۡ أَهۡوَآءَهُمۡۖ وَقُلۡ ءَامَنتُ بِمَآ أَنزَلَ ٱللَّهُ مِن كِتَٰبٖۖ وَأُمِرۡتُ لِأَعۡدِلَ بَيۡنَكُمُۖ ٱللَّهُ .... (١٥)

"So, to this you must invite, and remain steadfast as you are commanded, and do not follow their desires, and say: I believe in whatever Allah has revealed of the Book, and I am commanded to be just among you…." (Ash-Shura 42:15)

This verse outlines a fourfold framework for preserving unity:

- Invite (ادعُ): Continuously call people back to the essence of the faith, not to factions or personalities.
- Remain Steadfast (استقم): Embody consistency in belief and action, becoming a model of principled conduct.
- Reject Bias: Resist being drawn into partisan loyalties driven by desire rather than truth.
- Uphold Justice (لأعدل بينكم): Maintain fairness toward all, regardless of affiliation, ensuring that justice prevails over group interest.

In addition to these individual qualities, the Qur'an establishes a collective mechanism to manage differences: shura (mutual consultation).

وَٱلَّذِينَ ٱسۡتَجَابُواْ لِرَبِّهِمۡ وَأَقَامُواْ ٱلصَّلَوٰةَ وَأَمۡرُهُمۡ شُورَىٰ بَيۡنَهُمۡ وَمِمَّا رَزَقۡنَٰهُمۡ يُنفِقُونَ (٣٨)

"And those who respond to their Lord, establish prayer, conduct their affairs through mutual consultation, and spend from what We have provided them." (Ash-Shura 42:38)

Shura functions as a preventive system: it allows اختلاف (differences) to be expressed, examined, and resolved before they escalate into conflict. It transforms disagreement from a source of division into a process of collective wisdom.

It is a common misconception that unity requires complete uniformity. The Qur'an corrects this by affirming that diversity itself is part of the divine design:

وَلَوۡ شَآءَ ٱللَّهُ لَجَعَلَهُمۡ أُمَّةٗ وَٰحِدَةٗ (٨)

"And if Allah had willed, He could have made them one (single) nation." (Ash-Shura 42:8)

Since diversity is intentional, اختلاف (difference) is natural. The danger lies not in اختلاف itself, but in how it is managed.

To prevent اختلاف from devolving into destructive division, Allah establishes the ultimate principle of resolution:

وَمَا ٱخۡتَلَفۡتُمۡ فِيهِ مِن شَيۡءٖ فَحُكۡمُهُۥٓ إِلَى ٱللَّهِۚ (١٠)

"And in whatsoever you differ, its judgment rests with Allah." (Ash-Shura 42:10)

This principle places a necessary limit on human claims. No individual or group has the authority to declare themselves the exclusive possessors of truth or the sole inheritors of salvation. The ultimate judgment of people rests with Allah alone.

Recognizing this boundary curbs arrogance, neutralizes sectarian absolutism, and opens the door for coexistence grounded in humility and shared devotion.

Unity is not the absence of differences, it is the discipline of managing them with justice, humility, and submission to Allah.

4. Addressing Domestic Discord: Divine Decree in Family Life

A significant source of conflict and emotional strain within families arises from misconceptions surrounding childbirth, particularly when a couple is unable to conceive or when they are granted only daughters. In many societies, this burden is unjustly placed upon the wife, leading to tension, emotional harm, and even family breakdown.

The Qur'an decisively removes the foundation for such disputes by establishing that procreation and gender are matters of divine decree alone, completely beyond human control. Allah states

لِّلَّهِ مُلْكُ ٱلسَّمَٰوَٰتِ وَٱلْأَرْضِ ۚ يَخْلُقُ مَا يَشَآءُ ۚ يَهَبُ لِمَن يَشَآءُ إِنَٰثًا وَيَهَبُ لِمَن يَشَآءُ ٱلذُّكُورَ (٤٩) أَوْ يُزَوِّجُهُمْ ذُكْرَانًا وَإِنَٰثًا ۖ وَيَجْعَلُ مَن يَشَآءُ عَقِيمًا ۚ إِنَّهُۥ عَلِيمٌ قَدِيرٌ (٥٠) ۞

"To Allah belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth; He creates what He wills. He grants to whom He wills females, and He grants to whom He wills males. (49) Or He grants both males and females, and He renders whom He wills barren. Indeed, He is All-Knowing, All-Powerful." (Ash-Shura 42:49-50)

These verses outline four distinct outcomes of parenthood, forming a complete framework for understanding family circumstances:

1. The Gift of Daughters: Mentioned first in the verse, elevating the status of female children in a society that historically devalued them.
2. The Gift of Sons: Equally a manifestation of divine grace.
3. The Gift of Both: A balanced provision, reflecting divine generosity.
4. The State of Barrenness: Defined not as a "failure" or deficiency, but a deliberate decree from Al-Alim (the All-Knowing) and Al-Qadir (the All-Powerful).

By framing all possibilities as acts of divine will, the Qur'an removes any basis for blame, shame, or resentment between spouses.

To use these outcomes as a justification for conflict, whether through emotional abuse, social pressure, or even divorce, is, in reality, a rejection of divine wisdom. It transforms what Allah has defined as decree into a human accusation.

Instead, such situations are meant to cultivate higher spiritual qualities:

- Ṣabr (patience) in facing trials,
- Riḍa (contentment) with Allah's decree, and
- Mutual support within the family unit.

From a scientific perspective, this Qur'anic principle is further reinforced: the biological determination of a child's gender is linked to the chromosomal contribution of the father. Thus, the cultural practice of blaming the mother is not only theologically unfounded, but also scientifically incorrect.

When these truths are internalized, a major source of domestic tension is removed. In its place emerges a family environment grounded in acceptance, compassion, and shared submission to the will of Allah. Peace in the home begins when blame ends and faith in Allah's decree begins.

5. The Universality of Islam and the Centrality of Mecca

While the core message of Islam is consistent across all messengers, the Final Revelation is distinguished by its universal scope. Previous scriptures were directed to specific communities and nations, whereas the Qur'an is addressed to all of humanity. Allah states:

وَكَذَٰلِكَ أَوۡحَيۡنَآ إِلَيۡكَ قُرۡءَانًا عَرَبِيّٗا لِّتُنذِرَ أُمَّ ٱلۡقُرَىٰ وَمَنۡ حَوۡلَهَا وَتُنذِرَ يَوۡمَ ٱلۡجَمۡعِ لَا رَيۡبَ فِيهِۚ فَرِيقٞ فِي ٱلۡجَنَّةِ وَفَرِيقٞ فِي ٱلسَّعِيرِ (٧)

Thus, We have revealed to you an Arabic Qur'an so that you may warn the " Mother of the Towns (Makkah) and all those around it, and warn of the Day of Gathering, about which there is no doubt, when a group will be in Paradise and a group in the Blaz." (Ash-Shura 42:7)

This verse identifies Makkah as the spiritual and geographical center of the final message, *Umm al-Qura* (the Mother of Towns). The expression "and all those around it" (وَمَنۡ حَوۡلَهَا) extends beyond a local or regional scope. Classical and contemporary scholarships understand it as encompassing all of humanity. Thus, Makkah is not merely a city; it is the point from which divine guidance radiates to the entire world.

An essential feature of this universal message is its accessibility. The Qur'an describes itself as *'Arabiyyan* (عَرَبِيًّا), which signifies more than linguistic identity, it denotes clarity, precision, and intelligibility.

- 'Arabi (عربي): Derived from a root conveying clarity, expression, and articulation.
- A'jami (أعجمي)**:** That which is unclear, indistinct, or difficult to comprehend.

By describing the Qur'an as *'Arabiyyan*, Allah emphasizes that the message has been made clear and accessible to human understanding, removing ambiguity and eliminating any excuse for ignorance.

<u>Contemporary Application: The Unified Calendar</u>

The designation of Makkah as *Umm al-Qura* carries practical implications for the global Muslim Ummah. Some scholars and contemporary jurists have drawn upon this concept to advocate for a unified Islamic calendar. They argue that since Makkah serves as the spiritual center of Islam, and the focal point of Hajj, particularly the Day of Arafah, its lunar observations could serve as a unifying reference for determining the beginning and end of Ramadan and the dates of the two Eids.

Such an approach seeks to translate the universality of Islam into lived unity, allowing the Ummah to fast, celebrate, and worship as a single body, transcending geographical divisions.

A universal message calls for a united response, and Makkah remains the heart that gathers the Ummah into one direction, one purpose, and one destiny.

6. The Grave Loss: The Reality of Divine Abandonment

The most precarious state a human being can reach is to be abandoned by Allah. When a person is left entirely to themselves, cut off from divine support, they lose their only true protector and guide.

وَمَنْ يُضْلِلْ اللَّهُ فَمَا لَهُ مِنْ وَلِيٍّ مِنْ بَعْدِهِ وَتَرَى الظَّالِمِينَ لَمَّا رَأَوْا الْعَذَابَ يَقُولُونَ هَلْ إِلَى مَرَدٍّ مِنْ سَبِيلٍ

"And whoever Allah allows to stray, there is no protector for him after Him. And you will see the wrongdoers, when they see the punishment, saying: 'Is there any way to return?" (Ash-Shura 42:44)

At first glance, this verse may give rise to a critical misunderstanding: that Allah arbitrarily withholds guidance from some people, effectively forcing them into misguidance. Such an interpretation contradicts the foundational Qur'anic principles of Divine Justice ('Adl) and Mercy (Raḥmah).

In reality, Allah's guidance is universally extended through two primary channels:

1. Al-Fiṭrah (الفطرة): The innate, pure disposition embedded within every human being.
2. The Messengers and Revelation: External guidance that clarifies, confirms, and preserves the truth recognized by the fiṭrah.

Just as Allah has established physical laws governing the universe, He has also established spiritual laws (*sunan*) governing human behavior and its consequences. Divine abandonment is not arbitrary, it is the final stage of a process in which a person persistently rejects truth, suppresses their fiṭrah, and turns away from revelation.

Thus, Allah does not force misguidance upon anyone. Rather, when individuals repeatedly choose falsehood, they become unfit for divine support that enables guidance to take root in the heart.

The Qur'an explicitly identifies categories of people whose consistent actions lead to the withdrawal of this special guidance:

- The Wrongdoers (الظالمون – Al-Zalimin), those who violate the rights of others and the truth.: (وَاللَّهُ لَا يَهْدِي الْقَوْمَ الظَّالِمِينَ) **"Allah does not guide the unjust/wrong doers".** (Al-Baqarah 258, Al-Imran 86, Al-Maeda 51, Al-An'am 144, Al-Tuba 19, Al-Tuba 109, Al-Qasas 50, Al-Ahqaf 10, Al-Saf 7, Al-Jumma 5).

- The Rebellious (الفاسقون – Al-Fasiqin), those who defiantly break their covenant with Allah: (وَاللَّهُ لَا يَهْدِي الْقَوْمَ الْفَاسِقِينَ) **(All does not guide the rebellious).** (Al-Maeda 108, Al-Tuba 24, Al-Tuba 80. Al-Saff 5, Al-Munafeqoon 6)

- The Disbelievers (الكافرون – Al-Kafirin), those who actively cover up the truth: (وَاللَّهُ لَا يَهْدِي الْقَوْمَ الْكَافِرِينَ) **"Allah does not guide the disbelievers/those who reject faith"**. (Al-Baqarah 264, Al-Tuba 37, Al-Nahl 107, Al-Maeda 67)

- The Betrayers (الخائنون – Al-Kha'inin), those who act with treachery and deceit. (وَأَنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يَهْدِي كَيْدَ الْخَائِنِينَ) **"Indeed, Allah does not guide the snare the betrayers, (Yusuf 12:52)**

- The Liars and Transgressors (كذّاب مسرف - Kadhib, Musrif), those who live in falsehood and excess. (إِنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يَهْدِي مَنْ هُوَ مُسْرِفٌ كَذَّابٌ) **"Indeed, Allah does not guide the extravagant, the liar." (Ghafer 40:28)**

These categories are not defined by isolated mistakes, but by persistent patterns of behavior. The door of repentance remains open, but when rejection becomes habitual and deliberate, the consequence is the gradual withdrawal of divine support. In this light, "misguidance" is not imposed, it is the natural outcome of sustained resistance to guidance.

The greatest loss is not ignorance but being left without Allah's guidance after knowing the truth.

7. Firmness on the Straight Path and the Reality of Power

Maintaining steadfastness (istiqāmah) is a fundamental requirement for those who carry the message of the Qur'an. Consistency in belief and character is what gives credibility to that message in the eyes of others. Allah commands the Prophet ﷺ—and by extension, all believers to hold firmly to revelation, regardless of external pressure:

فَٱسْتَمْسِكْ بِٱلَّذِىٓ أُوحِىَ إِلَيْكَ ۖ إِنَّكَ عَلَىٰ صِرَٰطٍ مُّسْتَقِيمٍ (٤٣) وَإِنَّهُۥ لَذِكْرٌ لَّكَ وَلِقَوْمِكَ ۖ وَسَوْفَ تُسْـَٔلُونَ (٤٤)
"So, hold firmly to that which is revealed to you. Indeed, you are on the Straight Path. (43) And indeed, this (the Quran) is a reminder for you and your people and all of you will be questioned (about it)." (Az-Zukhuruf 43:43:44)

This dhikr (reminder) is both an honor and a responsibility. Being "questioned" implies that belief alone is insufficient; the message must be embodied in conduct, especially in interactions with those who oppose or disagree.

Accordingly, when confronted with hostility or false arguments, the Qur'anic response is not retaliation, but dignity and restraint:

فَٱصۡفَحۡ عَنۡهُمۡ وَقُلۡ سَلَٰمٞۚ فَسَوۡفَ يَعۡلَمُونَ (٨٩)

“So, forgive them and say: Salam (peace)! For they will come to know (the result of their attitude).” (Az-Zukhuruf 43:89)

Forgiveness, coupled with a peaceful disengagement, preserves the dignity of the believer and prevents النزاع (conflict) from descending into ego-driven confrontation. It also leaves space for reflection, free from the noise of hostility.

The Reality of Perception and Power

While believers are instructed not to be attracted by materialism, the Qur’anic worldview does not ignore sociological realities. When the followers of truth appear weak, divided, or impoverished, it can create a psychological barrier that prevents others from embracing the message.

People are often influenced not only by truth itself, but by the condition of those who claim to uphold it. This reality is illustrated in the encounter between the Prophet ﷺ and Oday ibn Hatim (عدي بن حاتم), a tribal leader who hesitated to accept Islam due to three perceived weaknesses:

1. Poverty of the Muslims
2. Insecurity and constant threats
3. Lack of political power and authority

The Prophet ﷺ addressed each concern with clarity and prophetic certainty:

- **“O ‘Odiay perhaps what prevents you from entering this religion is what you see of their poverty. By Allah, wealth will soon become abundant among them until no one remains to accept it.**
- **And perhaps what prevents you is what you see of their many enemies and their small number. By Allah, you will soon hear of a woman traveling from al-Qdisiyyah to this House (the Ka‘bah), fearing none but Allah.**
- **And perhaps what prevents you is that you see power and authority in the hands of others. By Allah, you will soon hear of the white palaces of Babylon being opened to them.”**

Oday later testified that he witnessed the fulfillment of the first two promises and had absolute certainty in the third.

لعلك يا عدي إنما يمنعك من دخول في هذا الدين ما ترى من حاجتهم ، فوالله ليوشكن المال أن يفيض فيهم حتى لا يوجد من يأخده ؛ ولعلك إنما يمنعك من دخول فيه ما ترى من كثرة عدوهم وقلة عددهم ، فوالله ليوشكن أن تسمع بالمرأة تخرج من القادسية على بعيرها (حتى) تزور هذا البيت ، لا تخاف ؛ ولعلك إنما يمنعك من دخول فيه أنك ترى أن الملك والسلطان في غيرهم ، وايم الله ليوشكن أن تسمع بالقصور البيض من أرض بابل قد فتحت عليهم ؛ قال : فأسلمت. فكان عدي يقول : مضت اثنتان ، وبقيت الثالثة ، والله لتكونن ، قد رأيت القصور البيض من أرض بابل قد فتحت عليهم ، وقد رأيت المرأة تخرج من القادسية على بعيرها ولا تخاف حتى تحج هذا البيت ، وايم الله لتكونن الثالثة ، ليفيض المال حتى لا يوجد من يأخذه]}. المحدث : ابن كثير | المصدر : البداية والنهاية الصفحة أو الرقم : 5/57 التخريج : أخرجه ابن سعد في ((الطبقات الكبرى - متمم الصحابة)) (2/ 642) والطبراني في ((المعجم الأوسط)) (6614) بنحوه، والترمذي (2953) وأحمد (18260) مختصرا بمعناه{

These promises are not merely historical predictions; they establish a recurring principle:

- Material weakness can obscure the visibility of truth.
- Strength, when grounded in guidance, removes barriers to belief.

Thus, strengthening the socioeconomic condition of the Muslim community is not a pursuit of worldly excess, but a means of enabling the truth to be seen without distortion. Neglecting resources does not eliminate their influence, it simply allows them to be used by others, often against the very values Islam seeks to uphold.

Steadfastness preserves the truth within, but strength allows the truth to be seen.

8. The Major Signs: Divine Warnings and Human Preparedness

The Qur'an warns that the approach of the Last Hour will be marked by profound and unmistakable events, signs that serve both as warnings and as decisive tests for humanity. Among these is the emergence of a "visible smoke" (Dukhan Mubin), described as a phenomenon that will affect all people:

بَلۡ هُمۡ فِی شَكّٖ یَلۡعَبُونَ (٩) فَٱرۡتَقِبۡ یَوۡمَ تَأۡتِی ٱلسَّمَآءُ بِدُخَانٖ مُّبِینٖ (١٠) یَغۡشَی ٱلنَّاسَۖ هَٰذَا عَذَابٌ أَلِیمٌ (١١)

"Yet, they are in doubt, playing. (9) So, watch for the Day when the sky will bring visible smoke. (10) that will envelop the people; this is a painful punishment." (Al-Dukhan 44:9-11)

Islamic tradition identifies several "Major Signs" (Al-Alamat al-Kubra) that precede the Hour. While the Hadith literature details several, including the Dajjal and the rising of the sun from the West, the Quran explicitly highlights three: The Smoke (Al-Dukhan), The Beast (Dabbat al-Ard/ دابة الأرض), and Gog and Magog (Ya'juj wa Ma'juj/يأجوج ومأجوج).

Islamic tradition speaks of major signs (*Al-Alamat al-Kubra*) that precede the Hour. While the Hadith literature elaborates on several of these signs—such as the Dajjal and the rising of the sun from the west, the Qur'an explicitly highlights key phenomena, including:

- The Smoke (الدخان)
- The Beast of the Earth (دابة الأرض)
- Gog and Magog (يأجوج ومأجوج)

These are not abstract symbols; they are presented as real events with profound implications for human existence.

A common misconception is that the signs of the Hour are to be awaited passively. However, a deeper Qur'anic reading suggests that they are meant to awaken preparedness, both spiritually and materially.

If we consider scholarly interpretations that understand the "smoke" as a widespread, enveloping phenomenon, it raises critical questions for Muslims:

- **Agricultural Resilience:** If sunlight were significantly obstructed, traditional agriculture would be disrupted. This calls for the development of alternative systems, such as controlled-environment agriculture and hydroponics, to ensure the preservation of life.
- **Technological Contingency:** A global atmospheric disruption could affect communication systems, satellites, and digital infrastructure. Are communities prepared to function through resilient, decentralized, or non-digital systems?
- **Civilizational Ethics:** The Qur'an repeatedly links destruction to moral corruption, *ẓulm* (injustice), *baghy* (transgression), and فساد (corruption on earth). These signs may thus reflect not only physical disruption, but the culmination of a deeper ethical crisis.

The importance of engaging with the future is rooted in the famous Hadith of Jibril. When Jibril (عليه السلام) questioned the Prophet ﷺ, the discussion encompassed four essential dimensions of the Din:

- **Islam:** The outward acts of worship and law
- **Iman:** The core beliefs
- **Ihsan:** Spiritual excellence and awareness of Allah
- **As-Sa'ah (the Hour):** Its reality and its signs

The inclusion of the Hour and its signs within this foundational framework indicates that awareness of the future is not peripheral, it is integral to the Islamic worldview.

However, this awareness is not about predicting *when* events will occur. Rather, it is about preparing for *how* to respond, maintaining faith, stability, and ethical integrity in times of profound disruption.

The signs of the Hour are not given to alarm us, but to prepare us.

9. Accountability: The Personal and Collective Record

Allah warns those who reject His message of the undeniable reality they will face when the Hour is established. This judgment is not based on assumption or hearsay, but on a precise and undeniable record of reality itself.

وَلِلَّهِ مُلْكُ ٱلسَّمَٰوَٰتِ وَٱلْأَرْضِ وَيَوْمَ تَقُومُ ٱلسَّاعَةُ يَوْمَئِذٍ يَخْسَرُ ٱلْمُبْطِلُونَ (٢٧) وَتَرَىٰ كُلَّ أُمَّةٍ جَاثِيَةً كُلُّ أُمَّةٍ تُدْعَىٰٓ إِلَىٰ كِتَٰبِهَا ٱلْيَوْمَ تُجْزَوْنَ مَا كُنتُمْ تَعْمَلُونَ (٢٨) هَٰذَا كِتَٰبُنَا يَنطِقُ عَلَيْكُم بِٱلْحَقِّ إِنَّا كُنَّا نَسْتَنسِخُ مَا كُنتُمْ تَعْمَلُونَ (٢٩)

To Allah belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth, and the Day when the Hour will take place. On that Day the followers of falsehood will lose. (27) And you will see every nation kneeling (in anticipation). Every nation will be called to its record: "This Day you will be recompensed for all what you used to do. (28) "This is Our record that speaks about you in all truth: Indeed, We were having transcribed whatever you used to do." (Al-Jathiya 45:27-29)

A profound linguistic nuance exists in the word نَسْتَنسِخُ (nastansikh). While often translated as "We record" or "We transcribe," the root in Arabic conveys the meaning of producing an exact copy or replica, cloning.

This suggests that the “Book of Deeds” is not merely a written log, but a complete and faithful reproduction of one’s actions, leaving no room for denial or reinterpretation. It is as if reality itself is preserved and presented back to the individual with absolute precision.

Beyond the Individual: The Record of the Nation

While personal accountability is central to Islamic belief, these verses introduce a second dimension: collective accountability. The Qur’an portrays entire nations (*umam*) as being called to their records:

“Every nation will be called to its book…” This raises a critical question: Are individuals accountable not only for their private deeds, but also for the collective actions of the society they are part of? This perspective suggests multiple layers of responsibility:

- **Systemic Injustice:** To what extent does an individual share responsibility for the ظلم (injustice), corruption, or aggression carried out by their society?
- **The Silent Majority:** When a community collectively abandons divine guidance, silence or passive acceptance may itself become a form of participation.

Thus, accountability extends beyond the الفرد (individual) to the الأمة (community). This dual accountability can be likened to a comprehensive evaluation:

- **Individual Assessment:** Based on one’s personal actions, intentions, and efforts.
- **Collective Assessment:** Based on the outcomes of the group or society one contributes to.

Even if an individual fulfills their personal responsibilities, they may still bear a share in collective failure if they enabled, ignored, or did not strive to correct systemic wrongdoing. Conversely, collective success elevates all who contributed to it.

The Al-Fatihah Principle: Speaking as “We”

This collective identity is embedded in the very foundation of daily worship. In every unit of prayer, the believer recites:

إِيَّاكَ نَعْبُدُ وَإِيَّاكَ نَسْتَعِينُ

"You alone we worship, and You alone we ask for help." (Al-Fatiha 1:5)

The use of the plural “we” is not incidental, it reflects the reality that the believer is part of a larger Ummah. Guidance is sought collectively, and responsibility is shared collectively. If we ask for guidance as a community, then deviation as a community also carries shared consequences.

Following the presentation of records, both individual and collective, humanity will be divided based on its response to the truth:

فَأَمَّا ٱلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُواْ وَعَمِلُواْ ٱلصَّٰلِحَٰتِ فَيُدۡخِلُهُمۡ رَبُّهُمۡ فِي رَحۡمَتِهِۦۚ ذَٰلِكَ هُوَ ٱلۡفَوۡزُ ٱلۡمُبِينُ (٣٠) وَأَمَّا ٱلَّذِينَ كَفَرُوٓاْ أَفَلَمۡ تَكُنۡ ءَايَٰتِي تُتۡلَىٰ عَلَيۡكُمۡ فَٱسۡتَكۡبَرۡتُمۡ وَكُنتُمۡ قَوۡمٗا مُّجۡرِمِينَ (٣١)

“As for those who believed and did righteous deeds, their Lord will admit them to His mercy. That is the evident triumph. (30) But as for those who disbelieved (it will be said to them): Were My revelations not recited to you? But you showed arrogance and were a guilty people.” (Al-Jathiya 45:30-31)

It appears that our record is not only what you did alone, but what we allowed to be done around us.

10. The Protection of Believers: True Adornment vs. The Glitter

Surat Az-Zukhruf, named after "gold adornments" or "glitter", draws a powerful contrast between the fleeting luxuries of this world and the enduring honors of the Hereafter.

To demonstrate how insignificant worldly wealth is in the sight of Allah, He presents a striking hypothetical scenario:

وَلَوۡلَآ أَن يَكُونَ ٱلنَّاسُ أُمَّةٗ وَٰحِدَةٗ لَّجَعَلۡنَا لِمَن يَكۡفُرُ بِٱلرَّحۡمَٰنِ لِبُيُوتِهِمۡ سُقُفٗا مِّن فِضَّةٖ وَمَعَارِجَ عَلَيۡهَا يَظۡهَرُونَ (٣٣) وَلِبُيُوتِهِمۡ أَبۡوَٰبٗا وَسُرُرًا عَلَيۡهَا يَتَّكِـُٔونَ (٣٤) وَزُخۡرُفٗاۚ وَإِن كُلُّ ذَٰلِكَ لَمَّا مَتَٰعُ ٱلۡحَيَوٰةِ ٱلدُّنۡيَاۚ وَٱلۡأٓخِرَةُ عِندَ رَبِّكَ لِلۡمُتَّقِينَ (٣٥)

“Had it not been that mankind would become one community (of disbelievers), We would have provided for those who disbelieve in Al-Rahman, silver roofs for their houses, and (silver) stairs upon which they ascend, (33) And also for their houses, doors (of silver), and couches (of silver) on which they could recline, (34) And adornments of gold. Yet all this is nothing but an enjoyment of this worldly life. And the Hereafter with your Lord is (only) for the righteous.” (Az-Zukhuruf 43:33-35)

This verse reveals a profound reality: wealth itself is not a sign of divine favor. In fact, Allah indicates that He could have granted overwhelming material luxury to those who reject Him—were it not for the consequence that humanity would be collectively misled.

Thus, the current distribution of wealth is not arbitrary, it is a form of divine wisdom and protection. By limiting the visible dominance of material excess, Allah shields the hearts of believers from a trial that could overwhelm their faith.

Worldly wealth, no matter how dazzling, is described as متاع (mata‘) a temporary utility, not a lasting possession

The Qur’an then redirects the believer’s gaze from the silver and gold of this world to the true adornment of the Hereafter:

ٱدۡخُلُواْ ٱلۡجَنَّةَ أَنتُمۡ وَأَزۡوَٰجُكُمۡ تُحۡبَرُونَ (٧٠) يُطَافُ عَلَيۡهِم بِصِحَافٖ مِّن ذَهَبٖ وَأَكۡوَابٖۖ وَفِيهَا مَا تَشۡتَهِيهِ ٱلۡأَنفُسُ وَتَلَذُّ ٱلۡأَعۡيُنُۖ وَأَنتُمۡ فِيهَا خَٰلِدُونَ (٧١) وَتِلۡكَ ٱلۡجَنَّةُ ٱلَّتِيٓ أُورِثۡتُمُوهَا بِمَا كُنتُمۡ تَعۡمَلُونَ (٧٢)

“Enter Paradise, you and your spouses, in joy. (70) Circulated among them will be trays and cups of gold, and therein is whatever the souls desire and the eyes delight in, and you will abide therein eternally. (71) This is the Paradise which you have been made to inherit because of what you used to do. (Az-Zukhuruf 43:70-72)

Here, gold is no longer a test, it becomes an honor. What was once a distraction in الدنيا becomes a reward in الآخرة. Unlike worldly enjoyment, which is often followed by anxiety, competition, or loss, the pleasure of the Hereafter is complete, pure, and eternal, fulfilling both the soul and the senses without any نقصان (deficiency) or نهاية (end).

A Message for the Modern Believer

In an age defined by material display and constant comparison, the Qur’an calls the believer to see beyond the zukhruf, the glitter. No matter how advanced or abundant worldly wealth becomes, it remains finite and temporary. The true investment is not in what is possessed, but in what is preserved for the Hereafter.

The believer is thus invited to reframe life itself, not as a race for accumulation, but as a purposeful journey of deeds whose returns are eternal.

Do not be dazzled by what glitters, be guided by what endures.

Conclusion

The journey through Juz 25 leads to a unifying and transformative realization: every dimension of human existence, personal, familial, societal, and global, operates within the framework of Sunan Allah (divine laws).

We have seen that the greatest threat to human success is not ignorance, but the elevation of desire (hawa) above revelation. From this deviation emerge division, injustice, and the illusion of permanence in what is merely temporary, the zukhruf of worldly life.

In contrast, the Qur'an calls the believer to a higher path:

- To be future-aware, preparing not only for the certainty of the Hour, but for the conditions that precede it.
- To be socially responsible, recognizing that accountability extends beyond the individual to the collective.
- To be spiritually steadfast, anchoring the heart in what endures rather than what dazzles.

Ultimately, this Juz teaches that success lies in aligning oneself with divine guidance, in thought, in action, and in intention. May these reflections serve not merely as knowledge, but as direction: guiding us away from the grave loss of divine abandonment and toward the evident triumph of Allah's mercy.

Jewels from the Twenty Sixth Juz: From Individual Excellence to Global Stewardship

(Al-Ahqaf 46:1 to Adh-Dhariyat 51:30)

Introduction

The Twenty-Sixth Juz of the Qur'an marks a profound transition in the believer's journey, from the intimate sphere of the family to the expansive responsibility toward society and humanity at large. It begins by grounding the individual in the fundamental duty of honoring one's parents, then gradually broadens to define ethical conduct within the community and ultimately situates the believer as a witness to all of humanity.

Within these "Jewels," we explore the multifaceted nature of Taqwa, not as a static attribute, but as a dynamic and transformative force. It shapes how we engage with information, how we interact with others, how we manage wealth, and how we understand our purpose in life.

Through the guidance of Surah Al-Ahqaf, Surah Muhammad, Surah Al-Fath, Surah Al-Hujurat, Surah Qaf, and Surah Adh-Dhariyat, this Juz presents a comprehensive blueprint for a balanced life, one that harmonizes spiritual humility with intellectual clarity, and inner devotion with outward excellence.

1. The Obligation of Children towards their Parents

The Qur'an places immense emphasis on the obligation of children to honor and respect their parents, regardless of their parents' faith. In Surah Al-Ahqaf, Allah highlights a profound milestone: the age of forty. This stage represents a moment of deep reflection, when an individual becomes fully aware of the sacrifices made by their parents, especially the mother, who endured hardship in pregnancy, childbirth, and nursing.

A person's righteousness is reflected in their recognition of these parental rights and in their consistent supplication for them. In return, Allah promises reward for both the children and their parents.

وَوَصَّيْنَا ٱلْإِنسَـٰنَ بِوَٰلِدَيْهِ إِحْسَـٰنًا ۖ حَمَلَتْهُ أُمُّهُۥ كُرْهًا وَوَضَعَتْهُ كُرْهًا ۖ وَحَمْلُهُۥ وَفِصَـٰلُهُۥ ثَلَـٰثُونَ شَهْرًا ۚ حَتَّىٰٓ إِذَا بَلَغَ أَشُدَّهُۥ وَبَلَغَ أَرْبَعِينَ سَنَةً قَالَ رَبِّ أَوْزِعْنِىٓ أَنْ أَشْكُرَ نِعْمَتَكَ ٱلَّتِىٓ أَنْعَمْتَ عَلَىَّ وَعَلَىٰ وَٰلِدَىَّ وَأَنْ أَعْمَلَ صَـٰلِحًا تَرْضَىٰهُ وَأَصْلِحْ لِى فِى ذُرِّيَّتِىٓ ۖ إِنِّى تُبْتُ إِلَيْكَ وَإِنِّى مِنَ ٱلْمُسْلِمِينَ (١٥

"And We have commanded man to show excellence to his parents. His mother carried him with hardship and gave birth to him with hardship, and his gestation and weaning period is thirty months. When he reached maturity and reached forty years, he said, 'My Lord, enable me to be grateful for Your favor which You have bestowed upon me and upon my parents, and that I do righteous deeds that

please You, and make my offspring righteous. Indeed, I have repented to You, and indeed, I am of the Muslims." (Al-Ahqaf 46:15)

The age of forty is thus presented as the peak of intellectual and spiritual maturity. At this stage, a person should fully recognize their lifelong responsibilities, especially toward their parents. As a reward for fulfilling this duty, Allah declares His acceptance of such individuals:

أُوْلَـٰٓئِكَ ٱلَّذِينَ نَتَقَبَّلُ عَنۡهُمۡ أَحۡسَنَ مَا عَمِلُواْ وَنَتَجَاوَزُ عَن سَيِّـَٔاتِهِمۡ فِيٓ أَصۡحَـٰبِ ٱلۡجَنَّةِۖ وَعۡدَ ٱلصِّدۡقِ ٱلَّذِي كَانُواْ يُوعَدُونَ (١٦)

"Those are the ones from whom We will accept the best of what they did and overlook their misdeeds, [being] among the companions of Paradise. That is the promise of truth which they were promised." (Al-Ahqaf 46:16)

The duty of Birr (goodness/kindness) towards parents does not end with their death. A man once asked Prophet Muhammad (PBUH):

يا رسول الله هل بقي عليّ شيء مِن برِّ والديّ بعد موتهما ؟)

“O Messenger of Allah, is there any act of goodness remaining that I owe my parents after their death?”

The Prophet (PBUH) replied, **“Yes, four things:**

نعم ، أربعة أشياء ، أن تدعُوَ لهما كل يوم خمس مرات ، رب اغفر لي ولوالديّ ، رب ارحمهما كما ربَّياني صغيرًا وأن تصل صديقهما ، وأن تنفذ عهدهما ، وأن تصل الرَّحِمَ التي لم يكن لها صلة إلا بهما ، فهذا الذي بقي عليك مِن برِّهما بعد موتهما

1) **Supplication: Pray for them five times every day, saying: "My Lord, forgive me and my parents. My Lord, have mercy on them as they raised me when I was young."**
2) **Social Ties: Maintain relationships with their friends.**
3) **Legacy: Fulfill their promises and legal testaments.**
4) **Kinship: Uphold ties with family members who were only connected to you through them.**

This is what remains of your duty to honor them after their death. (Ahmad, Abu Dawood & Ibn Majah)

1. The Quran: A Revelation for Both Humans and Jinn

The Qur’an is a divine message addressed not only to humanity but also to the jinn. Both realms share the responsibility of receiving this guidance, internalizing it, and conveying it to their respective communities. In Surah Al-Ahqaf, Allah records the profound reaction of a group of jinn when they first heard the recitation of Prophet Muhammad ﷺ:

وَإِذۡ صَرَفۡنَآ إِلَيۡكَ نَفَرٗا مِّنَ ٱلۡجِنِّ يَسۡتَمِعُونَ ٱلۡقُرۡءَانَ فَلَمَّا حَضَرُوهُ قَالُوٓاْ أَنصِتُواْۖ فَلَمَّا قُضِيَ وَلَّوۡاْ إِلَىٰ قَوۡمِهِم مُّنذِرِينَ (٢٩)

"And (remember) when We sent towards you a group of the jinn, listening to the Quran, when they stood in its presence, they said: "Listen in silence!" And when it was finished, they returned to their people, as Warners. (Al-Ahqaf 46:29)

The response of the jinn represents a model of ideal engagement with revelation. They listened with complete attentiveness, observed proper etiquette during recitation, and, upon its completion, immediately assumed the role of conveyers of the message.

قَالُواْ يَٰقَوۡمَنَآ إِنَّا سَمِعۡنَا كِتَٰبًا أُنزِلَ مِنۢ بَعۡدِ مُوسَىٰ مُصَدِّقٗا لِّمَا بَيۡنَ يَدَيۡهِ يَهۡدِيٓ إِلَى ٱلۡحَقِّ وَإِلَىٰ طَرِيقٖ مُّسۡتَقِيمٖ (٣٠) يَٰقَوۡمَنَآ أَجِيبُواْ دَاعِيَ ٱللَّهِ وَءَامِنُواْ بِهِۦ يَغۡفِرۡ لَكُم مِّن ذُنُوبِكُمۡ وَيُجِرۡكُم مِّنۡ عَذَابٍ أَلِيمٖ (٣١)

"They said: " O our people! Indeed, we have heard a Book sent down after Musa, confirming what came before it. It guides to the truth and to a straight path. O our people! Respond to the caller of Allah and believe in him; He will forgive you of your sins and protect you from a painful punishment." (Al-Ahqaf 46:30-31)

Their words reflect both immediate conviction and a clear understanding of their responsibility to call others, demonstrating that true reception of revelation must lead to action and transmission.

The statements made by the Jinn highlight two profound theological points:

1. The Nature of Forgiveness**:** Their statement: "He will forgive you **of** your sins" (يَغْفِرْ لَكُم **مِّن** ذُنُوبِكُمْ) employs the preposition min (مِن), which suggests partiality rather than totality. This linguistic nuance has been noted by scholars to indicate that while Allah forgives sins related to His own rights through sincere repentance, violations involving the rights of others require restitution, reconciliation, or compensation. Thus, divine forgiveness operates within a framework of both mercy and justice.

2. The Absolute Sovereignty of Allah: The jinn further recognized that no being could escape the dominion of Allah. Power, intellect, and status offer no ultimate protection. Even the strongest individual may be rendered helpless by something as subtle as a microscopic clot. This realization reflects a deep awareness of human vulnerability and affirms that there is no refuge or protector except Allah.

Reflection on the Mention of Musa (Moses)

A striking feature of their statement is their reference to the Qur'an as a revelation sent after Musa, without mentioning Isa ibn Maryam, despite his chronological position between Musa and Muhammad (peace be upon them all).

This invites a deeper reflection on the nature of revelation. The Qur'an frequently describes what was given to Musa as "Al-Kitab" (The Book), a comprehensive legal and

societal framework. In contrast, what was given to Isa is often described as “Al-Bayyinat” (clear proofs or evidences:

وَءَاتَيۡنَا عِيسَى ٱبۡنَ مَرۡيَمَ ٱلۡبَيِّنَٰتِ

and We gave Jesus, son of Mary, clear proofs …” (Baqarah 2:87, 253)

This distinction may suggest that the Torah and the Qur’an share a structural role as complete legislative systems (Kutub), whereas the Injil is presented more as a confirmation, spiritual refinement, and moral illumination.

Thus, the jinn’s direct linkage of the Qur’an to the Torah, bypassing mention of the Injil, may reflect an awareness of this structural continuity between the two “Books.” It highlights a continuity of comprehensive guidance, governance, and law, inviting deeper exploration into how different forms of revelation function within the divine framework.

3. The Divine Law for Victory and Conflict

Surah Muhammad establishes a clear divine framework governing conduct during and after conflict. It outlines not only the ethics of engagement but also the treatment of prisoners of war, while defining a fundamental principle that may be described as the Law of Reciprocity in divine support.

The Qur’an provides explicit guidance on how to deal with adversaries once the intensity of battle subsides and victory is secured:

فَإِذَا لَقِيتُمُ ٱلَّذِينَ كَفَرُواْ فَضَرۡبَ ٱلرِّقَابِ حَتَّىٰٓ إِذَآ أَثۡخَنتُمُوهُمۡ فَشُدُّواْ ٱلۡوَثَاقَ فَإِمَّا مَنَّۢا بَعۡدُ وَإِمَّا فِدَآءً حَتَّىٰ تَضَعَ ٱلۡحَرۡبُ أَوۡزَارَهَاۚ ... (٤)

“So when you meet those who disbelieve [in battle], strike [their] necks until, when you have subdued them, then secure their bonds; thereafter, either [grant them] favor or ransom [them] until the war lays down its burdens…” (Muhammad 47:4)

This verse establishes two primary approaches for handling prisoners of war:

1. Grace (*Mannan*): Releasing them as an act of goodwill and mercy.
2. Ransom (*Fida*): Releasing them in exchange for compensation, including the return of Muslim prisoners.

It is significant that the verse explicitly limits the options to these two outcomes. The absence of enslavement as a stated option in this foundational directive invites careful reflection. While later juristic discussions incorporated prevailing historical norms and reciprocal practices between competing empires, the Qur’anic text itself emphasizes resolution through mercy or negotiated release.

The Law of Reciprocity

Allah establishes a clear and profound condition for receiving divine support:

يَـٰٓأَيُّهَا ٱلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوٓاْ إِن تَنصُرُواْ ٱللَّهَ يَنصُرۡكُمۡ وَيُثَبِّتۡ أَقۡدَامَكُمۡ (٧)

“O you who have believed, if you support Allah, He will support you and make your footing firm.” (Muhammad 47:7)

Although Allah is absolutely Self-Sufficient and in no need of assistance, “supporting Allah” signifies actively upholding His cause on earth. This responsibility is manifested in two central dimensions:

- Conveying the Message: Delivering the truth of Tawheed to humanity with clarity and sincerity.
- Establishing Justice: Striving to ensure that fairness, equity, and divine guidance govern human interactions.

The essence of this mission is powerfully captured in the statement of the companion Rib'i ibn Amer (ربعي بن عامر) during his encounter with Rostam, the commander of the Persian forces. When questioned about the purpose of the Muslim campaign, he replied:

الله ابتعثنا لنخرج من شاء من عبادة العباد إلى عبادة الله ,ومن ضيق الدنيا إلى سعة الآخرة ومن جور الأديان إلى عدل الإسلام

“Allah has sent us to bring forth whomever He wills from the worship of men to the worship of Allah, from the narrowness of this world to the vastness of the Hereafter, and from the injustice of (man-made) religions to the justice of Islam.”

Despite possessing absolute power to eliminate oppression instantly, Allah has ordained that believers engage in struggle. This is not due to necessity, but as a form of trial, a means to test sincerity, commitment, patience, and moral integrity.

Through this framework, conflict is not merely a physical encounter but a transformative process. It distinguishes between those who merely profess belief and those who actively uphold it, demonstrating that victory is not granted solely through strength, but through alignment with divine purpose.

4. Preservation Through Charity

Surah Muhammad concludes with a solemn warning to the believers, including the companions of the Prophet (PBUH), against miserliness. The message is clear: if they withhold their wealth and efforts in the cause of Allah, He is not in need of them. Rather, He is fully capable of replacing them with others who possess greater sincerity and readiness to sacrifice.

One of the primary means through which Allah tests the sincerity of faith is wealth. For many, financial security represents the ultimate attachment. The heart inevitably inclines toward what it treasures most. For this reason, the institution of Zakat, as one of the pillars of Islam, transforms financial sacrifice into a foundational expression of faith.

When a person is presented with an opportunity to give yet withholds, the loss is not to the cause of Allah, but to the individual themselves. Allah states:

هَٰٓأَنتُمۡ هَٰٓؤُلَآءِ تُدۡعَوۡنَ لِتُنفِقُواْ فِي سَبِيلِ ٱللَّهِ فَمِنكُم مَّن يَبۡخَلُۖ وَمَن يَبۡخَلۡ فَإِنَّمَا يَبۡخَلُ عَن نَّفۡسِهِۦۚ وَٱللَّهُ ٱلۡغَنِيُّ وَأَنتُمُ ٱلۡفُقَرَآءُۚ وَإِن تَتَوَلَّوۡاْ يَسۡتَبۡدِلۡ قَوۡمًا غَيۡرَكُمۡ ثُمَّ لَا يَكُونُوٓاْ أَمۡثَٰلَكُم (٣٨)

“Here you are, being invited to spend in the way of Allah; yet among you are those who are miserly. And whoever is miserly is only miserly toward himself. Allah is the Rich, while you are the poor. And if you turn away, He will replace you with another people; then they will not be the likes of you “(Muhammad 47:38)

This verse naturally caused concern among the companions, who asked, “O Messenger of Allah, who are these people Allah mentioned, those who would replace us if we turned away?”

At that moment, Salman al-Farisi (may Allah be pleased with him) was sitting beside the Prophet (PBUH). The Prophet (PBUH) struck Salman’s thigh and said:

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ، أ قَالَ قَالَ نَاسٌ مِنْ أَصْحَابِ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صلى الله عليه وسلم يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ مَنْ هَؤُلاَءِ الَّذِينَ ذَكَرَ اللَّهُ إِنْ تَوَلَّيْنَا اسْتُبْدِلُوا بِنَا ثُمَّ لَمْ يَكُونُوا أَمْثَالَنَا قَالَ وَكَانَ سَلْمَانُ بِجَنْبِ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صلى الله عليه وسلم قَالَ فَضَرَبَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صلى الله عليه وسلم فَخِذَ سَلْمَانَ قَالَ " هَذَا وَأَصْحَابُهُ وَالَّذِي نَفْسِي بِيَدِهِ لَوْ كَانَ الإِيمَانُ مَنُوطًا بِالثُّرَيَّا لَتَنَاوَلَهُ رِجَالٌ مِنْ فَارِسَ " .} أخرجه الترمذي (3261)

“This one and his people. By the One in Whose Hand is my soul, if faith were suspended near the Pleiades (the highest star), men from among these people would surely attain it.” (Al-Tirmidhi)

The reference to the people of Persia, the people of Salman, highlights a foundational Islamic principle: faith is not determined by lineage, ethnicity, or historical proximity, but by sincerity, striving, and receptivity to truth.

The preservation of faith is thus entrusted not to a specific group, but to those who value it, uphold it, and are willing to sacrifice for it. Whenever a community fails in this responsibility, Allah replaces them with others who will carry the trust with greater integrity.

This passage establishes a direct connection between charity and civilizational continuity. Financial sacrifice is not merely an act of personal piety; it is a mechanism through which the mission of faith is sustained across generations. Miserliness, therefore, is not only a moral deficiency, but also a threat to the continuity of divine guidance within a community.

Note: Because this Hadith touches upon the excellence of a specific group, it is important to approach it with scholarly care to ensures proper contextualization and guards against interpretations influenced by modern ethnic or political biases.

5. The Unique Traits of Believers

Surah Al-Fath concludes by defining the essential characteristics of true believers. These traits are not presented in abstraction; rather, they are a direct extension of the character of Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) and are embodied by those who accompanied him.

مُّحَمَّدٌ رَّسُولُ ٱللَّهِۚ وَٱلَّذِينَ مَعَهُۥٓ أَشِدَّآءُ عَلَى ٱلۡكُفَّارِ رُحَمَآءُ بَيۡنَهُمۡۖ تَرَىٰهُمۡ رُكَّعٗا سُجَّدٗا يَبۡتَغُونَ فَضۡلٗا مِّنَ ٱللَّهِ وَرِضۡوَٰنٗاۖ سِيمَاهُمۡ فِي وُجُوهِهِم مِّنۡ أَثَرِ ٱلسُّجُودِۚ ذَٰلِكَ مَثَلُهُمۡ فِي ٱلتَّوۡرَىٰةِۚ وَمَثَلُهُمۡ فِي ٱلۡإِنجِيلِ كَزَرۡعٍ أَخۡرَجَ شَطۡـَٔهُۥ فَـَٔازَرَهُۥ فَٱسۡتَغۡلَظَ فَٱسۡتَوَىٰ عَلَىٰ سُوقِهِۦ يُعۡجِبُ ٱلزُّرَّاعَ لِيَغِيظَ بِهِمُ ٱلۡكُفَّارَۗ وَعَدَ ٱللَّهُ ٱلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُواْ وَعَمِلُواْ ٱلصَّٰلِحَٰتِ مِنۡهُم مَّغۡفِرَةٗ وَأَجۡرًا عَظِيمَۢا (٢٩)

“Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah; and those with him are forceful against the disbelievers, merciful among themselves. You see them bowing and prostrating [in prayer], seeking bounty from Allah and [His] pleasure. Their mark is on their faces from the trace of prostration. That is their description in the Torah. And their description in the Gospel is as a plant which produces its offshoots and strengthens them so they grow firm and stand upon their stalks, delighting the sowers, so that Allah enrages the disbelievers with them. Allah has promised those who believe and do righteous deeds among them forgiveness and a great reward.” (Al-Fath 48:29)

This verse identifies several defining qualities of the Prophet’s companions, and, by extension, the model for all believers:

1. Emotional Intelligence and Moral Balance**:** They possess complementary traits of severity and mercy. They are firm and resolute in the face of opposition to truth, yet deeply compassionate and gentle with one another. Their distinction lies not merely in possessing these traits, but in applying each in its proper context in a manner that pleases Allah.

2. Spiritual Marks (The Torah Description): Their “likeness in the Torah” emphasizes their deep devotion to worship. The “mark” on their faces is not limited to a physical trace, but reflects an inner radiance (*nur*), a manifestation of humility, sincerity, and constant prostration before Allah.

3. Collective Growth and Strength (The Gospel Description): Their “likeness in the Gospel” portrays them as a living organism, growing, strengthening, and stabilizing over time. What began as a small group developed into a cohesive and resilient community. Like a seed that matures into a firm plant, they achieved both numerical growth and structural strength, becoming a source of stability and

a force that both delight those who "sowed" the message and frustrate those who opposed it. This imagery points to the material success and societal stability they achieved.

It is fascinating to see the Quran confirm descriptions found in previous scriptures, anchoring the final message in a long line of revelation:

- The Torah Connection: The concept of a “mark” or distinguishing sign of the righteous appears in passages such as Ezekiel 9:4, where a mark is placed upon the foreheads of the faithful. Similarly, Exodus 34:29–30 describes the radiance of Musa after his communion with the Divine, paralleling the Qur’anic notion of spiritual mark manifesting outwardly.

- The Gospel Connection: The imagery of a growing and strengthening plant closely aligns with the parables attributed to Isa ibn Maryam, such as the Parable of the Growing Seed (Mark 4:26–28) and the Mustard Seed (Matthew 13:31–32). These parables describe a process where something small evolves into a stable and impactful structure, mirroring the Qur’anic depiction of the believers.

Reflections on the Dual Likenesses

The dual reference, to the Torah and the Gospel, presents a comprehensive model of faith:

- The Torah dimension emphasizes the internal state: devotion, humility, and spiritual discipline.
- The Gospel dimension emphasizes the external manifestation: growth, strength, and societal impact.

Together, they establish that true faith is not confined to private worship nor limited to public success. Rather, it is the harmonious integration of both: a deep, sincere connection with the Creator that naturally produces a visible, constructive presence in the world.

6. The Ethics of Information: The Principle of Verification

Surah Al-Hujurat establishes a foundational ethical principle that is uniquely critical in the modern age: the obligation to verify information before accepting, acting upon, or transmitting it. In an era dominated by instant communication and social media, where a single click can reach thousands, the Qur’anic directive serves as a vital safeguard for truth, justice, and social harmony.

Allah provides a clear protocol for handling reports, particularly those that originate from unreliable sources or carry the potential for harm:

يَـٰٓأَيُّهَا ٱلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوٓاْ إِن جَآءَكُمۡ فَاسِقُۢ بِنَبَإٖ فَتَبَيَّنُوٓاْ أَن تُصِيبُواْ قَوۡمَۢا بِجَهَـٰلَةٖ فَتُصۡبِحُواْ عَلَىٰ مَا فَعَلۡتُمۡ نَـٰدِمِينَ (٦)
"O you who have believed, if a disobedient person brings you news, verify it, lest you harm a people out of ignorance and then become regretful over what you have done." (Al-Hujurat 49:6)

Acting upon or sharing unverified information, whether by forwarding a message, reposting a claim, or amplifying a rumor, constitutes a violation of Islamic ethical conduct. The harm caused by misinformation is often irreversible, particularly when it affects the dignity, honor, and reputation of others.

Ironically, while modern technology accelerates the spread of falsehood, it simultaneously provides the tools necessary for verification. Thus, the responsibility upon the believer is not diminished, it is amplified.

This responsibility becomes even more critical in matters involving:

- Slander or Character Assassination**:** Undermining the honor and credibility of individuals.
- Religious Fabrications**:** Attributing statements to the Prophet (PBUH) without verifying their authenticity.

The Qur'anic command (فَتَبَيَّنُوا) (verify thoroughly), focuses on the content of the report, not merely the character of the transmitter. Even if the source is known to be unreliable (fasiq), the obligation remains to investigate the information itself before forming judgment or taking action. This ensures that decisions are grounded in truth rather than reaction.

The Prophet ﷺ established a foundational principle of disciplined speech:
مَن كانَ يُؤمِنُ باللهِ واليَومِ الآخِرِ فليَقُلْ خَيرًا أو ليصمُتْ،
"Whoever believes in Allah and the Last Day, let him speak good or remain silent." (Bukhari and Muslim)

In line with this meaning, it has been wisely said:
مَنْ كَثُرَ كَلامُهُ كَثُرَ سَقْطُهُ ، وَمَنْ كَثُرَ سَقْطُهُ كَثُرَتْ ذُنُوبُهُ ، وَمَنْ كَثُرَتْ ذُنُوبُهُ كَانَتِ النَّارُ أَوْلَى بِهِ
"Whoever speaks excessively will make many mistakes, and whoever makes many mistakes will accumulate many sins. Whoever accumulates many sins, the Fire is more deserving of him."

A Contemporary Reflection
In the digital age, "speech" extends beyond spoken words to include every post, share, comment, and endorsement. Each action becomes a recorded testimony of one's ethical discipline.

Every unverified message contributes to what may be considered "excessive speech," increasing the likelihood of error and the spread of falsehood. The believer, therefore, must adopt a disciplined approach:

- Verify before believing.
- Confirm before sharing.
- Assess benefit before amplifying.

The Qur'anic principle of verification is not merely a guideline, it is a protective system designed to preserve truth, safeguard dignity, and maintain trust within society. In an age overwhelmed by information, it stands as one of the most urgent and practical ethical commands of the Qur'an.

7. The Divine Code of Social Ethics

Beyond the obligation to verify information, Surah Al-Hujurat establishes a comprehensive code of conduct governing interpersonal relationships among believers. These verses prohibit a range of verbal and social offenses that erode trust and fracture the moral fabric of the community, such as ridicule, insult, suspicion, spying, and backbiting.

يَٰٓأَيُّهَا ٱلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُواْ لَا يَسۡخَرۡ قَوۡمٞ مِّن قَوۡمٍ عَسَىٰٓ أَن يَكُونُواْ خَيۡرٗا مِّنۡهُمۡ وَلَا نِسَآءٞ مِّن نِّسَآءٍ عَسَىٰٓ أَن يَكُنَّ خَيۡرٗا مِّنۡهُنَّۖ وَلَا تَلۡمِزُوٓاْ أَنفُسَكُمۡ وَلَا تَنَابَزُواْ بِٱلۡأَلۡقَٰبِۖ بِئۡسَ ٱلِٱسۡمُ ٱلۡفُسُوقُ بَعۡدَ ٱلۡإِيمَٰنِۚ وَمَن لَّمۡ يَتُبۡ فَأُوْلَٰٓئِكَ هُمُ ٱلظَّٰلِمُونَ (١١) يَٰٓأَيُّهَا ٱلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُواْ ٱجۡتَنِبُواْ كَثِيرٗا مِّنَ ٱلظَّنِّ إِنَّ بَعۡضَ ٱلظَّنِّ إِثۡمٞۖ وَلَا تَجَسَّسُواْ وَلَا يَغۡتَب بَّعۡضُكُم بَعۡضًاۚ أَيُحِبُّ أَحَدُكُمۡ أَن يَأۡكُلَ لَحۡمَ أَخِيهِ مَيۡتٗا فَكَرِهۡتُمُوهُۚ وَٱتَّقُواْ ٱللَّهَۚ إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ تَوَّابٞ رَّحِيمٞ (١٢)

"O you who have believed, let not a people ridicule [another] people; perhaps they may be better than them; nor let women ridicule [other] women; perhaps they may be better than them. And do not insult one another and do not call each other by [offensive] nicknames. Wretched is the ungodly name after having believed. And those who do not repent are indeed the wrongdoers. (11) O you who have believed, avoid much suspicion, for indeed, some suspicion is sin. And do not spy or backbite each other. Would one of you like to eat the flesh of his brother when dead? You would detest it. And be conscious of Allah; indeed, Allah is Accepting of repentance and Merciful." (Al-Hujurat 49:11-12)

The Prophet (PBUH) further elaborated on these divine principles through practical and timeless guidance:

1. Self-Correction Over Criticism: The Prophet (PBUH) advised:

طوبى لمن شغله عيبه عن عيوب الناس]]رواه البزار عن أنس بن مالك]

"Glad tidings to the one whose preoccupation with his own faults keeps him from becoming concerned with the faults of others."

A True believer is encouraged to be a "mirror" to himself first. His primary concern is internal refinement, not external fault-finding. Communities deteriorate when individuals become critics of others instead of reformers of themselves.

2. The Sanctity of Privacy: the Prophet (PBUH) taught:

من حسن إسلام المرء تركه ما لا يعنيه [أخرجه الترمذي عن أبي هريرة]

“Part of being a good Muslim is leaving alone what does not concern him.” (Tirmidhi)

In an age of constant exposure and intrusive curiosity, this principle is profoundly relevant. Islam prohibits spying, the deliberate search for the hidden faults or private matters of others, thereby preserving dignity and psychological safety within society.

3. The Severity of Backbiting: When Abu Dharr (RA) asked for a definition of backbiting, the Prophet (PBUH) provided a profound distinction:

يا رسول الله ما الغيبة ؟ قال : ذِكْرك أخاك بما يكره فقال رجل : أرأيتَ إن كان في أخي ما أقول ؟ قال : إن كان فيه ما تقول فقد اغتبته ، وإن لم يكن فيه ما تقول فقد بَهتَّه) أخرجه أبو داود عن أبي هريرة]

البهتان أي الافتراء ، تهمة ليس لها أساس من الصحة ، فهذا بهتان وإفك

"O Messenger of Allah, what is backbiting?"
The Prophet (PBUH) replied: **" Backbiting is mentioning about your brother something he would dislike in his absence."**
Abu Dharr (RA) asked: **"What if what I say is true?"**
The Prophet (PBUH) replied **“If it is true, you have backbitten him. And if it is not true, you have slandered him.” (Reported by Abu Dawood)**

The Qur’anic imagery, likening backbiting to consuming the flesh of one’s dead brother, captures the moral repugnance of this act. It is a violation not only of social ethics but of human dignity itself. Some scholars, including Sayyida Aisha (RA), emphasized its severity by suggesting it could invalidate the spiritual merit of a fast.

4. The Principle of Moral Foresight: It has been narrated that the Prophet ﷺ advised:

جاء رجل إلى النبي صلى الله عليه وسلم فقال: يا رسول الله أوصني, قال: ... وإياك وما يعتذر منه. ورواه الطبراني من حديث ابن عمر.

"Beware of actions that will require you to apologize later." (Al-Tabarani)

This principle introduces a powerful ethical filter: before speaking or acting, one should ask: Will I regret this? Will I need to justify or apologize for it later? If the answer is yes, restraint is the wiser path.

These verses and teachings establish a comprehensive ethical system governing the unseen dimensions of social life, speech, intention, perception, and interaction. While laws regulate outward behavior, these principles refine the inner moral compass that sustains trust, unity, and mutual respect.

A community that upholds these standards protects not only its external stability, but also its internal integrity, ensuring that hearts remain as sound as actions appear.

8. The Divine Metric: Redefining Human Honor

While the previous sections addressed conduct within the community of believers, the Qur'an now broadens the scope to encompass humanity at large. It establishes a universal framework for human relationships, rooted in shared origin, mutual recognition, and a divinely defined standard of honor.

In Surah Al-Hujurat, Allah reminds humanity of its common origin:

(يَـٰٓأَيُّهَا ٱلنَّاسُ إِنَّا خَلَقْنَـٰكُم مِّن ذَكَرٍ وَأُنثَىٰ وَجَعَلْنَـٰكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَآئِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوٓا۟ ۚ إِنَّ أَكْـرَمَكُمْ عِندَ ٱللَّهِ أَتْقَىٰكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ عَلِيمٌ خَبِيرٌ).

"O mankind, indeed, We have created you from a male and a female and made you peoples and tribes so that you may know one another. Verily, the most honorable among you in the sight of Allah is the most in Taqwa among you. Indeed, Allah is All-Knowing, All-Aware." (Al-Hujirat 49:13)

By affirming that all humanity descends from a single pair, Adam and Hawa, the Qur'an dismantles the very foundations of racism, tribal superiority, and social hierarchy. Diversity in nations and tribes is not a cause for division, but a divine design for mutual recognition, understanding, and cooperation. Thus, human differences become a means of enrichment, not conflict.

This verse introduces a revolutionary shift in how value is measured. In worldly life, people compete for wealth, power, beauty, and status. Yet the Qur'an redirects this competition toward a higher and more meaningful objective. Allah declares:

: إِنَّ أَكْرَمَكُمْ عِندَ اللَّهِ أَتْقَاكُمْ

"Indeed, the most honored of you in the sight of Allah is the one with the most Taqwa." (Al-Hujurat 49:13)

If the metric is flawed, then even apparent success is, in reality, failure. The Qur'an replaces superficial measures with a single, universal criterion: Taqwa, a conscious awareness of Allah that shapes both intention and action.

The pursuit of Taqwa operates on two interconnected levels:

- The Outward Dimension: Manifested through Ihsan (excellence) in actions, integrity in dealings, justice in judgment, and compassion in relationships.
- The Inward Dimension**:** Rooted in the purification of the heart. Without sincerity and inner awareness, outward actions lose their true value.

In this Juz, Allah describes the ultimate reward for those who succeed in this divine competition. In Surah Qaf, He portrays the nearness of Paradise to the people of Taqwa:

وَأُزْلِفَتِ ٱلْجَنَّةُ لِلْمُتَّقِينَ غَيْرَ بَعِيدٍ (٣١) ..... مَّنْ خَشِىَ ٱلرَّحْمَـٰنَ بِٱلْغَيْبِ وَجَآءَ بِقَلْبٍ مُّنِيبٍ (٣٣)

“**And Paradise will be brought near to the Muttaqeen not far off. (31) … Who feared Al-Rahman in the unseen and came with a heart turned in repentance.” (Qaf 50: 31, 33)**

At the center of Taqwa lies a heart that constantly returns to Allah. It is a heart that remains spiritually alert, responsive to divine guidance, and quick to repent when it falters. This القلب المنيب "repenting heart" is the engine of transformation. It sustains the believer’s journey, anchoring them in humility, renewing their sincerity, and ensuring that their outward actions remain connected to an inward reality.

The Qur’an thus redefines human honor not as something inherited, acquired, or displayed, but as something cultivated within. It is neither lineage nor achievement that elevates a person, but the depth of their consciousness of Allah.

In a world obsessed with external measures, this divine metric restores balance, reminding humanity that the true scale of worth is known only to Allah.

9. The Certainty of Sustenance (Rizq)

One of the most profound lessons in this Juz is the transformation of how we perceive sustenance (rizq). The Qur’an establishes that provision is not the result of chance, market forces, or human favor, but a matter decreed and secured in the Divine realm.

In Surah Adh-Dhariyat, Allah affirms this reality with a powerful and emphatic oath:

وَفِى ٱلسَّمَآءِ رِزۡقُكُمۡ وَمَا تُوعَدُونَ (٢٢) فَوَرَبِّ ٱلسَّمَآءِ وَٱلۡأَرۡضِ إِنَّهُۥ لَحَقٌّ مِّثۡلَ مَآ أَنَّكُمۡ تَنطِقُونَ (٢٣)
“And in the heaven is your provision and all that that you are promised. (22) By the Lord of the heavens and the earth, it is indeed the truth, as [certain as] the fact that you are speaking”. (Adh-Dhariyat 51:22-23)

The intensity of these verses is striking. Allah does not merely inform us of His provision, He swears by Himself to affirm it. The comparison is equally powerful: just as a person does not doubt their own speech, they should not doubt the certainty of their provision.

When this reality is internalized, it transforms the believer’s worldview. One begins to recognize that while they interact with apparent sources, employers, clients, markets—these are merely means (asbab), not the true source. The ultimate Provider is Allah alone.

This realization liberates the believer from fear-driven compromise. It prevents the sacrifice of principles, dignity, or faith in pursuit of sustenance, because provision is not controlled by creation, it is guaranteed by the Creator.

To better understand how rizq operates in human life, it can be viewed through two complementary categories:

1. Unconditional *Rizq* (The Gift of Life): This includes provisions granted without any effort on our part, such as the air we breathe, the intricate design of our bodies, and the heartbeat that sustains life even before birth. This form of rizq is a direct manifestation of divine mercy, independent of human action.

2. Conditional *Rizq* (The Reward of Striving**):** This includes provisions placed within creation that require human effort to access, such as cultivating crops, extracting resources, or acquiring knowledge for livelihood. Here, effort is required, but it remains only a means, not a guarantee.

While conditional *rizq* necessitates striving, the outcome is never solely determined by effort. The believer operates within a balanced framework:

- The body engages in effort.
- The heart remains attached to Allah.

True reliance (tawakkul) is not the abandonment of effort, but the detachment from dependence on it. The believer works diligently yet understands that success is granted only by Al-Razzaq.

This Qur'anic perspective redefines the relationship between effort and outcome. It instills confidence without arrogance, and reliance without passivity. In a world driven by anxiety over provision, these verses anchor the believer in certainty: What is written for you will reach you, without compromising who you are.

10. The Ultimate Purpose: Stewardship and the Divine Bargain

The Twenty-Sixth Juz culminates in answering the most fundamental question of human existence: Why are we here? The answer is rooted in a relationship that is both humble in its submission and noble in its responsibility.

In Surah Adh-Dhariyat, Allah defines the purpose of creation with unmistakable clarity:

مَا خَلَقْتُ ٱلْجِنَّ وَٱلْإِنسَ إِلَّا لِيَعْبُدُونِ (٥٦) مَآ أُرِيدُ مِنْهُم مِّن رِّزْقٍ وَمَآ أُرِيدُ أَن يُطْعِمُونِ (٥٧)
"And I have not created the jinn and mankind but to worship Me. (56) I do not want from them any provision, nor do I want them to feed Me". (Adh-Dhariyat 51:56-57)

The term ibadah is often translated narrowly as "worship," yet its root "abd" denotes complete belonging and submission to a Master. In the Islamic worldview, to be a slave

(abd) of Allah is not a state of humiliation, but the highest form of honor. It liberates the human being from all false forms of servitude, whether to desires, wealth, status, or societal approval, and redirects the heart toward its only true Master.

This servitude is not one-sided. Allah, in His mercy, presents what may be described as a Divine Bargain: although He is the original Owner of our lives and wealth, He offers to "purchase" them from us in exchange for eternal success. In Surah At-Tawbah, Allah declares:

۞ إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ ٱشۡتَرَىٰ مِنَ ٱلۡمُؤۡمِنِينَ أَنفُسَهُمۡ وَأَمۡوَٰلَهُم بِأَنَّ لَهُمُ ٱلۡجَنَّةَۚ .... (١١١)

"Indeed, Allah has purchased from the believers their lives and their wealth in exchange for Paradise…" (Al-Tawbah 9:111)

This transaction elevates the believer's life into a purposeful offering. Every action, every sacrifice, and every choice becomes part of a conscious covenant with Allah, one whose outcome is guaranteed by the Most Truthful.

To be a true servant of Allah is to be entrusted as a steward (khalifah) upon the earth. This role transforms "ibadah" from passive devotion into active responsibility. It requires the believer to:

- Develop and Cultivate Resources**:** Utilize intellect and capability to explore, refine, and benefit from the resources of the earth.
- Uphold Justice**:** Establish systems that reflect divine justice and remove barriers of oppression that hinder access to truth.
- Pursue Knowledge**:** Engage in science, technology, and industry as acts of worship when aligned with divine purpose.

In this sense, civilization-building itself becomes an expression of "ibadah".

Those who live with this clarity, recognizing that their lives are a "sold property" dedicated to Allah, ascend to the rank of the muhsineen (those who excel in faith and action). Allah describes their reward in Surah Adh-Dhariyat:

إِنَّ ٱلۡمُتَّقِينَ فِي جَنَّٰتٖ وَعُيُونٍ (١٥) ءَاخِذِينَ مَآ ءَاتَىٰهُمۡ رَبُّهُمۡۚ إِنَّهُمۡ كَانُواْ قَبۡلَ ذَٰلِكَ مُحۡسِنِينَ (١٦)

"Indeed, those who have Taqwa will be in gardens and springs, (15) Receiving what their Lord has given them. Indeed, they were before that Mohsineen. (Al-Dhariyat 51:15-16)

To give one's life and wealth to Allah is not a loss, it is the ultimate realization of their true value. What is offered to the Divine is never diminished; it is elevated, preserved, and returned in a form far greater than what was given.

Conclusion:

As we reflect upon the Jewels of the Twenty-Sixth Juz, a unifying theme emerges with clarity and force: the Sovereignty of Allah and the sincerity of human response.

We have seen that Allah is the ultimate Provider, Al-Razzaq, yet He commands us to strive in His cause, not out of need, but as a test of our sincerity. He is the true Owner of our lives and wealth, yet He offers to “purchase” them from us in exchange for Paradise. This is the essence of the supreme success, the realization that everything we possess is a trust, and every moment is an opportunity to fulfill that trust.

From the most subtle act, restraining the tongue from spreading a rumor, to the most visible, establishing justice, building communities, and cultivating the earth, every action becomes an expression of ibadah. In this way, life itself is transformed into a continuous act of devotion.

By aligning our character with these divine instructions, we rise from being mere inhabitants of the earth to becoming true stewards (khulafa) of its message. Our interactions reflect our faith, our ethics preserve our communities, and our efforts contribute to a higher purpose.

The promise of Allah is true. And for those who return to Him with a sincere and ever-turning heart (qalb munib), the end is not merely success, but an eternal bliss that neither fades nor diminishes.

Jewels from the Twenty Seventh Juz:

(Ibrahim 14:53 – Al-Nahl 16:128)

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Jewels from the Twenty Eighth Juz:

(Al-Nahl 16:129 – Al-Kahf 18:83)

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About the Author

Dr. Mamdouh M. Salama is a Life Fellow of the American Society of Mechanical Engineers (ASME) and a retired Senior Engineering Fellow from a major oil company. He earned his B.S. in Mechanical Engineering with highest distinction in Egypt, followed by M.S. and Sc.D. degrees from the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT).

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Beyond engineering, Dr. Salama is an active speaker at Islamic centers in Houston, where he delivers Friday khutbahs and weekend lectures. He has authored articles on Islam in various newspapers and given talks to both Muslim and non-Muslim audiences.

He is the author of the following books:

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- Tadabbur of the Quran through the Lens of Key Terms
- Guided by Divine Purpose – Your Life in Light of Eternity

He is currently working on several new books drawn from his lectures, including:

- From Al-Fatiha to An-Nas: The Central Theme of Every Surah
- The Qur’an: A Blueprint for Civilization and Salvation
- The Memoirs of the Prophet (PBUH)
- The Companions of the Prophet (PBUH)

These works reflect his dedication to bridging scholarly insight and spiritual reflection through the guidance of the Qur’an and Prophetic teachings.